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1 diocese still resists naming priests

Worcester bishop's stance on accused abusers angers survivors

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

For years, Worcester Bishop Robert McManus has balked at disclosing the names of all the priests in his diocese who had been credibly accused of abusing children, standing alone in opposition among the state's four Catholic leaders.

Now, McManus is under pressure to publicly release the names of every accused priest following a withering state report this week on sexual abuse by hundreds of Catholic clergy in Massachusetts.

In her blockbuster report released Wednesday, Attorney General Andrea Campbell found 90 clergy who had been accused of abuse in the Worcester diocese and 216 survivors, although she cautioned that investigators had not assessed the accusations for credibility.

Campbell, as well as survivors and watchdog groups, said disclosing their names is an important driver for healing and institutional accountability.

"It's been business as usual: Protect the church at all costs," said Dave Lewcon, 72, who said he was sexually abused as a teenager by a priest at St. Mary's Church in Uxbridge, which is in the Worcester diocese.

But the 75-year-old McManus has yet to waver from his decision to keep the names private.

He has, however, noted that the diocese in recent years reported every allegation to law enforcement and that church officials publish information on the diocesan website about every priest who has been placed on leave due to a credible report of abuse or who has been removed from clerical duties.

A spokesperson for McManus, Ray Delisle, added that "we will study the AG's report to identify any additional improvements that can be made to respond to victims of past abuse and to continue to

WORCESTER, Page A6

Wealthy back question on primaries — but why?

Their foes say it's all about money, but supporters point to idealistic reasons

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

The campaign to get rid of Massachusetts' partisan primaries has a fairly consistent type of donor.

There's $250,000 in contributions from John Connaughton, the chairman of Bain Capital, one of the world's largest investment firms. Andrew Balson, a former Bain executive who started his own private equity firm, has given nearly $800,000, while Mark Nunnelly, another Bain alum, has chipped in a half-million dollars.

David "Randy" Peeler, who for years held a top position at Berkshire Partners, another private equity firm, has contributed more than $1 million.

They are part of a cohort of wealthy individuals with ties to various investment, private equity, and venture capital firms who have collectively contributed millions to the campaign pushing the ballot question. The donations have made the Coalition for Healthy Democracy the top-funded ballot question campaign this election cycle, though it is unclear why they are contributing in such large amounts.

Nearly $500,000 has flowed from those who identified as working for Bain Capital, records show. Another $250,000 came from others at Berkshire Partners beyond Peeler, who is listed as a senior adviser there. All told, the commit-

DONORS, Page A5

AVENUE OF BROKEN TRUST

A welcome, yet feared, development

No one's quite sure what an improved Blue Hill Ave. would mean, but businesses in Black Boston wonder if they'll find themselves pushed out

TOP: SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF; ABOVE: JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

At top, Skye Warren is aiming to move her beauty business to Mattapan, where her roots are. Getting funding hasn't been easy. Above, Rafael Diaz waited for his car in an area owned by the Stamatos family, one of the biggest property owners on Blue Hill Avenue.

Third in a series.

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Skye Warren grew up just off Blue Hill Avenue in Mattapan, within walking distance of a roller skating rink and a pizza place. Her short one-way street was the site of blow-out block parties where she and her friends performed dance routines and bands performed on a stage set up in front of her house. That brick-red triple decker, purchased by her grandparents in the 1960s, was the center of her family's universe, the north star guiding everyone home.

Today Warren, 31, is trying to make her way back. She owns a beauty business in Milton but is trying to buy a commercial space to move it to a few blocks from her childhood home. Doing so would put her in a prime position: owning property on Blue Hill Avenue before it gets a $164 million injection to revitalize the long-neglected commercial corridor linking Mattapan, Dorchester, and Roxbury.

Putting down roots in a neighborhood Warren's family has lived in for generations, closer to her clients' and employees' homes, is about more than being a property owner: It's about investing in the Black community.

BLUE HILL AVENUE, Page A7

Putting the state's energy future into words

JON CHESTO

COMMENTARY

Here we go again. The business and environmental lobbies are at odds on Beacon Hill — and this time the fight's over a tiny, blink-and-you'll-miss-it section in a 170-page energy bill.

The controversial measure in question, approved by the Senate, would give legal cover to utilities to end natural gas service if they're directed to do so by state regulators, as long as alternatives exist. What alternatives? While geothermal is an option, we're mostly talking about electric heat.

Forcing people to switch from gas to electricity for heat, business leaders argue, gets expensive quickly because of conversion costs. The environmentalists disagree, particularly when factoring in the upkeep of the gas system, and claim a 2024 energy law already gives state officials this power anyway. The issue revolves around the state's "obligation to serve" that has blocked utilities from ending service to existing gas customers without their consent.

ENERGY, Page A6

Sox caught resting on their laurels

Easing up on the gas in September left them sluggish when it counted

FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS

It was a familiar sight over the two nights — a Red Sox player trudging back to the dugout after striking out.

PETER ABRAHAM

COMMENTARY

You know that feeling when you show up for work on Monday after a vacation? That's how the Red Sox looked against the Yankees in the American League Wild Card Series.

A step slow and lacking energy; like everybody was waiting for tech support to reset their password so they could get back to work.

It showed up on the scoreboard at Yankee Stadium with a 9-0 loss in Game 1 on Tuesday and a season-ending 9-2 loss in Game 2 on Wednesday.

The Yankees scored 18 runs over 16 innings without star slugger Aaron Judge in their lineup. The Red Sox bullpen allowed 15 of those runs.

Offensively, the Red Sox struck out 19 times in 60 plate appearances and had four extra-base hits, three of them by Willson Contreras.

ABRAHAM, Page C4

A woman was killed and two people were injured when a vehicle crashed into a building on the campus of Brigham and Women's Faulkner Hospital. **B1.**

A judge denied Lindsay Clancy's request for a directed verdict of not guilty, ruling that prosecutors presented sufficient evidence for a jury to find her criminally responsible. **B1.**

A woman was in critical condition after a failed attempt to execute her pushed Tennessee's governor to halt further executions this year. **A2.**

A federal lawsuit was filed against DraftKings, alleging it uses predatory AI models that promote gambling addiction for profit. **B5.**

Sunscreen time

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The Nation

Woman in hospital after botched execution

Tenn. governor orders inquiry

By Kim Chandler and Kristin M. Hall
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NASHVILLE, Tenn. — Christa Pike was in critical condition Thursday and receiving "lifesaving care" at a hospital, her lawyers said, a day after a failed attempt to execute her pushed Tennessee's governor to halt further executions this year and order an independent review.

Pike, who was sentenced to death for a 1995 murder, was taken to a hospital Wednesday night after surviving a double dose of the drug Tennessee uses to execute prisoners.

"We don't have a sense of her prognosis or much update on her health at the moment," attorney Randy Spivey said during a news conference. "But we know she is alive right now."

The failed execution, which one death penalty expert described as unprecedented, led Governor Bill Lee to order a review, calling what happened "deeply disturbing" and indefinitely postponing Pike's execution and another one that had been scheduled for this year. It also reignited the debate over the state's execution procedures, including its single-drug lethal injections.

Spivey called the process cruel and torturous, saying he was "haunted" by watching and hearing Pike talking, singing, and then snoring loudly during her more than 90 minutes in the death chamber. Her attorneys also said it was unclear if she might have suffered brain damage from being deprived of oxygen.

May Martinez, whose daughter was murdered by Pike and her boyfriend and who traveled to Nashville to watch the execution, was also upset.

"I didn't get justice for my daughter," Martinez said Thursday.

"I watched the whole thing. She was awake. She was laughing. She was moving her head, moving her feet. She was trying to sit up," Martinez said. "Didn't work the first time they gave her a shot. It didn't work the second time."

The execution team worked for an hour to administer the lethal drugs, said Pike's attorney, who counted at least seven needles in her left arm.

During the struggle to locate a vein, Pike even suggested where they might find one, he said.

"Please try here, please try here," Spivey recalled her saying. "She told them over and over, please try higher on my shoulder."

At one point, Pike asked prison officials if her arm was supposed to feel that way, though it's unclear if it was after the first dose entered her body because officials don't share that information.

Neither the initial nor backup dose of pentobarbital worked. Pike was still snoring when the execution chamber's microphone was cut off more than an hour into the attempt.

Another of Pike's attorneys, Steve Ferrell, said she feared there would be complications because of a lifelong blood disorder that made it tough to get needles into her veins.

It was quite possible, Ferrell said, that the IV line didn't enter her vein properly and that the drug was filling her arm instead of entering her bloodstream.

Pike's lawyers now want her death sentence to be commuted. Now age 50, she was sentenced to death for a murder she committed at 18. She would have been the first woman executed in Tennessee in more than 200 years.

An appeals court had stopped her execution an hour before it was scheduled to begin Wednesday morning, but the US Supreme Court overturned that stay hours later.

It was the second time this year that Tennessee was unable to complete an execution. In the other case, officials couldn't find a suitable vein for an IV line so the drugs weren't administered.

Lee said it appeared that prison staff followed procedure, and that there was no clear sense Thursday about what went wrong.

Pentobarbital, the barbiturate Tennessee uses for executions, has been used to carry out death sentences in multiple states and by the federal government. But there have been concerns raised about the potential for "unnecessary pain and suffering."

GEORGE WALKER IV/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Media witnesses to the failed execution recounted the moments in Tennessee's death chamber.

Justices to review migrant detention

Policy departs from past practice

By Ann E. Marimow
NEW YORK TIMES

The Supreme Court on Thursday agreed to review the Trump administration's policy of indefinitely detaining immigrants who crossed the border illegally years ago, signaling the court plans to weigh in on major pieces of President Trump's aggressive deportation agenda as it begins its new term Monday.

The policy is a departure from past practice, when such migrants were generally allowed an opportunity to seek release after a hearing before a judge.

The justices previously announced that they would fast-track a separate case testing the administration's policy of deporting immigrants to countries where they have no ties, including nations that have faced allegations of human rights abuses.

Between the two cases, the justices will consider the legality of some of the most controversial aspects of the Trump administration's efforts to rapidly expel millions of migrants living in the United States.

The justices also added two other cases to the docket of issues they will hear and decide by next June.

One is a Kentucky case about whether a federal religious discrimination law protects a group of Catholic priests who want to build a shrine to the Virgin Mary over neighbors' objections. The other is a divorce dispute over military benefits originating in North Dakota.

The immigration case the court accepted Thursday involved noncitizens who entered the United States illegally but had been living in the country for years. For decades, such people could be released on bond pending additional court proceedings, so long as they were not found to be a threat to public safety or a flight risk.

But last year, the Trump administration announced a new interpretation of a 1996 law, concluding it allowed noncitizens living in the United States to be held without bond. As a result, immigration judges have denied hearings to people, even if they have been living and working in the United States for years.

More than 500 district court judges and nine of 11 federal appeals courts to consider the issue have rejected the administration's new detention rule and its interpretation of the immigration law at issue.

About 70,000 people are currently in immigration detention across the United States, up from 40,000 before Trump took office in January 2025.

More than two-thirds of immigrants in the country illegally have lived in the United States for at least a decade.

Most of the appeals courts to consider the issue have said the government should have provided hearings to determine whether they posed a danger to others or a flight risk pending the completion of removal proceedings.

In April, the 2nd US District Court of Appeals sided with a Brazilian citizen, Ricardo Aparecido Barbosa Da Cunha, who has lived in the United States for about 20 years.

He was arrested by federal agents on his way to work in Massachusetts, where he owns a construction business and a home with his wife, also a Brazilian citizen, and their two children, who are US citizens.

He crossed the US border with Mexico in 2004, applied for asylum in 2016, and was granted a work permit. He had not previously been detained and has no known criminal history.

In its decision, the appeals court noted that Congress had never challenged the settled practice of releasing certain migrants on bond despite making major changes to immigration law.

DAILY BRIEFING

Miami rapper facing domestic battery charge

MIAMI BEACH, Fla. — Rapper Rick Ross was arrested in Miami Beach early Thursday and charged with battery related to a domestic violence accusation, authorities said.

Ross, whose legal name is William Roberts II, faces a felony charge of battery by strangulation, as well as a misdemeanor battery charge, according to online court records.

An attorney for Ross, 50, said in a statement that Ross is being wrongfully accused by an ex-girlfriend whose true motivations are unclear.

"The ex did not even file a police report until a month after the claimed incident allegedly took place," defense attorney Steve Sadow said in the statement. "Mr. Roberts is innocent and has pled not guilty to the charges. He respectfully requests that his friends, fans, and the general public not prejudge the situation and allow the judicial process to run its course."

Jail records showed that Ross was being held Thursday morning on $5,000 bail. An arraignment is scheduled for Oct. 22.

Ross is a longtime South Florida resident who gained prominence in 2006 with his debut single "Hustlin'."

The rapper and entrepreneur helped put Miami on the musical map in the early 2000s, when most hip-hop fans looked to Atlanta and Houston as Southern rap headquarters. "Hustlin'" was certified platinum twice by the Recording Industry Association of America (RIAA) and sparked a bidding war for Ross. He eventually signed with Def Jam Records, headed by Jay-Z.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

SAUL LOEB/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

ARCH RIVALS — Demonstrators protested Thursday against President Trump's planned "triumphal arch" at Memorial Circle in Washington, D.C. The proposed giant structure along the Potomac River near the Arlington National Cemetery is part of Trump's drive to put his personal stamp on the capital.

Toddler brings gun to day care

CANTON TOWNSHIP, Mich. — The parents of a 3-year-old Detroit-area boy who had a loaded gun in his backpack at a day care were charged with misdemeanor crimes Thursday as prosecutors also revealed the firearm was passed to other children before a staff member intervened.

The gun was not fired, and no one was injured.

"It is very unsettling to think about what may have happened in this case," Wayne County prosecutor Kym Worthy said.

One parent was charged with violating Michigan's gun storage law, while the other parent, a Detroit-area police officer, was charged with creating a risk of harm, which is fourth-degree child abuse. They appeared in court and were released on bond.

The gun was in a holster Monday when the boy pulled it from a backpack at Childrens World Early Learning Center in Canton Township and shared it with other children, the prosecutor's office said. It was not the officer's work weapon.

Under state law, firearms must be locked up at home when children are present.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Two killed in Calif. helicopter crash

A medical helicopter transporting a patient crashed off Catalina Island near Los Angeles, killing two people and leaving two hospitalized, authorities said Thursday.

Rescuers continued searching Thursday for a fifth person who was aboard the aircraft and went missing after the Wednesday night crash.

The Coast Guard, area firefighters, and divers with the Los Angeles County Sheriff's Department were among emergency personnel who worked through the night, Coast Guard Captain Stacey Crecy said.

"We're still doing an active search for the person who's missing, and then, in addition to that, the divers and the remote operated vehicle are going to get a look at more of the wreckage and hopefully if there's a sunken fuselage ... we're hoping to get a better picture of that this morning," Crecy said.

The cause of the crash was not immediately clear. Crecy said the helicopter went down shortly after takeoff and hit the water a short distance from the island.

Authorities were working on identifying the victims, she said.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Four astronauts launched to International Space Station

CAPE CANAVERAL, Fla. — Four astronauts rocketed into orbit Thursday on a space station mission that will stretch until spring, among them a Canadian whose wife will give birth while he's away.

SpaceX launched commander Jessica Watkins and her crew for NASA after a three-week delay to fix the Dragon capsule's leaking fuel system. Thick clouds threatened to halt the countdown, but in the end, the skies cleared enough to allow for a safe liftoff.

Although their stay at the International Space Station will last a long six months, the flight there promised to be the quickest yet for Elon Musk's company: a mere eight-hour transit with an arrival well before bedtime.

With the late morning liftoff from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station, Watkins became the first Black woman to lead a crew to orbit. A geologist who worked with NASA's Mars rover Curiosity a decade ago, Watkins is making her second trip to the space station following a lengthy stay in 2022.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

JOHN RAOUX/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Astronaut Joshua Kutryk, pilot Luke Delaney, commander Jessica Watkins, and cosmonaut Sergey Teteryatnikov.

The World

MANISH SWARUP/ASSOCIATED PRESS

PROTESTERS HELD — Exiled Tibetans shouted slogans from a police vehicle after being detained during a protest outside the Chinese Embassy in New Delhi, India, on Thursday, China's National Day. The day commemorates the formal founding of the People's Republic of China in 1949.

Trump warns Iran over cockpit attack

President hints at Tehran link; motive unclear

By Melanie Lidman and Samy Magdy
ASSOCIATED PRESS

JERUSALEM — President Trump said Thursday that if Iran is linked to the copilot who tried to crash an Israel-bound flight, the Islamic Republic would be struck "very hard" for the attempt on the lives of more than 180 people aboard the jet.

Trump issued the warning as investigators worked to determine why the copilot stabbed the flight's captain, causing the FlyDubai plane to plummet before others on board stopped the attack and landed the airliner in Saudi Arabia.

The president was asked by reporters at the White House whether he had been briefed about any links between the pilot behind the attack and Tehran. He said, "We're working on it right now."

"I would say the answer, based on what I'm hearing, is yes, but we're working on it right now," Trump said. He did not elaborate about why he suspects Iran might be involved.

Asked if the US would retaliate against Tehran if it was behind the attack, Trump said, "Oh they'll be hit, very hard, don't worry."

"You just ask them," he added. "They know what happened. They'll be hit very hard."

His remarks came as diplomatic efforts to end the war appear to have stalled.

Iranian officials indicated Wednesday that they received an official US response to their latest proposal to end the seven-month war, which Trump had publicly rejected just days earlier. The officials did not say what the response contained and whether it was a rejection.

Trump said in a Time magazine interview published Thursday that he will not accept proposals from Iran that "he wouldn't have approved a year ago," and left open the possibility of resuming bombing after the Nov. 3 US election.

Meanwhile, the American military has dispatched roughly 9,000 troops aboard a group of ships to the Middle East, a US official said Thursday. That could mean three carriers will be in the region as soon as late October, according to the official, who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive military operations.

Despite Trump's public rebuff, mediators have continued working with Iran and the US to try to broker a deal to end the fighting and open the Strait of Hormuz, according to officials who were not authorized to comment publicly and spoke on condition of anonymity.

Passengers on the plane — which was carrying 182 people, mostly Israelis, from the United Arab Emirates to Tel Aviv — have described how the bloodied Indian captain managed to open the cockpit door to let them in before they grappled with the copilot and stabilized a descent so sharp that the plane's rudder was torn away.

ERIK MARMOR/GETTY IMAGES

FlyDubai passengers were greeted by crowds of supporters upon arriving at Ben Gurion Airport Wednesday in Israel.

"We felt helpless, suspended in midair, and I didn't know who to turn to. But it was all instinct to survive," Asaf Rajuan, who was among those who intervened, said in a statement shared by Israel's presidency.

A regional official briefed on the investigation said the suspect, an Omani citizen, was under arrest and confirmed that Saudi authorities were working with countries, including Israel, to try to determine a motive. He said the UAE, the United States, and Oman also were involved. Saudi Arabia said the copilot had been handed over to the UAE.

"All possible scenarios, from terrorism to mental disorders, are being looked into. Nothing is ruled out for now," said the official, speaking on condition of anonymity.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, without giving details, claimed the attacker underwent Islamist indoctrination. Asked who helped radicalize him, the prime minister told Fox News channel's "Fox and Friends" he did not know.

When asked by AP how the prime minister knew the copilot underwent indoctrination, Netanyahu's office said it would not comment.

Netanyahu told Fox that the suspect apparently got through a loophole in Israeli aviation rules that normally bar pilots from flying to Israel if they are from countries that do not have diplomatic relations with Israel, which Oman does not.

The copilot has not been publicly identified. Video shot inside the plane by Dr. Shota Musayev, a dentist who treated the captain, shows the copilot on his knees, with his hands tied behind his back.

Captain Smit Machchhar, widely praised as one of the heroes of the flight, was recovering in the Emirati capital of Abu Dhabi, the Indian government said Thursday.

It was not clear what the copilot used as a weapon.

Israeli intelligence and security officials were in Saudi Arabia to help investigate the copilot, according to another regional official who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak to the media.

Israel has requested that the copilot be sent to Israel for the investigation, though it was unclear if that request would be granted, the official said.

Saudi Arabia does not have formal diplomatic ties with Israel, but the countries have long cooperated on security and intelligence matters.

Terror at 30,000 feet: plumber and dentist to the rescue

Passengers tell how they saved plummeting jet

By Cara Anna
ASSOCIATED PRESS

JERUSALEM — A captain, despite being stabbed, managed to open the cockpit door. A dentist and other passengers wrestled with a violent copilot. A plumber seized the controls as the plane plunged toward the desert — all helping save the 182 people aboard the Israel-bound flight.

"Hollywood isn't creative enough to come up with stories like this!" said Mike Huckabee, the US ambassador to Israel.

Although major questions remained unanswered on Thursday about the attacker and his motive, the story of ordinary passengers saving the FlyDubai flight from disaster has quickly become the stuff of legend.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu warmly embraced plumber Yaniv Hayoun shortly after the passengers arrived in Tel Aviv late on Wednesday. He later posted a five-star review of Hayoun's professional services, calling him "a hero who has saved many lives."

"He can help you too — I highly recommend him!" Netanyahu added on X.

Hayoun was among several Israelis recommended for the Presidential Award for Civilian Heroism, while Indian Captain Smit Machchhar was called "a HERO" by Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Many of the details emerged in a rush shortly after the passengers, most of them Israeli, landed back home to cheers and waving flags.

Hayoun, apologizing for his bloody shirt, within minutes was telling the prime minister and journalists what happened.

There had been little time for him and the others to think. Passengers screamed after spotting the copilot stabbing the captain, and the flight from Dubai, in the United Arab Emirates, to the Israeli city of Tel Aviv began a steep dive. Some believed they were about to die.

A handful of Israelis reacted, hurtling up the aisle after the badly wounded captain managed to open the cockpit door. That was crucial, as cockpit doors are typically locked to prevent hijackings.

They had to struggle, Hayoun said, with the captain's body resting against it.

Hayoun said the copilot appeared to be trying to damage the plane's controls. He grabbed the copilot, and others began struggling with the man.

Hayoun then tackled the controls. He had no training, but he remembered what he had seen in movies.

"I asked him, how did you know how to do that? And he said, 'Well, I, I watched these air disaster films,'" Netanyahu told Fox News on Thursday.

It was not clear who among the passengers had security experience, though military service is compulsory for most men and women in Israel.

Crew who had been traveling on the plane stepped in to stabilize it, issuing a mayday call and seeking a place to land.

ISRAEL'S FOREIGN MINISTRY/AFP

Captain Smit Machchhar, who was stabbed before opening the cockpit, was called a hero by Narendra Modi, India's prime minister.

"He managed to stabilize the plane by the skin of his teeth," another Israeli praised for intervening, Asaf Rajuan, told journalists. Aviation experts have marveled that the plane didn't crash after a descent so sharp that the rudder was torn away.

The handful of Israeli passengers grappled with the copilot for several minutes before subduing him and binding his hands with the cord from a set of headphones.

One of them, Dr. Shota Musayev, a dentist, also attended to the captain, who appeared to have lost a lot of blood. "He was just praying the whole time and was in contact with me, and I was afraid we would really lose him," Musayev said.

Musayev later told journalists he and the other responders knew they'd had just seconds to act before a "critical event."

But even with the copilot bound and subdued, they were scared that other attackers might be on the plane. They sent other people around the cabin to stand by.

"We didn't know where we were going to land. Underneath us there was only desert. We were afraid that they were taking us to a hostile country," Rajuan said. "We didn't know who to trust."

Finally, just about an hour after the plane issued a distress call, it made an emergency landing in Saudi Arabia.

DAILY BRIEFING

UK-Iranian national arrested in alleged plot

LONDON — Police on Thursday arrested a dual UK-Iranian national on suspicion of plotting a terror attack following a security incident at a US-run military air base in England that British authorities have linked to Tehran.

The 27-year-old man was arrested in central London on Thursday, and police have searched two properties in the UK capital, Counter Terrorism Policing said in a statement.

A 26-year-old British national was interviewed by police "under caution," which means the interview was recorded and can be used in future prosecutions.

Five men, all British nationals in their 20s and from London, were arrested in the early hours of Sunday on suspicion of explosives and terror offenses close to the RAF Fairford air base, which has been used by American bombers to strike Iran. The suspects have since been released on bail.

Scores of residents were evacuated from their homes near the base as armed police officers and army bomb-disposal experts swooped on the rural area.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kidnappings by violent gangs on rise in Haiti

PORT-AU-PRINCE — Kidnappings are on the rise in Haiti, with gangs increasingly targeting high-profile people and launching mass abductions as the country pushes to hold long-awaited presidential elections.

At least 81 people were reported kidnapped between April and June alone, a 42 percent increase compared with the first quarter of the year, according to UN statistics. Those abducted include James Boyard, police inspector general and cabinet director of Haiti's Defense Ministry. He was kidnapped during broad daylight in June from Bourdon, a Port-au-Prince neighborhood considered relatively safe. He has not been released.

Also kidnapped are well-known attorney Caleb Jean-Baptiste and Stéphanie Paultre, director general of Haiti's National Office for Educational Partnerships, according to local media reports.

The kidnappings come as Haiti prepares to hold general elections for the first time in more than a decade.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Court grants legal protection to human voice

TOKYO — A Tokyo court has awarded legal protection to the human voice in a landmark case in which a popular Japanese anime voice actor demanded that TikTok close an account over its unauthorized use of an artificial intelligence clone of his trademark baritone.

The Tokyo District Court's decision Wednesday was the first acknowledgment of the right to one's voice in Japan. The ruling was good news for many anime voice actors at a time when they are increasingly concerned about the use of AI-generated versions of their voices.

The plaintiff, Kenjiro Tsuda, is an actor best known for his "lustrous and deep" voice in starring characters such as Kento Nanami in "Jujutsu Kaisen," a popular anime series.

In his lawsuit, Tsuda said that the anonymous operator of the TikTok account "Nanami" wrongfully profited by attracting viewers with his voice narrating in more than 180 videos about urban legends and paranormal phenomena, and asked for the material to be deleted.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Cornell police statement omitted claim of rape

Prosecutor was not informed of key assertion

By Hurubie Meko
NEW YORK TIMES

At a campus police department Nov. 14, 2024, a Cornell University sophomore detailed how she found herself naked in a fraternity house nearly a month before, with a "ring of men" around her. She was drunk and had been given ketamine, she said. Her phone was across the room.

"There was really no escape," she said.

The woman spoke for hours with an officer, telling him how what began as a consensual sexual encounter with a man she liked spiraled into a prolonged drug-fueled attack by several men inside the Chi Phi fraternity house.

"I don't remember the very end of the event where I was raped," she told them. "I can say with 100 percent confidence I was raped."

The officer then condensed the interview into a six-page "voluntary statement" written from her perspective, according to documents obtained by The New York Times. The student, after leaving about 20 handwritten corrections on a draft, signed a final version the next day.

While the shorter statement explained that she felt some of that night's events were a crime, it omitted some of the more forceful and definitive language she used. And it was missing her unequivocal statement that she had been raped. The omission, which for a time seemed to end the case, instead now appears to have only delayed a case that has roiled the campus and renewed the national debate how colleges handle claims of sexual assault.

That condensed statement was shared with the district attorney, Matthew Van Houten, who decided there was not enough evidence to bring criminal charges against the seven men. It looked like the case was over.

Van Houten's decision in 2024 largely transpired quietly, through a process that is often shielded from public scrutiny. Cornell, though, conducted its own investigation. That investigation, which the Times has reviewed, concluded months after the woman dropped out of Cornell because of the incident.

Then last month the woman, as Jane Doe, filed a lawsuit against Cornell, the seven men, the fraternity, and her sorority. The lawsuit ricocheted online, plunging the university into a crisis and landing Van Houten's office in a maelstrom of criticism. Many in the public, including politicians and celebrities, began questioning what law enforcement officials knew about the woman's allegations two years ago and why a criminal case was never pursued.

The men have not been charged criminally, and during the university investigation the men almost universally denied the accusations against them and said any sex that took place was consensual. Several of the men suggested that Jane Doe had not only initiated the sexual encounters, but in some cases, had done so without asking.

Van Houten has defended his office's decision and said he wants to meet with the woman this week as he considers bringing new evidence to a grand jury.

In a nine-page public statement Monday, Van Houten said the statement the woman provided at the time did not "allege she was drugged against her will or gang raped."

"On the contrary, Jane Doe's statement described her participation in drug and sexual conduct as voluntary, conscious, and consensual," he wrote.

But in the documents reviewed by the Times, the Cornell police did not inform Van Houten's office that Jane Doe had said she had been raped. It's unclear what other conversations the police and district attorney's office had about the case.

On Nov. 25, the officer who took Jane Doe's statement filed a document and said he contacted an investigator in the district attorney's office to talk.

The officer reported that he was told, based on a review of Jane Doe's statement, that the prosecutor's office had decided that "criminal charges would not be pursued in this case."

"Nothing further at this time," he wrote.

ESTEBAN FELIX/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Between July and August, Chile recorded record rainfall in several regions; the precipitation was driven by a super El Niño.

A sea of wildflowers in the driest desert

Heavy rains bring rare blooms to Chile's Atacama

By Nayara Batschke
ASSOCIATED PRESS

THE ATACAMA DESERT, Chile — Spring has finally arrived in the Southern Hemisphere and, in Chile, even the desert is blossoming.

Known as the driest nonpolar desert on Earth, a massive portion of the Atacama Desert has been covered in flowers after the El Niño weather pattern brought heavy rains to the region earlier this year. The unusually large amount of water allowed millions of seeds and bulbs to sprout and bloom, many of them after remaining dormant for decades.

"It is a unique phenomenon; there are more than 200 plant species," said Jorge Carabantes, head of the Protected Areas Department at the National Forest Corporation. "This is a flowering event that is obviously extraordinary and unusual, very different from other blooms that occur elsewhere on the globe."

The Atacama lies between the Pacific Ocean and the Andes Mountains, stretching some 1,000 miles all the way down the northern coast of Chile.

Although flowering is common during the transition from winter to spring, this year the rocky, brownish dunes that make up the desert's traditional landscape have turned into a vibrant, colorful carpet of wildflowers during a historic Desierto Florido, or "flowering desert."

"I always thought it was just going to be brown. That's my image of a desert, just brown," said Felix Banda, 51, who was born in Chile but has lived his whole life in Australia. "I knew that it had rained a lot, so I was expecting to see some beautiful greenery, but this is an incredible landscape," he added about his first visit to the Atacama.

Between July and August, Chile recorded record rainfall in several regions, with some levels never seen since measurements began in the 1950s. The heavy precipitation was driven by a super El Niño, a climate phenomenon that causes sharp rises in global temperatures and is becoming increasingly strong.

"Since rainfall records began, these are the most significant figures in terms of volume: 160, 180, 190 millimeters (6 to 7 inches) in some locations," explained biologist César Pizarro, head of the Biodiversity Conservation Section at CONAF Atacama. "What has happened now has an origin, and it is called 'super El Niño.'"

The storms have caused flooding, havoc, and devastation in several parts of Chile. In the north, they have also enabled the historic desert bloom, with an estimated coverage of some 6,560 square miles this year. This area is similar in size to the Santiago Metropolitan Region, the country's largest and most populous area.

According to CONAF projections, this is expected to be the most intense and extensive Desierto Florido since 1997.

That's because, Pizarro said, the heavy rainfall activated the desert's biological material, known as germplasm. This includes seeds, bulbs, and tubers but also the eggs of various invertebrates and reptiles.

The result is a true visual spectacle featuring more than 200 species of plants and flowers in a variety of colors, shapes, and forms. Red and yellow ñañucas, purple rock purslane, white suspiros, orange terciopelos and the native garra de león, one of the desert's most iconic species, have transformed the hills, plains and ravines of the Atacama.

"There are hills and mountain ranges where no greenery or flowers had been seen for more than 30 or 40 years," Pizarro added. "This desert germplasm can remain (dormant) for many years, even decades."

Whether arriving from within Chile or overseas, tourists are venturing into the remote, inhospitable areas of the Atacama to admire the millions of flowers adorning vast areas of the desert, stretching from the coast to the horizon.

Russia to increase war budget, cuts to social programs

Military takes up over one-third of planned spending

By Ivan Nechepurenko
NEW YORK TIMES

The Kremlin plans to sharply increase spending on the war in Ukraine, even at the cost of ballooning debt, cuts to health care and other social programs, and higher taxes, according to a draft 2027 budget made public Wednesday.

Russia and Ukraine are engaged in a war of attrition that, beyond deadly fighting on the front lines, includes an intense battle to cripple each other's economies. As the war approaches its fifth anniversary, both sides are finding it increasingly difficult to finance the conflict.

Ukraine has targeted Russian fuel refineries, causing lines at gas stations. As the attacks cut Russian oil output, Moscow has been unable to fully take advantage of an increase in global oil prices caused by the war in Iran. Kyiv has also been striking Russian e-commerce giants, disrupting supply chains for online retailers and wiping out inventories for many merchants.

In Ukraine, officials have said that Russia is waging "total war" against the country with assaults against ports, grocery and pharmaceutical warehouses, data centers, and other targets. Relentless air raids on major cities like Kyiv, the capital, have slowed economic activity.

Judging by next year's Russian budget, President Vladimir Putin is not planning to stop.

Russia intends to spend more than $200 billion on its military in 2027, an increase of more than a quarter from the sum the last budget initially provided for 2026. The new figure represents more than a third of overall federal spending planned next year.

Speaking Wednesday at the opening session of the lower house of Russia's parliament, Putin exuded confidence.

Referring to Ukraine's need to seek financial help from its European allies, he said that "Russia cannot go around the world, humiliatingly begging for handouts with an outstretched hand."

"First, because, as I have said, it is humiliating," he said. "Second, we know full well that no one is going to give us handouts. And third, and most important, we do not need them. Russia's financial system and economy are performing well."

The numbers tell a less rosy story.

A year ago, the Russian government projected a slight decrease in military spending for 2026 and 2027. But with peace talks foundering and the war only escalating in the past year, the Kremlin now plans to trim spending on social programs, including child and family allowances, in order to increase expenditures on the war. Such social spending will fall by 7 percent.

Allocations for education will be cut by 6 percent, while spending on health care, such as cancer treatment infrastructure, will be reduced by nearly 7 percent, according to the draft budget.

Russia will also expand its national debt, with the budget deficit exceeding $60 billion next year. Although Putin often boasts about Russia's relatively low debt — currently around 20 percent of the country's gross domestic product — Western sanctions have forced the government to borrow almost entirely domestically, primarily from state banks at bond interest rates sometimes exceeding 15 percent.

According to the draft budget, Russia's debt-servicing costs next year will more than double in real terms from prewar levels, surpassing expenditures on health care, education, and housing combined.

To help offset the strain, Russia will raise taxes again. The Russian finance minister announced in late September that the government would raise taxes on bank deposit interest, dividends, and asset sales, including real estate.

That is expected to bring in an additional $4.6 billion. The government has also proposed a new tax on mining companies.

Jamaica struggles to recover a year after Hurricane Melissa struck

Strain on tourism grows as peak season looms

By John Myers Jr.
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KINGSTON, Jamaica — Jamaica's once-flourishing tourism sector is struggling to regain its footing nearly a year after Hurricane Melissa slammed into the island as a Category 5 storm.

High deductibles and delays in insurance claim settlements mean that hotels and other businesses are running out of operating capital as Jamaica's peak winter travel season approaches.

An estimated 20 hotels remain closed nearly a year after Melissa hit, killing dozens of people and causing an estimated $12 billion in damage, much of it in the island's northwest region.

Tourism represents up to 35 percent of Jamaica's GDP. It also accounts for more than half of the country's total foreign exchange earnings and employs roughly one in four workers when indirect jobs are factored in.

The greatest hurdle to full recovery of the tourism sector isn't the availability of construction materials or labor; it's a mounting insurance crisis characterized by severe payout delays, massive deductions, and a crippling cash shortfall.

"Claims are being paid slowly and settled short, and that leaves a working-capital hole across the sector," said O'Brian Heron, president of the Jamaica Hotel and Tourist Association.

According to the association, more than 61 percent of claimants are awaiting full settlements, leaving operators struggling to finance their own rebuilding efforts.

ERIN SCHAFF/NEW YORK TIMES

Hurricane Melissa slammed into Jamaica last year, killing dozens and causing an estimated $12 billion in damage.

More than eight in 10 association members submitted a property or business interruption claim after the hurricane, underscoring the widespread impact on the sector.

Despite the insurance industry's public commitment to resolve the bulk of non-litigated claims by the end of September, this has not happened.

Damages from the hurricane are the equivalent of roughly 57 percent of Jamaica's GDP, and the physical and economic scars of the storm are profound.

Commercial claims filed by Jamaica's hospitality sector make up the bulk of the island's projected $2.2 billion to $4.2 billion in total private insured losses.

The disruption to room stock caused a 17 percent drop in visitor arrivals and an 18 percent drop in tourism revenue, costing the country roughly $550 million in lost earnings.

Tourism stakeholders argue that the problem is how claims are being processed and undervalued. According to Jamaica's Hotel and Tourism Association, seven in 10 claimants reported facing deductions that exceed what they understood their policies allowed under the controversial "average clause" — a provision that penalizes policyholders if a property is deemed underinsured. For nearly a third of claimants, these deductions have slashed the value of their claims by more than 40 percent.

"Complexity is not an acceptable excuse for delay, still less for silence, and it does not justify deductions beyond the policy terms," Heron said.

Insurers have blamed the delays on the complex nature of commercial hotel claims and a severe shortage of licensed property adjusters in Jamaica. They point out that fewer than half the number of loss adjusters registered with the Financial Services Commission are licensed to handle property claims, leading to a severe backlog.

Wealthy backing primaries question — but why?

▶DONORS
Continued from Page A1

tee has pulled in more than $5.6 million in donations since last year.

That support has fueled attacks from the question's opponents, who allege that the wealthy donors are trying to "buy elections" in Massachusetts.

But their exact motivations are unclear. Nor is there an apparent ideological motive. None of the committee's top donors responded to requests for comment sent to them or their firms, including spokespeople for Bain.

Danielle Allen, a Harvard University professor who is leading the campaign, chalked up the support to "social relationships" she's built. She called Peeler a friend she has known in the democracy reform space; he and others also put large donations behind an unsuccessful ranked-choice voting ballot question in 2020. Balson and Nunnelly are both "people who care about democracy," Allen said.

"I've got a fair amount of experience organizing, and you do what an organizer does: You ask your friends to ask friends, and you keep snowballing out," said Allen, a former gubernatorial candidate who has criticized the party nominating process.

"I have been a bulldog," she said of her fund-raising efforts.

The proposal Allen is pitching this fall would eliminate the party primary process for state elections, and instead establish a system in which all candidates would be listed on a single primary ballot, regardless of party. Voters could vote for only one candidate; the top two vote-getters would advance to the general election.

Supporters of the measure have argued that the change would shift the power over ballot access from the Republican and Democratic party apparatuses to voters. They also say it would generate more competition in a state that's long lacked competitive elections, particularly at the legislative level.

But opponents contend that eliminating partisan primaries would open Massachusetts elections to the influence of wealthy individuals who can spend large sums of money on their own political bids or their preferred candidates.

Some have also warned it could wipe out any chance of a third-party or independent candidate qualifying for the general election, or further diffuse the ability of Republicans — who already are a super-minority in the Legislature and hold no statewide office — to compete in November.

The ballot measure has also deeply divided Democrats around the state, and drawn opposition from the leaders of the two major political parties.

Jordan Berg Powers, the chair of the union-backed committee opposing the ballot question, said the investment-world executives' donations are concerning because it's a "big play to upend the system to really benefit themselves."

"You look around the country, and you're a private equity person, what are you worried about? You're worried about populism from both the left and the right. You're worried about bills that will rein in the investment you've made," Berg Powers said. "They have an interest in having politicians and a system that privileges their money."

Christian Grose, a University of Southern California political science professor who has studied the effect of his state's "top-two" system since it was implemented in 2012, said the impact of money in California elections isn't "any more or less than closed primary systems."

JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Danielle Allen, a Harvard University professor who is leading the campaign on the primaries question, chalked up the support to "social relationships" she's built.

"There's lots of money in politics," he said.

Allen also pushed back on the argument that a top-two system would benefit wealthy individuals. She pointed to the nonpartisan preliminary election used in Boston ahead of the general election.

"If this kind of system advantaged money, then Josh Kraft would be mayor of Boston," Allen said, referring to Kraft's failed 2025 challenge of Mayor Michelle Wu in which he reported spending more than $6.6 million.

Ballot question campaigns often require large sums of money to be successful, to fund signature-gathering efforts, pay attorneys to draft language, hire campaign staff, and litter television and social media with advertising.

Allen said she has worked on the all-party primaries movement for five years, and initially funded it with cash from her retirement account. State records show she gave $80,000 in September 2023 to a now-defunct campaign committee associated with the measure.

Allen's current campaign has raised more money than the 20 other ballot question committees that are either supporting or opposing any of the nine questions slated to go before voters in November.

Many of the donors have heavily donated to past political causes that drew a mix of ideological support.

Nunnelly, the Bain alum, gave $275,000 while working in Charlie Baker's administration to a 2016 campaign supporting an unsuccessful ballot initiative to lift the cap on the number of charter schools in the state — a measure the former governor, too, aggressively campaigned for.

Balson, the former Bain executive who is now managing partner at Cove Hill Partners, also gave hundreds of thousands of dollars to a ballot question committee supporting the charter school measure, and put at least $200,000 behind the unsuccessful ballot question in 2020 that would have implemented ranked-choice voting in the state.

Balson is also a longtime political contributor of Attorney General Andrea Campbell, giving $250,000 in 2021 to a super PAC that backed Campbell's unsuccessful bid for Boston mayor. Nunnelly also gave the PAC $75,000, state records show.

Similar to Balson and Nunnelly, Peeler, the longtime Berkshire Partners executive, has financially supported ballot questions in Massachusetts for at least a decade, giving at least $75,000 in 2016 to the failed charter schools expansion push and $50,000 to the ranked-choice voting campaign, records show. He also gave at least $500,000 last year to American Promise, a Concord-based nonprofit focused on limiting money in politics.

Nathan Lockwood, chief of staff at Voter Choice Massachusetts, a nonprofit focused on advocating for ranked-choice voting that backed the 2020 ballot question, said Peeler holds "progressive values and a pragmatic mind."

"He's devoted a massive portion of his time and attention to conversation, thinking, and investing in making Massachusetts a better place — often against the preferences of his own colleagues, who would prefer he focus only on 'other states that need it more,' " Lockwood said.

Other major donations to the primary ballot question include $200,000 from Paul Sagan, an adviser at General Catalyst Partners, and $100,000 each from Adam Koppel, a partner at Bain Capital, and Paul Edgerley, a senior adviser at the firm.

None of them returned requests for comment.

Adam Webster, a Massachusetts-based Democratic political consultant who is not involved with the ballot question campaign, said the wealth behind the committee feeds into the criticisms that the proposed system could ultimately benefit those with the most money.

"This," he said of the ballot question, "is really a way to subvert the 'small-d' democratic grass-roots campaign process where candidates need to meet and greet voters, local elected officials, activists."

Chris Van Buskirk can be reached at chris.vanb@globe.com. Follow him on X @byChrisVan

Family sues US over ICE killing in Minn.

Seeks damages for death of Renee Good

By Tim Sullivan, Kathy McCormack, and Mark Vancleave
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ELLEN SCHMIDT/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Brent Ganger (center) and Becca Good (right) embraced after a news conference announcing the lawsuits on Thursday.

MINNEAPOLIS — Renee Good's family sued the US government and the architects of President Trump's immigration crackdown Thursday, saying "the time is absolutely now for accountability" for her killing in January by a federal agent in Minneapolis.

Good's partner, Becca Good, and her brother Brent Ganger on behalf of her larger family, accused the government and Jonathan Ross, the Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer who shot into her SUV and killed her, of unjustified and excessive use of force.

The Jan. 7 shooting, captured on bystander video, was "the predictable and intended product" of the Trump administration's crackdown on Somali and other immigrants in Minnesota dubbed Operation Metro Surge, according to one of the two lawsuits.

"She was the love of my life," Becca Good said at a news conference announcing the lawsuits. "I'm here today because last January, the whole world had to watch as our entire universe was destroyed — as the sunshine who was my amazing Renee was robbed from us, from her children, and from her community."

The killings of Good, a 37-year-old mother of three, and another US citizen, Alex Pretti, in Minneapolis just weeks later sparked outrage across the country and calls to rein in immigration enforcement. At least 10 people have died in encounters with immigration officers during Trump's second term.

The crackdown, a pillar of Trump's second term, has prompted a slew of lawsuits filed by everyone from Chicago-area pastors to more than a dozen states and the cities of Minneapolis and St. Paul. Hundreds of protesters have been arrested, but few have been convicted of any crimes.

"What happened to Renee was completely senseless," Ganger said. "And the fact that there's been no accountability, no investigation, no expression of condolence, no change in policy is completely mind blowing."

The lawsuits — one against the government, the other against Ross and officials including White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller, ex-Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem, and White House border czar Tom Homan — seek unspecified damages for wrongful death, conspiracy, and other violations.

"Our government has become a grave and mortal threat to its own citizens," the family's lawyer, Antonio Romanucci, told reporters.

The Justice Department has not responded to an email seeking comment.

Renee Good was killed while driving with Becca on a street where masked federal immigration officers were conducting an enforcement operation. They had just dropped their 6-year-old son at school. Renee stopped their red SUV in the street and honked her horn to warn people about the operation while Becca got out and started recording video with her cellphone.

Bystander video shows Renee Good in the driver's seat, her car blocking part of the road, as she repeatedly honks the horn. Two immigration officers get out of a truck, their faces covered, and one orders Good to get out of the car. She reverses briefly, then turns the steering wheel as an officer again demands: "Get out of the car."

Almost simultaneously, Becca Good, standing in the street, shouts: "Drive, baby, drive!"

The officer standing in front of the vehicle pulls his weapon and fires into the windshield. He lurches back as the car turns away from him. The officer, by then very close to the open window on the driver's side, fires two more times, fatally shooting Renee Good, according to an analysis of the videos by the Associated Press and others.

Federal officials at the time said the officer acted in self-defense and that Good had engaged in "an act of domestic terrorism."

Becca and Renee Good were not legally married, according to a family lawyer, but referred to one another as wives.

"I don't hate the people that took Renee from us," Becca Good said. "But what I want them to understand: Every single day they get to look at their children and their wives and their sisters and know what they took from our family. They took a mother away from her children. They know that. And they will carry it forever."

The wrongful death lawsuit against the US government seeks damages for "the immense suffering" Good endured in her final moments and her family's "profound and permanent" loss.

The other lawsuit, against Ross and top federal immigration officials, paints Operation Metro Surge as a conspiracy to trample the civil rights of immigrants, and accuses the administration of targeting Becca instead of thoroughly investigating Good's killing.

Judge nixes charge of Olympian

POLITICAL NOTEBOOK

WASHINGTON — Federal prosecutors can never revive a felony charge against former Olympian David Hearn over alleged vandalism of the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool, a judge in Washington said Thursday, finding that President Trump had tried to influence the case.

Judge Todd E. Edelman of the Superior Court in Washington agreed with Hearn's lawyers that the case should be dismissed with prejudice, barring prosecutors from bringing it back in the future.

US Attorney Jeanine Pirro had already dropped the charges on July 31, admitting that damage to the pool was the result of botched renovations, rather than sabotage, as officials had originally alleged.

But Trump complained on social media about Pirro's decision, saying she had "made a mistake" and "choked" because "the judge was really vicious." Those and other comments prompted Hearn's lawyers to file a motion to ensure that the charge couldn't be revived.

"While all defendants deal with some degree of uncertainty regarding the odds of reprosecution after a case has been dismissed," Edelman wrote, "Mr. Hearn faces the unique possibility that the government will revive this case — one that it has already announced to be meritless — based on political pressure brought by the president of the United States upon his subordinate officers."

"The court agrees with the defense that in securing the indictment against Mr. Hearn, the government shot first and asked questions later," he added. "Nothing about the grand jury process would prevent it from giving in to the president's pressure and doing so again."

Hearn's lawyers, Norm Eisen, Mary Dohrmann and Steve Levin, said in a statement that the ruling was "a victory for the rule of law and for an innocent American seeking justice."

"This case never should have been brought in the first place," they said. "This was a miscarriage of justice, and what happened to Davey is an outrage that should shock every American."

A spokesperson for the US attorney's office did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

NEW YORK TIMES

States, cities sue over Trump's EPA eliminating rule

WASHINGTON — States and cities sued the Trump administration Thursday for repealing rules that limit planet-warming greenhouse gas emissions from power plants fueled by coal and natural gas.

Twenty-one states, led by New York and including Massachusetts, are challenging the Environmental Protection Agency's power plant rule. The coalition also includes Pennsylvania's governor, the District of Columbia, New York City, Chicago, and the city and county of Denver. They argue that "gutting one of the country's most significant climate protections" will set the nation back decades and worsen the climate crisis.

The EPA announced last month it's revoking the Biden-era rule, and said it is taking a separate but related step to prevent future administrations from regulating climate pollution from power plants.

New York Attorney General Letitia James said the federal government is showing "callous disregard" for Americans' health and the environment, and future generations will pay the price.

"Dismantling these protections is a betrayal of American families, and the stakes are too high to allow this administration to once again put profits over people," James said in a statement Thursday.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Poll shows most Americans blame Trump for high prices

WASHINGTON — Americans are deeply frustrated with President Trump's handling of the economy and rising prices, with most panning his performance and blaming his policies as higher costs threaten his party's chances in November.

A new poll from the Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research finds that only 17 percent of US adults approve of the Republican president's handling of the cost of living. Just 26 percent approve of his handling of the economy overall, marking a new low.

A majority, 65 percent, of US adults now blame Trump's policies for persistently high costs more than factors outside of his control, signaling growing weariness over his aggressive use of tariffs and continued unhappiness with the war with Iran.

The dismal numbers come just weeks before midterm elections that will determine whether Republicans maintain control of Congress and while Trump is hitting the campaign trail with an aggressive schedule of rallies. But Trump — who has asked voters to pretend that he is on the ballot as he tries to bolster turnout — remains deeply unpopular, with even many Republicans faulting him for failing to deliver on promised relief.

"I was hoping it would be better or different, but it's not really good," said Robert Gault, 66, a retired factory worker from Bradford, Pa., who describes himself as a Republican.

"Our president, I thought, was going to help the country, and so far he has not really seemed to have done that with the economy or in general. He's not really done what I was hoping he would," Gault said. "He said, 'Make America Great Again.' And I have not seen him do that."

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'Worcester has been in this kind of vacuum where there's been no pressure in the past to be accountable, to be transparent. McManus is almost singular in how much he has suppressed.'

ANNE BARRETT DOYLE, *codirector of BishopAccountability.org*

Worcester Diocese still resists naming priests

▶WORCESTER
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strengthen efforts to keep children safe."

In her report, which investigated sexual abuse in the Fall River and Springfield dioceses, Campbell took particular aim at the continued refusal by the Worcester Diocese to disclose the identities of its accused priests.

"We asked each sexual abuse survivor what changes they would like to see the dioceses implement in the future," the report stated. "All survivors from the Worcester Diocese named a credibly accused list as their No. 1 request from the diocese."

Although the US Conference of Catholic Bishops in 2002 adopted a charter that called "for openness and transparency, Worcester has refused an open and transparent practice, which is in place in every other diocese in Massachusetts," the report said.

In his defense, McManus has said the Vatican opposes publishing lists unless the clergy who are named have been found guilty of a canonical crime. However, most American bishops do share them in an effort to rebuild trust and repair the enormous damage from the clergy sex-abuse scandal.

In a diocesan report from 2023, McManus wrote that releasing the names "can be a cause for deep division among many members of our church."

Many Catholics, he said then, are concerned about "publicly branding as guilty those who never have been charged by law enforcement or had a chance to defend themselves in a court of law," due to death or the passage of many decades.

But for watchdog groups such as BishopAccountability.org, a Waltham-based advocacy group, releasing the names of all credibly accused priests — active, retired, or deceased — is a long-overdue effort to increase transparency and hold offending priests and their superiors responsible.

RICK CINCLAIR/WORCESTER TELEGRAM & GAZETTE VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Worcester Bishop Robert McManus has said the Vatican opposes publishing lists unless the clergy who are named have been found guilty of a canonical crime. Terence McKiernan, codirector of Bishop.Accountability.org. took the bishop to task.

"McManus has been very clear he does not intend to do it," said Terence McKiernan, codirector of Bishop.Accountability.org. "They have fought tooth and nail, and it's a very locked-down and inhospitable diocese to survivors."

McManus, who is required by the Vatican to submit a letter of resignation at age 75, has developed a reputation as an old-school conservative since becoming bishop in 2004.

In 2022, he directed a Jesuit middle school in Worcester to remove Pride and Black Lives Matter flags, which had been displayed there for more than a year. And in 2012, he voiced his displeasure when Vicki Kennedy, the pro-choice widow of Senator Edward M. Kennedy, was chosen as commencement speaker at Anna Maria College in Paxton. The college then withdrew the invitation.

GLOBE FILE

"Worcester has been in this kind of vacuum where there's been no pressure in the past to be accountable, to be transparent. McManus is almost singular in how much he has suppressed," said Anne Barrett Doyle, another codirector of BishopAccountability.org.

Among the examples cited in Campbell's report is that of Worcester priest Brendan O'Donoghue, who had been transferred 12 times between 1950 to 1965 by two bishops with knowledge of the allegations against him, the report said.

"Following several more transfers and additional sexual abuse of children, O'Donoghue spent time at the House of Affirmation but continued in ministry until his retirement in 1993," according to the report, citing his stay at rehabilitation home for clergy in Whitinsville.

In another example, a priest in the diocese reported allegations of abuse by another priest to his superiors. In response, a senior diocesan official said he would resolve the issue by taking the accused priest on a fishing trip and talking to him.

The report said victims described interviews with diocesan officials that were conducted over the telephone, and without the opportunity to meet with the diocese's Victim Assistance Coordinator or members of the Review Committee in person.

Delisle, the Worcester spokesperson, said the diocese welcomes the attorney general's report, noting that the "vast majority of cases occurred 40 to 60 years ago."

Delisle said that the diocese has passed a compliance audit each year since adopting the 2002 Charter for the Protection of Children and Minors, which had been approved by the US bishops in Dallas.

Still, some critics remain unconvinced that the diocese is doing enough.

The names should be released, said Lewcon, the abuse survivor, for transparency's sake and "to validate other victims. I feel the intimidation we've experienced has prevented others from coming forward."

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A small measure to put the state's energy future into words

▶ENERGY
Continued from Page A1

It is emerging as a sticking point in conference-committee negotiations between the House and Senate — and is emblematic of the ongoing debate over how much of a role natural gas should play in our energy mix.

As Representative Mark Cusack and Senator Mike Barrett begin their negotiations, the sides seem far apart. The two co-chairs of the Legislature's energy committee know there are many other differences between the House and Senate bills, legislation ostensibly aimed at "energy affordability." Most notably, the House would pare back the Mass Save home-efficiency program, while the Senate's version phases out a pricey gas-pipe replacement initiative known as GSEP.

The language addressing utilities' obligation to serve is tucked into the Senate's GSEP section. Essentially, if a utility determines a gas pipe needs replacing for a particular neighborhood, and most homeowners want to convert to electric heat, the state Department of Utilities could force the holdouts to convert, too, instead of passing the costs of pipe upgrades on to ratepayers. (The Senate bill doesn't spell out how many volunteer conversions would be needed.)

The business community is sounding the alarm. Jon Hurst, head of the Retailers Association of Massachusetts, says having no energy bill at all is a better outcome than passing the Senate's, given the anger from consumers and small businesses about utility bills lately. The "Big Four" — Mass. Business Roundtable, Greater Boston Chamber, Associated Industries of Massachusetts, and Mass. Taxpayers Foundation — told conferees that the language eliminates customer choice while forcing ratepayers to accept a different energy source (electricity) that also faces supply constraints.

PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Environmentalists envision the state switching away from natural gas in the not-too-distant future.

As Bill Ryan, spokesman for the business group-funded Mass Coalition for Sustainable Energy, puts it: "This is a 'tip of the iceberg' type of thing" toward ending natural gas service in Massachusetts. His group estimates billions in added costs over time, for everything from furnace replacements to electrical upgrades.

While natural gas plants still provide much of our electricity, environmental groups argue that it's time to get more serious about moving off fossil fuels. State law, after all, requires carbon emissions to be all but eliminated by 2050.

At Environmental League of Massachusetts, Amy Boyd Rabin says inaction on this issue will only increase utility profits amid overspending on antiquated gas networks, without providing necessary rate relief.

And the Conservation Law Foundation's Caitlin Peale Sloan called the warnings from business groups "a self-serving story peddled by the utilities" to defend a program that pads their profits at the expense of families and businesses exposed to volatile fossil fuel prices.

The Legislature's most recent energy law, passed in 2024, includes language that allows the DPU to consider greenhouse gas emissions as a reason for rejecting a petition for natural gas supply, if electricity is available for heat instead. However, utilities argued they still have an obligation to serve existing gas customers, even if that law prevents service for future ones.

Barrett says the Senate's new language doesn't represent the end of natural gas delivery as we know it, despite the doomsday scenarios being presented by who he calls "apologists for fossil fuels." Instead, it's an attempt to provide flexibility for neighborhoods in which most, but not all, residents want to make the switch to electric. Without this language, Barrett says the holdouts could result in ratepayers supporting electric-system upgrades *and* pipe replacements for a dwindling number of gas customers, making the energy system more expensive for everyone.

Better state law is needed, he adds, to allow communities to selectively decommission sections of their gas networks. That's why, he says, the Senate supports this clarifying language. In the end, the DPU would still have the final say in determing whether affected customers have access to an affordable alternative.

If a utility determines a gas pipe needs replacing for a particular neighborhood, and most homeowners want to convert to electric heat, the state could force the holdouts to convert.

Sure, this is a contentious issue. But Barrett says the main debate is around the pace at which we transition off fossil fuels, not about the fundamental need to do so eventually. Some communities want to move faster than others. The question, Barrett says, they face isn't whether a utility can force a particular customer off gas, but whether that customer can hold out and force everyone else to help pay for maintaining the pipes.

The environmental advocates see this as a small but helpful step toward moving more people to cleaner forms of energy. The business lobbyists, though, see one more piece of legislation to chip away at access to natural gas — and a potentially expensive one at that.

Resolving that conflict won't be easy. But it could be crucial to getting the Legislature's latest energy bill over the finish line.

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A welcome, yet feared, Blue Hill Ave. development

▶BLUE HILL AVENUE
Continued from Page A1

This overhaul, the latest of several attempts to improve traffic and bus travel on Blue Hill Avenue, has the potential to redefine the avenue by spurring more development and attracting new visitors to an area that has long been stigmatized as rundown and unsafe. At the same time, tension is building over who will benefit.

If construction keeps customers away, or the area becomes more expensive, small-business owners of color could be priced out of one of the few affordable commercial areas in the city. And, some local entrepreneurs fear, they could be replaced by wealthier, whiter enterprises.

A refreshed Blue Hill Avenue would increase property values for people like Warren and her family, who still own the house in Mattapan, but many of the commercial real estate owners who stand to benefit from the multimillion-dollar makeover are far less invested in preserving the authenticity and local flavor of the neighborhood. Some of those owners inherited paid-off properties and live elsewhere, while others scooped up neglected space for a song and are just waiting to cash in. A number of storefronts sit empty.

Even though the latest plan for Blue Hill Avenue would increase parking in some places, disruption during a years-long construction process could keep customers away, putting a strain on the businesses there. And even though the upgrade would likely raise property values, it could also increase taxes for building owners, which could cause them to jack up the rent or sell to the highest bidder. This could have a domino effect: closing down some of the more than 1,100 establishments — some barely hanging on, almost all locally owned — located in the census tracts along the 3-mile stretch slated for redevelopment, and opening the door to more profitable corporate chains.

Blue Hill Avenue is the most important corridor in the city for Black Bostonians, said Fatima Ali-Salaam, president of the Greater Mattapan Neighborhood Council. With the right support and investment, she said, it could become the "Black Wall Street" of Boston.

The city stands to gain from increased tax revenues generated along the refurbished corridor, but it doesn't conduct economic impact studies before projects. So it's unclear: Will it generate jobs, or destroy them? Will it increase sales? Drive up prices? Depending on what happens, the diversity and strong local connections that are essential to Blue Hill Avenue's character could be at risk.

Sami Salameh, who opened Salameh Jewelry in Mattapan Square 30 years ago with his father, a Palestinian tailor, once kept a gold chain and bracelet on layaway for 13 years for a customer who went to prison — and let him purchase it for close to the original price when he got out. A few years ago, Danielle Johnson moved her digital radio station Spark FM from Hyde Park to a second-floor space overlooking Blue Hill Avenue: "Location, location, location," she said. It makes sense, she said, for a Black media company that broadcasts the community's concerns about the redevelopment's proposed center-running bus lane to be based in the middle of the Black community.

But with the rent rising steadily, Johnson is already looking for a new home, and trying to save up to buy a space, preferably before the redevelopment drives prices even higher. "We're going to be displaced in droves," she said.

In one of the last affordable areas of the city, largely populated by immigrants and people of color, the overarching worry is not about the bus lane. It's about being pushed out.

* * *

From her station on the front porch, Warren's grandmother, Indianola Walker, watched the neighborhood evolve from white to Black after she and her husband moved into their triple decker off Blue Hill Avenue in 1967.

A federally insured loan program in the late 1960s aimed at Black home buyers transformed the area, and in just a few years' time, a majority-Jewish area became a majority-Black one. But by 1974, more than half the people who took advantage of those loans, many of which didn't require down payments or thorough home inspections, had lost their houses. And the formerly thriving Blue Hill Avenue has never been the same.

Today, parts of the corridor remain rundown, with boarded-up shops and long-vacant storefronts dotting the street alongside numerous corner markets, tire shops, and churches.

For Warren, the ability to bring her educational nonprofit and Sadiddy Lifestyle Beauty Studio to her childhood neighborhood goes beyond her entrepreneurial dreams. The three-building complex on formerly vacant city-owned land, called Blume on the Ave, is being built by an affordable housing developer who also grew up in the area. Condos are being sold at below-market rates, and ground-floor commercial spaces sold at cost, to promote local ownership.

"When we talk about 'buying back the block' and we talk about ensuring generational wealth in our communities, that's what this project is," said Warren, who has held fund-raisers and applied for loans at three banks to secure funding for her retail space.

Getting loans can be challenging for entrepreneurs of color if they don't have the right connections or access to capital, said Dariela Villon-Maga, the Blume on the Ave developer, who grew up in Roxbury and lives in Mattapan. Black- and Latino-owned small businesses with low credit risk are less than half as likely to be fully approved for financing as white-owned ones, according to a 2021 survey by the Federal Reserve Banks.

Villon-Maga is one of a number of local professionals, many from immigrant families, who have started investing in their communities before corporate developers start to circle.

Ernst Guerrier, the child of a Haitian cab driver and housekeeper in Mattapan, recently bought his second commercial property in Mattapan Square and hopes to put a restaurant and eight condos on the ground floor. Guerrier's first job was in the first building he bought, at a fish market still in operation, and he has plans to add 110 units of housing above it. That property also has the square's only sit-down restaurant, Marabou Cafe, which was just approved for a liquor license.

Guerrier, a 57-year-old real estate lawyer, said his tenants' leases all include the right to make the first offer if he decides to sell.

"It's a quiet storm," he said of local efforts to improve the area. "Within 10 years, I guarantee it, you won't even recognize Mattapan Square."

But costs for property owners stand to increase, as building values — and taxes — rise. And that could be an issue for lower-income landlords with rundown buildings in need of repair. Raising the rent or selling the building could force local businesses out — and invite corporate chains in.

Raising prices isn't a good option either. Of the more than 45,000 residents living in the census tracts along the avenue, 65 percent are Black and 23 percent are Latino; almost half were born in another country. And nearly 40 percent of households make less than $40,000 a year.

"This is a very economically vulnerable part of the city," said James Jennings, a professor emeritus at Tufts University who has studied the redevelopment area.

A number of mom-and-pop enterprises along the avenue conduct some business in cash and don't report it, according to members of the business community. This eases their tax burden but also keeps their total profits off the books, which can make it harder to get loans, and also means they might not qualify for grants like the ones offered during the pandemic. Some of these businesses don't have lawyers or insurance; some don't even have leases.

As with houses, commercial buildings in Black communities are often undervalued. Commercial real estate in majority-Black ZIP codes is valued 7 percent lower than comparable properties in areas with fewer Black residents, according to Brookings Institution research. This means building owners are getting less rental income than they could elsewhere and leaves these neighborhoods vulnerable to exploitation by investors who buy properties and use the depreciation as a tax break, opening them up to neglect.

In Roxbury and Dorchester, retail properties are worth $2.8 million each, on average — 43 percent less than in Allston/Brighton and 10 percent less than in the South End, according to the commercial real estate analytics platform CoStar.

The city has awarded grants to more than a dozen businesses on the corridor in recent years, said Mayor Michelle Wu, and a fund is in the works to help mitigate revenue lost during construction. The city, state, and MBTA are "ready to do what's needed to ensure that our small businesses will be protected," she said.

"Blue Hill Ave. is a key economic corridor for the city," she said. "There are so many storefronts and important community hubs along the roadway."

But promises to refurbish it have been made, and broken, for decades. Many locals feel the revitalization project isn't for them — it's for the wealthy white people on their way.

The redevelopment is a "form of trauma," said Derick Foster-Toney, whose family has run the historic roller skating rink Chez-Vous for more than 50 years and bought the building in the mid-'90s.

The community has been so marginalized, Foster said, it's hard to believe anyone has its best interests in mind.

"When you're operating in survival mode for so long," he said, "who do you really trust to save you?"

* * *

One of the biggest property owners on Blue Hill Avenue is the Stamatos family, which owns dozens of residential and commercial buildings around Boston and recently purchased the former Kay's Oasis function hall — just around the corner from the home where Warren's 94-year-old grandmother lives.

Some of their properties are tidy and well-kept, but others are dilapidated, with chipped paint, crumbling bricks and trash-strewn lots. The first four of 14 buildings on the city's "problem properties" list are Stamatos-owned — for repeated calls to the police about noise, late-night parties, and poor conditions.

In 2009, on the tail end of the financial crisis, they had purchased more foreclosed housing units than any other buyer in Boston, according to news reports. They have tried to impose huge rent hikes at a newly purchased apartment building in Mattapan, been hit with violations for serving alcohol to underage customers in Roxbury, and been sued by a man who was shot in one of their buildings in Mattapan Square.

A number of Stamatos properties have been cited for code violations involving mice and roach infestations, water leaks, faulty smoke detectors, and unsecured fire escapes. They also owe more than $700,000 in property taxes and fines.

One neighborhood advocate referred to the family as "extractionists" — and despite their neglect and disregard for tenants, they stand to see their investments pay off handsomely as Blue Hill Avenue improves.

Family members and Stamatos Property Management in Jamaica Plain did not respond to requests for comment.

The city can levy fines, withhold permits, and put problematic properties in receivership, but has little oversight over private real estate transactions.

Small business owners have fewer rights than residential tenants do, said Boston College law professor Carlos Teuscher. Commercial building owners know tenants are unlikely to leave once their businesses are established, which gives landlords little incentive to maintain the property. And they can raise the rent as much as they want when a lease is up. Many noncorporate landlords don't even bother with leases, Teuscher said, leaving tenants unprotected.

"Commercial tenants are assumed to be sophisticated business entities, so there's very few legal protections," Teuscher said. "Generally speaking, if it's not in your lease, tough luck."

Teuscher surveyed Somerville business owners before the Green Line extension to Union Square in 2022 and found that many landlords had stopped making repairs or offering leases, making it easier to sell or find tenants willing to pay more.

A number of protections can be put in place to help Blue Hill Avenue businesses survive, and thrive, beyond the redevelopment.

The city could institute formal agreements with developers requiring that ground-floor retail space be occupied by local businesses, a share of commercial space be sold at affordable rates, and a percentage of contracts and construction jobs go toward area residents, including apprenticeships that will build new skills, said Jennings, the Tufts urban planning professor. The city can also commit to contracting goods and services from local vendors.

Different types of businesses also have to be accounted for, he said, including the roughly 50 stores along the corridor that accept SNAP payments from low-income residents.

These plans need to be drafted with community input, committed to on paper, and measured and monitored along the way to ensure their success, Jennings said.

"The city has a lot of power, direct and indirect, to say, this is the kind of vision we have for this community, based on community input and community residents, and this is what we need to do," he said.

Supporting ground-floor retail will be a priority during the zoning process, Wu said, and the city is looking for resources to continue its program to help residents buy commercial space. Community feedback has been part of the process all along, according to the city, which is working with the MBTA to understand businesses' needs during construction and beyond.

This type of support will go a long way toward winning over the business community, said Denise O'Marde, who owns the smoothie shop Cafe JuiceUp. O'Marde, who bought the building as it was being foreclosed on in 2007, worries that, without assistance, revenue could plummet during construction and she'd be forced to lay off employees, leading to higher unemployment taxes.

Now that there's a fund dedicated to helping small businesses during the redevelopment, O'Marde said, she supports the redevelopment.

Without help, she said: "We could definitely go under."

Ursula Vaughn, co-owner of Lawson's Hair Salon, has already lived through the construction of the Columbus Avenue center bus lane in front of her shop in Egleston Square about five years ago — a process that took away parking and dropped traffic to one lane each way. Now she's gearing up for a similar disruption at her shop in Mattapan Square, part of a chain started by her father and his brothers in the 1960s.

More than anything, though, Vaughn wants to preserve the cultural and social diversity of Blue Hill Avenue. A number of local business owners said they don't want to see the corridor turn into the Seaport; they want to maintain its soul, in other words.

A politician who lives in the area told Vaughn: "Mattapan will be a destination." But attracting visitors shouldn't be the selling point, she pushed back.

"It's not a destination," Vaughn said. "It's people's homes and people's businesses."

So many Black and brown residents are already leaving the city for less expensive suburbs, she noted. This project, in the heart of Black Boston, could force even more out.

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SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Above, Skye Warren worked on a client's nails at her Sadiddy Lifestyle Beauty Studio in Milton. Below, Denise O'Marde, owner of the smoothie shop Cafe JuiceUp, is glad she'll be getting help during construction on Blue Hill Avenue.

> 'When you're operating in survival mode for so long, who do you really trust to save you?'
>
> DERICK FOSTER-TONEY, *whose family has run the historic roller skating rink Chez-Vous for more than 50 years*

JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION

EDITORIAL

Take the money, Healey

At a time when public schools are struggling with teacher layoffs and program cuts, a new pot of money could become available next year to boost public and private education in Massachusetts — if Governor Maura Healey agrees to take it.

The federal government on Thursday released long-awaited regulations governing the new Federal Scholarship Tax Credit. The program is controversial because it is, effectively, a backdoor voucher program that lets public money subsidize private school tuition.

But, importantly, it also lets the same pot of money improve public schools — paying for technology, afterschool programs, tutoring, and special needs services.

Healey should take the money.

Although she has until Jan. 1 to make Massachusetts eligible for the funding in 2027, Healey should opt in soon. That will give her time to use her bully pulpit and state resources to shape the program to have the biggest possible positive impact on public schools that need it most.

Under the program, taxpayers can donate to a nonprofit scholarship granting organization of their choice and get a federal income tax credit up to $1,700 to match their donation. So an individual giving $1,700 or married couple giving $3,400 effectively donates for free.

The scholarship granting organization can give scholarship money to any student whose family earns less than 300 percent of area median income ($500,000 for a family of four in the Boston area). Foster children and children receiving public benefits are categorically eligible without having to prove their income.

To help lower-income districts, schools drawing primarily from low-income census tracts — including parts of Boston, Lawrence, Springfield, Chelsea, and other poorer cities — can use the money to pay for tutoring and special education for all students, without verifying individual family incomes.

For private and parochial schools, this money could provide financial aid for tuition. For public schools, it could cover things like books, supplies, computers, tutoring, or afterschool activities. (The federal government plans to release additional information about eligible expenses.) The size of scholarships will be up to the scholarship granting organizations.

How much money Massachusetts schools would get depends on how many people donate. The American Federation for Children's calculator estimates that if 10 percent of eligible Massachusetts taxpayers (around 290,000 people) give to scholarship granting organizations operating in Massachusetts, that would amount to $459 million in 2027. How much goes to public versus private schools would depend on which scholarship granting organizations taxpayers donate to.

While states must submit lists of approved scholarship granting organizations to the federal government, states may not add their own requirements — for example, requiring an organization to only fund scholarships at public schools.

One concern critics have is the program could disproportionately benefit wealthier districts and private schools. After all, private schools with wealthy alumni networks or public school districts with tax-savvy, high-earning parents will be easier to solicit donations from.

That's why it will be important for nonprofits and school districts serving low-income students to create scholarship granting organizations and find creative ways to fund them — like allowing employees to contribute through payroll tax deductions or partnering with local employers to solicit employee contributions. Healey and other state leaders could fund-raise for scholarship granting organizations that benefit programs in needy districts.

Another valid concern is that if increased availability of financial aid makes private education more affordable, some students may leave public schools for private schools. Jon Valant, director of the Brown Center on Education Policy at Brookings, told the editorial board he worries this will lead to a more stratified education system where "the 'haves' end up in private schools, the 'have nots' in public schools."

Enrollment in Massachusetts public schools is already declining for reasons ranging from demographic shifts to federal immigration policy to dissatisfaction with COVID-era practices. As schools lose students, they lose the state money that comes with each student.

Private school tuition is expensive, and certainly, added financial aid could make a difference to middle-class families on the margins of being able to afford it. But declining enrollment also points to a need to use all available money — including the new scholarships — to improve the quality of public schools, so parents want to keep their children there.

So far, 30 states, though only a handful with Democratic governors, have opted into the program.

If Massachusetts opts out, some taxpayers will still contribute money, but that money will flow out of state. Opting in is the only way to keep potentially hundreds of millions of dollars earmarked for education in Massachusetts. Our schools — private and public — could use that money.

BGSPRNWRDHN/ADOBE

A lively time at the death cafe

By Renée Loth

Renée Loth is a contributing Globe Opinion writer.

We gathered on a bright fall evening at the Mount Auburn Cemetery to sip tea, eat cupcakes, and talk with complete strangers about society's ultimate taboo.

For about two hours, some 40 people sitting below the dark wooden beams of Mount Auburn's Story Chapel dared to ask the big questions: What scares you most about dying? What would you like done with your body after you die? We talked about death as the ultimate loss of control, the search for ways to confront dying beyond organized religion, and how to approach our deaths without regret. And the cupcakes were delicious.

This is a death cafe, an increasingly popular forum where people gather to discuss — and perhaps demystify — this most universal truth. "We are on the cusp of a significant change in how we talk about death and dying," Bree Harvey, Mount Auburn's vice-president of cemetery and visitor services, said in an interview. "I feel it's in the ether."

Like many in my age cohort, now passing 70, death has been much with me lately; the circle of those close to me who are falling ill or dying tightens seemingly every month. Even the death of famous figures — Dolly Parton, Wendell Berry, Gloria Steinem — seem to touch me more, because their lives and times were nearly in tandem with my own. Mortality feels very alive when you get to my age.

Which is why I was so surprised that everyone at my table was under 40.

One young man, 24, spoke about his father's unexpected death. "I didn't feel I had the right to cry," he said. "Mom did all the grieving instead." A woman in her 20s described having a sister who died years before she herself was born. "I feel like it was a kind of soft launch to grief," she said. But despite carrying the knowledge of death's caprice in her core, she couldn't fathom her own end. "I can't sit with the idea that I won't be able to talk or think." (The participants knew I was a journalist and agreed to be quoted without their names.)

Although there were plenty of gray hairs in attendance as well, the evening's facilitator wasn't surprised by Gen Z's participation. "It's become a fashionable conversation to have," said Corinne Elicona, 31, Mount Auburn's end of life educator, who began hosting death cafes in her dorm more than 10 years ago. The climate crisis, artificial intelligence, and the staggering pace of change compel young people to address the greatest unknown of them all, she said. "You think about your existence in a way older generations did not at the same age."

Death cafes aren't new; Mount Auburn has been hosting them twice a year, on the equinox, for about a decade. But their popularity is spiking as part of a larger movement to reimagine death — including the growing acceptance of medical aid in dying, natural burial, and end-of-life doulas who guide their clients through the process with emotional and spiritual support. Swiss anthropologist Bernard Crettaz hosted the first cafes mortels in 2004, aiming to break what he called the "tyrannical secrecy" surrounding death. In just a few decades the idea has taken off. Death cafes are scheduled in Winthrop, Weymouth, and Martha's Vineyard this month.

Some set a winking tone, with coffin-shaped cookies or skull cakes. Some are more somber affairs, though they are not formal bereavement groups. Anyone can facilitate; hosts need not be certified in anything but empathy. The team at Mount Auburn believes young people are attracted to a forum that lets them take some measure of agency over an experience deeply bound by societal strictures. The same could be said about baby boomers, looking to put an alternative stamp on death, just as they have with every other life passage.

"We haven't had this level of disruption in the funeral industry since cremation came in, in the late 1800s," Harvey said. Indeed, before the advent of commercial funerals, most families laid out their dead at home, in the parlor. When that started to change in the early 20th century, the term "living room" was coined.

One paradox I noticed that evening at Mount Auburn is that every person's experience with death is uniquely theirs, and yet, of course, it happens to everyone. Roughly 63 million people worldwide will die this year. This universality could help us remember that we are all part of nature, and few things are more natural than death. There may be some comfort in that.

When I left the Story Chapel it was dusk; the cicadas were sawing away, and the stately Mount Auburn memorials were in silent silhouette. Far from being down after two hours discussing death, I felt lighter, more than ever in love with life.

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JOAN VENNOCHI

Wu's bold White Stadium plan hasn't convinced everyone

With a recent Supreme Judicial Court ruling, Mayor Michelle Wu won the legal battle over an ambitious plan to renovate White Stadium in partnership with a professional women's soccer team. But the battle for the hearts and minds of those who live in adjacent neighborhoods is not over — and, for once, Wu sounds like she knows it.

Since the SJC decision, city officials have been hosting a series of community meetings to explain how the city plans to get fans in and out of the stadium with minimum neighborhood disruption.

At the most recent meeting at Boston English High School, some of the roughly 100 attendees said they are excited about the new facility. But tough questions remained about parking and traffic, as well as anger over what some still see as wrongful use of public land — no matter how much the private entity is paying. Based on several conversations following the meeting, it seemed clear that those who didn't like the project from the start didn't leave the meeting any more convinced.

Asked if she had a message for those constituents, Wu told me in an interview, "We are going to keep at it with everyone who is part of our community."

One of the most heated discussions surrounds the lack of designated stadium parking. Game attendees are expected to walk, bike, or use shuttle buses from remote parking sites and MBTA stations, with 124 total bus trips projected for each of up to 20 games per season. When fans buy a ticket on the website, they have to choose which transportation option they'll use. How many will actually stick with that choice, rather than take their chances on finding a parking spot somewhere near the stadium, is unknown.

A so-called parking protection program gives residents within a 0.75-mile radius of the stadium the choice of opting in or out of game-day parking bans. If they opt in to parking bans, residents will be issued a placard for every car registered to that address, plus two visitor passes. If they opt out of a parking ban, neighborhoods will be open parking for all.

According to the city's presentation package, neighborhood associations covering the streets within the stadium zone will offer recommendations on parking protection implementation. Residents will be informed about the process through fliers and directed to a survey on a city website about the White Stadium project.

> Tough questions remain about parking and traffic, as well as anger over what some still see as wrongful use of public land — no matter how much the private entity is paying.

Wu told me that any parking decisions made now are not final. The goal is to let residents drive the decision.

At the English High meeting, Alcurtis Clark, chair of the Jamaica Plain Neighborhood Council, told city officials that she found the survey hard to find — and she has a point. In an interview after the meeting, Clark also told me, "I am not opposed to change. … I'm opposed to the way this project was forced down our throats." The parking plan "really knocked me for a loop," she said, because residents are just now learning which streets are affected and which are not.

Clark recounted that as she was leaving the meeting, she told another attendee, "'Am I crazy to keep talking and trying to understand the process?' He replied, 'You're crazy if you think they heard you.'"

If people still feel they aren't been heard, that's a problem.

When I asked Wu if she would do anything differently when it comes to community engagement, she said, "If I could have a magic wand that could change anything in the world, it would have been more time to engage everyone in the early stages of the project." However, the window between the league's announcement about a new soccer team and the deadline for submitting plans for it was short. As a result, she said, "The project was forced to move a lot faster than it otherwise would have."

That explains some, but not all of the reasons why people felt locked out of her decision-making on this project. A piece in Commonwealth Beacon also notes a "community engagement gap," which the piece attributes to Wu's decision to bypass a more rigorous community review process that applies to most large infrastructure proposals, but not White Stadium.

Wu has said before that she believes in taking big swings. This, she acknowledged, "is a particularly contentious one. That's because our community has lots of different perspectives" and "is not shy" about expressing them. She still sees this as a big swing that will end up providing the city's student athletes with access to "the best public school athletic facility in the country."

Some skeptics will have to see it to believe it.

Meanwhile, are the legal battles really over?

In an interview, Louis Elisa, a member of the Franklin Park Defenders, the named plaintiffs who challenged the White Stadium plan, called the traffic plan update sessions "a dog and pony show" and told me that even with the SJC decision, he does not consider the outcome "a done deal." Elisa, who is also president of the Garrison Trotter Neighborhood Association, said there is talk about filing a lawsuit on the basis of environmental justice challenges.

It seems like Wu should do all the listening and bridge-building that is necessary to avoid that outcome.

Joan Vennochi is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at joan.vennochi@globe.com. Follow her @joan_vennochi.

KIMBERLY ATKINS STOHR

The Supreme Court puts cruelty on its docket

The cruelty is the point.

That phrase, coined by The Atlantic's Adam Serwer during President Trump's first term to describe his administration's penchant for making marginalized people suffer in order to please his populist base, still rings painfully true. Nothing has made that clearer than the president's draconian immigration enforcement policies that harm citizens and noncitizens alike by tearing families apart; sowing terror in schools, churches, and hospitals; and militarizing border crossings.

These practices have not been carried out merely in the interest of enforcing the law, as evidenced from the slew of court rulings blocking immigration actions that, in judges' views, have strayed beyond legal and constitutional limits. It's done for show. Just check out the Department of Homeland Security's taxpayer-funded, music video style-social media posts of immigration agents detaining mostly Black and brown people at gunpoint.

But that lack of humanity isn't limited to Trump's White House. It seems to have spread to the nation's highest court's conservative supermajority.

What other explanation could there be for Tuesday's Supreme Court order allowing the Trump administration to resume its third-country removal scheme, under which noncitizens are rapidly sent to countries where they have never been, have no family, and don't speak the local language. Despite the sometimes deadly perils they face, they are given little notice or opportunity to object before being loaded onto planes to destinations from which they may never return.

While a majority of third-country removals go to Mexico, a growing number of people are being sent to central Africa, where leaders have entered into often lucrative contracts with the US government to accept noncitizen immigrants. And frequently those destinations, including the Central African Republic, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Libya, South Sudan, and Uganda, are designated by the US State Department to be too dangerous for Americans to even visit, let alone be forced to live.

Lawyers from some of the migrants report that they have been subject to brutality upon arrival to these countries. Attorneys for Eritrean and Egyptian nationals told the Guardian that they were "trapped" in a hotel in Equatorial Guinea, where they were bound, had bags placed on their heads and brutalized in ways that included being pushed downstairs.

> The justices at least agreed to move the case from its shadow docket, which is supposed to be reserved for emergency matters, and onto its list of cases it will consider on the merits this upcoming term.

Such pending peril has been recounted in media reports, leading one detained Nicaraguan migrant to tell immigration agents, according to the Los Angeles Times: "I'd rather die here than in Africa." What could be the point, if not the cruelty?

Normally in cases where the stakes are so high, it would be reasonable for courts to issue preliminary orders to stop the potential harm to those involved while considering whether the administration's policy runs afoul of the law or Constitution. That is exactly what Boston-based US District Court Judge Brian E. Murphy did in February.

Murphy's order didn't put a halt to third-country deportations, which are allowed in some circumstances under US and international law. But Murphy's order did require those facing third-country deportations a "a meaningful opportunity" to argue that they'd suffer such danger from the removal that they deserved protection from it. A federal appellate court upheld Murphy's order in September.

But just days later, the Supreme Court eliminated that protection. Justices Sonia Sotomayor, Elena Kagan, and Ketanji Brown Jackson indicated that they would have left the injunction in place.

The justices at least agreed to move the case from its shadow docket, which is supposed to be reserved for emergency matters, and onto its list of cases it will consider on the merits this upcoming term, which begins Monday. That means both the government and the parties challenging the policy will have the opportunity to fully brief and argue the legal issues involved. It also means the justices will actually have to explain the decision they make in a signed opinion. Arguments will take place in December, meaning a decision could come by late spring or early summer.

But that serves as no solace to the estimated 25,000 people who have been shipped to countries they have no connection with. Nor will it protect the countless more who face the same fate until or unless the justices choose to stop it.

I know there are Americans who would argue that breaking the law has to come with consequences, otherwise the laws are meaningless. I share that belief.

But I also have a deep and abiding belief in the American legal principles that ensure fairness and justice within that process. Those protections demand that any person facing legal consequences receive proper notice and have the chance to be heard and contest those charges. That is all the parties in this case were asking for, if only on a temporary basis while the Supreme Court ponders its final judgment. But that was too big of an ask for the court's conservatives. Cruel, indeed.

Kimberly Atkins Stohr is a columnist for the Globe. She may be reached at kimberly.atkinsstohr@globe.com.

INBOX

Dartmouth provost in a real bind over use of artificial intelligence

Before reputations are harmed, we should be clear on what AI-detection tools actually measure

The Globe's reporting on Dartmouth's provost and the use of artificial intelligence in his academic writing highlights a growing misunderstanding about what AI-detection tools actually measure ("Provost's use of AI angers campus: Dartmouth leader relied heavily on tool, review says," Page A1, Sept. 26). These tools do not determine who wrote a text or whether its ideas were generated by a machine. Rather, they compare the writing to statistical patterns found in modern academic prose, which is now routinely edited with AI-assisted tools such as Grammarly or language models used for grammar and flow refinement.

As scientific writing has become more standardized and syntactically polished, it increasingly resembles the stylistic profile that AI systems produce. Ironically, the clearer and more coherent the prose, the more likely detectors are to flag it as "AI-generated." A scholar who writes his own papers and uses AI only to check syntax or logical flow may therefore be misidentified as having outsourced authorship, even when the intellectual work is entirely his or her own.

Academic integrity is essential. But resemblance in style is not evidence of misconduct. Before reputations are damaged, the public deserves a more accurate understanding of what AI detectors can and cannot tell us.

LUIS D. BERRIZBEITIA
Concord

Provost and college president talk around the problem

The details about Dartmouth College's provost, Santiago Schnell, and his use of artificial intelligence in his writing are appalling. I am sick of people who have done wrong saying things like, "I am sorry that this was not my standard practice," as Schnell did, saying, "I now realize I should always explicitly disclose use of AI in my public writing."

The response from Sian Leah Beilock, president of Dartmouth, was mealy-mouthed: "The questions this moment raise go well beyond any one person. Thoughtful people on our campus can and should disagree about those norms, which are rapidly shifting."

What the college's provost has done is wrong. Someone needs to say so. Since AI won't say so, and since the president of Dartmouth won't say so, I will.

MARY M. TYLER
Concord

Seniors signed their names on a window at New Bedford High School in June.

JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

MCAS woes and funding gaps persist for Mass. public schools

As a school committee member in a Gateway City, I have two reactions to the disappointment that's been expressed over recent MCAS results ("Big hike in funds, modest returns: State boosted aid to needy schools but gaps persist," Page A1, Sept. 29).

First, Massachusetts public schools are not yet seeing the full effect of the 2019 Student Opportunity Act as designed. This is the first year schools have reached the final targeted funding, and the effects of added funding are still working their way through low-income districts. Moreover, under current law, school districts will never see the level of "foundation budgets" and state aid intended when the act was passed. That's because annual inflation adjustments are capped at 4.5 percent. To date this cap has cumulatively reduced foundation budgets — which establish a minimum foundational level of funding for each school district — by 6 percent. School purchasing power will further erode this year and every year when inflation, as measured for the state's Foundation Inflation Index, exceeds 4.5 percent.

Second, changes are needed in the way the state implements its tiered system for matching educational resources with individual student needs. We will never get the majority of our students meeting expectations on MCAS if we focus too narrowly on the smallest tiers with the highest-need students. Improving district-level MCAS results requires effectively engaging mainstream students.

All of our students can receive the level of education Massachusetts defines as "foundational" if we stay the course on reforms that work, such as early literacy instruction; focus on instructional strategies that engage every student; and remove the cap and restore funding levels to fully reflect recent and future inflation.

THOMAS GRANNEMANN
Vice chair
Haverhill School Committee
The views expressed here are the writer's own.

The Red Sox had great chemistry … till their stars returned

I'm sure there will be a lot of opinions about why the Boston Red Sox ended their season on such a dismal note. I'm also sure all have some merit. The change in the team that I noted was when the two purported superstars, Roman Anthony and Trevor Story, returned at the end of August.

Prior to that, the team had great chemistry and enjoyed playing the game and competing together. You could feel the energy, even if you weren't that familiar with some of the players' names.

After the stars' return, it was as if the Peanuts character Pig-Pen had gifted his cloud to the team. The smiles were gone, the energy was gone, and arguably, the Red Sox' hopes for the postseason were gone.

ANN SANDERS
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PROFESSIONAL

The Barnstable Housing Authority (BHA) seeks an experienced and innovative

Executive Director

to lead and oversee its programs, properties, and contracts with state, federal and local entities.
The BHA owns and operates a 68 unit federally funded building for elderly and younger disabled tenants, a 20-bedroom congregate facility, 136 Ch. 667 units, 52 Ch. 705 units (single family homes/condos), and 52 Ch. 689 units. The BHA manages a 9-unit property in Hyannis. We hold 15 VASH vouchers, 200 DIAL/NED special vouchers, and over 300 additional vouchers – Enhanced, Fair Share, HCV, and project based. BHA administers 39 MRVP vouchers, 13 AHVP vouchers, and 31 DMH vouchers in various locations. BHA created a Rental Acquisition Program (RAP) and added 52 units to our portfolio; the RAP units are affordable, not subsidized.

The BHA has a well-established affordability monitoring program, consisting of 11 rental developments located Barnstable and Yarmouth MA.
Required Minimum Qualifications: Six years' experience in public or private housing, community development, public administration, non-profit administration, or a closely related field that demonstrates strong management and organizational skills. Evidence of effective leadership and private industry business skills will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis. Strong management and organizational skills desired. At least three years supervisory experience of a staff of seven or more is required. Excellent written and verbal skills necessary to communicate with local officials, boards, residents, service providers, and funding agencies. Demonstrated record of creativity and innovation strongly desired. Must have experience working with people of various socio-economic backgrounds.

Working knowledge of fiscal management, maintenance systems, personnel, and administrative management systems in public or private housing is desirable. A working knowledge of local, state, and federal government procedures and regulations as they relate to housing development, construction and the management of housing operations is desirable but not required and may be substituted by high level business or other administrative experience.

While not required for hiring, certification as a property manager or similar classification by a nationally recognized housing or real estate organization or by certification as a MPHA of an EOHLC approved Massachusetts Public Administrator Certification Program is desirable or must be obtained within the first year of employment.
The annual starting salary ranges from $ 122,241 to $ 153,901 depending on experience, certifications, and in compliance with the EOHLC Executive Director Salary Schedule. The work week consists of 37.5 hours, and a generous benefit package is included.
For a complete job description go towww.barnstablehousing.org. Submit cover letter and resume to Executive Search, Barnstable Housing Authority, 146 South Street, Hyannis, MA 02601 The deadline for receipt of applications is October 15, 20262 by the close of business.

Barnstable Housing Authority is an Equal Opportunity Employer.

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All real estate advertising in this newspaper is subject to the Federal Fair Housing act of 1968, the Massachusetts Anti Discrimination Act & the Boston & Cambridge Fair Housing Ordinances which makes it illegal to advertise any preference, limitation or discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, handicap, familial status, national origin, ancestry, age, children, marital status, sexual orientation, veterans status, or source of income or any intention to make any such preference, limitation or discrimination.

This newspaper will not knowingly accept any advertising for real estate which is in violation of the law. Our readers are hereby informed that all dwellings advertised in this newspaper are available on an equal opportunity basis. To complain of discrimination call HUD tollfree at 1-800-669-9777. For the N.E. area call HUD at 617-994-8335. The toll-free number for the hearing impaired is 1-800-927-9275.

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LEGAL NOTICES

Notice of Death: Raymond F. Potvin, date of birth 10/04/1947. Last domicile 237 Franklin Street, Apt 1102, Cambridge MA 02139. Mr. Potvin expired at Winchester Hospital on 06/25/2026. Family and friends are asked to call Mary Tuminelli at 781-756-7531 at Winchester Hospital.

LEGAL NOTICES

LEGAL NOTICE
Request for Proposal (RFP) Announcement

The Boston Public Health Commission (BPHC) is seeking proposals from qualified organizations to implement community-rooted strategies to help reduce life expectancy gaps and advance health equity for Black men in Boston through the Live Long and Well: Black Men's Health Initiative. The RFR will be released on October 1, 2026, on the BPHC website (BPHC RFPs and Bids | Boston.gov).

LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in that certain mortgage from Ayaz Zaffar to Bank of America, N.A., dated February 7, 2006, stamped and accepted for recording or filing at Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 46959, Page 68, thereafter recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 66119, Page 99, as affected by a Reformation Order dated August 18, 2015, and recorded at said registry of Deeds in Book 66119, Page 94, of which mortgage Wells Fargo Bank N.A., as Trustee for Banc of America Funding Corporation Mortgage Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-C is the present holder by Assignment from Bank of America, N.A. to Wells Fargo Bank N.A., as Trustee for Banc of America Funding Corporation Mortgage Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-C dated June 8, 2016 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 67823, Page 544, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 241 North Street, Sudbury, MA 01776 will be sold at a Public Auction at 12:00 PM on October 22, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

The property is described as follows:

A certain parcel of land situated in Sudbury, Middlesex County, Massachusetts, being shown as Lot A-4 North Road on a plan dated September 14, 1992, prepared by Stamski and McNary, Inc., recorded with the Middlesex South Registry of Deeds at Book 23398, page 500 to which plan reference may be made for a more particular description of said lot.

Containing 40,916 square feet of land, more or less, according to said plan or however otherwise said premises may be bounded, measured and described.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 42646, Page 485.

The property will be sold subject to the redemption rights in favor of the Internal Revenue Service by virtue of the tax lien(s) recorded in Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 72349, Page 213 and Book 72597, Page 93.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of $5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designee(s) are exempt from this requirement); high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Wells Fargo Bank N.A., as Trustee for Banc of America Funding Corporation Mortgage Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-C
Korde & Associates, P.C.
900 Chelmsford Street
Suite 3102
Lowell, MA 01851
(978) 256-1500
Zaffar, Ayaz, 23-042944

COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket No. 26 SM 003104
ORDER OF NOTICE

TO: Michael McGrath

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq):

Selene Finance, LP

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in Malden, numbered 63 Beach Street, given by Marie E. McGrath and Michael McGrath to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Quicken Loans Inc., its successors and assigns, dated November 27, 2018, and recorded in Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 71968, Page 561, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/9/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 9/25/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of a Conditional Judgment entered on February 11, 2026 by the Hampden Superior Court, Case No. 2479CV00367 and Order for Sale August 25, 2026, and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Steven James to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for William Raveis Mortgage, LLC, its successors and assigns, dated March 31, 2009 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 17719, Page 574 (the "Mortgage"), as affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated May 25, 2012, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 19407, Page 214, and further affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated May 20, 2014, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 20490, Page 153, and further affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated December 23, 2016, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 21586, Page 3 of which mortgage Onity Mortgage Corporation f/k/a PHH Mortgage Corporation successor by merger to Ocwen Loan Servicing, LLC is the present holder by Assignment from Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as nominee for William Raveis Mortgage, LLC, its successors and assigns to GMAC Mortgage, LLC dated January 11, 2013 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 19645, Page 111, and Assignment from GMAC Mortgage, LLC to Ocwen Loan Servicing, LLC dated July 8, 2013 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 19921, Page 2, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 181 Edendale Street, Springfield, MA 01104 will be sold at a Public Auction at 2:00 PM on October 23, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

The land in Springfield, Hampden County, Massachusetts, described as follows:

Lot numbered Four Hundred Five (405) on the northeast side of Edendale Street, as shown on a plan of lots called REVISION OF EAST SPRINGFIELD SUB-DIV. F, recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book of Plans V, Page 64, to which plan and record thereof reference is hereby made for a more particular description.

Said lot is deeded subject to the restrictions that no old buildings shall be moved on said lot and no building shall be erected on said lot nearer than Twenty (20) feet to the street line, and no garage or outbuilding nearer than sixty-five (65) feet to the street line, and no single dwelling costing less than Two Thousand Five Hundred Dollars ($2,500.00), and no two tenement house costing less than Four Thousand Dollars ($4,000.00) shall be erected thereon.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 17719, Page 572.

The sale of the premises shall constitute a judicial sale pursuant to 28 U.S.C. § 2410 and 12 U.S.C. § 1701k, by virtue of a Lien or a Notice of Lien recorded at Hampden County Registry of Deeds, Book 19630, Page 342 and by virtue of a Lien or a Notice of Lien recorded at Hampden County Registry of Deeds, Book 20360, Page 460 and by virtue of a Lien or a Notice of Lien recorded at Hampden County Registry of Deeds, Book 24781, Page 273.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of $5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designee(s) are exempt from this requirement); high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Onity Mortgage Corporation f/k/a PHH Mortgage Corporation successor by merger to Ocwen Loan Servicing, LLC
Korde & Associates, P.C.
900 Chelmsford Street
Suite 3102
Lowell, MA 01851
(978) 256-1500
James, Steven, 17-030703

Commonwealth of Massachusetts
The Trial Court
Middlesex Probate and Family Court Department

COMPLAINT FOR DIVORCE PURSUANT TO G.L.c. 208 § 1B

Thomas Coker, Plaintiff vs.
Paulina A. Sarpong, Defendant

Plaintiff who resides at 46 Ripley Street, Malden, Middlesex, MA 02148 was lawfully married to the defendant who now resides at 21 Pine Street. Waltham, Middlesex, MA 02453. The parties were married at 610 Main Street, Waltham on January 20, 2012 and last lived together at 46 Ripley Street, Malden on 06/02/2015. On or about 06/02/2015 an irretrievable breakdown of the marriage under G.L.c. 208 § AB occurred and continues to exist. Wherefore, plaintiff requests that the Court grant a divorce on the ground of irretrievable breakdown.

Date: 12/24/25

LEGAL NOTICES

LEGAL NOTICE
MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Kenneth P. Waring and Cindy D. Waring to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for EquiFirst Corporation, its successors and assigns, dated June 15, 2004 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 14268, Page 158 (the "Mortgage"), as affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated May 11, 2016, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 21181, Page 263 of which mortgage The Bank of New York Mellon Trust Company, N.A. FKA The Bank of New York Trust Company, N.A. as Trustee for Residential Asset Mortgage Products, Inc. Mortgage Asset-Backed Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-RP4 is the present holder by Assignment from Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as nominee for EquiFirst Corporation, its successors and assigns to The Bank of New York Mellon Trust Company, National Association fka The Bank of New York Trust Company, N.A. as successor to JPMorgan Chase Bank, National Association as trustee pooling and servicing agreement dated as of September 1, 2006 Mortgage Asset-Backed Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-RP4 dated October 26, 2009 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 18107, Page 172, and Corrective Assignment from Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as Mortgagee, as Nominee for Equifirst Corporation, its successors and assigns to The Bank of New York Mellon Trust Company, N.A., FKA The Bank of New York Trust Company, N.A.., as Trustee for Residential Asset Mortgage Products, Inc., Mortgage Asset-Backed Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-RP4 dated January 25, 2024 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 25311, Page 173, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 81 Florida Street, Springfield, MA 01109 will be sold at a Public Auction at 10:00 AM on October 16, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

Beginning on the northeasterly side of Florida Street at the southerly corner of land now or formerly of one Bosworth and running thence N. 56° 07' E. through a stone bound which is8/100 (.08) feet northeasterly of street line, one hundred sixty-four and 77/100 (164.77) feet to a stone bound; thence northeasterly on said land of Bosworth, 23/100 (.23) feet to another stone bound; S. 33° 53' E. On land now or formerly of Warren D. Kinsman, One hundred seven and 50/100 (107.50) feet to a stone bound; thence S. 58° 14'W. through a stone bound one hundred sixty-five(165) feet to a stone bound in the northeast line of Florida Street; and thence N. 34° W. On Florida Street, one Hundred (100) feet to the point of beginning. Subject to all encumbrances of record.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 13268, Page 464.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of $5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designee(s) are exempt from this requirement); high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

The Bank of New York Mellon Trust Company, N.A. FKA The Bank of New York Trust Company, N.A. as Trustee for Residential Asset Mortgage Products, Inc. Mortgage Asset-Backed Pass-Through Certificates Series 2006-RP4
Korde & Associates, P.C.
900 Chelmsford Street
Suite 3102
Lowell, MA 01851
(978) 256-1500
Waring, Kenneth P. and Cindy D. Waring, 24-045404

STATE OF RHODE ISLAND
FAMILY COURT
NOTICE OF ADVERTISEMENT

Case Number
WJ26-002128
McGrath Judicial Complex
Washington County
4800 Tower Hill Road
Wakefield RI 02879
(401)782-4111

FOR PUBLICATION:
STATE OF RHODE ISLAND FAMILY COURT JUVENILE CLERK'S OFFICE, Washington County. Notice to Amanda Tiemey and any and all parties in interest. In re: Raelin Tiemey born on 8/20/2012 Case Number WJ26-002128. The Department of Children, Youth, and Families has filed a Petition in the Rhode Island Family Court to terminate your parental rights. The Petition is scheduled for a hearing at 4800 Tower Hill Road Wakefield RI 02879 on 10/13/2026 at 10:30 AM. If you do not appear on 10/13/2026 at 10:30 AM an Order will enter terminating your parental rights to the child(ren). Ronald J. Pagliarini, Administrator/Clerk, 9/11/2026

This Notice of Advertisement was generated on 9/11/2026.

/s/ Ronald J. Pagliarini. Administrator/Clerk

LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Judy E. Wilks to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Rocket Mortgage, LLC, FKA Quicken Loans, LLC., its successors and assigns, dated August 19, 2022 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 24696, Page 238 (the "Mortgage") of which mortgage Lakeview Loan Servicing, LLC is the present holder by Assignment from Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Rocket Mortgage, LLC, FKA Quicken Loans, LLC, its successors and assigns to Lakeview Loan Servicing, LLC dated August 11, 2025 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 25981, Page 473, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 79 High Pine Circle, Unit No.79, The Woods at Wilbraham Condominium, Wilbraham, MA 01095 will be sold at a Public Auction at 3:00 PM on October 23, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

The dwelling Unit in Wilbraham, Hampden County, Massachusetts, known as UNIT NO. SEVENTY-NINE (79) in PHASE NO. TWELVE (XII) of THE WOODS AT WILBRAHAM CONDOMINIUM located at 79 High Pine Circle, in said Wilbraham, and created by the Grantor pursuant to Chapter 183A of the Massachusetts General Laws by a Master Deed dated May 21, 1999, and recorded with Hampden County Registry of Deeds on May 21, 1999 in Book 10775, Page 313, as amended by First Amendment to Master Deed dated June 17, 1999 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 10818, Page 463, further amended by Second Amendment to Master Deed dated October 8, 1999 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 10957, Page 264, further amended by Third Amendment to Master Deed dated November 2, 1999 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 10986, Page 458, further amended by Fourth Amendment to Master Deed dated January 19, 2000 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11072, Page 102, further amended by Fifth Amendment to Master Deed dated April 7, 2000 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11152, Page 465, further amended by Sixth Amendment to Master Deed dated June 15, 2000 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11230, Page 513, further amended by Seventh Amendment to Master Deed dated June 23, 2000 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11240, Page 325, further amended by the Eighth Amendment to the Master Deed dated October 31, 2000 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11392, Page 172, further amended by the Ninth Amendment to the Master Deed dated December 14, 2000 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11445, Page 293, further amended by the Tenth Amendment to the Master Deed dated May 25,2001 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11657, Page 232, further amended by the Eleventh Amendment dated October 30,2001 and recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 11944, Page 290, further amended by the Twelfth Amendment to the Master Deed dated January 10, 2002 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 12095, Page 007 as corrected by instrument recorded aforesaid in Book 12128, Page 194., further amended by the Thirteenth Amendment to the Master Deed dated February 28,2002 and recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 12187, Page 342.

Said Unit is conveyed with a 1.329 undivided percentage interest in the Common Areas and Facilities as set forth in said Master Deed which percentage may decrease in the event additional phase(s) are added to the Condominium under paragraph 16 of the Master Deed.

Said Unit as shown on the plans filed with said Master Deed and on the copy of a portion of said plans attached hereto and made a part hereof, and to which is affixed the verified statement in the form required by Section 9 of Chapter 183A.

This conveyance is made subject to and with the benefit of an encroachment easement, an easement for pipes, wires, ducts, flues, cables, conduits, public utility lines and other common elements, all other provisions of the Master Deed, Trust, By-Laws, and Floor Plans of the Condominium recorded with said Registry, or as later amended of record, and all provisions of Chapter 183A.

The unit is conveyed together with an undivided percentage interest in the common areas and facilities of the condominium as set forth in the Declaration of Condominium or Master Deed.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 24689, Page 430.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of $5,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designee(s) are exempt from this requirement); high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

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Lowell, MA 01851
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KEVIN CULLEN

End to the wiseguy era

They say old soldiers never die, but Spucky Spagnolo was an old soldier and he did, in fact, die the other day.

He was 84, and to make it to that ripe old age in his chosen profession is nothing to sneeze at.

Anthony "Spucky" Spagnolo grew up in Revere and was a soldier, first in the US Army, where he served as a paratrooper, then in La Cosa Nostra, the fancy name for the Mafia.

He rose through the wiseguy ranks to eventually become the acting boss of the Patriarca crime family, which was headquartered in Providence and oversaw Boston as one of its fiefdoms.

Though, with all due respect to Spucky, his ascension had as much to do with attrition as with criminal acumen. Which is ironic, as a lot of wiseguys got locked up because of a Mafia induction ceremony Spucky attended more than 35 years ago.

By 2012, when Spucky became acting boss, there weren't many made guys left, and the mob in Boston was more or less reduced to running sports betting operations and a few assorted scams.

But then the government legalized sports betting and the wiseguys were left with bupkis.

Spucky was part of local Mafia lore. He made his bones, as they like to say, when he allegedly took part in one of the most infamous hits in New England mob history.

Back in the day, Spucky used to run with Bobby Carrozza and Bobby's stepbrother, Joe "J.R." Russo. Joe Russo was the Bobby Thomson of the Boston mob, the man who got the biggest hit ever for The Outfit in the North End: He whacked Joe Barboza, a thug-turned-stool pigeon who testified against, among others, Boston underboss Jerry Angiulo.

Almost everything Joe Barboza said, egged on by the FBI, was a lie, and he framed four guys for a murder they didn't commit. The feds moved him to San Francisco, where, naturally, Barboza went right back to crime, because crime paid.

When Joe Russo clipped Joe Barboza in San Francisco in 1976, it put him in the local wiseguy hall of fame, and Spucky, whom the feds claimed was a lookout and getaway driver for that hit, basked in that reflected glory. While Joe Russo was eventually found guilty of the murder, Spucky was never charged in connection with it.

According to the feds, Spucky was an up and comer in 1981 when he, Bobby Carrozza, Freddie Simone, and Vincent "Dee Dee" Gioacchini were in a car the cops stopped outside a Revere nightclub. The club owner had just been beaten up, and Spucky and his buddies matched the description of the attackers. When the cops found two guns under the car seats, Spucky, Bobby, Freddie, and Dee Dee looked at each other with genuine surprise, as if to say, "How'd those get there?"

Still, they beat the rap. The late, great Alan Chapman, Spucky's lawyer, had a line for the ages while trying to convince the jury that Spucky and his goombahs were innocent.

"You have nothing here," Chapman told the jurors, "but a lot of suspicious facts."

In 1989, Spucky ensured his place in national mob history when he was among those who got caught attending a Mafia induction ceremony in Medford.

That induction ceremony led to a series of indictments, including Spucky's in 1991. He got nine years for racketeering and drug dealing, but, God love him, he refused to admit he was in the Mafia, or that there even such a thing as the Mafia. Unfortunately for Spucky, the tapes the feds made at that induction ceremony were more convincing than his denials.

The induction ceremony was overseen by then-boss Raymond Patriarca Jr., who gave nepotism a bad name after taking over the crime family named for his father.

CULLEN, Page B4

Vehicle slams into building at campus of Faulkner Hospital, killing bystander

PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Medical staff, along with patients, were evacuated (top) from a building on the campus of Faulkner Hospital after a car crashed into it. Above, an investigator examined the vehicle.

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
and Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

A woman was killed and at least two people were injured Thursday morning when a vehicle crashed into a building on the campus of Brigham and Women's Faulkner Hospital in Jamaica Plain, rupturing a gas line and prompting the evacuation of more than 30 people, authorities said.

The crash closed the building and forced the hospital to redirect dialysis patients to another site, officials said.

The woman was sitting on a bench in front of Belkin House when the black vehicle struck her, Boston police Superintendent Paul McLaughlin said at a news briefing. She was taken into the hospital's emergency department but did not survive, officials said.

"This, as you can imagine, has caused significant disruption here at the hospital," McLaughlin said. "The preliminary investigation indicates that this was not a deliberate act."

The victim's name was not immediately released Thursday.

Police are not investigating the crash as a crime, McLaughlin said, calling it "a very tragic situation."

Two people in the vehicle were injured and also received medical help at the hospital, officials said. The vehicle came to rest between the entrance to the parking garage and the front steps of the Belkin House, a standalone building that the hospital leases to a dialysis clinic.

Boston paramedics were in the area and witnessed the crash. They called 911 call and requested additional support from firefighters and others because of a gas leak, Boston Emergency Medical Services said in a post on X.

Multiple EMS units responded, established a command center, and coordinated a response alongside hospital staff, firefighters, and police officers, the post said.

Four paramedics were evaluated for exposure.

The Belkin House will remain closed Friday, MGB spokesperson Kelly Mitchell said. Dialysis Clinic

CRASH, Page B4

Judge denies Clancy request for not guilty verdict

By Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

A judge denied Lindsay Clancy's request for a directed verdict of not guilty Thursday, ruling that prosecutors presented sufficient evidence at her trial for a jury to find her criminally responsible for the slayings of her three children, even though jurors were unable to reach a unanimous verdict.

Plymouth Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan found that the evidence, "when viewed in the light most favorable to the Commonwealth and with the reasonable inferences permitted to be drawn, was sufficient to have satisfied any rational trier of fact beyond a reasonable doubt as to the essential element" of Clancy's criminal responsibility.

CRIMINAL RESPONSIBILITY

A judge ruled that sufficient evidence was presented to find her criminally responsible for the slayings.

In the five-page decision, Sullivan wrote that prosecutors presented evidence at Clancy's six-week trial to support their theory that she knew what she was doing was wrong when she strangled her three children in the basement of their Duxbury home in 2023.

He noted that prosecutors called three expert witnesses who testified that, in their opinion, Clancy was capable of appreciating the wrongfulness of her actions.

Although Clancy "also produced expert witnesses who disagreed with the Commonwealth's experts, it is within the discretion of the fact finder to place little or no weight on that evidence," Sullivan wrote. He cited case law indicating that, "When expert testimony conflicts on the matter of sanity the decision is to be left to the jury."

In Clancy's case, Sullivan declared a mistrial Sept. 4 after the jury announced in several notes that it was deadlocked, with jurors voting 11-1 for acquittal based on insanity.

Clancy, 36, admitted to strangling 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan with exercise

CLANCY, Page B4

INSIDE

Farwell's venue change request is denied again
For the second time this year, a federal judge rejected the request of Matthew Farwell, a former detective, to move his upcoming murder trial out of state. B2

No jail time in case of blast at Harvard
The two men who caused a small explosion inside a Harvard Medical School building last November avoided jail time as a federal judge sentenced each to three years of probation. B3

Man charged after woman was allegedly held captive for 6 weeks in Malden attic

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

The report initially seemed routine — a pair of landlords reporting a dispute with their tenants.

But when police arrived at the Malden home, they discovered a horrific scene, a woman who authorities say was held against her will in appalling conditions for weeks.

The property owners said there was a water leak on the second floor, but the people living in the unit were refusing to let them in. When one landlord tried to enter the attic to fix the problem, a man ran past him down the stairs, leaving a woman sitting on a small mattress in the corner, according to a police report.

The residential building is a short walk away from the Oak Grove MBTA Station and several parks. But until then, no one appeared to notice what was allegedly happening inside.

The landlord immediately contacted police, who went up to the attic.

The space was small and dimly lit, and the insulation was exposed. Electrical wires hung overhead, and trash was scattered across the plywood floor. There was a large bucket filled with urine, police said. The woman wore minimal and dirty clothing. Bite marks and scabs covered her arms and legs. She seemed disoriented, unwell.

Police suspected she was a victim of human trafficking and removed her from the apartment. She later recounted what she had allegedly endured there for weeks, leading to the arrest of Jordende Pierre, 29, four days later.

He pleaded not guilty in Malden District Court on Sept. 25 to felony charges of trafficking a person for sexual servitude, kidnapping, and inde-

MALDEN, Page B4

PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

ARBORETUM AMBLE — A woman walked through the Arnold Arboretum Thursday, a warm day in Jamaica Plain, as a bee gathered nectar and a bicyclist rode in the background (right).

Farwell's attempt to move murder trial out of state rejected again

By Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

For the second time this year, a federal judge on Thursday rejected Matthew Farwell's request to move his upcoming trial out of state.

Farwell's lawyers have "not met the high burden of demonstrating that pretrial publicity would prevent" him from receiving a fair trial here, US District Court Chief Judge Denise J. Casper wrote in her decision.

That's the same language Casper used in January when she turned down Farwell's request to relocate his trial to Rhode Island.

A hearing in Farwell's case is set for Friday morning. Jury selection is scheduled to begin Tuesday.

Farwell, 40, a former Stoughton police detective, is accused of strangling Sandra Birchmore, a young pregnant woman he allegedly began sexually exploiting after meeting her when she was a teenager in a youth police Explorers program.

Farwell has pleaded not guilty and asserts Birchmore, 23, killed herself.

On Monday, Farwell asked again to have his trial moved, arguing that coverage of the case in The Boston Globe, Boston Herald, and by local television stations has tainted the jury pool by fostering "widespread public belief that Mr. Farwell is guilty of multiple crimes."

His lawyers included comments posted to news stories about Farwell and argued they show bias against him.

Prosecutors opposed Farwell's request; they wrote Farwell "does not meet the high standard" required to relocate his upcoming trial. The prosecution cited the case of Boston Marathon bomber Dzhokhar Tsarnaev, who repeatedly tried and failed to get his death penalty trial moved.

Prosecutors said questionnaires submitted by potential jurors and interviews conducted with them during the empanelment process will identify people with bias and keep them off the jury.

"Farwell will receive a fair and impartial trial in Boston," the prosecution wrote.

Prosecutors are seeking to seat 12 jurors, plus four alternates, they wrote in court papers.

PRETRIAL PUBLICITY

Matthew Farwell's lawyers have argued on behalf of their client that media coverage has tainted the jury pool.

Testimony is expected to take about a month. There are more than 100 possible witnesses and hundreds of possible exhibits, including thousands of text messages between Farwell and Birchmore.

Birchmore was eight to 10 weeks pregnant when she died, and had told Farwell that he was the father. DNA testing later excluded Farwell as the father of Birchmore's unborn son.

Federal prosecutors allege Farwell killed Birchmore to cover up that he had been sexually exploiting her beginning when she was 15, and he was 27, and other alleged crimes.

Farwell and Birchmore met some time after she enrolled in the Stoughton Police Department Explorers Program in 2010, the year she turned 13. Farwell participated in the program as a youth and stayed involved as a volunteer instructor.

Farwell is charged with killing a witness, Birchmore, and causing the death of her unborn baby boy. If convicted, he faces life in prison.

Testimony is expected to cover disputes over whether Birchmore was killed or died by suicide, allegations of child sexual exploitation and police misconduct, and questions over whether the initial investigation into her death was adequate.

Prosecutors wrote in court papers that they are collaborating with Farwell's attorneys to develop a questionnaire for potential jurors.

Laura Crimaldi can be reached at laura.crimaldi@globe.com. Follow her @lauracrimaldi.

Storm prompts extra flight stops out of Logan

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Last weekend's nor'easter caused a fuel shortage at Boston's Logan International Airport, forcing flights to make additional stops days after the storm passed, officials said Thursday.

Hundreds of flights to and from Logan were canceled and delayed over the weekend, as were ships making fuel deliveries needed to replenish Logan's reserves for refilling aircrafts, said Jennifer Mehigan, a spokesperson for Massport, which operates the airport.

From Sunday to Wednesday, many flights out of Boston had to be diverted to make fueling stops across the country on their way to their destination, airline officials said.

"Due to the forecasted nor'easter, fuel ships couldn't make their regularly scheduled way up to Boston until it was over," Mehigan said. "The airport had enough fuel to get through the weekend, but just to be safe, the fueling consortium asked airlines for the last few days to bring extra fuel in their aircraft to lighten the fueling load here."

DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF FILE

Boston faced a shortage of jet fuel from the nor'easter.

On Delta Air Lines, the provider that flies the most planes out of Logan, spokesperson Anthony Black said most short flights in the region addressed the shortage by carrying enough fuel to get to Boston and the next destination, a practice called "tankering."

But, on longer cross-country flights, there was no choice but to add additional stops to refuel.

From Sunday through Wednesday, roughly a dozen flights from Boston each day were saddled with extra pit stops.

"It's like an F1 or NASCAR stop," Black said, explaining the process known as "gas and go." Customers do not deplane during the stops and are notified ahead of time, he added.

Boston was the only airport Delta serves that saw such disruptions, Black said, even as the nor'easter caused delays in New York, New Jersey, and Pennsylvania.

It remains unclear why the fueling issue only affected services in Boston. Mehigan referred further questions to the airlines.

"There are contingency plans in place, but the unprecedented storm impacted the entire East Coast and caused a bottleneck in the fuel supply chain," said Michael Hardesty of Delta who manages Logan's fuel consortium, a joint ownership structure used at most airports that lets airlines pool fuel resources.

Logan never ran out of fuel, Hardesty said. The first new fuel shipment arrived at Logan on Monday and Tuesday, Mehigan said, and more are planned to arrive this week.

Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@globe.com.

Gang member admits to trafficking guns, drugs

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

A Lawrence man who admitted to trafficking guns and drugs in New Hampshire and Maine under the protection of the violent Trinitarios gang will be sentenced in federal court in January, according to the office of Leah B. Foley, US attorney for Massachusetts.

Nilbel Ventura Amaro, 26, pleaded guilty Tuesday in federal court in Boston to two charges — conspiracy to distribute controlled substances and conspiracy to possess firearms in furtherance of drug trafficking, prosecutors said.

Ventura Amaro, who went by the street names Nino, Megamind, Ben, and Migo, was charged in June along with four other members of the transnational criminal organization. His sentencing date has been set for Jan. 6.

Ventura Amaro trafficked drugs in Maine and supplied fentanyl and cocaine to MacKenzie Bimpson, a large-scale drug and firearms dealer currently serving a state sentence in New Hampshire, prosecutors said.

Investigators uncovered numerous photos and videos documenting conversations between the defendants about their drug and gun activities, federal prosecutors said.

If convicted as charged, Ventura Amato faces a maximum penalty of 40 years in prison.

Ventura Amato was the target of a kidnapping in May 2024 after he took over drug distribution in certain area of New Hampshire and Maine, prosecutors said. He was held in a basement for several days.

The two accused kidnappers were arrested in June 2024 and are awaiting trial.

Tonya Alanez can be reached at tonya.alanez@globe.com.

The Boston Globe

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This day in history

Today is Friday, Oct. 2, the 275th day of 2026. There are 90 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Singer-songwriter Don McLean ("American Pie") is 81. Fashion designer Donna Karan is 78. Actor Avery Brooks is 78. Photographer Annie Leibovitz is 77. Singer-actor Sting is 75. Actor Lorraine Bracco is 72. R&B singer Freddie Jackson is 70. Nobel Peace Prize laureate Maria Ressa is 63. Singer-songwriter Gillian Welch is 59. Actor-talk show host Kelly Ripa is 56. Actor Efren Ramirez is 53. Musician-singer Brittany Howard is 38.

►In 1919, President Woodrow Wilson had a serious stroke at the White House that left him paralyzed on his left side.

►In 1942, the RMS Queen Mary, an ocean liner carrying thousands of American soldiers as a converted troop ship during World War II, accidentally rammed and sank the escort ship HMS Curacoa in the North Atlantic, killing more than 300 crew members aboard the Curacoa.

►In 1944, German troops crushed the 2-month-old Warsaw Uprising, during which a quarter of a million people were killed.

►In 1970, one of two chartered twin-engine planes flying the Wichita State University football team to Utah crashed into a mountain near Silver Plume, Colo., killing 31 of the 40 people on board.

►In 1967, Thurgood Marshall joined the US Supreme Court as its first African American justice; he would serve on the bench for 24 years until his retirement in 1991.

►In 1968, as many as 300 people were massacred at a student protest in Mexico City's Tlatelolco plaza in what the government initially reported as a lawful suppression of a violent riot just 10 days before the Summer Olympics' Opening Ceremony.

►In 2006, an armed milk truck driver took a group of girls hostage in an Amish schoolhouse in Nickel Mines, Pa., killing five of them and wounding five others before taking his own life.

►In 2016, Hall of Fame baseball broadcaster Vin Scully signed off for the last time, ending 67 years behind the mic for the Dodgers as he called a 7-1 loss to the Giants in San Francisco.

►In 2018, US-based journalist Jamal Khashoggi, a critic of Saudi Arabia's government, was killed by Saudi Arabian officials at the Saudi consulate in Istanbul, Turkey.

►In 2019, a B-17 Flying Fortress owned by the Collings Foundation crashed at Bradley International Airport in Connecticut. Seven of the thirteen people on board were killed, and the other six, as well as one person on the ground, were injured.

►In 2020, stricken by COVID-19, President Donald Trump was injected with an experimental drug combination at the White House before being flown to a military hospital, where he was given remdesivir, an antiviral drug.

►In 2023, a fire broke out in a nightclub in the southeastern Spanish city of Murcia, killing 13 people and injuring several others.

Lottery

THURSDAY MIDDAY **2540**

Payoffs *(based on a $1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$6,172
First or last 3	$864
Any 2 digits	$74
Any 1 digit	$7

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$257
First 3	$144
Last 3	$144

THURSDAY NIGHT **9965**

Payoffs *(based on a $1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$6,677
First or last 3	$935
Any 2 digits	$80
Any 1 digit	$8

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$556
First 3	$312
Last 3	$156

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE

Sept. 30 **13-18-22-23-51**
Millionaire Ball 02

Jackpot: $1 million a year for life; winners

MASS CASH

Oct. 01 **02-11-18-27-30**
Jackpot: $100,000; no winners

MEGABUCKS

Sept. 30 **10-19-23-31-41-42**
Jackpot: $1.2 million; winners

PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Wednesday	9671	1957
Tuesday	1512	3422
Monday	6411	1480

THURSDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND

Maine, N.H., Vermont
Day: 3-digit **427** 4-digit **2909**
Eve: 3-digit **004** 4-digit **6470**

Wed. Tri-State Megabucks
10-12-15-25-41 (02)

Rhode Island **0377**

Wednesday's Powerball
04-06-23-33-44
Powerball **13**
Estimated jackpot: $440 million

Defendants in Harvard building explosion receive probation

Halloween antics preceded blast

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

The two men who caused a small explosion inside a Harvard Medical School building last Halloween avoided jail time Thursday, as a federal judge sentenced each to three years of probation.

Logan David Patterson, 19, of Plymouth, and Dominick Frank Cardoza, 21, of Bourne, were also ordered to perform roughly 300 hours of community service and jointly pay $28,517 in restitution for damage caused by the explosion.

US District Court Judge Angel Kelley declined prosecutors' request that the first six months of their probation be served in home confinement.

"I believe the harsh consequences that flowed from this conviction are a sufficient deterrent," Kelley said.

Both men pleaded guilty in April to conspiracy to damage a building by means of fire and an explosive.

No one was injured in the blast, which damaged the fourth floor of the medical school's Goldenson Building in Boston's Longwood area during the predawn hours of Nov. 1, 2025, after the pair had been at multiple Halloween parties with friends.

Along with probation, community service, and restitution, Patterson and Cardoza were ordered to write letters apologizing to Harvard.

Patterson also apologized in court.

"This was a very serious act," Patterson said. "At the time, I thought my actions were harmless and they turned out to be much bigger."

Prosecutors had recommended three years of probation, with the first six months on home confinement. In sentencing papers, they acknowledged the defendants' youth while emphasizing the seriousness of what they did.

ASSOCIATED PRESS FILE

Dominick Frank Cardoza, one of the defendants in the Harvard blast, left federal court last November.

"The defendant committed a serious offense, even if that offense was motivated by immaturity and revelry rather than more serious intentions to cause damage or fear," prosecutors wrote.

Outside court, Stefan Rozembersky, a lawyer for Cardoza, called the sentence fair and stressed that neither man had a criminal record.

"This was not a terrorist attack. This was not a coordinated attack against the government or aimed at Harvard; this was a couple of kids with firecrackers, not even bombs," Rozembersky said, calling it "mischief that went way out of control."

But he said the felony convictions would continue to carry serious consequences for the men.

"It's not without severity," he said. "Having this felony record is going keep them from having some things in life and harm them for a long time."

The break-in and explosion prompted a massive emergency response and unnerved the elite campus, home to cutting-edge medical research.

The blast caused little property damage but drew national attention given the contemporary political climate, particularly at elite universities such as Harvard, which the Trump administration has accused of fostering a climate of antisemitism, a charge the Ivy League institution has adamantly and resolutely denied.

According to an FBI affidavit, the pair arrived at Wentworth Institute of Technology around 8 p.m., meeting up with several people who were going out for Halloween festivities.

Cameras began to record them in Longwood after 2 a.m., and they were seen walking toward the medical school campus at 2:23 a.m.

At 2:24 a.m., they set off what appeared to be Roman candle fireworks outside, footage showed.

A few minutes later, video footage from the Goldenson Building shows them climbing a chain-link fence and hopping into a construction area, the affidavit said. At 2:36 a.m., they're spotted climbing scaffolding next to the building and getting onto the roof.

At 2:45 a.m., police received an alert that there had been an explosion on the fourth floor of the building, which houses a research laboratory that focuses on neurobiology.

They soon left the building, fleeing in opposite directions, according to video footage.

A message was sent to Harvard officials seeking comment Thursday night.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report. Travis Andersen can be reached

DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

MAJESTIC — The Queen Mary 2 made a port of call on Tuesday at the Black Falcon Pier in South Boston assisted by the Anna R., a line service boat.

Family of Springfield teen who drowned on school trip sues camp

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

The Connecticut day camp where a Springfield teenager drowned on a middle school trip in June allowed too many children into the camp's pool that day and operated without proper permits, the family alleged in a wrongful death lawsuit filed this week.

E'Mari Marshall-Woodard, an eighth grader at Kiley Prep Middle School, drowned in the pool at the High Meadow Day Camp in Granby, the lawsuit stated.

The pool's maximum capacity of 142 people had been reduced by the closure of the diving area to 105 people, according to the lawsuit.

When the 14-year-old drowned, there were 150 children in the pool watched over by three lifeguards, the lawsuit alleged. The water quality was poor, with low visibility, it stated.

"In those conditions, E'Mari disappeared beneath the surface within a crowd and drowned in shallow water," the lawsuit alleges. "Resuscitative efforts failed and E'Mari was pronounced dead at 4:11 pm."

According to the lawsuit, 800 students from Springfield and several Connecticut school districts had paid $53 per child for admission to the 150-acre park.

The lawsuit names High Meadow Management Company and 311 LLC as the defendants. The lawsuit identified James D. Cunningham and Michael F. Cunningham as the owners of High Meadow and a second recreational area, Holiday Hill in Prospect, Conn.

The lawsuit alleges that as of June 10, the resort had not received the required "annual authorization from the Farmington Valley Health District to open the pool for the season."

A staffer who answered the phone at High Meadow on Wednesday said no one was available to comment.

The company is accepting reservations for the 2027 season, according to its website.

In June, the boy's mother, Maurissa Marshall, recalled her son as a "math wizard" and said she was devastated by his death.

"I've been crying like crazy because a lot of the kids have reached out to me," she said. "He loved school. He likes to be on time. He didn't like to get things wrong. He's an amazing mathematician."

He told her every day that he loved her, Marshall said.

Granby is a town in northern Hartford County, near the Massachusetts border. It is about a 30-minute drive from Springfield.

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Four in N.H. sue over Medicaid ban on gender-affirming care

By Steven Porter
GLOBE STAFF

Four transgender children from lower-income families in New Hampshire filed a federal lawsuit Thursday challenging a new Medicaid rule that will soon block coverage for the gender-affirming medication their doctors view as medically necessary.

The patients — who are 11, 13, 15, and 15 years old — and their parents are represented by a coalition of advocacy groups. They allege the Trump administration violated their constitutional rights and broke the law by adopting an arbitrary policy for political reasons.

This lawsuit isn't the first to dispute the Medicaid rule change, which goes into effect on Oct. 13. A coalition of more than a dozen states, including Massachusetts, filed suit last month, accusing the federal government of illegally usurping state authority in administering the health programs that insure more than 73 million Americans.

But while many Democrat-led states have explored ways to counteract the impacts of this Medicaid change, there has been no evidence of comparable conversations underway in New Hampshire, where Republicans hold a trifecta in state government, said Chris Erchull, senior staff attorney for GLBTQ Legal Advocates & Defenders.

New Hampshire is the only state in New England that has banned puberty blockers and hormone therapy for transgender minors. The only kids allowed to undergo such gender-affirming treatments in the state are those who began doing so prior to Jan. 1, 2026.

Erchull said the government's move to deny Medicaid coverage for these medications — which comes after President Trump issued executive orders denouncing "gender ideology extremism" and directing federal agencies to bring an end to what he called the "chemical and surgical mutilation of children" — is part of a broader campaign to purge transgender people from public life.

"It's just a glaring example of the hostility that this administration has been demonstrating toward transgender people," he said.

The federal agency that oversees Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance Program adopted a final rule in August that will begin denying coverage for two types of gender-affirming medications: puberty blockers and hormone therapy.

"The impact is falling on the most economically disadvantaged families in America, those who are dependent on Medicaid benefits for accessing health care," Erchull said. "These are people who don't have another option available to them. They have nowhere else to turn."

The final rule also prohibits spending federal dollars on gender-affirming surgeries for minors, which are rare. But the newly filed New Hampshire lawsuit doesn't directly challenge that component of the policy.

"None of these plaintiffs are asking for surgical intervention or need it at this time," Erchull said.

A spokesperson said the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services wouldn't comment on a matter of pending litigation.

The young patients in this lawsuit, who are all identified by pseudonyms to protect their private health information, obtained diagnoses of gender dysphoria years ago, according to court filings.

Dr. Frances B. Lim-Liberty — who is employed as a pediatric endocrinologist at Dartmouth Health, but emphasized she is speaking in her individual capacity — said halting these medications would lead to puberty-driven changes and exacerbate the gender dysphoria that families and physicians have worked carefully for years to manage.

"We're really looking at a forced detransition," she said.

> 'These are people who don't have another option available to them.'
>
> CHRIS ERCHULL,
> *Senior staff attorney for GLBTQ Legal Advocates & Defenders*

All four of the plaintiff patients in this case are transgender girls, so blocking their continued access to these medications would result in masculinizing changes to their bodies, such as developing a deeper voice, facial hair, an Adam's apple, and changes to their bones and faces, according to the lawsuit.

Lim-Liberty said masculine characteristics are difficult to override with hormones alone after puberty has passed.

Professional medical groups overwhelmingly accept gender-affirming care as medically appropriate for adolescents, and the plaintiffs contend the care they have been receiving is essential. But their treatments can cost as much as $70,000 per year each without Medicaid coverage, which is more than their families can afford.

"Medicaid is their lifeline," Lim-Liberty said. "When that is removed or no longer is able to cover certain important aspects of their medical care, it's really hard for families to find other places they can go to access care."

The plaintiffs — who are represented by GLAD Law, the National Center for LGBTQ Rights, and the American Civil Liberties Union of New Hampshire — are asking the judge to block enforcement, invalidate the final rule in its entirety, and issue a declaratory judgment finding that the rule was "motivated by discriminator animus against transgender individuals" in violation of the US Constitution.

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Judge denies Lindsay Clancy's request for not guilty verdict

▶CLANCY
Continued from Page B1

bands on Jan. 24, 2023, after sending her husband, Patrick, out to pick up medication and takeout for dinner. However, she pleaded not guilty to first-degree murder charges, asserting she suffered a psychotic episode and couldn't resist a man's voice she hallucinated commanding her to kill them and herself. Afterward, she slashed her neck and wrists and jumped out of a second-story window, leaving her paralyzed from the waist down.

Clancy's lawyer, Kevin Reddington, asserted that she was failed by the medical system after seeking help for postpartum depression and anxiety following the birth of her third child. In the months and weeks leading up to the slayings, she was prescribed more than a dozen medications, made trips to the emergency room, called a suicide prevention hotline twice, and was voluntarily committed to McLean Hospital for five days.

Prosecutors allege she premeditated the slayings because she was deeply depressed, unhappy with her life, and wanted to kill herself and take her children with her.

Plymouth District Attorney Timothy Cruz has yet to decide whether to retry Clancy on first-degree murder charges, which would require the empanelment of another jury. If he reduces the charges to second-degree murder, Clancy could waive her right to a jury trial and let a judge decide her fate.

During a hearing Wednesday, Reddington urged Sullivan to order a directed verdict of not guilty in Clancy's case, arguing that there was a "complete lack of evidence" showing she killed her three children — despite her admission at trial that she did.

"She was told what happened; she had no memory of what happened," Reddington said.

Assistant District Attorney Shanan Buckingham called Reddington's claims "laughable," noting the defense repeatedly stipulated at trial to physical evidence showing she killed her three children in the basement of their Duxbury home in 2023.

But Reddington argued that Clancy was required to admit to the slayings while asserting an insanity defense because the judge "created a conundrum" by denying the defense request for a bifurcated trial. The defense wanted jurors to decide whether Clancy was guilty during the first phase of the trial, then, if she was, move on to a second phase to decide whether she was criminally responsible.

"In this case there was no investigation," Reddington argued. "They just immediately assumed that this woman was guilty."

In Thursday's decision, Sullivan cited evidence linking Clancy to the slayings of her children.

"With respect to the elements of murder and the identity of who committed the alleged crimes, the evidence presented by the Commonwealth in its case in chief, when viewed in the light most favorable to the Commonwealth, was sufficient to satisfy any rational trier of fact beyond a reasonable doubt," Sullivan wrote.

Sullivan is slated to hear arguments Nov. 2 on a flurry of additional motions, including a request to drop murder charges against Clancy on double jeopardy grounds.

The defense argues that she should not be subjected to another trial because 11 jurors were poised to find her not guilty by reason of insanity and the lone holdout juror was accused of refusing to follow the judge's instructions regarding reasonable doubt. Prosecutors oppose that motion, and a lawyer representing the juror has said he had no doubts when pushing for a guilty verdict.

> 'In this case there was no investigation. They just immediately assumed that this woman was guilty.'
>
> KEVIN REDDINGTON, *Lindsay Clancy's lawyer, asserts that she was failed by the medical system.*

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PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Wheelchairs were lined up after a car crashed into a building Thursday morning on the campus of Brigham and Women's Faulkner Hospital in Jamaica Plain.

Vehicle kills bystander, strikes Faulkner building

▶CRASH
Continued from Page B1

Inc., which operates at the facility, is redirecting its patients to other sites, she added.

The Belkin House, which also houses administrative offices, was evacuated as a precaution while crews checked gas lines for potential damage. Thirty two people including patients and staff were safely evacuated, hospital officials said.

The building was in the process of "incrementally" reopening operations, McLaughlin said.

"Brigham and Women's Faulkner Hospital is deeply saddened by this tragic incident," MGB spokesperson Kelly Mitchell wrote in a statement, adding hospital staff can receive support through an employee assistance program. "We extend our sincere condolences to the family of the individual who died and to those who were injured. Our thoughts are also with all who witnessed today's events."

Esmeralda Villar was leaving the hospital around 11 a.m. when she walked past the aftermath of the crash.

She said she saw blood on the sidewalk outside the building. She said the driver appeared to be an elderly man and worried he may have hit the accelerator by accident.

The cause of the crash is under investigation, officials said.

Around noon, roughly a dozen patients who said they were receiving treatment at the dialysis center sat on the lawn waiting for rides home.

Mike Jones, who came to pick up his mother, said he got a call to pick her up halfway through her treatment.

Medical staff checked on patients who were evacuated from a building on the Faulkner campus.

"I just hope everyone's OK, that's all I can say," he said.

His mother said she was not harmed and didn't witness the crash.

Caution tape surrounded the hospital lawn, where staff watched over patients being sent home.

By Thursday evening, the area largely had been cleared of debris. A chunk of white metal fence remained on the grass. Blood was no longer visible. All was quiet but for a sanitation crew cleaning the Belkin House entrance.

This is not the first time that a vehicle crash has occurred on the hospital campus.

In 2024, a nurse sleeping in her car while on call suffered multiple broken bones after accidentally pressing the gas and driving off the top floor of the hospital's parking garage.

Sarah Rahal and Tonya Alanez of the Globe staff contributed to this report. John R. Ellement can be reached at john.ellement @globe.com. Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@ globe.com. Madyline Swearing can be reached at madyline. swearing @globe.com.

Woman allegedly held in an attic

▶MALDEN
Continued from Page B1

cent assault and battery on a person 14 or older, according to court records.

He was ordered held without bail pending a dangerousness hearing on Oct. 6, records show.

In a police report filed in court after his arraignment, investigators disclosed grim details in a case authorities have described as "deeply disturbing."

"No person should ever be subjected to the violence, exploitation, and loss of freedom alleged here," Dennis Matulewicz, US marshal for Massachusetts, said in a statement last week.

The woman told police she met Pierre about six weeks earlier on the dating app Tinder. He picked her up from the rehab facility she was staying in and brought her to his residence in the Oak Grove neighborhood, the report said. She said she remained inside the attic, only leaving a couple of times, until police arrived on Sept. 20.

She referred to Pierre as her "boyfriend," according to the report.

The woman said she was given crack cocaine and smoked it daily. A man she called "Skinny" who lived on the second floor gave Pierre the drugs, and she told police she was forced to have sex with Skinny's and Pierre's friends as payment for the drugs. Authorities have not said whether the drug supplier will face charges.

The woman told police that she is addicted to cocaine and crack.

Pierre would also arrange "dates" between her and multiple men, the report said.

Pierre would take money from the men and the woman said she would have to "perform sexual acts on the men in the attic bed," police wrote in the report. "[The woman] stated that she never received the money."

She estimated that this happened on 16 different occasions. The conversations between the men and Pierre were all believed to be in Haitian Creole, leaving the woman unable to understand them, according to the report.

She told police that Pierre regularly forced her to have sex with him. When she said she didn't want to, he "would become enraged and begin to scream at her," the report said. She feared abuse if she refused, police said.

The woman told police she often went days without eating. Only when she asked Pierre directly for food, she said, did he bring her something to eat.

At the time of his arrest, Pierre was on release for assault and battery and weapons charges out of Somerville, records show. He had been ordered to stay away from and not contact or abuse the alleged victim.

An attorney for Pierre could not immediately be reached for comment.

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Spucky Spagnolo is dead. So is the Boston Mafia he once led.

▶CULLEN
Continued from Page B1

Junior used to routinely call into radio talk shows in Providence, which made it easy for the feds to identify his voice on the bugs planted at the induction ceremony. A member of Mensa he was not.

For decades, federal prosecutors used the induction ceremony tapes to prove the Mafia did, in fact, exist and dozens of Mafia leaders and soldiers were carted off to prison for long stretches as a result.

Speaking of stretches, when Spucky got out of prison, he teamed up with a soldier named Pryce "Stretch" Quintina, and they began picking over the bones of the old wiseguys's business.

Alas, Spucky and Quintana got jammed up in 2014 for threatening guys at the Moose Lodge in Revere over illegal video poker games.

Bosses, acting or otherwise, used to be insulated from doing the dirty work. But there weren't enough soldiers anymore, and the only insulation guys like Spucky had was in the attic.

At that infamous induction ceremony in Medford, Spucky watched on as the newly made guys burned the card of a saint.

These days, the Mafia might as well burn an AARP card at the Moose Lodge in Revere.

In Boston, the Mafia that Spucky Spagnolo once served now sleeps with the fishes.

Kevin Cullen is a Globe columnist. He can be reached at kevin.cullen@globe.com.

GEORGE RIZER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Anthony "Spucky" Spagnolo was led out of the John F. Kennedy Federal Builing in March 1990.

Business

Bank of America donates $10m to psychiatric hospital for children

Will be part of new complex at Franciscan campus in Brighton

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Boston Children's Hospital has received $10 million to support its construction of a new pediatric psychiatric campus in Brighton, officials said Thursday.

The donation from Bank of America will go toward the $640 million hospital at Franciscan Children's campus. The new space will offer inpatient, outpatient, and rehabilitation services at a larger scale and in a reimagined facility compared to the current campus, hospital representatives said.

The construction comes at a time of rising mental and behavioral health issues among children, studies show.

The bank's gift will be pooled with the project's capital funds, and the bank's name will be emblazoned on a rooftop play area.

"Bank of America is putting a stake in the ground that child mental health is absolutely critical and important," said Dr. Stacy Drury, psychiatrist in chief at Boston Children's. "We're going to say that it is okay to invest and care about child mental health."

The announcement comes almost a year after a historic $100 million donation to jumpstart the project from Quincy billionaire philanthropists Rob and Karen Hale. It was the largest gift in the hospital's history. The first building is expected to break ground on Oct. 8 and open in 2029.

Boston Children's acquired Franciscan in 2023.

Drury said the 10-acre Brighton campus will offer a full continuum of

DONATION, Page B6

SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Liza Little and Art Howe got their grandson, Kai Gunn, ready for physical therapy at Franciscan Children's Hospital in Brighton.

PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY RYAN HUDDLE

Massachusetts has been bringing home plenty of Cs and worse for three years on a report card that aims to assess its economic vitality.

A bad report

Business group's new rankings show Mass. stuck near bottom on jobs and costs

As a kid, when I brought home As and Bs on a report card, my parents always said the same thing: "Nice, but we know you can do better."

But even one C — an F in Mom and Dad's book — got an ominously terse warning: "Do better."

Massachusetts has been bringing home plenty of Cs and worse for three straight years on a report card that aims to assess its economic vitality and ability to attract and retain residents and businesses.

Just as troubling, the state's performance in areas where it has struggled has barely improved since the Massachusetts Taxpayers Foundation, a business-backed policy group, issued its first competitiveness scorecard in 2024.

Do better.

LARRY EDELMAN

TRENDLINES

The latest: An exclusive first look at MTF's 2026 report shows Massachusetts once again ranked near the bottom of all states in key categories.

Among them: job growth, loss of residents to other states, commute times, and, most important, costs for energy, infant child care, and employer-paid health insurance.

MTF's rankings are data-driven, based on government and private statistics.

In addition, the state lost ground in metrics where it had scored better in previous years. On the rate of labor force growth, the increase in people working or looking for a job, Massachusetts fell to 39th from 10th, in part because of a drop in immigration.

TRENDLINES, Page B6

N.H. expands free in-state tuition eligibility

Comes as families grapple with cost of postsecondary education

By Steven Porter
GLOBE STAFF

DURHAM, N.H. — Incoming college students from New Hampshire whose families earn up to $100,000 per year will soon qualify for free tuition at any of the three institutions that comprise the University System of New Hampshire, officials announced Thursday.

A new program, called the New Hampshire Promise, will be available to Granite Staters enrolling for the first time in fall 2027 at the University of New Hampshire, Keene State College, and Plymouth State University.

Cathy Provencher, the university system's chancellor, said the initiative will give students a potentially "transformative" opportunity.

"In launching this new program, all of the university system institutions are working together to make higher education more accessible for more New Hampshire students, enabling them to pursue their dreams right here in the Granite State," she said in a statement.

The announcement follows similar moves by other

FREE TUITION, Page B8

JIM DAVIS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Families earning up to $100,000 per year will be eligible for free in-state tuition at the three University System of New Hampshire schools.

Suit: DraftKings 'weaponized' AI to promote addiction

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A federal lawsuit was filed against online gambling platform DraftKings Wednesday, alleging the Boston-based company uses predatory AI models that promote gambling addiction for profit.

The proposed class action lawsuit filed in US District Court in Boston alleges that DraftKings used artificial intelligence to identify customers who are more likely to gamble and lose, and thus spend more money in response to targeted promotions.

Plaintiff Daniel Vest, of West Virginia, says in the lawsuit that he lost thousands of dollars while gambling through DraftKings. He filed the lawsuit on behalf of himself and to represent all those who received targeted promotions. He said in the lawsuit that in the month prior to Sept. 26, he received about 70 emails, texts, notifications, and other messages from DraftKings, coaxing him to spend more money gambling.

LAWSUIT, Page B7

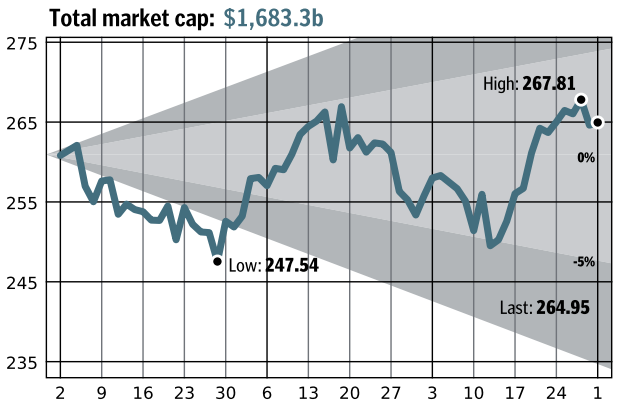
THE BOSTON GLOBE

25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Globe 25 index

Total market cap: $1,683.3b



Yesterday 264.95 ▲ 0.34 ▲ 0.1% ▲ YTD 9.5%

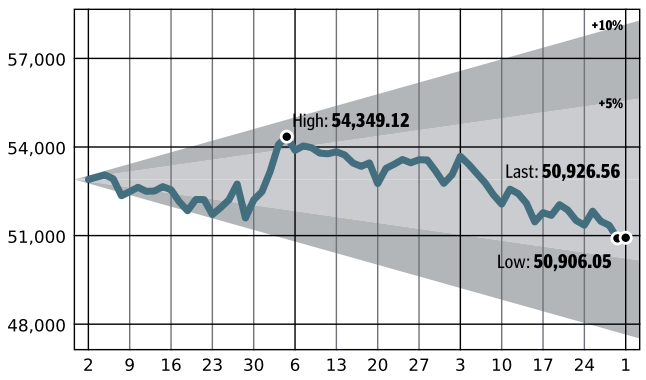
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	987.45	+36.96	+3.9	263.0
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	652.51	-22.54	-3.3	241.3
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	404.60	+7.89	+2.0	196.1
TJX COS INC (TJX)	133.59	+1.28	+1.0	146.9
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	506.74	-16.07	-3.1	128.4
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	188.94	-3.63	-1.9	75.4
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	161.06	-2.63	-1.6	75.0
TERADYNE INC (TER)	415.79	+14.88	+3.7	65.0
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	43.23	-0.42	-1.0	62.7
STATE ST CORP (STT)	174.62	+0.03	+0.0	48.0
WATERS CORP (WAT)	425.53	-13.86	-3.2	41.8
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	30.69	+0.35	+1.2	41.8
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	111.13	+0.18	+0.2	33.1
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	222.82	-3.06	-1.4	32.9
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	231.18	-15.56	-6.3	30.9
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	43.17	+1.10	+2.6	26.1
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	64.31	+0.15	+0.2	24.2
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	158.48	+4.42	+2.9	24.2
VERALTO CORP (VLTO)	94.60	+0.28	+0.3	23.1
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	301.63	+16.81	+5.9	23.0
MKS INC (MKSI)	271.24	+5.88	+2.2	18.3
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	312.51	+2.28	+0.7	16.5
PTC INC (PTC)	146.47	+6.17	+4.4	15.9
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	106.93	+0.58	+0.5	15.4
VICOR CORP (VICR)	308.59	+19.65	+6.8	14.2

Markets

Action overseas as Wall St. idle

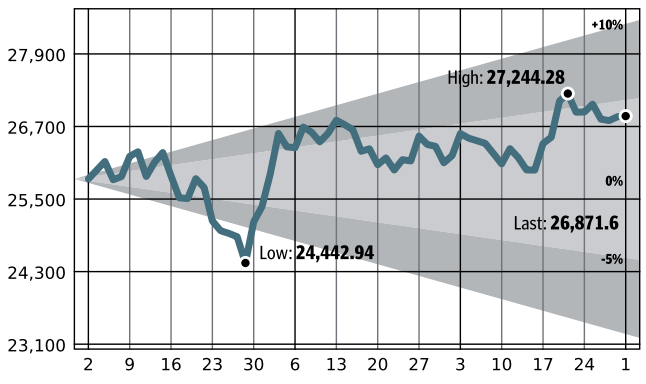
More swings in the bond market rattled stock markets around the world on Thursday. On Wall Street, the moves were relatively modest after US bond yields cranked higher but then gave back the gains later in the day. The moves were more dramatic in Europe, where stock indexes tumbled 1.7 percent in London, 1.6 percent in Paris, and 1 percent in Frankfurt. They were hurt by sharp moves for bond yields on that side of the Atlantic. The yield on the 10-year French government bond, for example, seesawed between 4.8 percent and 4.95 percent. That is a punishing swing for the bond market, where moves get measured in hundredths of a percentage point. Oil prices climbed again Thursday to keep the pressure up on inflation. The price for a barrel of Brent crude leaped 4.4 percent to $102.31 for its latest yo-yo move on uncertainty about when the war with Iran will allow the global oil industry to return to normal. Further reports also signaled the US economy is powering through its many challenges. Fewer US workers applied for unemployment benefits last week, which could mean companies are laying off fewer workers. — ASSOCIATED PRESS

DOW JONES industrial average



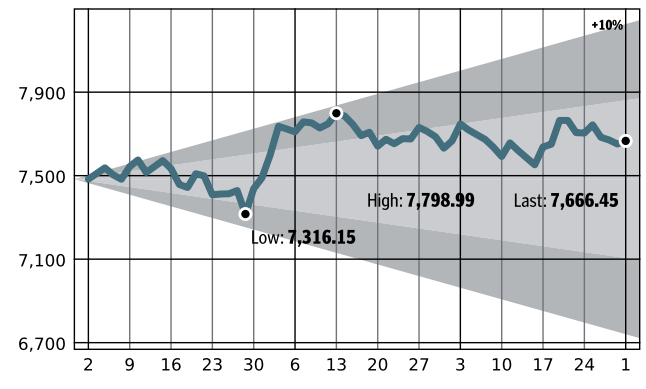
Yesterday 50,926.56 ▲ 20.51 ▲ 0.0% ▲ YTD 6.0%

NASDAQ Composite index



Yesterday 26,871.60 ▲ 10.54 ▲ 0.0% ▲ YTD 15.6%

S&P 500 index



Yesterday 7,666.45 ▲ 14.91 ▲ 0.2% ▲ YTD 12.0%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

Mass. stuck near bottom on jobs, costs

▶TRENDLINES
Continued from Page B5

After the unemployment rate ticked up last year, the state dropped to 43rd from 31st.

But there is good news, too.

The state remained in the top 5 in areas of traditional strength, including economic productivity (second), average weekly wages (third), and venture capital investments (second). It climbed into the top 10 for low poverty rates.

Why it matters: The lack of progress over the past three years underscores that making Massachusetts a more appealing place to live or run a company will be a slog.

"Turning the ship is a slow process," said Doug Howgate, MTF's president. "We are not going to lose our strengths overnight. At the same time, the work being done on things such as housing costs, energy costs, and commute times is nowhere near finished."

Closing the gap: As the Globe has detailed in a series of stories, Massachusetts is losing jobs and people to other states with lower taxes, cheaper living costs, and less burdensome business regulations.

Florida, North Carolina, and Texas still lagged Massachusetts in economic productivity (per-capita economic output) last year, but they posted faster increases over the past one- and five-year periods.

DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

The lack of progress underscores that making the state a more appealing place to live or run a company will be a slog.

Venture capital investments in Massachusetts rose 7 percent last year, while Florida, New York, California, and Texas saw increases of more than 50 percent.

Texas, ranked third in number of international students, increased enrollment 8.4 percent last year, while in fourth-ranked Massachusetts, enrollment grew by just 2.2 percent.

D.C. complications: MTF highlighted two examples of Trump administration policies pressuring the state.

Immigration restrictions. The rate of international migration to Massachusetts fell by almost half last year, a major factor — along with boomer retirements — in the shrinking labor force.

Meanwhile, growth in international student enrollments at colleges and universities has slowed for two years in a row, a trend that, if continued, could take a meaningful toll on their tuition revenue and research operations.

National Institutes of Health funding. Massachusetts receives more NIH grant money per capita than any other state. Funding dropped 2.7 percent in the last federal fiscal year from the peak in 2023.

"While many NIH grants resumed after the court overturned the Trump administration's effort to eliminate funding, new federal regulations have been announced that could further limit access to funding if research projects are not aligned with the administration's agenda," MTF said.

Final thought: There are no simple solutions for improving the state's competitiveness.

But MTF, like other business groups, has policy priorities.

Cut the estate tax and the amount employers pay into the unemployment insurance fund. Spur housing production in downtown areas. Support research institutions hit by federal funding cuts. And enact a rigorous statewide high school graduation standard to ensure that the state protects its highly ranked K-12 education system.

Offsetting lost tax revenues and funding incentives to build more housing without sacrificing essential services are not insignificant challenges. But ideas like these should be getting more serious attention from state and local leaders.

I know we can do better.

Larry Edelman can be reached at larry.edelman@globe.com.

PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Clinicians with MGB Home Care, and their supporters, staged an informational picket outside Massachusetts General Hospital in Boston in March.

MGB dismisses nurses union's claim about postponed summit

By Alison Kuznitz
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

Brigham and Women's Hospital nurses who are prepared to go on strike indefinitely claimed Thursday that a planned action for next week prompted Mass General Brigham to delay a major event, while the health system dismissed the union's assertion as the contract negotiation stalemate continues.

The 10th Annual Mass General Brigham Summit was slated for next Wednesday at the system's Somerville headquarters. Anna Brown, MGB's senior vice president of human resources, told staff Tuesday the event was "being postponed to a future date," according to a message the Massachusetts Nurses Association circulated Thursday morning.

The MNA argued the scheduling change happened after the union issued a picket notice for outside the event. Nurses and clinicians also protested outside MGB's World Medical Innovation Forum last week in the Seaport, drawing support from US Representatives Stephen Lynch and Richard Neal, the MNA said.

"MGB may pretend that everything is business as usual, but our protests about their corporate greed are clearly upsetting the billionaires who run MGB," said Kelly Morgan, a labor and delivery nurse and chair of the Brigham bargaining committee.

"As 4,000 Brigham nurses prepare for a potential open-ended strike, we have one message for MGB: Negotiate a fair contract that protects our patients and respects the world-class care we provide," she added.

MGB achieved a profit of nearly $2.4 billion in fiscal 2025, according to a recent state report.

LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

> 'It is unfortunate that the postponement of an event that is valued by so many of our employees is being celebrated by the [Massachusetts Nurses Association].'
>
> JESSICA PASTORE,
> *Mass General Brigham spokesperson*

Brigham nurses last week voted to authorize an open-ended strike, after their July work stoppage did not create a breakthrough in contract negotiations. Nurses want cost-of-living increases and affordable health insurance, while MGB says that nurses receive annual 5 percent raises as part of a 20-step wage scale.

MGB spokesperson Jessica Pastore said the union's press release was "inaccurate" and that the summit was "not postponed because of the MNA."

"The MGB Annual Summit is hosted by our Office of Workforce Enrichment and is intended to provide a safe space for all members of our workforce to come together for inclusive, transparent, and respectful dialogue about workplace culture and belonging," Pastore said. "It is unfortunate that the postponement of an event that is valued by so many of our employees is being celebrated by the MNA."

Ahead of Labor Day weekend, Governor Maura Healey called on MGB to schedule another bargaining session and "then stay at it until contracts are done." Pastore said MGB has unsuccessfully tried to schedule sessions through a federal mediator.

Bank gives $10m to Children's Hospital

▶DONATION
Continued from Page B5

mental health care facilities, meaning children can move between levels of care in the same space, which she said can be helpful for kids with neurodevelopmental disorders or disabilities.

Inpatient units will include 60 beds for inpatient psychiatric care and 60 for complex care and medical rehabilitation. All inpatient rooms will have a single bed. Past designs could house up to four beds in a room and lead to blocked beds due to a mental health condition that prevents shared rooms. Such expansion will reduce wait times, improve early intervention, and ensure accurate diagnosis and care, per the hospital's announcement.

The overall design of the new campus will include large windows with ample daylight, outdoor spaces, and dedicated family rooms, where patients' relatives can take personal calls or time for themselves while remaining near their loved one.

"It is an entire system in one physical space to ensure seamless care," Drury said.

The hospital's announcement said the new campus will create between 150 and 200 new jobs in the community and more than 3,320 construction jobs.

On Thursday, about 25 Bank of America workers volunteered at the Franciscan hospital and spent time with patients in the medical rehabilitation and behavioral health units.

When Holly O'Neill, Bank of America's president of consumer, retail, and preferred banking, toured the hallways of the current Franciscan campus, she noted its age and dark atmosphere.

"It felt very isolating," she told the Globe. "I think that is really what opens the door to a space that's more thoughtfully designed."

She touted Boston Children's commitment to provide care that is designed to meet the needs of patients.

"I've experienced Boston Children's as a parent and appreciate the care that they provide," she said. "I know firsthand from friends and family that [mental health care for children] is a need."

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TALKING POINTS

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DELIVERY

AMAZON SETTLES LAWSUIT OVER CLAIMS OF SLOW DELIVERIES TO LOW-INCOME NEIGHBORHOODS

Amazon on Thursday settled a lawsuit brought by the District of Columbia over claims it made slower deliveries in the city's low-income neighborhoods, as the e-commerce giant faces pressure from government officials over how it runs its vast logistics network. The lawsuit, filed in 2024 by Attorney General Brian Schwalb in Superior Court of the District of Columbia, argued Amazon had excluded two ZIP codes from its in-house Prime delivery services. Those ZIP codes covered historically low-income areas, the lawsuit said. The company failed to inform customers about the slower deliveries and violated the District of Columbia's consumer protection laws, according to the lawsuit. Under the terms of the settlement, Amazon will refund $7.25 million in Prime membership fees to affected customers, according to a news release. The company will also pay a $1 million penalty to the district and agreed to notify Amazon customers there of future restrictions on its delivery service. The attorney general's office said roughly 69,000 members of Amazon's Prime service experienced slower deliveries as a result of Amazon's practices. "Amazon deceived thousands of its customers," Schwalb said in a news release. "Now, we're putting more than $7 million back in the pockets of people who were taken advantage of." An Amazon spokesperson, Steve Kelly, said the company had never deceived anyone about the deliveries and in "no way is this settlement an admission of wrongdoing." "Rather than engage in prolonged litigation, we chose to resolve this matter so we can stay focused on what we do best: delivering great service to every customer across Washington, D.C.," he said. — NEW YORK TIMES

HOUSING

MORTGAGE RATES KEEP CLIMBING, LEADING SOME BUYERS TO RISKIER LOANS

Mortgage rates continue to creep higher, compounding an affordability crunch that has squeezed many Americans' wallets. Now soaring rates are prompting some homebuyers to roll the dice that they will fall in a few years. The average 30-year, fixed-rate mortgage, the most popular home loan in the United States, rose to 7.28 percent this week, up from 7.03 percent last week and the highest since November 2023, mortgage financing giant Freddie Mac said Thursday. "Mortgage rates jumped to their highest level in almost three years, pushing borrowers to the sidelines," said Joel Kan, deputy chief economist at the Mortgage Bankers Association, a trade group. Mortgage rates had fallen below 6 percent at the end of February but began to inch higher after the United States and Israel attacked Iran on Feb. 28. The war in Iran has driven up energy costs, which in turn has stoked inflation fears. In response, investors have pushed up the yield on the 10-year Treasury note, which on Thursday reached its highest level since 2002. The 10-year Treasury yield underpins a wide range of consumer and corporate borrowing, including mortgages. With the yield climbing quickly, the jump in mortgage rates this week was the biggest since October 2022. Adjustable-rate mortgages can be significantly lower than their fixed-rate counterparts, real estate experts say, sometimes as much as a full percentage point, a difference that can potentially save homebuyers thousands of dollars annually. The ARM, as the loan is known, also comes with the risk that rates will continue to climb, hurting owners when the loan resets. ARMs are an increasingly enticing option among buyers put off by the jump in fixed-rate mortgages, Kan said, adding, "They are looking for more ways to get into that home." The association reported a recent uptick in the share of ARM applications, to 10.3 percent of overall mortgage applications, the highest in a year. — NEW YORK TIMES

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

MARYLAND GOVERNOR FORMS BIPARTISAN GROUP ON AI, CITES FEDERAL INACTION

Governor Wes Moore (below left) of Maryland is forming a bipartisan group of governors to respond to mounting concerns about the threats posed by artificial intelligence as he argued that states need to fill a void left by the federal government's inaction on the issue. In an interview, Moore, a Democrat, criticized President Trump's meeting with AI executives at the White House this week as a "billionaire boys club." He was also critical of Congress for leaving Washington until after next month's midterms without addressing the rapidly evolving technology. "The federal government has a unique leadership role that they have to play and that includes both the White House and Congress," Moore said after speaking at an innovation conference in Baltimore. "In the absence of that, the governors cannot just sit on our hands." Moore is the chair of the National Governors Association this year and said his co-chair, Republican Governor Mike Braun of Indiana, would partner with him in developing an AI framework. Other governors from both parties are planning to participate, Moore said. Increasingly dire warnings from tech executives that AI could pose an existential threat to humanity have tested the ability of governments at all levels to respond nimbly to fast-moving developments. So far, states have been more active than the federal government, but their power is limited when it comes to dealing with a technology that spans the country and the globe. — ASSOCIATED PRESS

JOBS

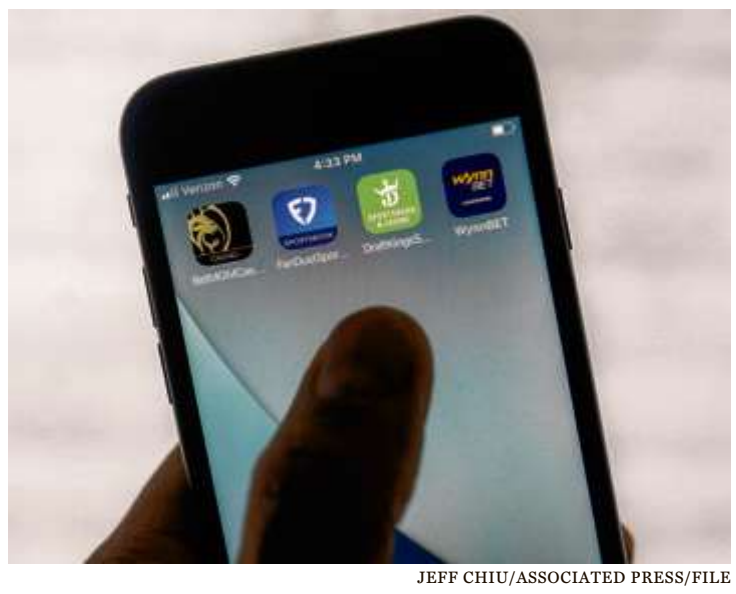
UNEMPLOYMENT CLAIMS DIP TO 197,000, LOWEST SINCE MID-JULY

The number of people applying for US unemployment benefits dipped last week to the lowest level since mid-July as layoffs remain low and most American workers enjoy job security. The Labor Department said Thursday that initial jobless claims ticked down to 197,000 from a revised 198,000 the week before. The four-week average of claims, which smooths out week-to-week volatility, dropped by 2,500 to 200,000. Claims for jobless benefits are a proxy for layoffs, and economists watch them because they can be a sign of where the job market is headed. So far this year, claims have mostly stayed below 220,000 — historically low. The American job market has remained sturdy despite higher energy prices that have squeezed businesses and consumers since the fighting with Iran began Feb. 28. The United States on Tuesday reported that US employers posted fewer job openings in August. The Labor Department's Job Openings and Labor Turnover Survey also showed that layoffs fell and the number of people quitting their jobs — a sign of confidence in their prospects — retreated slightly in August. The report's measure of gross hiring — before subtracting people who quit or lost their jobs — ticked up modestly in August but remains at low levels. — ASSOCIATED PRESS

FOOTWEAR

NIKE'S RESULTS FALL SHORT OF ESTIMATES AS COMPANY SEARCHES FOR ITS COMEBACK

Nike Inc. said it's consolidating its operations and cutting jobs while warning that its sales slump is poised to deepen. The company now sees revenue declining in the high-single digits in the current fiscal year. That's worse than the 2.4 percent drop that's projected in a Bloomberg survey of analysts. Sales were $11.2 billion in the company's fiscal first quarter ended Aug. 31, a decline of 4 percent and below the average of estimates. Chief executive Elliott Hill is about to begin his third year leading Nike, and pressure is mounting for the company to show signs of improvement. Nike's stock has slumped more than 40 percent this year, and it's headed for a fifth consecutive annual decline. On Thursday, the shares fell 4 percent at 4:41 p.m. in extended trading in New York. Nike plans to consolidate its geographical divisions. Greater China, which saw its a ninth consecutive quarterly decline, is being merged into its broader Asia Pacific region. Latin America, which previously was grouped with Asia Pacific, will be combined with North America. Hill said in a memo to employees that the change, along with other upcoming moves, means that "Nike will require fewer roles over time" and decisions about which roles will be impacted will be made beginning next year. The company expects the plan to generate $2.5 billion in savings over the next five years. It will generate about $1 billion of pre-tax charges. "The future will belong to companies that can move faster, serve athletes and consumers more locally, and invest more aggressively in innovation," Hill said in the memo. The latest report suggests the company's problems are getting worse. Nike's direct-to-consumer revenue missed expectations, as did the footwear division. Poor results at Boston-based Converse persisted, and the brand has now posted 14 straight quarters of falling sales. In China, Nike faces nimble local competition and a growing preference for national brands. Converse's performance has been marred by an overreliance on the Chuck Taylor All-Star shoe. A recent ad that evoked the Ku Klux Klan has further roiled the brand and sparked a temporary pause on advertising. — BLOOMBERG NEWS



JEFF CHIU/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

In Massachusetts, gambling organizations must disclose all use of AI and automated capabilities to the state.

Suit: DraftKings 'weaponized' AI to promote addiction

▶LAWSUIT
Continued from Page B5

"DK has weaponized AI to do just that — understand and exploit users' vulnerabilities to financially benefit the company," the lawsuit says.

The lawsuit also alleges that DraftKings collected and analyzed data points for each user, including their spending habits and how much they typically lose. The company allegedly then failed to disclose to users that it was using AI or machine learning for that purpose, violating Massachusetts state law.

"DraftKings does not use AI to target customers based on losses, nor do we use AI to target customers based on indicators of potential problem gaming," a DraftKings spokesperson said in a statement Thursday. "We intend to vigorously defend any potential lawsuits on the matter."

The lawsuit comes after a September investigation from The New York Times uncovered the trend, and the lawsuit quotes heavily from the Times article. The Massachusetts Gaming Commission, the state regulator overseeing DraftKings and other gambling companies, said last week that it would examine the allegations against the company and others operating in the state.

In a Wednesday interview with the online news outlet The Wrap, DraftKings chief executive Jason Robins refuted the Times' report, calling it "slanderous."

"They said that we are writing models to target people that have problem gaming issues, which is not true," Robins said in the interview, which was released ahead of the lawsuit's filing. "In fact, we tell people to do the opposite, to try to figure out if people have problem gaming issues and give them warnings and eventually shut down their accounts if we need to."

According to the lawsuit, a former DraftKings employee said he had worked on a system that identified people who were trying to ditch the platform. The system would then try to pull them back in, the employee told the Times.

Another former employee developed a program that boosted promotions for people who were gambling "more aggressively than usual," according to the lawsuit.

"It is as predatory as it sounds," a former employee told the Times, which is quoted in the lawsuit.

And DraftKings, the lawsuit alleges, reaped the benefits.

Analytics and data science helped drive up margins on promotion-driven sports bets by 13 percent in 2025 the lawsuit says. The program used AI to personalize hundreds of millions of promotional dollars, the lawsuit says.

The lawsuit refers to Citizens Bank research that showed DraftKings boasted around $8.7 billion in gross revenue from sports and casino gamblers in 2025, and handed out roughly $3 billion in promotions.

Per Massachusetts law, gambling organizations must disclose all use of AI and automated capabilities to the Gaming Commission, as well as report the ways in which they analyze customer data to mitigate addictive behavior. Gambling organizations are prohibited from using personal customer information in promotional material that uses AI or another form of an automated system.

"The New York Times does a very good job of reporting and checking their facts. But, as a government agency, we need to do some fact-finding on the ground," said Thomas Mills, a gaming commission spokesperson. The commission declined to comment on active litigation or say what its investigation into DraftKings would entail.

"We'll start with a conversation," Mills added.

Dr. Timothy Fong, a psychiatry professor and co-director of the Gambling Studies Program at the University of California Los Angeles, said enticements and promotions have been "going on since the dawn of regulated gambling."

But the introduction of AI and its ability to predict and analyze user patterns raise what he described as a dark question.

"If they are scrubbing AI platforms to find the [users] who are clearly vulnerable, who are already addicted or going to become addicted ... that would be a tremendous violation of the spirit of business," Fong said. "Are they using software deliberately to find those ones who are vulnerable and exploit them?"

AI and machine learning could be used for good, Fong added, if gambling companies identify users with alarming betting habits and help mitigate addiction or cut them off.

DraftKings is already defending a number of lawsuits related to illegal gaming offerings, or misleading and addictive products, as well as a proposed class action lawsuit filed in a federal district court in Pennsylvania in April. The Pennsylvania lawsuit alleges that DraftKings targeted users with gambling addictions through its VIP program and misleading promotions.

Mark Gottlieb, executive director of Northeastern University's Public Health Advocacy Institute, compared the mounting lawsuits to the pushback against tobacco companies in the 1990s, which resulted in policy changes at the state and federal levels.

"This is exactly what we are beginning to see with DraftKings and others in the online gambling industry" Gottlieb said. "Their conduct is coming to light and the resulting wave of litigation will soon provide a level of transparency needed to make these products safer for the public."

The lawsuit asks the court to certify a class action, award damages, require DraftKings to return money obtained through these practices, and order a stop to the use of AI models to target users and encourage them to gamble more.

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ABOVE: DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF; BELOW: ALEX BRANDON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The first national school choice scholarship program, the Federal Scholarship Tax Credit, will launch Jan. 1, establishing a taxpayer-funded incentive for families to choose private or homeschooling in participating states.

National school choice starts in 2027

Scholarships will be offered to students in at least 30 states

By Bianca Váquez Toness
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Nearly all schoolchildren in at least 30 states can apply for a new federal scholarship next year to help pay for private school, homeschooling, and other educational expenses, according to regulations proposed Thursday by the Trump administration.

The first national school choice scholarship program, the Federal Scholarship Tax Credit, will launch Jan. 1, establishing a taxpayer-funded incentive for families to choose private or homeschooling in participating states. Taxpayers who donate to an organization passing out the scholarships will receive a federal tax credit, a perk expected to further fuel the conservative school choice movement.

About 96 percent of children in those states should be eligible, according to the department. Children attending public schools could use the scholarships for extra learning expenses.

"Education freedom is the key to unlocking opportunity and success for our next generation of students," said US Secretary of Education Linda McMahon in a statement issued Thursday. The federal scholarship program, she said, will ensure "every child has access to the education they need, not one limited by ZIP code, family income, or government-imposed barriers."

School choice scholarships have been available for decades in conservative-led states and throughout the South, giving individual students taxpayer-funded grants ranging from a couple thousand dollars to more than $30,000 a year. In places where they are available to all students regardless of income, such as Florida and Arizona, the majority of students using the money were already in private or home school or were from affluent neighborhoods, an analysis by the Associated Press showed.

The federal program departs from most state programs by not forcing students to leave public school to qualify for a scholarship. Public school students could use the money for tutoring or special education therapies, although the Republican administration has not provided specific criteria for eligible expenses yet.

Regulators say they have set up the program in a way that will make it easier for poor students to apply, proposing to let students use proof of participation in a government assistance program in lieu of providing income documentation. Foster children would not have to provide any income verification when they apply, officials said.

Experiences with school choice scholarships in other states have shown barriers to using the programs go beyond paperwork.

Many families often do not know scholarship programs exist. Federal officials have not said how they would tell taxpayers and students about the scholarships.

US Secretary of Education Linda McMahon, pictured above greeting President Trump in August, said, "Education freedom is the key to unlocking opportunity and success for our next generation of students."

Taxpayers will have the chance to donate to a scholarship program in a participating state, even if they do not live there, starting Jan. 1. Individuals can donate up to $1,700 and receive a federal tax credit for the same amount in exchange. Federal officials propose a couple filing jointly could give as much as double that amount.

Scholarship recipients could use their funding to pay for religious or private school tuition, homeschooling costs, tutoring and special education therapies, books, computers and other expenses connected to enrollment or attendance, according to officials at the Treasury Department.

States could not turn to laws or regulations to narrow the uses for the scholarships or the type of organization that can grant them, federal officials said.

But states can choose whether to participate in the program.

According to the most recent Treasury Department list, as of mid-September these states are in for 2027: Alabama, Alaska, Arkansas, Colorado, Florida, Georgia, Idaho, Indiana, Iowa, Kansas, Kentucky, Louisiana, Mississippi, Missouri, Montana, Nebraska, Nevada, New Hampshire, North Carolina, North Dakota, Ohio, Oklahoma, South Carolina, South Dakota, Tennessee, Texas, Utah, Virginia, West Virginia, and Wyoming.

Governors from Arizona, Minnesota, Wisconsin, and Oregon have said their states will not join, with some arguing these programs divert resources from public schools.

More than two dozen states have yet to say what they will do. In New York, Democratic Governor Kathy Hochul has been supportive, and the state is expected to sign up.

In Massachusetts — a state with historically robust public school funding, caps on charter school expansion, and no taxpayer funding for private school tuition — education advocates on both sides are lobbying the governor to take a stand and pushing the public to register their opinion.

The state's association of school superintendents opposes the idea that districts should take advantage of the program by creating their own nonprofits to accept donations and distribute scholarships. Many big city school districts around the country already have their own foundations. In Massachusetts, where every municipality has its own district, the majority of the more than 300 school systems have no such entity.

"Districts face a significant disadvantage compared to the private school networks that already have elaborate fundraising and scholarship infrastructure in place," reads the Massachusetts Association of School Superintendents' position paper. The group said requiring families to apply for scholarships and, in many cases, prove income eligibility were "bureaucratic hurdles that will certainly leave behind our most vulnerable families."

On the other side, former Boston City Councilor and former public schoolteacher Annissa Essaibi George has argued Boston Public Schools faces severe budget shortfalls and needs new streams of income.

And besides, she argued in an op-ed published in the Dorchester Reporter: "Massachusetts taxpayers will be eligible to take advantage of this program whether the governor opts in or not. The only question is whether those dollars come back to Massachusetts children, or instead flow to students in states that moved faster."

In just a few years, after donations from taxpayers pick up, the IRS and the Treasury Department predict the program will direct nearly $26 billion into as many 2.2 million scholarships each year.

The federal tax-credit scholarship program was signed into law last year by President Trump as part of his signature tax breaks and spending cuts bill. The public has 60 days to comment on the Treasury Department's proposed regulations.

Most American children are being auto-enrolled in Trump accounts

By Tara Siegel Bernard and Claire Cain Miller
NEW YORK TIMES

Nearly every child in America now has a new savings account with their name on it, as well as someone else's: President Trump's.

The Treasury Department said Thursday that it automatically enrolled more than 60 million children into Trump accounts, the tax-deferred savings vehicles also called 530A accounts that were introduced in July.

The 530A accounts are essentially starter individual retirement accounts: Parents, guardians, and others can contribute up to $5,000 annually. But other relatives, employers, philanthropists, governments, and charitable groups can also make deposits, which grow tax-deferred in an ultralow-cost stock index fund.

Once all children have accounts, the hope is that nonprofits and government donors will be more likely to make contributions.

If you have children under 18, they probably have one now, too.

The Treasury Department created Trump accounts for all eligible children who didn't already have one — or those who have Social Security numbers and who will not have turned 18 before the end of the calendar year.

Before this week, parents or guardians had to sign up their children completely on their own. Though more than 7 million children had been enrolled as of late July, that represents only about 10 percent of all eligible American children. Just 5 percent of low-income families had opened 530A accounts for their children, according to a survey by Commonwealth, a nonprofit.

Automatic enrollment removes that hurdle, putting every eligible child in a position to receive the widely publicized free contributions from philanthropists, charitable organizations, and governments, all of which Trump accounts are permitted to collect.

"The research was overwhelmingly clear that auto enrollment is the way to get to full participation, especially for low-income folks, and I think Treasury listened," said Ray Boshara, a senior policy adviser at Washington University in St. Louis who has helped policymakers in both parties develop plans for children's savings accounts.

Parents and guardians do not need to do anything to claim contributions from philanthropic groups. With an open account, children can automatically capture anything they may be eligible for.

But parents will need to claim the account to make their own deposits and to receive matching contributions for employers. During that process, they must also elect to receive the federal government's seed deposit of $1,000 for eligible children born in 2025 through 2028.

They can do that through the Trump account mobile app. During that process, parents or guardians must verify their identity, confirm their relationship to the child, review their child's information, and accept the account terms, a Treasury spokesperson said.

Many financial experts say that all children can benefit from a 530A account, simply because it serves as a collection basket to receive free money. But not every household should contribute to one.

Trump (or 530A) accounts are essentially individual retirement accounts — and squirreling away money for your children's retirement usually ranks low on the hierarchy of savings needs when there are so many other goals that should be prioritized first: emergency funds, paying down debt, saving for your own retirement, and your children's college. There are already a variety of accounts that are more flexible and tailored for many of those purposes.

The Trump administration has highlighted the large balances that can materialize after many years with a fully funded account, but most American families don't have the wherewithal to contribute that much.

Individuals can contribute up to $5,000 a year, and employers can contribute up to $2,500, which counts toward that annual cap. But eligible government and philanthropic contributions can be made without limit and do not apply to the annual ceiling.

The Treasury Department's rules say it will continue to periodically auto enroll children, so most parents and guardians won't need to open the accounts on their own — they will still need, however, to claim their children's accounts.

If the rare need arises, parents and guardians can enroll their children through the mobile app, the web page, or through IRS Form 4547, the Treasury rules say.

The Social Security Administration said in July that it would enroll newborns in the accounts when new parents requested a Social Security number — and the Treasury Department will continue to work with the agency on that, according to a Treasury spokesperson.

These are individual accounts: Contributions are received and recorded by the individual account, but the money is invested collectively through a master group trust, the regulations said. Each account holds an interest in that trust, without disclosing taxpayer information, according to a Treasury Department spokesman.

This week, the IRS issued temporary rules that accelerates that process to adopt 530A accounts into the tax code, while also proposing final rules that allows the public to comment.

The accounts are estimated to cost just over $15 billion in taxes through 2034, according to estimates from the Joint Committee on Taxation.

N.H. expands free in-state tuition eligibility at public universities

▶FREE TUITION
Continued from Page B5

schools in New England and beyond — including public universities in neighboring Maine, Massachusetts, and Vermont — as they work to address the sticker shock that leads many prospective students to question the value of postsecondary education.

Some private institutions in New Hampshire have comparable programs in place. Saint Anselm College offers free tuition to residents of Maine, New Hampshire, and Vermont whose families earn $100,000 or less. Franklin Pierce University does likewise for residents of New Hampshire, Vermont, and Massachusetts. Dartmouth, meanwhile, touts a "Zero Parent Contribution Initiative" for families earning less than $125,000 per year.

The median household income is about $100,000 in New Hampshire, according to the US Census Bureau.

Phillip Levine, an economics professor at Wellesley College (which offers free tuition to families making $200,000 or less), recently took a closer look at the proliferation of free tuition policies. He concluded such changes are often smaller than they seem at first blush, since many students with low and moderate incomes already qualified for substantial financial aid without free tuition. Still, the policies may be useful, he said.

"Even if these programs don't reduce the net price of college much," Levine wrote in a research report for the Brookings Institution, "they have value if they communicate affordability in a way prospective students and their families can easily understand."

The newly announced New Hampshire Promise program will replace the Granite Guarantee, which was established in 2017 for students who qualified for a federal Pell Grant. The state's existing program covered the remaining cost of in-state tuition after other sources of financial aid were applied. But leaders have long felt it was underutilized.

A spokesperson, Tania DeLuzuriaga, said university leaders hope basing the new program's criteria on family income will be more straightforward than the Pell-based eligibility, leading to greater participation. After admitting an average of roughly 900 to 1,000 students per year under the Granite Guarantee, the university system expects to admit roughly 1,200 students per year under the New Hampshire Promise, she said.

In-state tuition for the 2026-2027 academic year is about $12,300 at Keene State College, $15,400 at Plymouth State University, and $16,300 at the University of New Hampshire. Out-of-state students may pay more than twice as much. (Students have many obligatory costs besides tuition, including food, housing, books, fees, and more.)

The New Hampshire Promise will be available to income-eligible full-time first-year students and transfer students who graduated from a New Hampshire community college, officials said. There isn't a separate application process. Admitted students who submit a Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA) will be considered automatically.

In a statement, Governor Kelly Ayotte heralded the program as an investment in students and the state's future.

"By expanding affordable pathways to higher education, we're creating more opportunities for our young people to pursue good-paying jobs and making it easier for them to build their careers in New Hampshire," she said.

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'I'm not making decisions and we're not going to make decisions. We are employees.'

WILLSON CONTRERAS, *Red Sox first baseman*

Contreras critical of reliance on analytics

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

NEW YORK — For the Red Sox, the playoffs had barely begun by the time the Yankees delivered a sledgehammer of shattering finality.

In two games, the Sox were outscored, 18-2, in the most lopsided Wild Card Series in the brief history of the best-of-three format. Their 9-0 blanking at the hands of Cam Schlittler and the Yankees in Game 1 was followed by a 9-2 slobberknocking in Game 2 that spelled the end of the series and the season.

How to make sense of the shellacking?

"It's a good question. It's different for everybody," said Trevor Story. "You work your [butt] off all year, all offseason, and you get to this point, and this is what we play for. You play to win in the postseason, and to have it end [in Yankee Stadium] two times in a row is tough, and everyone will process that differently."

For some players, there was appreciation of the zombie-like midyear return from the dead, a 15-game winning streak and 32-5 stretch unlike anything that most of the players had experienced. Yet the traces of those summer memories were clouded by the thrashing they'd just endured.

The Sox hit .117 (7 for 60) — the second-worst average by any team in any playoff series. Their .159 on-base percentage was the lowest. They barely had any runners in scoring position in the two games, and when they did, they literally did nothing, going 0 for 3 with nary a base runner.

Willson Contreras was in little mood for silver linings. At 34, he is their elder statesperson among position players. He was the team's best hitter this year, hitting .275/.386/.516 with career highs in on-base and home runs (27). He is an influential clubhouse voice.

RED SOX, Page C5

CALEB BOWLIN/GETTY IMAGES

ELSA/GETTY IMAGES

ABOVE, GAME 1
Chad Tracy removed Payton Tolle with two outs in the fifth inning and the Sox trailing, 1-0. Tolle faced 19 batters and threw 83 pitches.

RIGHT, GAME 2
In a stunning repeat, Tracy lifted Sonny Gray with two outs in the fifth inning and the Sox trailing, 1-0. "I would've liked to have been trusted in that moment," Gray said.

TARA SULLIVAN

Tracy blundered by pulling plug early

NEW YORK — Two final baseball nights in the Bronx saw the Red Sox get outdone by the Yankees in just about every way imaginable, swept out of the American League Wild Card Series by a team that hit the ball farther, pitched the ball harder, and fielded the ball cleaner.

And one more thing: managed the game better.

Perhaps that's unfair to Red Sox first-year manager Chad Tracy, but the truth hurts. Between the obvious mistake in pulling his starting pitchers too early in both games of the series and the clear overreliance on the analytics that led him to do so, Tracy — such a feel-good story across this comeback season — turned into a pumpkin just in time for the calendar to flip to October.

As the ugly accounting of back-to-back losses by a combined 18-2 score is completed, the manager's inexperience has to be included. For a first-time major league manager who had never actually managed a game he HAD to win before Wednesday night's elimination, his decisions, particularly when it came to pitching, backfired in repeated and spectacular fashion.

The head-scratcher from the 9-2 season-ending loss was the removal of starter Sonny Gray with two outs in the top of the fifth inning, a decision based largely in the desire to avoid having the veteran righthander face the Yankees a third time through the order.

Gray, the AL's leader in wins with an 18-5 record and a 2.72 ERA, had thrown only 70 pitches, and his own clipped words inside a muted postgame locker room left no doubt about how he felt about the decision.

"I think I am the best pitcher in the American League going through the order the third time. I think that's a fact," he said. "Yeah, I mean I would have liked to live or die with me in that moment,

SULLIVAN, Page C5

▶Red Sox lost their fight ahead of postseason meltdown against Yankees. On baseball, A1

NFL WEEK 4 PATRIOTS AT BILLS
Sunday, 1 p.m., CBS

No Gonzalez as Patriots prep for Bills

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Cornerback Christian Gonzalez, who has been the Patriots' most effective defensive player through the first three weeks of the season, missed his second straight practice Thursday, throwing his availability for Sunday's road game against the Bills into question.

Gonzalez is dealing what the team is calling a shoulder issue. He walked through the locker room during media availability without a wrap or sling on his shoulder.

The 6-foot-1-inch, 205-pounder, who signed a record-breaking contract just prior to the start of the season, has started the year on an excellent note. In the opening loss to the Seahawks while working against Jaxon Smith-Njigba, Gonzalez yielded one catch for 4 yards on five targets while recording two pass breakups. In a Week 2 win over

PATRIOTS, Page C2

▶ McDaniels says Maye "dinged" throwing shoulder in loss to Jaguars. C2

ADRIAN KRAUS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Patriots on Sunday will play at the Bills' palatial new home in Orchard Park, N.Y., a stadium that carried a price tag of $2.2 billion.

Buffalo finally has its football palace

Sparkling stadium a long time coming

By Ben Volin
GLOBE STAFF

ORCHARD PARK, N.Y.

Bill Farmer of Rochester stood against the chain link fence, staring at the giant hole in the ground at 1 Bills Drive. For 53 seasons and 429 games, this was the site of the Bills' home stadium, a mecca of memories for western New Yorkers. Now it sits as an empty construction site after the stadium was demolished this summer.

"It looks like the future site of parking lots or some shopping," said Farmer, a Boston native who says he has been a Bills season ticket-holder for 20 years. "It's pretty sad. But then again, this is pretty happy."

He points across Abbott Road to 1 Bills Plaza, where the team's sparkling new, $2.2 billion Highmark Stadium is about to host its first real game, the Bills' 41-31 win over the Lions on Sept. 17. Leaving the old Highmark Stadium is bittersweet for millions of Bills fans, but the excitement over finally having their own modern football palace after five decades at the old building is overwhelming.

The Patriots went 32-21 at the old building, formerly known as Rich Stadium and Ralph Wilson Stadium. Their first game at the new stadium is Sunday at 1 p.m.

"I'm well past mourning for the old former Highmark and onto the excitement of this place," said Steve Tasker, who played for the Bills from 1986-97 and is now part of their media team. "It's a big moment. We've seen all these new

BILLS STADIUM, Page C2

Pro football

McDaniels: Maye 'dinged' shoulder in loss

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

Patriots quarterback Drake Maye "dinged" his shoulder against the Jaguars last Sunday, prompting his addition to the injury report, offensive coordinator Josh McDaniels said Thursday.

"He ran the ball a few times last week," McDaniels said. "I think that's when it happened."

The Patriots on Wednesday and Thursday listed Maye as a full participant with a right (throwing) shoulder injury. McDaniels said the injury has not impacted his play-calling during games or practices.

"They would obviously tell me if there was something that we felt like we couldn't do or he couldn't do," McDaniels said. "That has not been the case. I know he's a tough kid. I know that for sure. He doesn't make a big deal out of much."

Against the Jaguars, Maye registered four carries — two as scrambles, one as a designed run, and one as a quarterback sneak. He also was sacked twice. It's not immediately obvious when his shoulder got banged up.

One possibility is the designed run at the end of the first half, when Jaguars defensive end Josh Hines-Allen made a strong tackle with Maye landing hard on his right shoulder. But Maye didn't appear noticeably shaken up on the play, or any throughout the game. He stayed in until the Jaguars extended their lead to 35-6 midway through the fourth quarter.

"He's always been a guy that can run and do things with his legs and all that," McDaniels said. "He's taken a few hits since he's been in the National Football League. That's, I think, part of the process when you can make things happen with your legs. You're going to incur some hits."

After the game, Maye answered two questions about his shoulder.

Asked if there are still lingering effects from the injury he suffered in the AFC Championship game in January, Maye would not answer definitively.

"I like to say when you have that much time off and you get to focus on getting back, that you're going out there healthy," he said. "You know you're going to get banged up every now and then, but at the same time, a lot of guys are banged up."

Asked if his shoulder feels as good as it did before that injury, Maye said, "I wouldn't say there's a problem with my shoulder."

Coach Mike Vrabel on Monday said, to his knowledge, Maye's shoulder is not experiencing issues that would require treatment or land him on the injury report.

"I don't anticipate that being any issue going forward," Vrabel said.

Maye also clarified Wednesday his shoulder is not impacting his ability to throw the football.

To then see the team add Maye to the injury report was somewhat of a surprise. Before McDaniels spoke on Thursday, it was unclear if the issue was still related to the injury Maye suffered in the AFC Championship.

In the week leading up to the Super Bowl, Maye said on multiple occasions that his shoulder was "feeling good. He participated in a limited capacity for one practice. In the aftermath of the loss to the Seahawks, Maye revealed he received a pain-relieving shot before kickoff but said he doesn't believe the injury affected his play.

In the weeks following the Super Bowl, Maye said the injury would not require surgery. He later said the shoulder "shouldn't be an issue" for the 2026 season.

Maye's shoulder was not much of a talking point throughout training camp but recently became one amid his glaringly poor start.

Vrabel is scheduled to speak next on Friday afternoon.

Maye is expected to speak next after Sunday's game against the Bills.

Nicole Yang can be reached at nicole.yang@globe.com.

JASON MILLER/GETTY IMAGES

Deshaun Watson, who passed for 268 yards, led the Browns on a game-winning drive late against the Steelers.

NFL NOTEBOOK

Watson, Szmyt cap Browns' win

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Deshaun Watson passed for 268 yards and moved the Browns into position for **Andre Szmyt's** career-long 56-yard field goal with 10 seconds remaining that gave host Cleveland a 27-24 win over the Pittsburgh Steelers on Thursday night.

Watson, who completed 24 of 33 passes with a touchdown and interception, was 4 of 5 for 46 yards as he led a go-ahead drive in the fourth quarter for the third straight week.

The Browns — who are 3-1 for the first time since 2021 — had a 21-7 lead late in the first half before the Steelers rallied to tie it at 24-all. **Aaron Rodgers** threw a 3-yard touchdown pass to **Pat Freiermuth** with 1:44 remaining and Rodgers sneaked it in for the 2-point conversion.

Rodgers, who was 22 of 40 for 299 yards with three touchdowns and two interceptions, had one final chance to get the Steelers in field goal range, but was picked off by **Grant Delpit** at the Browns 18 with 1 second left.

The Steelers' **Jaylen Warren** rushed for 93 yards on 17 carries and **DK Metcalf** had five catches for 115 yards.

The Browns' defense sacked Rodgers five times.

Daniels: 'Day by day'

Commanders quarterback **Jayden Daniels** said he has no concerns about re-injuring his left elbow and is "taking it day by day" on the possibility of starting against the Colts on Sunday at Tottenham Hotspur Stadium in London.

Daniels, who dislocated his elbow in Week 2 against the Cowboys, said he didn't need immediate surgery and wanted to show leadership by returning to help his team.

Daniels missed last Sunday's game against the Seahawks. **Marcus Mariota** threw three touchdown passes in the 33-31 win over the Super Bowl champions.

Head coach **Dan Quinn** said Wednesday Daniels would get more reps as the week progressed and that by Friday "we'll have a definite determination of where we're at."

McConkey misses practice

Chargers wide receiver **Ladd McConkey** missed practice Thursday because of a foot injury.

McConkey was downgraded after practicing on a limited basis Wednesday, putting his status to play at the Seahawks on Sunday in doubt.

McConkey leads the Chargers (0-3) with 12 receptions for 183 yards with one touchdown through three games. He had 82 receptions for 1,149 yards and seven touchdowns as a rookie, and had reasserted himself this season as the top option in the passing game for quarterback **Justin Herbert** following a drop in production in 2025.

Etienne placed on IR

Saints running back **Travis Etienne Jr.** is being placed on injured reserve, coach **Kellen Moore** announced. The move means Etienne, who pulled a hamstring during the third quarter of Sunday's 35-27 loss to the Raiders, will miss a minimum of four games. His earliest possible return would come against the Browns on Nov. 8. . . . NFL commissioner **Roger Goodell** met with Governor **JB Pritzker** of Illinois and the leadership of the state's General Assembly, adding another wrinkle to the Bears' long-running pursuit of a new home. The Bears said in August that the franchise's "sole focus" for the construction of a new stadium and mixed-use development was on Hammond, Ind. But the public confirmation of the conversation between Goodell and Pritzker indicates that Illinois remains in the mix.

Gonzalez out again as Patriots prep for Bills

▶PATRIOTS
Continued from Page C1

the Steelers, he was just as effective against DK Metcalf (four catches, 27 yards), coming away with a pair of passes defensed and four tackles.

"I think he's done really well," defensive coordinator Zak Kuhr said. "He's shown up in the run game. He's had some physicality in his vision-and-break stuff. He's done great in covering, in man and zone, and mixing it up.

"And he's been a savvy player. He's been communicating. I think he's had a really strong start. Obviously, he's a special piece to our defense, and he continues to be. I think he's had a great start."

Cornerbacks coach Justin Hamilton echoed Kuhr, saying Gonzalez has evolved into more of a vocal presence.

"Something that he's done that he's really taken ownership of, especially starting with the Seahawks game, was just trying to be vocal," Hamilton said. "[That's] out of character a little bit for him. That's out of his comfort zone, but that's something that he's growing in that way, which is good."

Last Sunday against the Jaguars, Gonzalez was in the midst of another impressive start when it looked like he was shaken up after a tackle on Jacksonville's LeQuint Allen. The cornerback left the field shortly after the play, and the training staff was seen taking a look at his left arm before he returned to action and finished with two tackles and one pass defensed.

Gonzalez said he was "good" when asked about his shoulder after the game. But his absence from practice on back-to-back days raises the question about what the defense would look like if he wasn't able to go against the Bills.

In Gonzalez's place, the Patriots would likely utilize Carlton Davis in the No. 1 cornerback role, with slot corner Marcus Jones or Charles Woods moving into Davis's position as the secondary. Another safety could also be added to the mix, as the defense operated in a three-safety set from time to time this season in an attempt to offer a different look.

"We've got guys in those roles [who] have stepped up and they played, and they [had] played in big roles, they've played in smaller roles, but they played in NFL games," Hamilton said of the defensive depth. "You put them in there, and you try to prepare them. Just like we tell them every week: prepare like starters, and then they get their opportunity to go, make the most of it."

MIKE STEWART/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Christian Gonzalez said he was "good" after Sunday's loss, but he has missed two practices since.

The Patriots have struggled with injury on both sides of the ball through the season's first month. Wide receiver A.J. Brown, offensive linemen Mike Onwenu and Greg Van Roten, outside linebackers Harold Landry and Dre'Mont Jones, and safety Craig Woodson have all missed at least one game.

Gonzalez is one of four players who did not practice Thursday. That group also included fullback Reggie Gilliam (knee), right tackle Morgan Moses (foot), and defensive tackle Christian Barmore (shoulder). Six players were limited, including Woodson (shoulder) and Jones (shoulder), while quarterback Drake Maye (shoulder) was a full participant.

Asked about the injury situation, Kuhr said it's just another week in the NFL.

"I don't really see it as challenging," he said. "It's just another week that we've got to find a solution to whatever the problem of the week is. And I get excited for that. I think the staff gets excited [for that].

"At the end of the day, whoever's out there, obviously we trust, and [we have] to find some creative ways to make sure they're in the best position possible for their skill set."

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Buffalo's sparkling football palace a long time coming

▶BILLS STADIUM
Continued from Page C1

stadiums being built — Gillette Stadium, MetLife, SoFi, Jerry World. To have one here in Buffalo, it's quite a moment. This stadium makes you feel like you're on the map."

The new Highmark was built with $850 million in public funds, and is a glorious shrine to Bills football. Sight lines are magnificent, as the seating bowl was built more vertically than horizontally. The concourse goes 360 degrees around the stadium and is open-air throughout, allowing fans to still watch the game while they buy concessions. The stadium is outdoors to maintain the Bills' frigid home-field advantage but was built with a roof covering approximately 65 percent of seats. Though the Bills reduced capacity by about 10,000 seats to 60,000, the smallest in the NFL, the stadium is *loud*, with the crowd roar bouncing off the roof and concrete walls.

"It still doesn't feel real yet," Bills tight end Dawson Knox said. "It's the coolest place I've ever played football in. There's going to be some incredible memories to be made here in the near future."

The stadium is also filled with homages to the team's history and fans, such as banners commemorating the team's AFL championships in 1964 and '65, or their "Perfect Game" against the Patriots in January 2022, or a replica broken folding table in the concourse. The Bills also insisted on installing natural grass for the first time in their history.

Most importantly, it's directly across the street from the old stadium, allowing the fans to maintain many of their game-day traditions — they park in the same neighbors' yards, tailgate in their favorite spots, and drink at their favorite bars in Orchard Park.

"The thing they did the best, the most important thing is the football game," former Bills quarterback Ryan Fitzpatrick said. "Being across the street from the old site, they kept a lot of the wonderful things that are important for the Buffalo community, and so I think in the end it's going to be a huge positive for them."

The new Highmark also represents something bigger for western New Yorkers — stability. As one NFL official noted on Opening Night, the stadium is the result of a 20-year effort to get the Bills a new home. It wasn't long ago that the Bills struggled to sell out, and moved one home game per year to Toronto from 2008-13. When former owner Ralph Wilson died in 2014, there was worry of a new owner moving the team out of the NFL's second-smallest market.

Instead, Sabres owner Terry Pegula bought the Bills, maintaining local ties. Then in 2018 they drafted Josh Allen, who has become the patron saint of Bills football. And in 2024 they finally got funding for their new stadium, cementing the Bills' presence in western New York.

"It's been decades that that's been hanging over this region, and now that's gone," Tasker said. "It's the final stamp of permanency that has been missing since Ralph reached the age of 80."

Of course, the new digs come with mixed emotions. The old stadium had charm — it was a concrete eyesore, but it was *their* concrete eyesore, the perfect embodiment of western New York's blue-collar spirit. Since 1973, multiple generations of fans watched their heroes play at the old building, from O.J. Simpson to Joe Ferguson to Jim Kelly to Doug Flutie to Allen. The Bills went 247-163 at the old Highmark, plus a 16-3 mark in the playoffs.

The Bills have not announced what they are going to do with the giant hole in the ground where the old stadium used to sit. There are rumors of commercial development, potentially in the same vein as Patriot Place, but it's all theoretical for now.

"I was happy with the old stadium. I didn't need a new one," said Chele Illig, a 40-year season ticket-holder from Cattaraugus. "But I'm nostalgic. It's usually the younger people who think you've got to have the newest and the latest."

Illig also said her tickets increased by about one-third with the move to the new stadium, highlighting an even bigger concern — the Bills pricing out many of their fans. Buffalo is decidedly more working class than most NFL cities. Yet not only did the Bills raise ticket prices, some by as much as double the amount, but also sold personal seat licenses ranging from $750 to $50,000.

The Bills are hardly the only team to price out many of its ardent fans, though, and the demand for tickets was clearly there. The Bills hoped to raise $225 million through PSLs, yet reportedly generated $264 million to help offset the cost of construction. The Bills also used an all-local construction crew, bolstering the notion that the stadium is by western New York, for western New York.

"A huge part of it was the people that were constructing and putting the stadium together were people from Buffalo. They kept that in mind the whole time they did it," Fitzpatrick said. "I think once the fans get over the sticker shock of the PSLs and things, it's going to be a wonderful place to watch a football game."

As much as the fans loved the old Highmark, many also believe it was cursed. The Bills still have not won a Super Bowl, losing four straight in the 1990s, and have suffered heartbreak after heartbreak in recent years with Allen.

Now it's time to make new memories in their new Highmark Stadium.

"All the superstition, everybody's going crazy with that stuff. 'This is the first year we're going to win the Super Bowl, the curse of the old place is going to be lifted,' the whole thing," Tasker said. "It's like cheering almost for a different team, because that stadium was so much a part of the team's identity. Now we have to get used to this place feeling like home."

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Football

Expanded NFL standings

AFC

	W	L	T	Pct.	PF/G	PA/G	Home	Conf.	Div.	Spread	Streak	This week
EAST												
Buffalo	3	0	0	1.000	33.7	26.0	2-0-0	2-0-0	0-0-0	3-0-0	W 3	New England
NY Jets	1	2	0	.333	21.3	20.3	0-1-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-0-2	L 2	At Chicago
New England	1	2	0	.333	12.0	17.0	1-0-0	1-1-0	0-0-0	1-1-1	L 1	At Buffalo
Miami	0	3	0	.000	12.0	28.7	0-1-0	0-2-0	0-0-0	0-3-0	L 3	At Minnesota
NORTH												
Cleveland	3	1	0	.750	20.3	23.8	2-0-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	3-1-0	W 3	Pittsburgh
Baltimore	2	1	0	.667	30.7	26.0	0-1-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	1-1-1	W 1	Tennessee
Cincinnati	2	1	0	.667	26.7	21.0	1-0-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	2-1-0	L 1	Jacksonville
Pittsburgh	2	2	0	.500	19.3	21.8	2-0-0	1-2-0	1-1-0	2-2-0	L 1	At Cleveland
SOUTH												
Jacksonville	2	1	0	.667	27.3	12.0	2-0-0	2-1-0	0-0-0	2-1-0	W 1	At Cincinnati
Indianapolis	1	2	0	.333	24.0	30.3	1-1-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	2-1-0	W 1	Washington
Tennessee	0	3	0	.000	12.3	19.7	0-2-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	1-2-0	L 3	At Baltimore
Houston	0	3	0	.000	18.0	25.0	0-2-0	0-3-0	0-1-0	0-3-0	L 3	Dallas
WEST												
Kansas City	3	0	0	1.000	29.3	16.7	2-0-0	3-0-0	1-0-0	2-1-0	W 3	At Las Vegas
Las Vegas	3	0	0	1.000	29.3	18.0	1-0-0	2-0-0	1-0-0	3-0-0	W 3	Kansas City
Denver	2	1	0	.667	20.0	23.3	2-0-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	2-1-0	W 2	At San Francisco
LA Chargers	0	3	0	.000	14.7	25.3	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-1-0	0-3-0	L 3	At Seattle

NFC

	W	L	T	Pct.	PF/G	PA/G	Home	Conf.	Div.	Spread	Streak	This week
EAST												
Philadelphia	2	1	0	.667	18.3	23.0	1-0-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	0-3-0	L 1	LA Rams
NY Giants	2	1	0	.667	15.3	18.3	2-0-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	2-1-0	W 1	Arizona
Dallas	1	2	0	.333	29.3	27.3	1-1-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	1-1-1	L 1	At Houston
Washington	1	2	0	.333	25.0	30.7	1-0-0	1-2-0	0-2-0	2-1-0	W 1	Indianapolis
NORTH												
Minnesota	3	0	0	1.000	23.7	13.7	1-0-0	3-0-0	2-0-0	3-0-0	W 3	Miami
Detroit	2	1	0	.667	31.0	31.7	2-0-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	0-2-1	W 1	At Carolina
Chicago	2	1	0	.667	29.7	17.7	1-1-0	2-1-0	0-1-0	2-1-0	W 1	NY Jets
Green Bay	1	2	0	.333	18.7	30.3	0-1-0	0-2-0	0-1-0	0-2-1	L 1	At Tampa Bay
SOUTH												
Carolina	1	2	0	.333	29.7	27.7	0-1-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	1-2-0	L 1	Detroit
New Orleans	1	2	0	.333	27.0	27.7	0-1-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	2-1-0	L 1	Atlanta
Atlanta	1	2	0	.333	17.0	22.7	0-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	1-2-0	W 1	At New Orleans
Tampa Bay	0	3	0	.000	20.7	26.3	0-2-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	0-3-0	L 3	Green Bay
WEST												
San Francisco	3	0	0	1.000	32.7	16.7	2-0-0	2-0-0	2-0-0	2-1-0	W 3	Denver
Seattle	2	1	0	.667	25.0	16.7	1-0-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	1-1-1	L 1	LA Chargers
LA Rams	1	2	0	.333	20.3	21.0	1-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	1-2-0	L 1	At Philadelphia
Arizona	1	2	0	.333	21.0	27.0	0-1-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	2-1-0	L 2	At NY Giants

NFL schedule, results

AFC

EAST

BUFFALO (3-0)
36 ... at Houston ... 31
41 ... Detroit ... 31
24 ... LA Chargers ... 16
O. 4 New England ... 1
O. 12 at LA Rams ... 8:15
O. 18 at Las Vegas ... 4:25
Bye week
N. 1 Baltimore ... 1
N. 9 at Minnesota ... 8:15
N. 15 at NY Jets ... 1
N. 22 Miami ... 1
N. 26 Kansas City ... 8:20
D. 6 at New England ... 4:25
D. 13 at Green Bay ... 8:20
D. 19 Chicago ... 8:20
D. 25 at Denver ... 4:30
J. 3 at Miami ... 1
J. 10 NY Jets ... TBA

MIAMI (0-3)
13 ... at Las Vegas ... 27
13 ... at San Francisco ... 35
10 ... Kansas City ... 24
O. 4 at Minnesota ... 4:05
O. 11 Cincinnati ... 1
Bye week
O. 25 at NY Jets ... 1
N. 1 New England ... 4:25
N. 8 Detroit ... 1
N. 15 at Indianapolis ... 1
N. 22 at Buffalo ... 1
N. 29 NY Jets ... 1
D. 6 at Denver ... 4:05
D. 13 Chicago ... 1
D. 20 at Green Bay ... 1
D. 27 LA Chargers ... 1
J. 3 Buffalo ... 1
J. 10 at New England ... TBA

NEW ENGLAND (1-2)
10 ... at Seattle ... 13
20 ... Pittsburgh ... 3
6 ... at Jacksonville ... 35
O. 4 at Buffalo ... 1
O. 11 Las Vegas ... 1
O. 18 NY Jets ... 1
O. 22 at Chicago ... 8:15
N. 1 at Miami ... 4:25
N. 8 Green Bay ... 4:25
N. 15 Detroit ... 9:30a
Bye week
N. 29 at LA Chargers ... 8:20
D. 6 Buffalo ... 4:25
D. 10 Minnesota ... 8:15
D. 21 at Kansas City ... 8:15
D. 27 at NY Jets ... 1
J. 3 Denver ... TBA
J. 10 Miami ... TBA

NEW YORK JETS (1-2)
23 ... at Tennessee ... 10
17 ... Green Bay ... 20
24 ... at Detroit ... 31
O. 4 at Chicago ... 1
O. 11 Cleveland ... 1
O. 18 at New England ... 1
O. 25 Miami ... 1
N. 1 Las Vegas ... 1
N. 8 at Kansas City ... 1
N. 15 Buffalo ... 1
N. 22 at LA Chargers ... 4:05
N. 29 at Miami ... 1
Bye week
D. 13 Denver ... 1
D. 20 at Arizona ... 4:05
D. 27 New England ... 1
J. 3 Minnesota ... 1
J. 10 at Buffalo ... TBA

SOUTH

HOUSTON (0-3)
31 ... Buffalo ... 36
6 ... Cincinnati ... 20
17 ... at Indianapolis ... 19
O. 4 Dallas ... 1
O. 11 at Tennessee ... 1
O. 18 Jacksonville ... 9:30a
O. 25 NY Giants ... 1
Bye week
N. 8 at LA Chargers ... 4:05
N. 15 at Cleveland ... 1
N. 19 Indianapolis ... 8:15
N. 29 Baltimore ... 1
D. 6 at Pittsburgh ... 8:20
D. 13 at Washington ... 1
D. 20 Jacksonville ... 1
D. 24 at Philadelphia ... 8:15
J. 4 at Green Bay ... 8:15
J. 10 Tennessee ... TBA

INDIANAPOLIS (1-2)
23 ... Baltimore ... 41
30 ... at Kansas City ... 33
19 ... Houston ... 17
O. 4 Washington ... 9:30a
O. 11 at Pittsburgh ... 1
O. 18 Tennessee ... 1
O. 25 at Minnesota ... 1
N. 1 at Jacksonville ... 1
N. 8 Dallas ... 1
N. 15 Miami ... 1
N. 19 at Houston ... 8:15
N. 29 NY Giants ... 1
Bye week
D. 13 at Philadelphia ... 1
D. 20 at Tennessee ... 1
D. 27 Cincinnati ... TBA
J. 3 at Cleveland ... 1
J. 10 Jacksonville ... TBA

JACKSONVILLE (2-1)
34 ... Cleveland ... 10
13 ... at Denver ... 20
35 ... New England ... 6
O. 4 at Cincinnati ... 1
O. 11 Philadelphia ... 9:30a
O. 18 Houston ... 9:30a
Bye week
N. 1 Indianapolis ... 1
N. 5 at Baltimore ... 8:15
N. 15 at Tennessee ... 1
N. 22 at NY Giants ... 1
N. 29 Tennessee ... 4:05
D. 6 at Chicago ... 1
D. 14 Pittsburgh ... 8:15
D. 20 at Houston ... 1
D. 27 at Dallas ... 8:20
J. 3 Washington ... TBA
J. 10 at Indianapolis ... TBA

TENNESSEE (0-3)
10 ... NY Jets ... 23
20 ... Philadelphia ... 24
7 ... at NY Giants ... 12
O. 4 at Baltimore ... 1
O. 11 Houston ... 1
O. 18 at Indianapolis ... 1
O. 25 Cleveland ... 1
N. 1 at Cincinnati ... 1
Bye week
N. 15 Jacksonville ... 1
N. 22 at Dallas ... 1
N. 29 at Jacksonville ... 4:05
D. 6 Washington ... 1
D. 13 at Detroit ... 1
D. 20 Indianapolis ... 1
D. 27 at Las Vegas ... 4:05
J. 3 Pittsburgh ... 1
J. 10 at Houston ... TBA

NORTH

BALTIMORE (2-1)
41 ... at Indianapolis ... 23
17 ... New Orleans ... 24
34 ... Dallas ... 31
O. 4 Tennessee ... 1
O. 11 at Atlanta ... 8:20
O. 18 at Cleveland ... 1
O. 25 Cincinnati ... 1
N. 1 at Buffalo ... 1
N. 5 Jacksonville ... 8:15
N. 16 LA Chargers ... 8:15
N. 22 at Carolina ... 1
N. 29 at Houston ... 1
Bye week
D. 13 Tampa Bay ... 1
D. 20 at Pittsburgh ... 1
D. 27 Cleveland ... 1
D. 31 at Cincinnati ... 8:15
J. 10 Pittsburgh ... TBA

CINCINNATI (2-1)
33 ... Tampa Bay ... 27
20 ... at Houston ... 6
27 ... at Pittsburgh ... 30
O. 4 Jacksonville ... 1
O. 11 at Miami ... 1
Bye week
O. 25 at Baltimore ... 1
N. 1 Tennessee ... 1
N. 8 Atlanta ... 9:30a
N. 15 Pittsburgh ... 8:20
N. 23 at Washington ... 8:15
N. 29 New Orleans ... 1
D. 6 at Cleveland ... 1
D. 13 Kansas City ... 4:25
D. 20 at Carolina ... 1
D. 27 at Indianapolis ... TBA
D. 31 Baltimore ... 8:15
J. 10 Cleveland ... TBA

CLEVELAND (3-1)
10 ... at Jacksonville ... 34
23 ... at Tampa Bay ... 19
21 ... Carolina ... 18
27 ... Pittsburgh ... 24
O. 11 at NY Jets ... 1
O. 18 Baltimore ... 1
O. 25 at Tennessee ... 1
N. 1 at Pittsburgh ... 1
N. 8 at New Orleans ... 1
N. 15 Houston ... 1
Bye week
N. 29 Las Vegas ... 1
D. 6 Cincinnati ... 1
D. 13 Atlanta ... 1
D. 20 at NY Giants ... 1
D. 27 at Baltimore ... 1
J. 3 Indianapolis ... 1
J. 10 at Cincinnati ... TBA

PITTSBURGH (2-2)
20 ... Atlanta ... 13
3 ... at New England ... 20
30 ... Cincinnati ... 27
24 ... at Cleveland ... 27
O. 11 Indianapolis ... 1
O. 18 at Tampa Bay ... 1
O. 25 New Orleans ... 9:30a
N. 1 Cleveland ... 1
Bye week
N. 15 at Cincinnati ... 8:20
N. 22 at Philadelphia ... 4:25
N. 27 Denver ... 3
D. 6 Houston ... 8:20
D. 14 at Jacksonville ... 8:15
D. 20 Baltimore ... 1
D. 27 Carolina ... TBA
J. 3 at Tennessee ... 1
J. 10 at Baltimore ... TBA

WEST

DENVER (2-1)
10 ... at Kansas City ... 31
20 ... Jacksonville ... 13
30 ... LA Rams ... 26
O. 4 at San Francisco ... 4:25
O. 11 at LA Chargers ... 4:05
O. 15 Seattle ... 8:15
O. 25 at Arizona ... 4:05
N. 1 Kansas City ... 4:25
N. 8 at Carolina ... 1
Bye week
N. 22 Las Vegas ... 4:25
N. 27 at Pittsburgh ... 3
D. 6 Miami ... 4:05
D. 13 at NY Jets ... 1
D. 20 at Las Vegas ... 4:25
D. 25 Buffalo ... 4:30
J. 3 at New England ... TBA
J. 10 LA Chargers ... TBA

KANSAS CITY (3-0)
31 ... Denver ... 10
33 ... Indianapolis ... 30
24 ... at Miami ... 10
O. 4 at Las Vegas ... 4:25
Bye week
O. 18 LA Chargers ... 4:25
O. 25 at Seattle ... 8:20
N. 1 at Denver ... 4:25
N. 8 NY Jets ... 1
N. 15 at Atlanta ... 1
N. 22 Arizona ... 1
N. 26 at Buffalo ... 8:20
D. 3 at LA Rams ... 8:15
D. 13 at Cincinnati ... 4:25
D. 21 New England ... 8:15
D. 27 San Francisco ... 4:25
J. 3 at LA Chargers ... TBA
J. 10 Las Vegas ... TBA

LOS ANGELES CHARGERS (0-3)
14 ... Arizona ... 26
14 ... Las Vegas ... 26
16 ... at Buffalo ... 24
O. 4 at Seattle ... 4:25
O. 11 Denver ... 4:05
O. 18 at Kansas City ... 4:25
Bye week
N. 1 at LA Rams ... 4:05
N. 8 Houston ... 4:05
N. 16 at Baltimore ... 8:15
N. 22 NY Jets ... 4:05
N. 29 New England ... 8:20
D. 6 at Tampa Bay ... 1
D. 13 at Las Vegas ... 4:05
D. 17 San Francisco ... 8:15
D. 27 at Miami ... 1
J. 3 Kansas City ... TBA
J. 10 at Denver ... TBA

LAS VEGAS (3-0)
27 ... Miami ... 13
26 ... at LA Chargers ... 14
35 ... at New Orleans ... 27
O. 4 Kansas City ... 4:25
O. 11 at New England ... 1
O. 18 Buffalo ... 4:25
O. 25 LA Rams ... 4:25
N. 1 at NY Jets ... 1
N. 8 at San Francisco ... 4:05
N. 15 Seattle ... 4:05
N. 22 at Denver ... 4:25
N. 29 at Cleveland ... 1
Bye week
D. 13 LA Chargers ... 4:05
D. 20 Denver ... 4:25
D. 27 Tennessee ... 4:05
J. 3 at Arizona ... 4:05
J. 10 at Kansas City ... TBA

NFC

EAST

DALLAS (1-2)
20 ... at NY Giants ... 28
37 ... Washington ... 20
31 ... Baltimore ... 34
O. 4 at Houston ... 1
O. 8 Tampa Bay ... 8:15
O. 18 at Green Bay ... 8:20
O. 26 at Philadelphia ... 8:15
N. 1 Arizona ... 1
N. 8 at Indianapolis ... 1
N. 15 San Francisco ... 4:25
N. 22 Tennessee ... 1
N. 26 Philadelphia ... 4:30
D. 7 at Seattle ... 8:15
Bye week
D. 20 at LA Rams ... 4:25
D. 27 Jacksonville ... 8:20
J. 3 NY Giants ... 1
J. 10 at Washington ... TBA

NEW YORK GIANTS (2-1)
28 ... Dallas ... 20
6 ... at LA Rams ... 28
12 ... Tennessee ... 7
O. 4 Arizona ... 1
O. 11 at Washington ... 1
O. 18 New Orleans ... 1
O. 25 at Houston ... 1
Bye week
N. 8 at Philadelphia ... 1
N. 12 Washington ... 8:15
N. 22 Jacksonville ... 1
N. 29 at Indianapolis ... 1
D. 6 San Francisco ... 1
D. 13 at Seattle ... 4:25
D. 20 Cleveland ... 1
D. 28 at Detroit ... 8:15
J. 3 at Dallas ... 1
J. 10 Philadelphia ... TBA

PHILADELPHIA (2-1)
24 ... Washington ... 22
24 ... at Tennessee ... 20
7 ... at Chicago ... 27
O. 4 LA Rams ... 1
O. 11 Jacksonville ... 9:30a
O. 18 Carolina ... 1
O. 26 Dallas ... 8:15
N. 1 at Washington ... 8:20
N. 8 NY Giants ... 1
Bye week
N. 22 Pittsburgh ... 4:25
N. 26 at Dallas ... 4:30
D. 6 at Arizona ... 4:05
D. 13 Indianapolis ... 1
D. 19 Seattle ... 5
D. 24 Houston ... 8:15
J. 3 at San Francisco ... 8:20
J. 10 at NY Giants ... TBA

WASHINGTON (1-2)
22 ... at Philadelphia ... 24
20 ... at Dallas ... 37
33 ... Seattle ... 31
O. 4 Indianapolis ... 9:30a
O. 11 NY Giants ... 1
O. 19 at San Francisco ... 8:15
Bye week
N. 1 Philadelphia ... 8:20
N. 8 LA Rams ... 1
N. 12 at NY Giants ... 8:15
N. 23 Cincinnati ... 8:15
N. 29 at Arizona ... 4:25
D. 6 at Tennessee ... 1
D. 13 Houston ... 1
D. 20 Atlanta ... 1
D. 27 at Minnesota ... TBA
J. 3 at Jacksonville ... TBA
J. 10 Dallas ... TBA

SOUTH

ATLANTA (1-2)
13 ... at Pittsburgh ... 20
3 ... Carolina ... 34
35 ... at Green Bay ... 14
O. 5 at New Orleans ... 8:15
O. 11 Baltimore ... 8:20
O. 18 Chicago ... 1
O. 25 San Francisco ... 1
N. 1 at Tampa Bay ... 1
N. 8 Cincinnati ... 9:30a
N. 15 Kansas City ... 1
Bye week
N. 29 at Minnesota ... 1
D. 6 Detroit ... 1
D. 13 at Cleveland ... 1
D. 20 at Washington ... 1
D. 27 Tampa Bay ... TBA
J. 3 New Orleans ... 1
J. 10 at Carolina ... TBA

CAROLINA (1-2)
37 ... Chicago ... 59
34 ... at Atlanta ... 3
18 ... at Cleveland ... 21
O. 4 Detroit ... 8:20
Bye week
O. 18 at Philadelphia ... 1
O. 25 Tampa Bay ... 1
O. 29 at Green Bay ... 8:15
N. 8 Denver ... 1
N. 15 at New Orleans ... 1
N. 22 Baltimore ... 1
N. 30 at Tampa Bay ... 8:15
D. 6 at Minnesota ... 4:25
D. 13 New Orleans ... 1
D. 20 Cincinnati ... 1
D. 27 at Pittsburgh ... TBA
J. 3 Seattle ... 1
J. 10 Atlanta ... TBA

NEW ORLEANS (1-2)
30 ... at Detroit ... 31
24 ... at Baltimore ... 17
27 ... Las Vegas ... 35
O. 5 Atlanta ... 8:15
O. 11 Minnesota ... 1
O. 18 at NY Giants ... 1
O. 25 Pittsburgh ... 9:30a
Bye week
N. 8 Cleveland ... 1
N. 15 Carolina ... 1
N. 22 at Chicago ... 1
N. 29 at Cincinnati ... 1
D. 6 Green Bay ... 1
D. 13 at Carolina ... 1
D. 20 at Tampa Bay ... 1
D. 27 Arizona ... 1
J. 3 at Atlanta ... 1
J. 10 Tampa Bay ... TBA

TAMPA BAY (0-3)
27 ... at Cincinnati ... 33
19 ... Cleveland ... 23
16 ... Minnesota ... 23
O. 4 Green Bay ... 1
O. 8 at Dallas ... 8:15
O. 18 Pittsburgh ... 1
O. 25 at Carolina ... 1
N. 1 Atlanta ... 1
N. 8 at Chicago ... 8:20
Bye week
N. 22 at Detroit ... 1
N. 30 Carolina ... 8:15
D. 6 LA Chargers ... 1
D. 13 at Baltimore ... 1
D. 20 New Orleans ... 1
D. 27 at Atlanta ... TBA
J. 3 LA Rams ... TBA
J. 10 at New Orleans ... TBA

NORTH

CHICAGO (2-1)
59 ... at Carolina ... 37
3 ... Minnesota ... 9
27 ... Philadelphia ... 7
O. 4 NY Jets ... 1
O. 11 at Green Bay ... 1
O. 18 at Atlanta ... 1
O. 22 New England ... 8:15
N. 2 at Seattle ... 8:15
N. 8 Tampa Bay ... 8:20
Bye week
N. 22 New Orleans ... 1
N. 26 at Detroit ... 1
D. 6 Jacksonville ... 1
D. 13 at Miami ... 1
D. 19 at Buffalo ... 8:20
D. 25 Green Bay ... 1
J. 3 Detroit ... 4:25
J. 10 at Minnesota ... TBA

DETROIT (2-1)
31 ... New Orleans ... 30
31 ... at Buffalo ... 41
31 ... NY Jets ... 24
O. 4 at Carolina ... 8:20
O. 11 at Arizona ... 4:25
Bye week
O. 25 Green Bay ... 4:25
N. 1 Minnesota ... 1
N. 8 at Miami ... 1
N. 15 New England ... 9:30a
N. 22 Tampa Bay ... 1
N. 26 Chicago ... 1
D. 6 at Atlanta ... 1
D. 13 Tennessee ... 1
D. 20 at Minnesota ... 8:20
D. 28 NY Giants ... 8:15
J. 3 at Chicago ... 4:25
J. 10 at Green Bay ... TBA

GREEN BAY (1-2)
22 ... at Minnesota ... 39
20 ... at NY Jets ... 17
14 ... Atlanta ... 35
O. 4 at Tampa Bay ... 1
O. 11 Chicago ... 1
O. 18 Dallas ... 8:20
O. 25 at Detroit ... 4:25
O. 29 Carolina ... 8:15
N. 8 at New England ... 4:25
N. 15 Minnesota ... 1
Bye week
N. 25 at LA Rams ... 8
D. 6 at New Orleans ... 1
D. 13 Buffalo ... 8:20
D. 20 Miami ... 1
D. 25 at Chicago ... 1
J. 4 Houston ... 8:15
J. 10 Detroit ... TBA

MINNESOTA (3-0)
39 ... Green Bay ... 22
9 ... at Chicago ... 3
23 ... at Tampa Bay ... 16
O. 4 Miami ... 4:05
O. 11 at New Orleans ... 1
Bye week
O. 25 Indianapolis ... 1
N. 1 at Detroit ... 1
N. 9 Buffalo ... 8:15
N. 15 at Green Bay ... 1
N. 22 San Francisco ... 8:20
N. 29 Atlanta ... 1
D. 6 Carolina ... 4:25
D. 10 at New England ... 8:15
D. 20 Detroit ... 8:20
D. 27 Washington ... TBA
J. 3 at NY Jets ... 1
J. 10 Chicago ... TBA

WEST

ARIZONA (1-2)
26 ... at LA Chargers ... 14
7 ... Seattle ... 31
30 ... at San Francisco ... 36
O. 4 at NY Giants ... 1
O. 11 Detroit ... 4:25
O. 18 at LA Rams ... 4:05
O. 25 Denver ... 4:05
N. 1 at Dallas ... 1
N. 8 at Seattle ... 4:25
N. 15 LA Rams ... 4:05
N. 22 at Kansas City ... 1
N. 29 Washington ... 4:25
D. 6 Philadelphia ... 4:05
Bye week
D. 20 NY Jets ... 4:05
D. 27 at New Orleans ... 1
J. 3 Las Vegas ... 4:05
J. 10 San Francisco ... TBA

LOS ANGELES RAMS (1-2)
7 ... San Francisco ... 27
28 ... NY Giants ... 6
26 ... at Denver ... 30
O. 4 at Philadelphia ... 1
O. 12 Buffalo ... 8:15
O. 18 Arizona ... 4:05
O. 25 at Las Vegas ... 4:25
N. 1 LA Chargers ... 4:05
N. 8 at Washington ... 1
N. 15 at Arizona ... 4:05
Bye week
N. 25 Green Bay ... 8
D. 3 Kansas City ... 8:15
D. 13 at San Francisco ... 4:25
D. 20 Dallas ... 4:25
D. 25 at Seattle ... 8:15
J. 3 at Tampa Bay ... TBA
J. 10 Seattle ... TBA

SAN FRANCISCO (3-0)
27 ... LA Rams ... 7
35 ... Miami ... 13
36 ... Arizona ... 30
O. 4 Denver ... 4:25
O. 11 at Seattle ... 4:25
O. 19 Washington ... 8:15
O. 25 at Atlanta ... 1
Bye week
N. 8 Las Vegas ... 4:05
N. 15 at Dallas ... 4:25
N. 22 Minnesota ... 8:20
N. 29 Seattle ... 4:25
D. 6 at NY Giants ... 1
D. 13 LA Rams ... 4:25
D. 17 at LA Chargers ... 8:15
D. 27 at Kansas City ... 4:25
J. 3 Philadelphia ... 8:20
J. 10 at Arizona ... TBA

SEATTLE (2-1)
13 ... New England ... 10
31 ... at Arizona ... 7
31 ... at Washington ... 33
O. 4 LA Chargers ... 4:25
O. 11 San Francisco ... 4:25
O. 15 at Denver ... 8:15
O. 25 Kansas City ... 8:20
N. 2 Chicago ... 8:15
N. 8 Arizona ... 4:25
N. 15 at Las Vegas ... 4:05
Bye week
N. 29 at San Francisco ... 4:25
D. 7 Dallas ... 8:15
D. 13 NY Giants ... 4:25
D. 19 at Philadelphia ... 5
D. 25 LA Rams ... 8:15
J. 3 at Carolina ... 1
J. 10 at LA Rams ... TBA

BC overly dependent on McKenzie's rushes

By Trevor Hass
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Four weeks into the season, Boston College quarterback Mason McKenzie has the 12th-most rushing attempts in the nation and second-most among quarterbacks with 74.

McKenzie's 26-carry game against Virginia Tech was somewhat of an outlier because of the weather. At the same time, it illuminated a larger issue that the BC offense needs more variety and unpredictability.

The Eagles (2-2, 0-1 Atlantic Coast Conference) have the lowest-scoring offense in the ACC at 19.8 points per game. They are also second to last in completion percentage (56.5) and third to last in passing yards (759).

When they face No. 21 Southern Methodist at Gerald J. Ford Stadium on Saturday at noon, they will need to prove they can keep pace with a high-powered offense. Familiar foe Kevin Jennings has the second-most passing yards in the nation (1,453), so winning a low-scoring game against the Mustangs (3-1, 1-1) seems like less of a possibility.

"We have to be better offensively," said BC coach Bill O'Brien. "We know that. We're working hard together to really try and improve it, whether it's schematically or techniques or maybe different players, whatever it is. We're all in it together."

The Eagles have talent at running back with Evan Dickens and Bo MacCormack, but they combined for 11 carries for 13 yards last Saturday and couldn't create separation against a formidable Hokies front seven.

BC's offensive line has shown flashes but has been inconsistent at times. Tackle Kristian Phillips has emerged as a leader, yet a lack of protection in spurts has forced McKenzie to read and react and simply take off rather than look downfield.

Javarius Green leads the Eagles with 13 receptions. Dawson Pough, Johnathan Montague Jr., and Landon Wright have displayed their speed in flashes, yet BC's lack of a true go-to target like Lewis Bond or Reed Harris is easy to spot. Jaedn Skeete and Reed Swanson, preseason contenders to lead the team in catches, have combined for five.

McKenzie's elusiveness is a double-edged sword. The Eagles appear content letting him lean on his creativity and shiftiness, but they have to avoid automatically defaulting to their most reliable option.

"Learning how to play with Mason is definitely different," said tight end Zeke Moore. "When to block, when to stay open, how to get open, it's a lot different. He's going to run, he's going to hit it in different ways."

It doesn't get any easier against a formidable SMU defense that has the best opponent third-down conversion percentage in the ACC (20.4) and the second-most sacks (12).

The Mustangs may dare McKenzie to beat them over the top and try to facilitate an open and free-flowing game. The Eagles can't fall for that trap.

They need to establish the run and generate momentum with quick passes to find a rhythm in the passing game. Then, they can turn to McKenzie in short-yardage situations to sustain drives and keep Jennings and Co. off the field.

"By him being as dual threat as he is, it really opens up the playbook a lot," Dickens said. "He really makes those off-schedule plays to help our offense be explosive."

One particularly alarming trend: BC is outscoring opponents, 30-3, in the first quarter and has been outscored, 89-49, the rest of the game, including 38-22 in the fourth quarter. Defenses know what is coming late in games. That predictability leads to stagnancy in key spots and puts immense pressure on the defense.

O'Brien preached the importance of everyone on the offense working in tandem. If a receiver isn't open, while route running may be part of the problem, it also comes down to blocking and the quarterback's read.

He said the Eagles have a "much better feel" for what they are good at now, especially offensively, and expects them to trend positively in the coming weeks.

"I do think we're improving," O'Brien said. "Offensively, it's been a struggle. No doubt about it. Everybody sees that. But there are some things we've done well. We've tried to tweak a lot of things this week."

KEN McGAGH FOR THE GLOBE

BC quarterback Mason McKenzie had 26 carries in the loss to Virginia Tech.

BC in 2026

RESULTS (2-2)

At Cincinnati ... L, 34-15
Rutgers ... W, 28-21
Maine ... W, 22-16
Virginia Tech ... L, 21-14

SCHEDULE

Oct. 3 at SMU ... 12 p.m.
Oct. 17 Pittsburgh ... TBA
Oct. 24 at Georgia Tech ... TBA
Oct. 31 at Duke ... TBA
Nov. 7 Florida St. ... TBA
Nov. 14 at Notre Dame ... 3:30 p.m.
Nov. 21 Syracuse ... TBA
Nov. 28 at Miami ... TBA

Globe staff's college picks WEEK 5

	Las Vegas line	Christopher Gasper	Greg Lang	Craig Larson	Katie McInerney	Michael Vega
Previous week		5-5	9-1	7-3	8-2	6-4
Season		28-12	35-5	32-8	34-6	27-13
Boston College at SMU	SMU by 21½	SMU	SMU	SMU	SMU	SMU
E. Michigan at UMass	UMass by 6	UMass	UMass	UMass	UMass	UMass
Colgate at Harvard	No line	Harvard	Colgate	Harvard	Harvard	Harvard
Holy Cross at William & Mary	No line	Holy Cross	William & Mary	William & Mary	William & Mary	Holy Cross
Syracuse at UConn	Syracuse by 6½	Syracuse	Syracuse	Syracuse	Syracuse	UConn
Ohio State at Iowa	Ohio State by 14½	Ohio State	Ohio State	Ohio State	Ohio State	Ohio State
Alabama at Mississippi St.	Alabama by 5½	Alabama	Alabama	Alabama	Alabama	Mississippi St.
Florida at Missouri	Florida by 5½	Missouri	Florida	Florida	Florida	Florida
Kentucky at South Carolina	South Carolina by 3½	Kentucky	South Carolina	South Carolina	Kentucky	Kentucky
BYU at TCU	BYU by 6½	BYU	BYU	BYU	BYU	BYU

Selections are not against the pointspread.

Globe staff's pro picks WEEK 4

	Las Vegas line	Chad Finn	Christopher Price	Tara Sullivan	Scott Thurston	Ben Volin	Nicole Yang
Last week		5-11	6-10	5-11	7-9	6-10	5-11
Season		22-25-1	19-28-1	16-31-1	23-24-1	18-29-1	18-29-1
Best bets		1-2	1-2	0-3	2-1	2-1	1-2
New England at Buffalo	Buffalo by 6½	**Buffalo**	Buffalo	Buffalo	New England	New England	New England
Indianapolis at Washington	Indianapolis by 3½	Washington	Washington	Washington	Indianapolis	Indianapolis	Indianapolis
Arizona at NY Giants	Arizona by 2½	Arizona	NY Giants	Arizona	Arizona	NY Giants	**Arizona**
Dallas at Houston	Houston by 3	Dallas	Houston	Dallas	Houston	Houston	Houston
Green Bay at Tampa Bay	Green Bay by 3½	Green Bay	Tampa Bay	Green Bay	Tampa Bay	Green Bay	Green Bay
Jacksonville at Cincinnati	Cincinnati by 2½	Jacksonville	Cincinnati	Jacksonville	Cincinnati	Cincinnati	Jacksonville
LA Rams at Philadelphia	LA Rams by 3½	LA Rams	LA Rams	**LA Rams**	LA Rams	Philadelphia	LA Rams
NY Jets at Chicago	Chicago by 3½	NY Jets	Chicago	Chicago	**Chicago**	NY Jets	Chicago
Tennessee at Baltimore	Baltimore by 11½	Tennessee	Tennessee	Baltimore	Baltimore	Baltimore	Baltimore
Miami at Minnesota	Minnesota by 10½	Minnesota	Minnesota	Minnesota	Minnesota	Minnesota	Minnesota
Denver at San Francisco	San Francisco by 2½	San Francisco	San Francisco	San Francisco	San Francisco	San Francisco	Denver
Kansas City at Las Vegas	Kansas City by 4½	Kansas City	Kansas City	Kansas City	Kansas City	**Las Vegas**	Las Vegas
LA Chargers at Seattle	Seattle by 7	LA Chargers	Seattle	LA Chargers	Seattle	Seattle	Seattle
Detroit at Carolina	Detroit by 3½	Detroit	Detroit	Detroit	Detroit	Detroit	Detroit
Atlanta at New Orleans	New Orleans by 2½	New Orleans	**New Orleans**	New Orleans	Atlanta	Atlanta	New Orleans

Best bets in **bold**. Selections are against the pointspread.

Baseball

Gray undecided about what comes next

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

NEW YORK — In the first moments after the end of another season, Sonny Gray was right where he wanted to be: with his kids.

Brothers Gunnar, 11, and Declan, 8, were periodic presences around the Red Sox since the start of spring training. They hung around with their father and his teammates in the visitors' clubhouse at Yankee Stadium late Wednesday, a cheerful, youthful salve for the wound of sudden elimination from the postseason.

It illustrated the position Gray finds himself in after 14 years in the majors. On the mound, he remains eminently capable, having just turned in another high-end season, with a 2.72 ERA across 29 starts. Away from the field, he feels the pull of family, well aware of what it would mean to be a full-time dad back home in Tennessee.

In the immediate aftermath of a season-ending loss to the Yankees, Gray was noncommittal about pitching in 2027. As he mulls retirement, though, he emphasized that he needs time to figure it out.

AL wild card

BOSTON VS. NY YANKEES

Yankees win series, 2-0
Tuesday, Sept. 29
At NY Yankees 9 ..... Boston 0
Wednesday, Sept. 30
At NY Yankees 9 ..... Boston 2

"I don't know what the future holds for me," he said. "I do know that I walked off of that mound with my chest back and my chin up, and I can definitely be proud that I left it all out there until the ball was taken out of my hand."

Gray, who turns 37 in November, is due to become a free agent, and is a virtual lock to decline his mutual option for next season and get a $10 million buyout instead.

If he does play next season, would the Red Sox be a destination?

"I don't know," he said.

Gray was sour after manager Chad Tracy pulled him in the fifth inning of an eventual 9-2 loss — a 1-0 game at the moment Gray exited.

"I would've liked to have been trusted in that moment," he said.

Cognizant of the emotion surrounding that managerial call, as well as the end of the season, Gray emphasized patience.

"I do know that in moments like this, it's never beneficial for any party involved to make rash decisions," he said. "You're a train going down the tracks, and it just gets stopped immediately. I know step No. 1 is to not make any rash decisions. I think I just try to take it one thing at a time for now. And No. 1 would be getting my bags packed, getting in the shower, getting some food, getting back to the hotel, seeing my family, and getting back to Boston, and then we'll go from there."

After coming off the field, Gray went around the room hugging teammates, a parade that "just felt right" and was "not a planned thing," he said.

Acquired from the Cardinals via trade last November, Gray was supposed to be the Red Sox' No. 2 starting pitcher, solidifying the rotation behind Garrett Crochet. Instead, he led it, emerging as a stabilizing force as Crochet missed more than five months because of a shoulder injury.

"I was telling him that a second ago: Whatever him and his family decide, it was a joy to watch this year," Crochet said. "I still think he's got a lot to give the game, but there's something to be said about going on your own terms, I suppose. Whatever he ultimately decides, that'll be something that — us as a team — that we support him on. But it was a pleasure having him here in Boston."

Gray told the Globe recently that "I'll be done in a heartbeat" when his family makes it clear he's wanted back home.

Does he still have baseball left in him?

"I think that's an easy answer," he said, breaking into a smile. "I got a lot of baseball left in me."

Tim Healey can be reached at timothy.healey@globe.com. Follow him @timbhealey.

FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Immediately after Wednesday night's season-ending loss, Sonny Gray was noncommittal about pitching in 2027.

RED SOX NOTEBOOK

Durbin finally to fix his pinkie

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Finally, **Caleb Durbin** can figure out what to do with that pinkie.

He played with a crooked, painful left little finger for three-plus months, and along the way consistently downplayed what specifically was wrong — and whether it might need surgery.

Now, with the Red Sox' season ending Wednesday, he can give it the care it needs.

"We were kind of putting it off to the end here, and I guess this is the end," Durbin said. "So we'll find out these next couple days, and we'll get it fixed up. It's been stuck in that certain position for a little while now. So I'm hoping they can put it back to normal."

Durbin initially partially dislocated the pinkie on June 24, which turned out to be the day before the start of the Red Sox' turnaround. He messed it up again on Aug. 6, the day before the Sox' hot stretch ended.

In 82 games after the first episode, he hit .272 with a .377 on-base percentage and .391 slugging rate.

Among the reasons Durbin played through: He wasn't alone.

"Some guys were grinding through stuff near the tail end here, but everyone's going through something, so you try to keep that in mind," he said. "Would have liked to have a couple more weeks in the tank, but it is what it is."

Gasper to have surgery

Mickey Gasper will have surgery Friday to repair a distal biceps tear, an injury suffered in the third-to-last game of the regular season.

"There's a little bit of tendon left," he said. "Doctor said that that's good for pinning it down. But yeah, they just got to repair it, reattach the biceps."

Gasper said after 6-8 weeks he should "start feeling really good," at which point "I've just got to not go too crazy." It'll take 4-6 months until he is game-ready again. That would bring him to sometime between early February and early April.

"My plan is to be ready to go March 1," Gasper said. "That's my mentality. March 1, be playing in that game."

A Merrimack, N.H., native and Bryant University alumnus, Gasper had a whirlwind year, beginning when he was claimed off waivers by the Nationals in January and the Red Sox in February. He had several stints in the big league and starting in mid-August hit eight home runs in 16 games, his first taste of immense success at the highest level — at age 30.

Does he feel he proved anything with that showing?

"No, you never arrive in this game," Gasper said. "One thing I always heard multiple guys say [on the 2025 Twins] was you can never arrive in this game. That's in the past. It goes on your baseball card, but you've got to do it tomorrow."

Banged up

Among other kinda, sorta injured Sox: **Willson Contreras** had a lot going on. "I'm sore all over," he said. "My hammy is tight, my right hand is sore, my right hip is tight. But you play the whole season just to be in the playoffs, and I couldn't miss it. I was not going to miss the playoffs." . . . **Garrett Crochet** (left shoulder injury) deemed himself "100 percent" healthy and headed toward a normal offseason after making it back for a four-batter, zero-out appearance in the playoffs. "It was definitely nice to [pitch] again," he said. "I felt like I was in control as much as you can be when you're getting the [expletive] beat out of you." . . . **Isiah Kiner-Falefa** hit .143/.265/.167 in September after returning from a left forearm stress reaction. On Wednesday, he referred to wanting to "just let this wrist get fully healthy" so he could resume his Driveline-based hitting training methods, with which he found much success before getting hurt in June. "I'm excited for what's to come," said Kiner-Falefa, a pending free agent . . . Perhaps the straightest straight-shooter on the team, Kiner-Falefa did not mince words on the Red Sox' "unacceptable" Wild Card Series loss to the Yankees. "Doesn't feel good. Obviously, not what any of us expected. An uncompetitive two games. Got boat-raced. I guess the better team won," he said. "You play in this market, you've got to win. We didn't get the job done."

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FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS

After the Red Sox lost 16 of their last 30 regular-season games, manager Chad Tracy could not prevent his team from being swept in the AL Wild Card Series.

Red Sox lost fire ahead of postseason collapse

▶ABRAHAM
Continued from Page A1

It goes back to how the Red Sox finished the regular season. In a weak American League, they had essentially sewn up a postseason berth by Aug. 25 when they were 73-59, a season-best 14 games over .500.

"Our players keep on fighting. I applaud them for that," manager Chad Tracy said at the time.

The Red Sox were 14-16 over the remaining 30 regular-season games and were outscored by 27 runs. They lost that fight.

Part of it was self-induced. The Red Sox adopted a strategy to give their regulars plenty of rest before the playoffs and use the time to get Isiah Kiner-Falefa, Jahmai Jones, and other backups extra at-bats so they could be sharper in the postseason.

There's a fine line between taking care of the players and losing your edge, and the Sox landed on the wrong side of it.

They hit .220 in September and averaged 2.96 runs. That malaise dragged right into the postseason. Cam Schlittler and Max Fried pitched well for the Yankees, but the Sox weren't ready for them, either.

"We ran into two good pitchers that threw the ball very well. But we didn't hit," Tracy said. "That's part of it. And obviously we wanted to. You're trying to. Your mindset is: can you get a lead?

"Can you get a two- or three-run lead and play from a lead and milk the game along that way? And we just weren't able to do that these two days."

That's a problem power hitters can fix. At the end of last season, after a playoff loss to the Yankees, chief baseball officer Craig Breslow said the Red Sox had to address their lack of power because home runs were so crucial in the postseason.

But the Red Sox hit 163 homers this season, 23 fewer than last season. That, too, was self-induced. Third baseman Alex Bregman wanted to return to the Sox after a productive 2025 season but was deemed too expensive.

Slugging first baseman Pete Alonso seemed like a perfect fit, but the Sox balked at his price. He signed with the Orioles and hit 43 home runs, four of them in six games at Yankee Stadium, and had 113 RBIs.

Think he might have helped? The Red Sox teams that won championships didn't milk the game and throw little jabs. They crushed the ball.

Tracy appeared stunned after Game 2, answering questions with just a few words in a voice barely above a whisper.

Like his players, the manager had a bad two games.

Tracy was too quick to take starting pitcher Payton Tolle out of Game 1 and a 1-0 deficit became 3-0 when Ben Rice homered off Erik Miller, a relief pitcher who allowed six runs in his final five games of the regular season.

The same thing happened in Game 2 when Tracy gave a quick hook to starter Sonny Gray in the fifth inning. Again, he chose Miller, who allowed an RBI single by Cody Bellinger.

Bellinger has hit lefthanders much better the last two seasons, which the number-crunchers who guide so many decisions the Red Sox make must have missed.

"I would have liked to live and die with me in that moment," Gray said. "But that's the competitor I am. I think you can probably ask the guys, and they felt the same way."

He was right about that. First baseman Willson Contreras pantomimed zipping his lips shut when asked about Gray leaving the game. Other players expressed similar sentiments.

Tracy, who received a three-year contract extension on Sept. 22, will learn from his mistakes. Maybe the Red Sox won't skimp on power hitters next time, too.

The Yankees will play the Rays on Saturday as the Red Sox contemplate a fifth consecutive season without winning a playoff series. That's a first for this ownership group since they took over in 2002.

The final two games were magnified, as is always the case with the postseason. But the roots were planted in August when they coasted to the finish.

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Yankees 9, Red Sox 2

Wednesday night game
At Yankee Stadium, New York City

BOSTON

	AB	R	H	2B	3B	HR	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
JJones dh	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	.000
Rutschman c	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	.125
Contreras 1b	2	1	2	0	0	1	1	2	0	.333
Abreu rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	.143
Rafaela cf	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Durbin 3b	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Sogard 2b	3	1	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	.167
Story ss	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	.167
Eaton lf	2	0	1	1	0	0	0	0	1	.500
Duran ph-lf	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Totals	**31**	**2**	**4**	**1**	**0**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**8**	

NY YANKEES

	AB	R	H	2B	3B	HR	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Rice dh	4	1	1	0	0	0	0	1	1	.556
Bellinger lf	5	1	2	0	0	1	4	0	1	.333
García 1b	5	1	3	0	0	1	1	0	1	.500
SJones rf	5	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	4	.250
Lombard ss	4	1	1	0	0	0	1	0	2	.500
Chisholm. 2b	3	2	2	0	0	0	0	1	0	.667
Grisham cf	3	1	2	0	0	0	0	1	0	.500
Wells c	3	1	1	0	0	0	2	0	0	.500
McMahon 3b	3	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	1	.250
Goldschmidt ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Caballero 3b	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	—
Totals	**36**	**9**	**14**	**0**	**0**	**2**	**9**	**3**	**10**	

Boston ..... 000 001 100 — 2 4 1
NY Yankees ..... 000 116 10x — 9 14 0

E—Rutschman (1). **LOB**—Boston 4, NY 7. **SB**—SJones (1), Chisholm 2 (2), Grisham (1). **SF**—Wells. **Runners left in scoring position**—Boston 1 (Rutschman), NY 2 (Rice 2). **RISP**—Boston 0 for 2, NY 6 for 9. **Runners moved up**—McMahon. **GIDP**—Chisholm. **DP**—Boston 1.

BOSTON

	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	HR	NP	ERA
Gray L 0-1	4⅔	6	2	2	0	5	1	70	3.86
Miller	⅓	2	0	0	0	0	0	5	13.50
Crochet	0	3	4	4	0	1	0	16	-
Whitlock	1⅓	3	3	3	3	1	1	35	20.25
Gamboa	⅔	0	0	0	0	0	0	7	27.00
Chapman	1	0	0	0	0	3	0	14	0.00

NY YANKEES

	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	HR	NP	ERA
Fried W 1-0	6	3	1	1	1	6	1	98	1.50
Warren	1⅔	1	1	1	0	1	1	19	5.40
Headrick	⅓	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	0.00
Bednar	1	0	0	0	1	1	0	22	0.00

Crochet pitched to 4 batters in the 6th. **Inherited runners-scored**—Miller 2-1, Whitlock 3-3, Gamboa 2-0. **IBB**—off Whitlock (Rice). **WP**—Crochet. **Umpires**—Home, Scott Barry; First, John Libka; Second, Mark Wegner; Third, John Tumpane; Left, Emil Jimenez; Right, Nate Tomlinson. **T**—2:59. **A**—49,004 (46,672).

HOW THE RUNS SCORED

FOURTH INNING

YANKEES — García homered to right. Jones singled to left. Lombard struck out. Chisholm grounded into a double play, first to short Story to first, Jones out.

FIFTH INNING

YANKEES — Grisham singled to right. Wells grounded into fielder's choice, second to short, Grisham out. McMahon struck out. Rice singled to right, Wells to third. Miller pitching. Bellinger singled to right, Wells scored, Rice to second. García singled to left, Rice was out advancing, left to catcher.

SIXTH INNING

RED SOX — Jones flied out to center. Rutschman popped out to second. Contreras homered to right. Abreu flied out to center.

YANKEES — Jones struck out, safe on wild pitch. Jones stole second, and on throwing error by catcher, Jones to third. Lombard singled to center, Jones scored. Chisholm singled to right, Lombard to second. Grisham hit an infield single to third, Lombard to third, Chisholm to second. Whitlock pitching. Wells hit a sacrifice fly to left, Lombard scored, Chisholm to third. McMahon grounded out to third, Chisholm scored, Grisham to second. Rice was intentionally walked. Bellinger homered to right, Grisham and Rice scored. García singled to right. Jones struck out.

SEVENTH INNING

RED SOX — Rafaela fouled out to first. Durbin grounded out to short. Sogard homered to right. Story struck out.

YANKEES — Lombard grounded out to second. Chisholm walked and stole second. Grisham walked. Chisholm stole third, Grisham stole second. Wells singled to center, Chisholm scored, Grisham to third. Gamboa pitching. Goldschmidt, pinch-hitting for McMahon, flied out to right . Rice lined out to center.

Baseball

NOTEBOOK

Braves start quickly, eliminate Phillies

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Michael Harris II hit a three-run homer in the first inning, **Ray Kerr** threw 3⅓ scoreless innings and the Braves beat the Phillies, 6-2, on Thursday night in the decisive Game 3 of their National League Wild Card Series.

Ozzie Albies launched a two-run homer in the fourth and **Matt Olson** added a solo shot in the seventh for the Braves, who advanced to a best-of-five Division Series against the Dodgers.

The Braves took a postseason series for the first time since winning the 2021 World Series.

After winning the NL East by six games over Philadelphia this year, the Braves came out on top in their postseason matchup, too.

Phillies righthander **Aaron Nola** was pulled after allowing three runs in 1⅔ innings. Nola walked **Ronald Acuña Jr.** and **Matt Olson** with one out in the first before giving up the homer to Harris.

Kerr made his postseason debut in only his fourth career start. Braves manager **Walt Weiss** wanted a lefthander to face Phillies lefthanded hitters **Kyle Schwarber** and **Bryce Harper** at least once.

Kerr allowed only one hit — to Schwarber in the first — and one walk — to Schwarber in the fourth. Righthander **Grant Holmes** followed Kerr and allowed one run in two innings to earn the win.

Lefthander **Chris Sale**, the starter in Atlanta's 5-3 win in Tuesday's series opener, struck out Harper to end the eighth and closed out the win in the ninth by striking out **Bryan De La Cruz** and pinch hitter **Otto Kemp**.

Guardians set staff

Parker Messick will be the first Cleveland rookie pitcher to start in a postseason game since 2016 when the Guardians lefthander takes the mound for Game 1 of the AL Division Series against the White Sox on Saturday.

Manager **Stephen Vogt** also announced that **Gavin Williams** will get start for Game 2 on Monday.

Ryan Merritt was the last Cleveland rookie pitcher to get a postseason start. He threw 4⅓ shutout innings in Game 5 of the AL Championship Series against the Blue Jays a decade ago.

Messick went 12-9 with a 2.56 ERA in 32 regular-season starts. The 25-year old leads MLB qualified rookies in innings pitched (186⅓), was second in strikeouts (193) and ERA, tied for second in wins, and fifth in opponent batting average (.217).

"He's taken the ball every time and given us a chance to win. Just the way he pitches, it just felt right to go with Parker," Vogt said.

Messick is 2-1 with a 2.81 ERA in four starts against the White Sox this season.

Williams went 14-8 with a 3.76 ERA and was second in the majors with 248 strikeouts and opponents batted .213.

Padres bounce Cubs

Pinch hitter **Gavin Sheets** blasted a two-run homer, five Padres pitchers combined on a five-hitter, and San Diego swept the Cubs out of the NL Wild Card Series with a 4-1 victory in Game 2 on Wednesday night.

Xander Bogaerts drove in the first run for the surging Padres, who followed up their 8-0 victory in Tuesday's opener with another dominant mound performance. The Cubs led the majors in runs and the NL in homers this year, but they managed just eight hits in two games.

Ethan Salas drove in a run while becoming the youngest player to catch a postseason game in major league history for the Padres, whose 19-3 surge since Sept. 6 has them looking like a threat in the NL. The Padres advanced to face the MLB-best Brewers in an NL Division Series this weekend.

Lovullo returning

The Diamondbacks announced that **Torey Lovullo** will return for his 11th season, with the manager signing a two-year deal that keeps him under contract in the desert through the 2028 season. Lovullo is the third-longest-tenured manager in the big leagues behind the Rays' **Kevin Cash** and Dodgers' **Dave Roberts** . . . Major League Baseball won't consider staging a game in Wyoming's Grand Teton National Park. Baseball commissioner **Rob Manfred** sent a letter to Teton County commissioner Chair **Mark Newcomb**, Jackson Mayor **Arne Jorgensen**, and Jackson Hole chamber of commerce president **Rick Howe**, who wrote to Manfred voicing objections on Monday following a report in The Washington Post that Grand Teton was under consideration. MLB and the players' association have played a handful of regular-season games away from the 30 big league ballparks in recent years, including in the Iowa cornfields made famous by the movie "Field of Dreams."

Baseball playoffs

AL wild card

CHI. WHITE SOX VS. HOUSTON

White Sox win series, 2-0
Tuesday, Sept. 29
Chi. White Sox 6.....at Houston 3
Wednesday, Sept. 30
Chi. White Sox 7.....at Houston 3

BOSTON VS. NY YANKEES

Yankees win series, 2-0
Tuesday, Sept. 29
At NY Yankees 9.....Boston 0
Wednesday, Sept. 30
At NY Yankees 9.....Boston 2

NL wild card

PHILADELPHIA VS. ATLANTA

Braves win series, 2-1
Tuesday, Sept. 29
At Atlanta 5.....Philadelphia 3
Wednesday, Sept. 30
Philadelphia 4.....at Atlanta 3 (10 inn.)
Thursday, Oct. 1
At Atlanta 6.....Philadelphia 2

CHI. CUBS VS. SAN DIEGO

Padres win series, 2-0
Tuesday, Sept. 29
At San Diego 8.....Chi. Cubs 0
Wednesday, Sept. 30
At San Diego 4.....Chi. Cubs 1

AL Division series

CHI. WHITE SOX VS. CLEVELAND

Schedule
Saturday at Cleveland.....1
Monday at Cleveland.....5
Wed. at Chi. White Sox.....TBA
*Thur., Oct. 8 at Chi. White Sox.....TBA
*Saturday, Oct. 10 at Cleveland.....TBA

NY YANKEES VS. TAMPA BAY

Schedule
Saturday at Tampa Bay.....6:30
Monday at Tampa Bay.....8
Wednesday at NY Yankees.....TBA
*Thursday, Oct. 8 at NY Yankees.....TBA
*Saturday, Oct. 10 at Tampa Bay.....TBA

NL Division series

ATLANTA VS. LA DODGERS

Schedule
Saturday at LA Dodgers.....4
Sunday at LA Dodgers.....8
Tuesday at Atlanta.....TBA
*Wednesday at Atlanta.....TBA
*Friday, Oct. 9 at LA Dodgers.....TBA

SAN DIEGO VS. MILWAUKEE

Schedule
Saturday at Milwaukee.....8:30
Sunday at Milwaukee.....4
Tuesday at San Diego.....TBA
*Wednesday at San Diego.....TBA
*Friday, Oct. 9 at Milwaukee.....TBA

* If necessary

BRYNN ANDERSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Braves pitcher Chris Sale (right) closed out the Phillies by striking out three in 1⅓ innings of relief Thursday.

BRAVES 6, PHILLIES 2

PHILADELPHIA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Turner ss	3	0	0	1	0	0	.091
Schwarber dh	3	1	2	0	1	0	.364
Harper rf-1b	4	0	1	0	0	2	.231
Bohm 1b-3b	4	0	1	1	0	0	.333
Stott 2b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.154
De La Cruz lf-rf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.222
Sosa 3b	1	0	0	0	0	0	.286
Marsh ph-lf	1	0	0	0	1	0	.400
Kemp ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Realmuto c	3	0	0	0	0	0	.200
Crawford cf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.143
Hill ph-cf	1	1	1	0	0	0	.200
Totals	**31**	**2**	**6**	**2**	**2**	**6**	

ATLANTA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Baldwin c	4	0	0	0	0	0	.154
Acuña rf	3	1	1	0	1	0	.111
Olson 1b	3	2	1	1	1	0	.182
Harris cf	3	1	1	3	0	1	.455
Dubón ss	4	0	0	0	0	1	.231
Yastrzemski lf	4	0	0	0	0	2	.111
Riley 3b	2	1	0	0	2	0	.222
Albies 2b	3	1	1	2	1	1	.333
Smith dh	3	0	2	0	0	1	.400
Totals	**29**	**6**	**6**	**6**	**5**	**6**	

Philadelphia.....000 001 010 — 2 6 0
Atlanta.....300 200 10x — 6 6 0

LOB—Phil. 5, Atlanta 5. **2B**—Harper (1). **3B**—Hill (1). **HR**—Olson (1), off Bowlan, Harris (1), off Nola, Albies (1), off Wheeler. **SF**—Turner. **DP**—Phil. 1; Atlanta 1.

Philadelphia	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Nola L 0-1	1⅔	2	3	3	2	1	16.20
Mayza	⅓	0	0	0	0	0	0.00
Wheeler	4	3	2	2	3	3	4.50
Bowlan	1	1	1	1	0	0	9.00
Duran	1	0	0	0	0	2	9.00

Atlanta	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Kerr	3⅓	1	0	0	1	2	0.00
Holmes W 1-0	2	2	1	1	1	1	4.50
Suarez	⅔	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
Fuentes	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.00
Dodd	⅔	1	1	1	0	0	13.50
Sale	1⅓	1	0	0	0	3	3.52

Inherited runners-scored—Mayza 1-0, Holmes 1-0, Suarez 1-1. **HBP**—by Bowlan (Harris). **WP**—Holmes. **NP**—Nola 38, Mayza 6, Wheeler 68, Bowlan 16, Duran 15, Kerr 47, Holmes 28, Suarez 11, Fuentes 13, Dodd 14, Sale 21. **Umpires**—Home, Mark Ripperger; First, Jordan Baker; Second, Nestor Ceja; Third, Charlie Ramos; Left, Dan Merzel; Right, Adam Beck. **T**—2:46. **A**—41,731 (40,819).

PADRES 4, CUBS 1

Wednesday night game

CHI. CUBS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Armstrong cf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Bregman dh	4	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Busch 1b	2	0	0	0	1	0	.000
TTaylor ph	1	0	1	0	0	0	1.000
Suzuki rf	4	1	1	0	0	2	.286
Happ lf	3	0	0	0	1	1	.000
Hoerner 2b	4	0	2	1	0	0	.500
Shaw 3b-1b	2	0	0	0	1	1	.000
Conforto ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000
CKelly c	3	0	1	0	0	0	.167
Swanson ss	3	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Totals	**31**	**1**	**5**	**1**	**3**	**8**	

SAN DIEGO	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Tatis rf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.286
Harris lf	4	0	0	0	0	0	.167
Machado 3b	4	0	1	0	0	1	.429
TFrance 1b	4	1	2	0	0	1	.500
Merrill cf	3	1	2	0	1	1	.571
Bogaerts ss	4	1	2	1	0	0	.500
Salas c	1	0	0	1	0	1	.000
Andujar ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Hays dh	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Sheets ph-dh	1	1	1	2	0	0	1.000
STaylor ph-dh	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Cronenworth 2b	2	0	0	0	0	0	.167
Totals	**30**	**4**	**8**	**4**	**1**	**6**	

Chi. Cubs.....000 100 000 — 1 5 0
San Diego.....020 200 00x — 4 8 0

LOB—Chi. 7, SD 5. **2B**—Hoerner (1), TFrance (1), Bogaerts (1). **HR**—Sheets (1), off Palencia. **SB**—Merrill (1). **CS**—Merrill (1). **SF**—Salas. **DP**—SD 1.

Chi. Cubs	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Gausman L 0-1	3⅓	5	3	3	0	1	8.10
Palencia	1⅔	1	1	1	0	2	5.40
Peterson	1⅔	1	0	0	0	1	0.00
Zeferjahn	1⅓	1	0	0	1	2	0.00

San Diego	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Pivetta	3⅓	3	1	1	2	4	2.70
Rodriguez W 1-0	1⅔	0	0	0	1	2	0.00
Adam	1	0	0	0	0	0	0.00
Morejon	2	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
MMiller S 1	1	1	0	0	0	2	0.00

Inherited runners-scored—Palencia 1-1, Rodriguez 2-0. **HBP**—by Palencia (Cronenworth), by Rodriguez (CKelly). **NP**—Gausman 54, Palencia 28, Peterson 28, Zeferjahn 30, Pivetta 66, Rodriguez 21, Adam 11, Morejon 29, MMiller 19. **Umpires**—Home, Erich Bacchus; First, Chad Fairchild; Second, Bill Miller; Third, Rob Drake; Left, Clint Vondrak; Right, Ramon De Jesus. **T**—2:50. **A**—47,513 (39,860).

Tracy erred again with early hook

▶SULLIVAN
Continued from Page C1

but that's the competitor I am. And yeah, I think if you probably ask the guys, they felt the same way. I felt strong, I felt confident, I felt convicted.

"I would've liked to have been trusted in that moment."

One of those teammates, Willson Contreras, was asked that very question. Rather than answer it, he mimed zipping his lip.

Not that the lineup had much to say in defense of its dismal performance. Contreras's home run in the sixth briefly cut the deficit to 2-1, but ultimately served only to forestall the coming onslaught. But there was clear and evident frustration about the same pitching story line on both nights.

In Game 1, it was the hard-throwing Payton Tolle who was pulled early, actually at the same point in the game as Gray was — two outs in the fifth, the Sox trailing, 1-0. Though Tolle had thrown 83 pitches, he too was certain he had more in the tank.

"As a competitor, you want to go as long as you can, and I think for me I see it as there's people they're going to trust," Tolle said. "I trust our bullpen, the way that they have gone about this year, they've been incredible and picked me up more times than I can count this year. It's the postseason and you got to limit as much as you can, so whenever those situations happen, it's just, 'OK, this is what's going to be best for the team.' "

Tracy handed the ball both nights to Erik Miller, the midseason addition who was acquired from the Giants for precisely these types of situations. On Tuesday, Miller gave up an immediate home run to Ben Rice, but neither that, nor the late-season struggles — such as the four straight games that he allowed at least a run in September — changed the manager's analytical calculus.

So there Miller was again on Wednesday. This time, he immediately gave up an RBI single to Cody Bellinger and was saved from further damage when the Yankees unwisely sent Rice home from third on another single, and he was thrown out by a strong throw from Red Sox left fielder Nate Eaton.

The way Tracy saw it, the plan was working.

"We were right in it," he said. "And once we got there, we actually had the ball turned over to the part of the bullpen for the latter part that we wanted to. Obviously, that didn't go our way."

Not many pitching decisions did. Brayan Bello in Game 1 giving up a grand slam. Garrett Crochet in Game 2, pitching in relief for the first time all season and failing to record an out. Alec Gamboa appearing in both games to the tune of a 27.00 ERA. Mainstays Garrett Whitlock and Aroldis Chapman reduced to Wednesday mop-up duty.

So much of it potentially avoidable had Tracy stuck with his starters. He described the same thinking for both nights.

"We were trailing, we're struggling to score runs, and you have to when you get in spots where you're struggling to score runs and you're already trailing, you feel like you've got to be aggressive and go," he said. "They're getting back to the top of the lineup, they got a couple hits against them, you see if you can put it out. And if you put it out, you're kind of lined up to where we wanted to go. That just didn't work.

"They were able to string a bunch of hits and we couldn't stop the bleeding."

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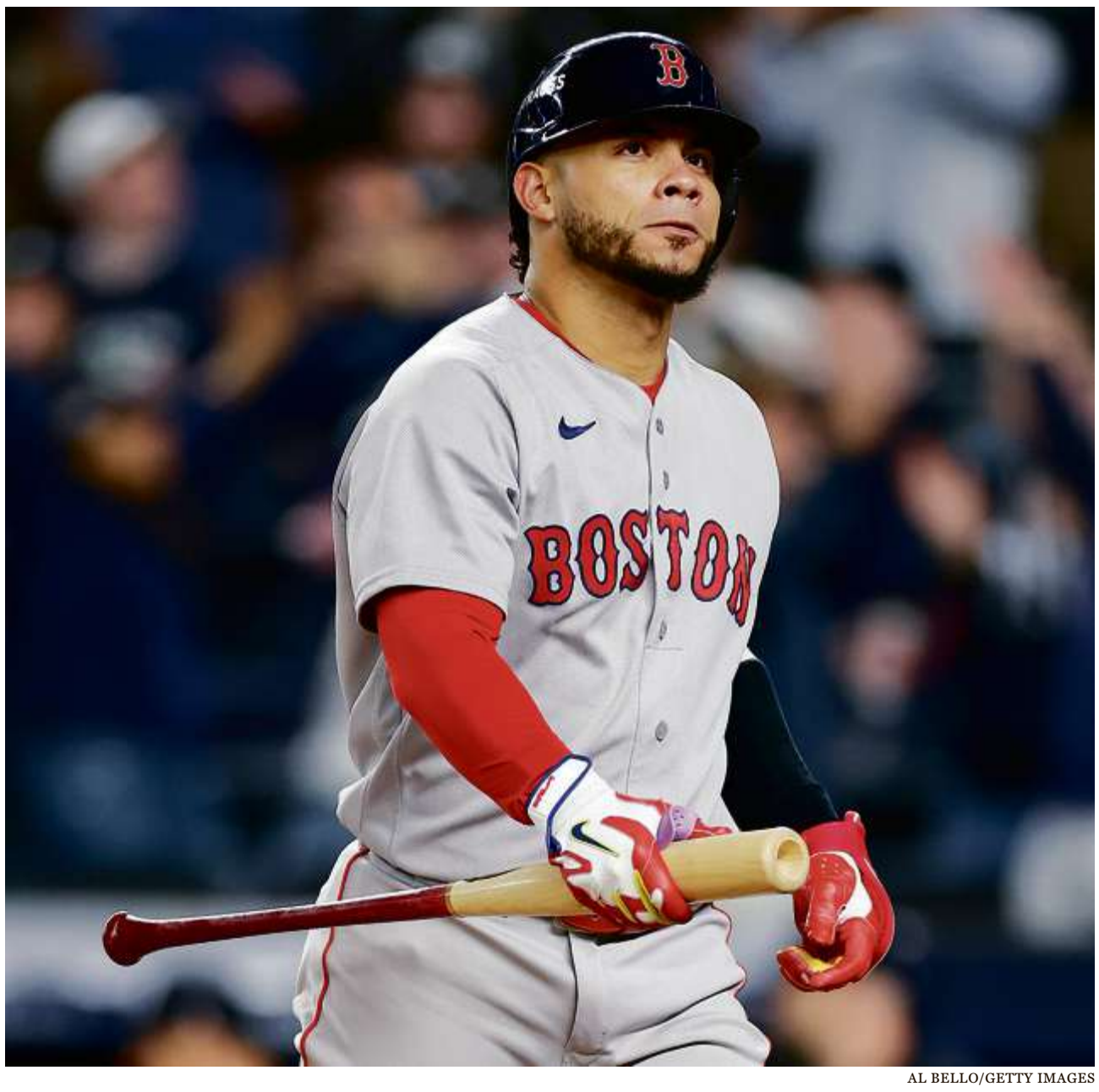

AL BELLO/GETTY IMAGES

Willson Contreras's contract with the Red Sox has one more guaranteed year, plus a team option for 2028.

Contreras offers critique of Sox' analytics reliance

▶RED SOX
Continued from Page C1

Despite playing through a number of injuries, he was their one source of offense Wednesday, going 2 for 2 with a homer and a pair of walks. His four times on base doubled the combined total of the rest of the lineup.

His view of the series?

"We didn't play good at all," he said. "We didn't pitch. We didn't hit. And when you don't have those two it's tough to win. [The Yankees] played better than us."

For Contreras, that straightforward analysis was the beginning of a critique of the Red Sox organization that sharpened as he continued.

"I'm really proud of this group, [but] whatever we did in the past stays in the past," he said. "We have to get better for next year. In every aspect of the game, we have to get better. That's the bottom line."

How did an offense that was tops in the American League for a 60-game stretch (5.18 runs per game from June 25 through Aug. 31) regress to early-season form by staggering through September (an MLB-worst 2.96 runs per game) and then collapse in a brief postseason?

"That's a good question. I'm not going to answer it because I don't want to give my honest answer," said Contreras. "We got eliminated. That's the bottom line. . . . We didn't produce. We didn't execute any part of the game. And that's why we [lost].

"I know we had a really good stretch. I'm really proud of what we did in the past, like I said. We were able to turn the season around for sure, 100 percent, but that's not enough. It's not enough."

Contreras suggested both specific areas in which the Sox needed to improve — for instance, controlling the running game of opponents — but also macro-level adjustments.

"It's not enough when you have talent or you have data or you have computers telling you what to do. This is baseball and the data is here to help us," he said. "But at the end of the day, you're going to need experience and veteran guys to win games. There's a lot of stuff that I would love to say but I'll stay [with] that."

Does Contreras believe the Sox are too data-reliant?

"If you watch the game," Contreras responded incredulously, implying that the answer was obvious. "If you watch the game."

Given that view, is there anything Contreras or other players can do to encourage the organization to evolve in its approach?

"I don't know. I cannot make decisions," he said. "The only thing that I can control is my part of the game. . . . Making decisions about data, about all that stuff, we cannot do anything about it. Like I said, it's here to help us. But at the end of the day, it's not about data. It's about executing the game plan.

"At the end of the day, we can talk, we can share ideas. I'm not making decisions and we're not going to make decisions. We are employees. We get paid to play baseball, and we play to be out there on the field, to perform. That's the bottom line."

Despite his misgivings, Contreras — who had to waive his no-trade protection in order to complete his December trade from the Cardinals to the Red Sox — suggested he is content in the organization.

"I really had fun," said Contreras, whose contract has one more guaranteed year, plus a team option for 2028. "This [was] my first season in Boston. I didn't have any expectations coming up here when I got traded. I didn't want to put anything in my mind.

"[But] I'm really proud [with] what I was able to do during the whole season. But also, I'm proud of the team that we've got here and proud of everybody."

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Ten years on, Tatum leads way for Celtics

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

In 2017, the Celtics held training camp in Newport, R.I. The sparkling new Auerbach Center in Brighton was a year away from opening, so the trip was a way to escape the team's rundown practice facility in the back of a Waltham health club and promote team bonding.

It was also Jayson Tatum's rookie year, and the superstar forward can hardly believe a decade has passed since then.

"I just kind of remember it like it was yesterday," Tatum said before Thursday's practice. "It's hard to imagine it's already my 10th one. Just trying to stay present more than anything, because obviously I know how fast it's going by. Just trying to enjoy it."

At the time, Tatum was a shy, greenhorn prospect from Duke trying to find his way on a roster that included All-Star talents such as Kyrie Irving and Al Horford.

Tatum has experienced so much since then. He is a four-time first-team All-NBA selection, he has his own signature sneaker — along with countless other endorsements — and he helped the Celtics win the 2024 NBA title.

But one of his most defining moments was also one he would like to forget. On May 12, 2025, he tore his Achilles in Game 4 of the conference semifinal series against the Knicks, and he wondered then if he would ever be the same.

He returned last March and showed glimpses of his All-Star form, but there were potholes to navigate. On his first dunk attempt, he was blocked by the rim because he did not have the necessary burst. After long stretches, he was much more winded than usual. And the speed of the game was initially jarring.

"I was cleared, but mentally, from a conditioning standpoint, I wasn't myself," Tatum said. "I think for me when I came back, it was great from a mentality standpoint to get over that hurdle of playing and even if I was at 80 percent of myself, knowing that I could still be effective."

Throughout, Tatum said those games were part of his rehab process. And that process continued this summer, when Tatum was able to attack and truly get his swagger back and push forward without reluctance or limitation.

"Just going into the offseason knowing that I had the whole summer to get my body right and get the rhythm of playing basketball again, I feel so much more confident from a mental standpoint and physically than I did last March," he said. "That's how it should be. It's a long journey from the injury I had, and I feel great."

So, he enters his 10th NBA season with a new appreciation and a new perspective. The 28-year-old will never be an in-your-face presence with his teammates, but he understands he is now, believe it or not, one of the older veterans. He is also one of the best basketball players in the world. And he is eager to take on more responsibilities as a leader.

Tatum has said that there are different ways to lead, and he provided an example this summer, when he organized informal workouts in Los Angeles with teammates. They played basketball and golf. They shared meals and started building the cohesion they believe will help them remain an Eastern Conference force, all at Tatum's urging.

"It had to do with the new guys on our team and with the rookies," he said. "And, I don't know, just trying something new. It's kind of like the first time we've ever done that since I've been here. Getting in the gym in the summertime when we normally wouldn't be around each other and play some golf and just hang out, just kind of build that chemistry."

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BRUINS NOTEBOOK

Clifton thrives with increased time on ice

By Conor Ryan
BOSTON.COM

Connor Clifton didn't think twice when the Bruins came calling on July 1.

Beyond his familiarity with Boston — having played parts of five seasons and 232 games with the Bruins — the free agent defenseman also felt his former club would offer an opportunity to earn steady playing time.

Despite playing just 50 games with the Penguins last season, the 31-year-old Clifton felt he had more to give with a team in need along the blue line.

Clifton's hopes of securing a greater role with Boston were validated in the season-opening win over the Rangers on Tuesday, as he recorded a team-leading 23:23 of ice time.

The Quinnipiac product has logged more than 23:23 just nine times in his 435 career NHL games.

"I was a little sore, but excited," Clifton said of his heavy workload. "That first game you're always a little sore. You're kind of juiced up to get at it, and a little nervous."

With **Charlie McAvoy** serving a six-game suspension, coach **Marco Sturm** has had to reshuffle his defense corps to properly allocate the heavy minutes McAvoy usually commands.

Clifton and **Nikita Zadorov** were the beneficiaries on Tuesday, with Sturm relying heavily on a duo that can dish out hits, ferry pucks through the neutral zone, and activate offensively.

"I think Cliffy is healthy for Z," Sturm said Thursday. "Z sometimes has a big mouth, and Cliffy settles him down, too. So, it's a good combo . . . I trust them. They played a lot of minutes the other night. It's not going to be like this every night, but they showed me they can play against the big boys, too."

Clifton said he was surprised by how fleet-footed the 6-foot-7-inch, 244-pound Zadorov can be. But that mobility should come in handy for a defense corps that needs to limit how much time it spends around goalies **Jeremy Swayman** or **Michael DiPietro**.

Swayman (24 saves) was the main equalizer in the 3-0 shutout of the Rangers.

But Clifton — donning the spoked-B in a game that mattered for the first time in 1,250 days — was pleased with how Boston's shorthanded defensive unit fared after an abbreviated training camp.

"I think we played to our identity," he said. A couple big hits by [Zadorov], so it was great. I think we were reading each other well."

'A' huge honor

Plenty of eyes were on **David Pastrnak's** sweater alteration for the season opener, with the veteran winger drawing an ovation from the TD Garden crowd after being introduced as captain for the first time.

But scrappy winger **Tanner Jeannot** also had some changes to his gear — skating with an "A" on his sweater as one of Boston's alternate captains alongside **Hampus Lindholm**.

Team president Cam Neely singled out the pugnacious forward as one of the emerging leaders in a reworked dressing room anchored by Pastrnak and McAvoy — alongside Lindholm, Zadorov, **Morgan Geekie**, and **Fraser Minten**.

"It's obviously a huge honor," Jeannot said. "To be able to wear that on my sweater on an Original Six team, it's a dream come true. I just want to do everything I can to help the guys, help the team win, whatever that needs to be. If that's making hits, blocking shots, getting to the net, going to the hard areas, I just want to help out."

Poitras back at practice

Matt Poitras returned to practice in a regular sweater but did not take part in line rushes.

The center was placed on injured reserve to start the season, with Sturm undecided if Poitras would make the trip to Winnipeg and Minnesota. A return for Poitras might not be in the cards until at least next week, considering Sturm wants him to get a few more practices under his belt.

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NHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

ATLANTIC	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Boston	1	1	0	0	2	1	3	0
Montreal	1	1	0	0	2	1	3	2
*Florida	1	1	0	0	2	1	1	0
Toronto	2	1	1	0	2	1	4	4
Detroit	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Ottawa	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Buffalo	1	0	1	0	0	0	3	6
Tampa Bay	1	0	1	0	0	0	1	5
METROPOLITAN	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Pittsburgh	1	1	0	0	2	1	7	0
Columbus	1	1	0	0	2	1	6	3
New Jersey	1	1	0	0	2	1	3	2
NY Rangers	2	1	1	0	2	1	5	4
Carolina	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	1
Philadelphia	2	0	1	1	1	0	2	10
Washington	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NY Islanders	1	0	1	0	0	0	1	2

WESTERN CONFERENCE

CENTRAL	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Colorado	1	1	0	0	2	1	8	4
Minnesota	1	1	0	0	2	1	3	1
Dallas	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
St. Louis	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
*Utah	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Winnipeg	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Nashville	1	0	1	0	0	0	1	3
*Chicago	1	0	1	0	0	0	2	5
PACIFIC	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Vegas	1	1	0	0	2	1	5	2
Seattle	1	1	0	0	2	1	6	1
*Vancouver	1	1	0	0	2	1	6	5
*Edmonton	1	0	0	1	1	0	5	6
Anaheim	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
*San Jose	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Los Angeles	1	0	1	0	0	0	4	8
Calgary	1	0	1	0	0	0	1	6

* — Not including late game; ROW — Regulation plus overtime wins

THURSDAY'S RESULTS

At Columbus 6	Buffalo 3	Seattle 6	at Calgary 1
At New Jersey 3	Philadelphia 2	Chicago	at Utah
At NY Rangers 5	Tampa Bay 1	Florida	at San Jose
Minnesota 3	at Nashville 1	Edmonton	at Vancouver

FRIDAY'S GAMES

Boston at Winnipeg	8	St. Louis at Dallas	9
NY Rangers at Detroit	6:30	Anaheim at Vegas	10
Washington at Carolina	7		

WEDNESDAY'S RESULTS

Pittsburgh 7	at Philadelphia 0	At Colorado 8	Los Angeles 4
At Toronto 2	NY Islanders 1		

BRUCE BENNETT/GETTY IMAGES

Igor Shesterkin (right) celebrates scoring the first goalie goal in Rangers history Thursday night in a 5-1 win over the Lightning.

Jets thumbnails

(2025-26 statistics)

■ **When, where:** Friday, 8 p.m. at Canada Life Centre, Winnipeg, Manitoba.
■ **TV, radio:** NESN, WBZ-FM (98.5).
■ **Goals:** Kyle Connor 39, Mark Scheifele 36, Gabriel Vilardi 30.
■ **Assists:** Scheifele 67, Connor 53, Josh Morrissey 41.
■ **Goaltending:** Stuart Skinner (23-17-9, 2.92 GAA), Clay Stevenson (3-1-0, 2.00).
■ **Head to head:** This is the first of two meetings. The Bruins went 2-0 vs. the Jets last season.
■ **Miscellany:** Goalie Connor Hellebuyck was suspended by the team Sept. 16 after failing to report to training camp. The 33-year-old is on a seven-year contract through 2030-31 and requested a trade in August . . . Skinner, 27, is expected to start in net. The Jets claimed Stevenson off waivers . . . The Jets went 26-12-6 last season when scoring first . . . Jets first-round pick Viggo Bjorck, an 18-year-old forward from Sweden, is on the roster to open the season.

JACKETS 6, SABRES 3

Buffalo.....1 2 0 — 3
Columbus.....3 1 2 — 6

First period — 1. Buffalo, Samuelsson 1 (Ostlund, Power), 7:21. 2. Columbus, CSillinger 1 (Coyle, Mateychuk), 12:51. 3. Columbus, Knies 1 (Coyle, Werenski), 17:58 (pp). 4. Columbus, Fantilli 1 (Werenski, Knies), 18:44. Penalties — Soucy, CBJ (cross check), 6:05. Thompson, BUF (hooking), 6:40. Samuelsson, BUF (holding), 17:03.

Second period — 5. Buffalo, Quinn 1 (Benson, Ostlund), 1:25. 6. Columbus, Knies 2 (Andrae, Johnson), 7:45. 7. Buffalo, Helenius 1 (McLeod, Power), 13:14. Penalties — Metsa, BUF, major (fighting), 3:58. Olivier, CBJ, major (fighting), 3:58. Olivier, CBJ, served by Fantilli (roughing), 3:58. CSillinger, CBJ (hooking), 3:58. Johnson, CBJ (hooking), 11:06.

Third period — 8. Columbus, Monahan 1 (Nichushkin, Voronkov), 14:21 (pp). 9. Columbus, Olivier 1 (Coyle), 17:53 (en). Penalties — CSillinger, CBJ (slashing), 9:10. Samuelsson, BUF (tripping), 12:23.

Shots on goal — Buffalo 6-13-7 — 26. Columbus 8-6-8 — 22.

Power plays — Buffalo 0-5; Columbus 2-3.

Goalies — Buffalo, Luukkonen 0-1-0 (21 shots-16 saves). Columbus, Greaves 1-0-0 (26 shots-23 saves).

Referees — Jon McIsaac, Francis Charron. Linesmen — Jesse Marquis, Libor Suchanek.

A — 18,207 (18,144). T — 2:37.

DEVILS 3, FLYERS 2

Philadelphia.....1 0 1 0 — 2
New Jersey.....0 1 1 1 — 3

First period — 1. Philadelphia, Ristolainen 1 (Sanheim, Konecny), 11:12. Penalties — Acciari, PHI (holding), 7:19. Zegras, PHI (holding), 11:31. Couturier, PHI (boarding), 15:29.

Second period — 2. New Jersey, Hamilton 1, 17:58. Penalties — Evangelista, NJD (tripping), 4:07.

Third period — 3. Philadelphia, Sanheim 1 (Couturier), 5:33. 4. New Jersey, LHughes 1 (Evangelista), 9:44. Penalties — Dvorak, PHI (high stick), 0:37.

Overtime — 5. New Jersey, JHughes 1 (Bratt), 3:23. Penalties — None.

Shots on goal — Philadelphia 6-8-8-3 — 25. New Jersey 14-16-11-3 — 44.

Power plays — Philadelphia 0-1; New Jersey 0-4.

Goalies — Philadelphia, Woll 0-0-1 (44 shots-41 saves). New Jersey, Allen 1-0-0 (25 shots-23 saves).

Referees — Wesley McCauley, Furman South. Linesmen — Jonathan Deschamps, Kyle Flemington.

A — 16,539 (17,625). T — 2:34.

RANGERS 5, LIGHTNING 1

Tampa Bay.....0 1 0 — 1
NY Rangers.....2 2 1 — 5

First period — 1. NY, Zibanejad 1 (Dorofeyev, Fox), 5:34 (pp). 2. NY, Dorofeyev 1 (Bjorkstrand), 10:51. Penalties — Moser, TBL (holding), 5:01. Schneider, NYR (holding), 8:20. Cuylle, NYR (holding), 13:31.

Second period — 3. NY, Tolvanen 1 (Laba), 1:40. 4. Tampa Bay, Kucherov 1 (Mikheyev, Point), 7:59. 5. NY, Perreault 1 (Fox, Zibanejad), 16:01. Penalties — Viel, TBL (roughing), 2:07. Schneider, NYR (roughing), 2:07. Miller, NYR (hooking), 12:51.

Third period — 6. NY, Shesterkin 1, 17:26 (en). Penalties — Miller, NYR (holding), 0:25. Moser, TBL (tripping), 3:34. Fox, NYR (tripping), 9:04. Laba, NYR (delay of game), 11:01. Durzi, NYR (delay of game), 19:03.

Shots on goal — TB 9-10-6 — 25. NY 7-11-7 — 25.

Power plays — TB 0-7; NY 1-2.

Goalies — Tampa Bay, Vasilevskiy 0-1-0 (24 shots-20 saves). NY, Shesterkin 1-1-0 (25 shots-24 saves).

Referees — Frederick L'Ecuyer, Morgan MacPhee.

A — 18,006 (18,200). T — 2:32.

AVALANCHE 8, KINGS 4

Wednesday night game

Los Angeles.....1 2 1 — 4
Colorado.....2 4 2 — 8

First period — 1. Colorado, Nelson 1 (Schwartz, Kadri), 6:33 (pp). 2. Los Angeles, Dumoulin 1 (Laferriere, Turcotte), 15:14. 3. Colorado, Kelly 1 (Manson), 17:58. Penalties — Lee, LAK (delay of game), 4:48. Schwartz, COL (hooking), 10:21. Toews, COL (holding), 15:55. Kempe, LAK (tripping), 19:12. Doughty, LAK (cross check), 19:52.

Second period — 4. Colo., MacKinnon 1 (Kadri, CMakar), 0:23 (pp). 5. LA, Armia 1 (Haula, Ceci), 1:28. 6. Colo., MacKinnon 2 (Necas, Burns), 8:33. 7. Colo., Roy 1 (Schwartz, Kelly), 16:01. 8. LA, Moore 1 (Anderson), 17:50. 9. Colo., Lehkonen 1 (Nelson, Toews), 18:34 (pp). Penalties — Hughes, COL (roughing), 12:19. Edmundson, LAK (slashing), 17:15.

Third period — 10. Los Angeles, Panarin 1 (Doughty, Laferriere), 11:51. 11. Colorado, Landeskog 1 (CMakar), 14:03. 12. Colorado, Lehkonen 2 (Nelson, Toews), 15:06 (pp). Penalties — Juulsen, COL (interference), 4:30. Clarke, LAK, major (fighting), 13:20. MacKinnon, COL, major (fighting), 13:20. Turcotte, LAK (tripping), 14:15.

Shots on goal — LA 13-12-6 — 31. Colorado 10-10-9 — 29. Power plays — LA 0-4; Col. 4-5. Goalies — LA, Kuemper 0-1-0 (29 shots-21 saves). Col., Blackwood 1-0-0 (31 shots-27 saves).

Referees — Carter Sandlak, Francois St. Laurent. A — 18,092 (17,809).

HIGH SCHOOL FOOTBALL ROUNDUP

Billerica's patience pays off in OT win

By Nate Weitzer
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As the seconds ticked down in regulation during a fierce Merrimack Valley Conference battle at North Andover, visiting Billerica never panicked.

Trailing by a field goal, the Indians stuck with the double-wing rushing attack that has become the program's identity, working the ball methodically into Scarlet Knights' territory before burning their final timeout.

Billerica didn't need to get into the end zone, because senior Danny Venezia drilled a 32-yard kick that would've been good from 50-plus yards, forcing overtime, where Billerica prevailed, 26-20.

"There were people kind of looking at me sideways," Billerica coach Shawn Theriault said after running the ball consistently in the final two minutes. "But I was thinking if we could just pound it and get to around the 20-yard line, Danny was good."

Venezia added 119 rushing yards, including a 56-yard touchdown, but fumbled in the first half to give No. 17 North Andover (3-1) a lifeline. The Scarlet Knights struggled to stop Billerica's rushing attack with road graders Prince Mahey, Thomas Arsenault, Jason Leipow, William Marshall, and Nicholas Cloutier blocking up front.

"The kids pride themselves on toughness," Theriault said. "They're Billerica kids. So they get excited when we call for the double wing."

Billerica (4-0) forced a fourth-down fumble to open the overtime, then Jackson Gearin (13 carries, 76 yards) showcased his toughness by pushing the pile into the end zone for the clinching score, marking the program's sixth straight conference win.

Senior quarterback Austin Allen rushed for 98 yards with electric touchdown runs of 36 and 32 yards to pace the Scarlet Knights. Allen found Jason Meaney on a 9-yard TD pass to give the hosts a 13-10 lead after three quarters.

But Erik Knight led Billerica back with a 50-yard kick return, followed by a 13-yard touchdown run, to put the Indians back in front. Allen answered with his second touchdown run, but leaving 3 minutes, 38 seconds on the clock proved too much time for Billerica to counter.

Norwell 41, Abington 14 — Explosive when it needs to be. Punishing when it wants to be.

That's the story of the Norwell offense. Playing at South Shore rival Abington on Friday, lightning struck when senior quarterback Jack Luccarelli blazed down the right sideline for a 56-yard game-opening touchdown at Memorial Field.

Immediately after intermission, the Clippers (3-1) were malicious and measured, executing a punishing eight-minute drive that ended in a 9-yard touchdown by senior halfback Colin Gerhart.

Bruising or blazing. Fast or slow. Norwell has both gears.

"We were going fast in the first half and we saw the effect on [Abington] . . . You saw some guys with their hands on their knees," said Norwell coach Jason Pithie. "I love going fast because our guys are in really good shape. Then, in that third quarter, we didn't want to go fast. . . . We wanted to pound our way down the field."

"We play Abington every year. We know them very well," Luccarelli added. "There's a lot of motivation coming into this game. They got us last year, and I thought this game was huge with our momentum."

After Luccarelli's opening-drive statement, the Green Wave (3-1) responded, with sophomore Jake Lehman powering in for a 1-yard touchdown.

Gerhart countered with a 3-yard score, and after a quick defensive stop, Luccarelli added to the Clippers' advantage with a 3-yard TD of his own for a two-score lead. Daniel Pifer scored from 3 yards out before halftime to cut Abington's deficit to 21-14.

Norwell's defense forced three consecutive third-quarter stops and allowing Luccarelli to run wild. His fourth-quarter 11-yard touchdown run — then a late-game 1-yard punch-in by junior Charlie Hajjar — all but iced it.

Medford 33, Saugus 0 — Tony Corrado threw three touchdown passes and Judson Jean took a punt return 30 yards for a score as the visiting Mustangs (1-3) earned the nonleague win vs. Saugus (0-4).

Correspondent Evan Walsh reported from Abington and Ethan Kagno contributed.

SportsLog

Wilson, Aces bounce Fever

A'ja Wilson made sure her basketball spoke for itself Thursday night, as the four-time WNBA MVP scored 36 points to lead the defending champion Las Vegas Aces to a 94-83 victory over the Indiana Fever in the deciding Game 3 of the first round. The third-seeded Aces, who have won three of the past four titles, moved on to play the winner of the Golden State-Dallas series, which will be decided Friday night in San Francisco. This is the second year in a row Las Vegas has ended the season for **Caitlin Clark** and the Fever, who were seeded sixth. The teams met in the semifinals a year ago, with the Aces pulling out an overtime victory in the finale of the five-game series. Wilson bookended this series with sensational performances in Games 1 and 3, making her sure verbal confrontation with a Fever fan Tuesday in Indianapolis wouldn't be the enduring memory. The league did not punish Wilson, who opened the series with 38 points and 16 rebounds, followed up in this game by making 11 of 18 shots and grabbing 10 rebounds. Teammate **Chelsea Gray** added 23 points and **Jackie Young** scored 18. Clark scored 11 points in the first quarter, but was held to seven the rest of the game. **Kelsey Mitchell** led Indiana with 23 points and **Aliyah Boston** had 19 points and 10 rebounds . . . Atlanta Dream star forward **Angel Reese** was voted WNBA Defensive Player of the Year, receiving 46 votes from 72 media members. Golden State's **Gabby Williams** finished second with 20 votes and Wilson was third. Reese grabbed a league-high 12.1 rebounds a game and ranked third in the league with 1.8 steals a game . . . The UConn men's and women's basketball teams were each picked to win the Big East by the league's coaches. **Silas Demary Jr.** and **Sarah Strong** were named preseason Big East Player of the Year.

HOCKEY

Shesterkin first Rangers goalie to score

Igor Shesterkin became the 18th goaltender in NHL history to score a goal and first for the Rangers when he shot the puck into an empty net late in a 5-1 victory against the Lightning. Shesterkin was mobbed by celebrating teammates after scoring with 2:34 left. He skated to the bench at the front of the line of players to fist-bump teammates and was serenaded by chants of "Igor! Igor!" from fans delighted to see him finally cash in. The first goal of his career is the 21st by a goalie, counting the playoffs. Shesterkin was also terrific at the other end, stopping 24 of the 25 shots he faced.

SOCCER

Portugal wins without Ronaldo

João Félix sealed Portugal's 4-2 Nations League win over Denmark in Copenhagen, where the visitors were without Ronaldo after he walked out on the team the day before after an apparent rift with coach **Jorge Jesus**. It has fueled speculation it may be the end for the veteran star. **Gonçalo Ramos**, who has taken the 41-year-old forward's place, had a goal and an assist in the first half. **Vitinha** gave Portugal a 3-2 lead in the 67th minute with a near-post header to **Bruno Fernandes's** free kick. Félix made sure of the win in the 87th.

KEN MCGAGH FOR THE GLOBE

Senior captain Ciara Nee, Woburn's all-time aces leader, has the Tanners off to a strong start in the Middlesex League Liberty.

HIGH SCHOOL GIRLS' VOLLEYBALL NOTEBOOK

Woburn wins with drive and devotion

By Tony Gleason
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Woburn girls' volleyball coach **Scott Roy** received a text from senior captain **Sophia Zapelini Viviani** last Friday morning.

"[S]ince we don't have practice on friday can't we have practice sat and sunday," Zapelini Viviani wrote.

It was the first time Roy could recall a captain making such a request since he started the program in 2012.

Thus, the Tanners were practicing at 8:30 a.m. Sunday on a scheduled off day.

Within the competitive Middlesex League Liberty division, Woburn has started 6-3 after a 10-10 finish last fall.

"That just really shows our drive and devotion to the sport," senior all-around **Addison McNamara** said. "How even though it's our off day, we want to get in the gym and we want to put in the work."

Another senior captain, outside **Ciara Nee** delivered 10 aces in Woburn's 3-0 win over Wilmington Sept. 18, passing the program's previous career mark of 147. She entered Thursday's match with 160.

Zapelini Viviani, a returning Middlesex League All-Star, set the program's single-game record for blocks with 13 in Monday's hotly contested 3-2 loss at Burlington. She and junior middle blocker **Sasha Lefang** are dominant at the net. McNamara and senior **Ava Scalesse** complete the starting lineup.

Scalessse has stepped in for senior captain **Alina Ayanian**, the starting libero last season, who tore her ACL last winter playing basketball.

In the offseason, the 5-foot-2-inch Scalesse played club for Mass Impact, often an age up against 18-year-olds. She dedicated herself to improving her reads of defensive plays, such as tips and hard hits.

"The first Monday clinic in the summer that we had, I couldn't recognize her," Lefang said.

Scalesse, along with Nee, has solidified the back row. She's delivered double-digit digs six times, with a season high 24 against Burlington.

Timid on the court last season, Scalesse now feels a responsibility to step up for the younger players.

"I have to start taking control and making the plays and making things happen," Scalesse said. "Especially since the first ball most likely comes to me."

From June through August, Roy hosts clinics every Monday and a summer league on Wednesdays. McNamara, previously a defensive specialist, earned the starting role after an offseason spent improving her vertical and strengthening her shoulders.

In a 3-0 victory over Arlington, McNamara had three sets on one sequence. On her third bid, she tipped it over a right-side block, delivering the point.

With more skill, knowledge, and confidence, the Tanners have been able to diversify their attack.

"Sometimes Addi will get three, four sets in a row, the [opposing] team will fall asleep," said Roy. "Next thing you know, no one's defending Sasha, and that's a big point for us."

McNamara credits her improved play to the confidence gained from getting regular reps.

"I thought the select times where I was in, I had to really prove that I could — I was perfect and wouldn't make any mistakes," McNamara said. "I was more focused on not making a mistake than just passing the ball and just performing."

The Tanners opened their season with a 3-1 win over a Wakefield squad that swept Woburn last season. In years past, Roy said his team featured good hitters but had trouble executing sets.

"We know who our big hitters are and they're people that are already starting the season on like an 8 out of 10," Roy said. "So we don't have to build them up that much."

Set points

■ Analyzing the first set of power rankings:

Division 1: After being a 7-seed and a 13-seed the past two seasons, Winchester stacked its nonconference schedule with top-tier opponents and it's working. The Red & Black debuted as No. 1. The Merrimack Valley has not played much out-of-conference yet, and the formula does not give much doubt. Undefeated Central Catholic starts at No. 8 and last year's top seed, Chelmsford, opened at No. 15.

Division 2: Reigning champ Oliver Ames is the top dog, as expected after taking down Franklin and extending its undefeated streak to 33 in a row. The next four are all from the Middlesex League, and No. 8 is too. The league is much more than just Winchester, and Reading is a team to watch.

Division 3: Defending champ Bellingham starts at No. 2, but may have the chance to move up after Melrose took down No. 1 Newburyport. Medfield and Weston, the 2024 and 2023 champions, respectively, rebounded nicely despite graduating their stars and are in the top six, along with No. 4 Joseph Case and its sophomore hitters fresh off a finals appearance.

Division 4: East Bridgewater brought back star players from its championship team, and holds the top spot. Ursuline is not far behind, but a significant gap follows. Ipswich, which went from a four-peat to a four-match winner last year, has already equaled that win total and cracks the top 10.

Division 5: Madison Park was a No. 2-seed last year and is off to a 4-2 start, but is No. 10 in the first power rankings; New Mission, at No. 8, is the top Boston-based squad. Pioneer Valley Christian is No. 1, and 150 miles away on the Cape is No. 2 St. John Paul II.

Correspondent AJ Traub contributed to this report. Tony Gleason can be reached at tony.gleason@globe.com.

Globe Top 20

No.		Rec.	Last
1.	Oliver Ames	8-0	2
2.	Franklin	9-1	7
3.	Winchester	9-1	1
4.	Brookline	6-1	3
5.	Central Catholic	9-0	4
6.	Chelmsford	6-1	8
7.	Andover	6-2	5
8.	Bellingham	7-0	6
9.	Newton North	5-2	9
10.	Newton South	4-3	10
11.	Needham	6-2	11
12.	Natick	7-1	12
13.	Reading	8-0	13
14.	Wellesley	2-5	14
15.	Weston	5-3	15
16.	Wayland	5-2	16
17.	Westford	6-1	17
18.	Melrose	7-2	—
19.	Newburyport	9-1	18
20.	Burlington	6-2	—

Scoreboard

★ ★ ★

	FRI 10/2	SAT 10/3	SUN 10/4	MON 10/5	TUE 10/6	WED 10/7	THU 10/8
			BUF 1:00 CBS				
	WPG 8:00 NESN	MIN 8:00 NESN		OTT 7:30 NESN			UTA 7:00 NESN
		POR 8:45 Ion					

Home games shaded
On the radio: Patriots, Bruins, and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5.

Schools

FIELD HOCKEY

Cushing 7...Austin Prep 0
CAPE & ISLANDS
Monomoy 4...Nauset 0
Sandwich 5...Falmouth 1
CAPE ANN
Ipswich 4...Amesbury 0
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Ursuline 2...Malden Cath. 0
COUNTY
Belchertown 3...Amherst-Pelham 0
DUAL COUNTY
Acton-Boxboro 5...Wayland 1
Waltham 2...Bedford 1
Weston 4...Westford 0
HOCKOMOCK
Attleboro 2...Mansfield 0
Foxboro 6...Stoughton 0
Franklin 11...North Attleboro 0
King Philip 8...Taunton 0
Oliver Ames 7...Milford 0
MAYFLOWER
Southeastern 2...Wareham/Mashpee 1
MID-WACH
Quabbin 2...Groton-Dunstable 0
MIDDLESEX
Melrose 3...Stoneham 1
NORTHEASTERN
Gloucester 5...Danvers 2
SOUTH COAST
Apponequet 2...Old Rochester 0
Joseph Case 4...Fairhaven 1
Somerset Berkley 7...W. Bridgewater 0
SOUTH SHORE
Cohasset 3...Norwell 0
SUBURBAN
Frontier 3...Longmeadow 0
TRI-VALLEY
Dedham 3...Hopkinton 1
Dover-Sherborn 5...Medfield 1
Medway 2...Norwood 1
Westwood 3...Bellingham 0
NONLEAGUE
Ashland 2...Westboro 1
Bay Path/David Prouty 5...Gr. Lowell 2
Bp. Fenwick 1...Swampscott 1
Bp. Stang 2...St. John Paul II 2
Doherty 5...Nipmuc 0
E. Bridgewater 4...Bridge.-Raynham 1
Hopedale 5...Auburn 1
Newton South 7...St. Mary's 0
St. Bernard's 3...Worcester South 0
St. Paul 9...Wor. Tech/Wor. North 0
Sutton 5...Northbridge 1
W. Springfield 1...Smith Academy 1
Westport 7...Digh.-Rehoboth 0

FOOTBALL

MERRIMACK VALLEY
Billerica 26...N. Andover 20
SOUTH SHORE
Norwell 41...Abington 14
TRI-COUNTY
Pathfinder 31...Smith Vocational 16
NONLEAGUE
Medford 33...Saugus 0
Minnechaug 46...W. Springfield 14

GOLF

BOYS
BAY STATE
Walpole 228...Weymouth 254
Wellesley 218...Needham 228
BERKSHIRE
Taconic 153...Monument Mtn. 154
BI-COUNTY
Franklin Cty. 155...McCann Tech 168
Pioneer Valley 168...Hopkins 195
BIG THREE
Durfee 118...Brockton 57
CAPE & ISLANDS
Dennis-Yarmouth 259...Rising Tide 319
Sandwich 237...Nauset 238
Sturgis West 262...Sturgis East 285
CAPE ANN
Amesbury 187...Georgetown 111
Ipswich 196...Ham.-Wenham 158
Lynnfield 177...Essex Tech 160
Manchester 135...Rockport 130
Newburyport 186...N. Reading 151
Pentucket 164...Triton 205
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Bp. Stang 199...Bp. Fenwick 173
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
BC High 219...Xaverian 221
St. John's (S) 232...Malden Cath. 251
DUAL COUNTY
Boston Latin 234...Weston 219
Lincoln-Sudbury 220...Bedford 250
Newton South 228...Waltham 239
Westford 220...Wayland 251
EIL
Portsmouth Abbey 5...Beaver CD 1
GREATER BOSTON
Medford 40½...Somerville 31½
HOCKOMOCK
Canton 134...King Philip 141
Milford 186...Foxboro 160
Taunton 150...Attleboro 159
MAYFLOWER
Diman 0...Bristol-Plymouth 0
Old Colony 7...Tri-County 2
Southeastern 8...Blue Hills 1
MERRIMACK VALLEY
N. Andover 231...Central Cath. 245
NORTHEASTERN
Beverly 36...Danvers 36
Gloucester 49...Salem 23
PATRIOT
Duxbury 241...Hanover 242
Hingham 225...Pembroke 260
Marshfield 233...Plymouth South 236
Scituate 236...Plymouth North 278
Silver Lake 249...N. Quincy 251
Whit.-Hanson 223...Quincy 254
SOUTH COAST
Apponequet 261...Digh.-Rehoboth 282
Bourne 250...Joseph Case 253
Old Rochester 222...Som. Berkley 262
W. Bridgewater 244...Fairhaven 265
SOUTH SHORE
Mashpee 120...Abington 107
Middleboro 111...Rockland 91
TRI-VALLEY
Norwood 216...Medfield 218
VALLEY LEAGUE
Longmeadow 147...E. Longmeadow 169
NONLEAGUE
Agawam 151...Chicopee Comp. 159
Bridge.-Raynham 150...New Bedford 69
Cath. Memorial 242...Newton North 261
Concord-Carlisle 236...Billerica 243
Easthampton 154...Monson 190
Groton-Dunstable 149...Oakmont 159
Ludlow 159...Belchertown 174
Minnechaug 151...Tantasqua 153
Natick 207...Dover-Sherborn 211
Pathfinder 182...Ware 197
St. John's Prep 238...Andover 249
St. Mary (Westfield) 199...Chicopee 218
Shepherd Hill 162...Leominster 171
Smith Voc. 164...Turners Falls 197
Westfield Tech 161...Athol 235

SOCCER

BOYS
BAY STATE
Braintree 3...Walpole 2
Framingham 1...Newton North 1
Natick 3...Brookline 1
Needham 1...Weymouth 0
Wellesley 3...Milton 2
BOSTON CITY
Boston Int'l. 2...Dearborn STEM 1
Brighton 3...Latin Acad. 2
E. Boston 3...TechBoston 1
Mad. Park 2...New Mission/English 2
CAPE ANN
Essex Tech 2...Ham.-Wenham 1
Georgetown 1...Triton 0
Lynnfield 2...Ipswich 2
Newburyport 0...Manchester 0
N. Reading 1...Rockport 0
Pentucket 4...Amesbury 0
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Cath. Memorial 9...Malden Cath. 0
St. John's Prep 0...BC High 0
Xaverian 1...St. John's (S) 0
CHARTER SCHOOL ATHLETIC
New Heights Charter 5...Boston Prep 3
Pacific Rim 7...Argosy Collegiate 2
COMMONWEALTH
Gr. Lawrence 5...KIPP 2
Shawsheen 1...Lynn Tech 1
DUAL COUNTY
Boston Latin 0...Waltham 0
GREATER BOSTON
Everett 4...Lynn English 0
HOLLEY
Chicopee 1...Springfield Central 0
Southwick 1...Holyoke 0
MAYFLOWER
Atlantis Charter 4...Holbrook 1
Cape Cod Tech 6...South Shore 1
Tri-County 3...Blue Hills 1
Westport 9...Avon 0
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Billerica 1...Lowell 1
Chelmsford 3...Central Cath. 1
Haverhill 3...Lawrence 2
N. Andover 2...Andover 1
Tewksbury 2...Methuen 0
MIDDLESEX
Belmont 4...Woburn 0
Melrose 1...Wilmington 0
Watertown 3...Stoneham 1
Winchester 1...Lexington 1
NORTHEASTERN
Masconomet 2...Beverly 1
PATRIOT
Duxbury 2...Plymouth North 2
Hanover 3...Plymouth South 1
Marshfield 2...Hingham 0
Pembroke 4...N. Quincy 0
Scituate 1...Quincy 0
Whit.-Hanson 3...Silver Lake 1
SMITH
Ludlow 1...W. Springfield 1
NONLEAGUE
Arlington 3...Somerville 2
Belchertown 8...Granby 0
Burncoat 5...St. Bernard's 3
Commerce 10...Ware 0
Concord-Carlisle 4...Bp. Feehan 0
Dartmouth 1...Durfee 0
Franklin Cty. Tech 6...Athol 2
Gateway 2...Mt. Everett 1
Leicester 5...David Prouty 1
Medford 1...Pioneer Charter I 1
Monomoy 1...Mashpee 0
Nashoba 1...Oakmont 1
Pope Francis 2...Agawam 1
Renaissance 4...Ham. Charter East 3
Upper Cape 2...Bristol-Plymouth 2
GIRLS
BAY STATE
Braintree 0...Walpole 0
Brookline 0...Natick 0
Needham 5...Weymouth 0
Newton North 2...Framingham 0
Wellesley 1...Milton 0

SOCCER

GIRLS
BOSTON CITY
Dearborn STEM 1...Boston Int'l. 1
Madison Park 6...Charlestown 1
TechBoston 5New Mission/English High 0
CAPE ANN
Georgetown 3...Triton 0
Ham.-Wenham 1...Essex Tech 1
Newburyport 7...Manchester 0
N. Reading 5...Rockport 1
COMMONWEALTH
Gr. Lawrence 10Innovation Academy 0
Lynn Tech 4...Minuteman 1
Notre Dame (T) 5...Lowell Cath. 2
COOMBS
Ludlow 1...W. Springfield 1
GREATER BOSTON
Chelsea 5...Lynn English 1
Malden 3...Lynn Classical 0
KURTY-FIELDING
S. Hadley 5...Agawam 0
Wahconah 1...Pittsfield 0
MAYFLOWER
Blue Hills 2...Tri-County 0
Westport 6...Avon 0
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 2...N. Andover 0
Central Cath. 1...Chelmsford 0
Haverhill 6...Lawrence 0
Tewksbury 4...Methuen 0
MID-WACH
Ayer Shirley 2...Gardner 2
Bromfield 1...Maynard 1
Clinton 3...W. Boylston 0
Grafton 2...Nashoba 0
Quabbin 5...Fitchburg 2
Shepherd Hill 3...Groton-Dunstable 1
Shrewsbury 1...Wachusett 1
Westboro 2...Algonquin 0
MIDDLESEX
Arlington 2...Reading 1
Belmont 1...Woburn 0
Melrose 0...Wilmington 0
Stoneham 2...Watertown 0
Wakefield 1...Burlington 1
Winchester 2...Lexington 0
PATRIOT
Hanover 3...Plymouth South 1
Hingham 5...Marshfield 0
N. Quincy 3...Pembroke 2
Scituate 5...Quincy 0
Silver Lake 2...Whit.-Hanson 1
PIONEER VALLEY
Hampden Charter East 4...Taconic 2
SOUTH SHORE
Abington 9...Randolph 0
NONLEAGUE
Auburn 5...Worcester South 0
Bridge.-Raynham 3...Bp. Stang 0
Bristol-Plymouth 7...Bristol Aggie 1
Bristol-Plymouth 8...Upper Cape 1
Card. Spellman 2...W. Bridgewater 0
Dartmouth 7...Durfee 2
Hampshire 4...Southwick 1
Littleton 3...Tahanto 1
Millbury 3...Quaboag 0
Mt. Greylock 3...Monument Mtn. 0
Narragansett 4...Franklin Cty. Tech 0
Oakmont 1...Leominster 0
Parker Charter 6...Sizer 0
St. Bernard's 5...Burncoat 0
Springfield International 1...Ware 1
Tyngsboro 4...Hudson 3
Ursuline 2...Abp. Williams 0

VOLLEYBALL

GIRLS
BAY STATE
Brookline 3...Wellesley 1
Framingham 3...Walpole 2
Milton 3...Weymouth 1
Needham 3...Braintree 1
Newton North 3...Natick 0
BOSTON CITY
Latin Acad. 3...Boston United 1
Madison Park 3...O'Bryant 1
New Mission 3...E. Boston 0
CAPE & ISLANDS
Monomoy 3...Nauset 0
Sandwich 3...Nantucket 2
CAPE ANN
Essex Tech 3...Pentucket 0
Lynnfield 3...N. Reading 0
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Notre Dame (H) 3...Malden Cath. 1
COMMONWEALTH
Shawsheen 3...Mystic Valley 2
Whittier 3...Innovation Academy 0
DUAL COUNTY
Acton-Boxboro 3...Wayland 1
Bedford 3...Waltham 2
Lincoln-Sudbury 3...Cambridge 1
Newton South 3...Boston Latin 0
HOCKOMOCK
Attleboro 3...Mansfield 0
Canton 3...Sharon 2
Foxboro 3...Stoughton 1
Franklin 3...North Attleboro 0
Oliver Ames 3...Milford 0
Taunton 3...King Philip 1
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 3...Dracut 0
Central Cath. 3...Lawrence 0
Chelmsford 3...Tewksbury 0
Methuen 3...N. Andover 2
MID-WACH
Groton-Dunstable 3...N. Middlesex 0
MIDDLESEX
Arlington 3...Woburn 1
NORTHEASTERN
Swampscott 3...Gloucester 0
NORTHERN
Franklin Cty. Tech 3...Athol 2
Greenfield 3...Pioneer Valley 1
Mahar 3...Mohawk Trail 0
PATRIOT
N. Quincy 3...Scituate 0
SOUTH SHORE
Abington 3...Norwell 0
Cohasset 3...Middleboro 0
E. Bridgewater 3...Carver 0
Rockland 3...Mashpee 0
NONLEAGUE
Arlington Cath. 3...Peabody 0
Bay Path 3...Assabet 1
Bellingham 3...Joseph Case 1
Bridge.-Raynham 3Somerset Berkley 2
Burlington 3...Concord-Carlisle 0
E. Longmeadow 3...Agawam 0
Hampden Charter East 3...Libertas 0
Ludlow 3...Belchertown 0
Muniz 3...English High 0
Randolph 3...Academy/Pacific Rim 2
St. John Paul II 3...Calvary Chapel 2
S. Lancaster 3...Monty Tech 2
Springfield International 3...Ware 0
Triton 3...Saugus 0

■ For updated scores and highlights, go to bostonglobe.com/sports/highschools.

FOOTBALL SCHEDULE

FRIDAY'S GAMES
EASTERN MASS.

BAY STATE — Framingham at Newton North, 6; Weymouth at Wellesley, 6; Needham at Walpole, 6:30.
BOSTON CITY — English High at East Boston, 6.
CAPE & ISLANDS — Falmouth at Nantucket, 5:15.
CAPE ANN — North Reading at Pentucket/Georgetown, 6; Amesbury at Manchester Essex, 6:30; Hamilton-Wenham at Triton/Ipswich, 6:30; Newburyport at Essex Tech, 6:30.
CATHOLIC CENTRAL — Bishop Fenwick at Archbishop Williams, 6; Cardinal Spellman at Cathedral, 6; Arlington Catholic at Bishop Stang, 6:30.
COMMONWEALTH — Nashoba Valley Tech at Greater Lowell, 6.
DUAL COUNTY — Weston at Cambridge, 6; Boston Latin at Newton South, 6:30; Bedford at Concord-Carlisle, 7; Lincoln-Sudbury at Westford, 7; Waltham at Wayland, 7.
GREATER BOSTON — Revere at Chelsea, 6.
HOCKOMOCK — Canton at North Attleborough, 6; Oliver Ames at King Philip, 6:05.
MAYFLOWER — Tri-County at Southeastern, 6; Wareham at Upper Cape, 6; Atlantis at South Shore Voc-Tech, 7; Bristol-Plymouth at Old Colony, 7; Blue Hills at Diman, 7:30.
MERRIMACK VALLEY — Lowell at Dracut, 6:30; Andover at Methuen, 7; Chelmsford at Tewksbury, 7; Lawrence at Haverhill, 7.
MIDDLESEX — Belmont at Lexington, 6; Reading at Arlington, 6; Wakefield at Woburn, 6; Wilmington at Burlington, 6; Stoneham at Watertown, 7; Winchester at Melrose, 7.
NORTHEASTERN — Marblehead at Danvers, 6:30; Swampscott at Salem, 6:30; Winthrop at Gloucester, 7.
PATRIOT — Hanover at Pembroke, 6; Plymouth North at Hingham, 7; Plymouth South at Scituate, 7; Silver Lake at Whitman-Hanson, 7.
SOUTH COAST — Bourne at Joseph Case, 6:30; Greater New Bedford at Somerset Berkley, 6:30; West Bridgewater at Fairhaven, 6:30.
SOUTH SHORE — Cohasset at Randolph, 6; Mashpee at Carver, 6; Rockland at East Bridgewater, 6.
TRI-VALLEY — Holliston at Bellingham, 6; Medfield at Norwood, 6; Westwood at Medway, 6.
NONLEAGUE — Latin Academy at KIPP, 5; Attleboro at Bridgewater-Raynham, 6; Barnstable at Milford, 6; Bishop Feehan at BC High, 6; Cape Cod Tech at Sandwich, 6; Catholic Memorial at Brockton, 6; Central Catholic at Xaverian, 6; Everett at Malden, 6; Lynn Classical at TechBoston, 6; Lynn Tech at Monomoy/JP II, 6; Masconomet at St. John's (Shrewsbury), 6; Middleborough at Dennis-Yarmouth, 6; Nauset at Sharon/Dedham, 6; North Quincy at Somerville, 6; Braintree at Durfee, 6:30; Dartmouth at Apponequet, 6:30; Foxborough at Old Rochester, 6:30; Hopkinton at Brookline, 6:30; Malden Catholic at Nashua South (N.H.), 6:30; Middetown (R.I.) at Whittier, 6:30; Norton at Dighton-Rehoboth/Bristol Aggie, 6:30; Acton-Boxborough at Milton, 7; Algonquin at Ashland, 7; Brighton at Hull, 7; Greater Lawrence at Groton-Dunstable/NM, 7; Holbrook / Avon at Lowell Catholic, 7; Natick at Mansfield, 7; St. Mary's at Shawsheen, 7; Taunton at Lynn English, 7:30.

ON THE AIR

PRO BASKETBALL

9 p.m.	WNBA: Dallas at Golden State	ESPN2

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

7 p.m.	Liberty at Delaware	CBSSN
7 p.m.	Pittsburgh at Virginia Tech	ESPN
8 p.m.	Penn State at Northwestern	Fox
10:30 p.m.	Montana St. at Idaho	ESPN

GOLF

7 a.m.	DP World: Dunhill Links	Golf
12 p.m.	Champions: Lehigh Valley Classic	Golf
3 p.m.	Korn Ferry: Compliance Championship	Golf
5 p.m.	PGA: Bank of Utah Championship	Golf
8 p.m.	LPGA: LOTTE Championship	Golf

PRO HOCKEY

6:30 p.m.	NY Rangers at Detroit	TNT
8 p.m.	Boston at Winnipeg	NESN
9 p.m.	St. Louis at Dallas	TNT

MEN'S COLLEGE HOCKEY

7 p.m.	Maine at Holy Cross	NESN+
9:30 p.m.	UMass at Colorado College	NESN+

HORSE RACING

4 p.m.	Breeders Cup Challenge Series	NBCSN

MEN'S COLLEGE SOCCER

7 p.m.	Maryland at Indiana	Big Ten
8 p.m.	Virginia Tech at Virginia	ACC

SOCCER

9:50 a.m.	UEFA: Kazakhstan vs. Moldova	FS2
2:30 p.m.	UEFA: France vs. Italy	FS1
5:50 p.m.	CONCACAF: Suriname vs. Guatemala	FS2
7:50 p.m.	CONCACAF: Martinique vs. Honduras	FS2
9:50 p.m.	CONCACAF: El Salvador vs. Jamaica	FS2

WOMEN'S COLLEGE SOCCER

6 p.m.	Notre Dame at North Carolina	ACC
7 p.m.	South Carolina at Mississippi St.	ESPNU

WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL

7 p.m.	Oklahoma at South Carolina	SEC
9 p.m.	Purdue at Oregon	Big Ten
11 p.m.	Michigan at USC	Big Ten

(For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings)

Golf

PGA: BANK OF UTAH

PLAY SUSPENDED BY DARKNESS
At Black Desert Resort, Ivins, Utah
Yardage: 7,421; par: 71
Clubhouse leaders

Zachary Bauchou	62	-9
Nick Dunlap	63	-8
Steven Fisk	63	-8
Stephan Jaeger	63	-8
David Lipsky	63	-8
Kevin Roy	63	-8
Jordan Smith	63	-8
Austin Smotherman	63	-8
Kevin Streelman	63	-8
Sudarshan Yellamaraju	63	-8
Christiaan Bezuidenhout	64	-7
Michael Brennan	64	-7
Garrick Higgo	64	-7
Rico Hoey	64	-7
Nick Taylor	64	-7
John VanDerLaan	64	-7
Joel Dahmen	65	-6
A.J. Ewart	65	-6
David Ford	65	-6
Doug Ghim	65	-6
Emiliano Grillo	65	-6
Max Homa	65	-6
Benjamin James	65	-6
Max McGreevy	65	-6
Erik van Rooyen	65	-6
Zac Blair	66	-5
Eric Cole	66	-5
Trace Crowe	66	-5
Patrick Fishburn	66	-5
Billy Horschel	66	-5
Ben Kohles	66	-5
Haotong Li	66	-5
Matt McCarty	66	-5
Matthieu Pavon	66	-5
Chad Ramey	66	-5
Tyson Shelley	66	-5
Jackson Suber	66	-5
Alejandro Tosti	66	-5
Kevin Yu	66	-5
Kihei Akina	67	-4
Luke Clanton	67	-4
Pierceson Coody	67	-4
Cam Davis	67	-4
Tyler Duncan	67	-4
Harry Hall	67	-4
Harry Higgs	67	-4
Lee Hodges	67	-4
Johnny Keefer	67	-4
Hank Lebioda	67	-4
Gordon Sargent	67	-4
Neal Shipley	67	-4
Adam Svensson	67	-4
Kris Ventura	67	-4
Rafael Campos	68	-3
Chris Kirk	68	-3
Patton Kizzire	68	-3
Denny McCarthy	68	-3
Taylor Moore	68	-3
William Mouw	68	-3
Pontus Nyholm	68	-3
Marco Penge	68	-3
David Skinns	68	-3
Hayden Springer	68	-3
Jesper Svensson	68	-3
Chandler Blanchet	69	-2
Boston Bracken	69	-2
Zecheng Dou	69	-2
Adrien Dumont De Chassart	69	-2
Brice Garnett	69	-2
Nick Hardy	69	-2
Tom Hoge	69	-2
Takumi Kanaya	69	-2
Jeffrey Kang	69	-2
Jackson Koivun	69	-2
Justin Lower	69	-2
Maverick McNealy	69	-2
Davis Riley	69	-2
Brendon Todd	69	-2
Danny Walker	69	-2
Dylan Wu	69	-2

DP WORLD: DUNHILL

At Glasgow, United Kingdom
Carnoustie Golf Links (host)
Yardage: 7,394; par: 72
At Kingsbarns Golf Links
Yardage: 7,227; par: 72
At Old Course
Yardage: 7,375; par: 72

Jack Buchanan	65	-7
Michael Stewart	65	-7
MJ Daffue	66	-6
Casey Jarvis	66	-6
Christiaan Burke	67	-5
Dean Burmester	67	-5
Hennie Du Plessis	67	-5
Mikael Lindberg	67	-5
Brandon Stone	67	-5
Hugo Townsend	67	-5
Daniel Van Tonder	67	-5
Sam Bairstow	68	-4
Jose Luis Ballester Barrio	68	-4
Ivan Cantero Gutierrez	68	-4
Jens Dantorp	68	-4
Matt Fitzpatrick	68	-4
Will Florimo	68	-4
Andreas Halvorsen	68	-4
Bjorn Hellgren	68	-4
Calum Hill	68	-4
Joakim Lagergren	68	-4
Ryan Palmer	68	-4
Sepp Straka	68	-4
Richard Bland	69	-3
Alejandro Del Rey	69	-3
Marcus Helligkilde	69	-3
Charley Hoffman	69	-3
Scott Jamieson	69	-3
Matthew Jordan	69	-3
Brooks Koepka	69	-3
Marc Leishman	69	-3
Jay Mackenzie	69	-3
Richard Mansell	69	-3
Felix Mory	69	-3
Declan O'Donovan	69	-3
Jeremy Paul	69	-3
Jaco Prinsloo	69	-3
Ollie Schniederjans	69	-3
Jack Senior	69	-3
Jack Thompson	69	-3
Austen Truslow	69	-3
Quim Vidal	69	-3
Daniel Young	69	-3
Albin Bergstrom	70	-2
Daniel Cronje	70	-2
Thomas Detry	70	-2
Tommy Fleetwood	70	-2
Daniel Hillier	70	-2
Rikuya Hoshino	70	-2
Jazz Janewattananond	70	-2
Nathan Kimsey	70	-2
Oliver Lindell	70	-2
Luke List	70	-2
Herman Loubser	70	-2
Matteo Manassero	70	-2
Francesco Molinari	70	-2
James Morrison	70	-2
Niklas Norgaard	70	-2
Jacob Skov Olesen	70	-2
Carlos Ortiz	70	-2
Eddie Pepperell	70	-2
Yurav Premlall	70	-2
David Ravetto	70	-2
Rocco Repetto Taylor	70	-2
Robert Rock	70	-2
Adrien Saddier	70	-2
Freddy Schott	70	-2
Jason Scrivener	70	-2
Marcel Siem	70	-2
Elvis Smylie	70	-2
Sebastian Soderberg	70	-2
Connor Syme	70	-2
Tom Vaillant	70	-2
Nick Voke	70	-2
Euan Walker	70	-2
Danny Willett	70	-2
Jeff Winther	70	-2

College football

THURSDAY'S RESULTS

North Texas...Tulsa
New Mexico St. 34...W. Kentucky 13

FRIDAY'S GAMES

Liberty at Delaware...7
Pittsburgh at Virginia Tech...7
Penn St. at Northwestern...8
Montana St. at Idaho...10:30

Tennis

JAPAN OPEN

At Tokyo
Men's singles

First round: Kyrian Jacquet def. Holger Rune, 6-3, 6-1; Frances Tiafoe (2) def. Kei Nishikori, 6-4, 6-4; Jiri Lehecka def. Zizou Bergs, 6-3, 6-7 (3), 6-3; Carlos Alcaraz (1) def. Alex Michelsen, 7-6 (1), 4-6, 6-1; Denis Shapovalov def. Sho Shimabukuro, 7-5, 6-1; Matteo Berrettini def. Alejandro Davidovich Fokina, 1-6, 7-6 (1), 6-4; Adolfo Daniel Vallejo def. Rafael Jodar (4), 6-1, 6-3.
, 6-1, 3-0; Gao Xinyu def. Panna Udvardy, 6-2, 6-3.

Soccer

MLS

THURSDAY'S RESULT
Sporting KC...at Seattle
WEDNESDAY'S RESULT
St. Louis 3...at NY Red Bulls 0

REVOLUTION SCHEDULE

OCTOBER
Sat., 10 Seattle...7:30
Wed., 14 at Cincinnati...7:30

NWSL

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Gotham FC	26	16	6	4	54
San Diego	26	15	3	8	48
Washington	26	14	4	8	46
Utah	26	14	3	9	45
Portland	26	12	7	7	43
Angel City	26	12	6	8	42
Kansas City	26	12	5	9	41
Seattle	26	12	4	10	40
North Carolina	26	12	3	11	39
Denver	26	9	8	9	35
Orlando	26	10	3	13	33
Houston	26	8	6	12	30
Bay FC	26	7	5	14	26
Boston	26	7	5	14	26
Louisville	26	7	2	17	23
Chicago	26	5	2	19	17

FRIDAY'S GAMES
San Diego at Orlando...8
North Carolina at Seattle...10

Latest line

COLLEGE FOOTBALL
Friday

Favorite	Pts.	Underdog
Liberty	6½	at Delaware
At Virginia Tech.	2½	Pittsburgh
Penn State	3	at Northwestern

NHL

Favorite	Line	Underdog	Line
At Detroit	-140	NY Rangers	+120
At Carolina	-145	Washington	+125
At Winnipeg	-115	Boston	-105
At Dallas	-195	St. Louis	+165
At Vegas	-185	Anaheim	+155

NFL
Sunday

Favorite	Pts.	Underdog
Indianapolis	4	at Washington
Arizona	2½	at NY Giants
At Houston	3	Dallas
Green Bay	3½	at Tampa Bay
At Cincinnati	2½	Jacksonville
LA Rams	3	at Philadelphia
At Buffalo	7	New England
At Chicago	3½	NY Jets
At Baltimore	11½	Tennessee
At Minnesota	10½	Miami
At San Fran.	2½	Denver
Kansas City	4½	at Las Vegas
At Seattle	7	LA Chargers
Detroit	3½	at Carolina
Monday		
At New Orleans.	2½	Atlanta

Transactions

BASEBALL
Cincinnati: SS Ivan Johnson outrighted to minors.
NY Yankees: P Alexander Cornielle outrighted to minors.
NBA
Chicago: G-F Jalen Bridges signed as free agent. PF Marquel Sutton, SG Peter Suder waived.
Houston: C Rafael Castro waived.
Toronto: PG Jamal Shead re-signed.
Utah: PG Jaelen House waived.
NFL
Atlanta: DT Gervon Dexter Sr. re-signed.
Baltimore: LB Carl Jones Jr. pract. squad add. LB Jamon Johnson pract. squad del.
Carolina: LB Maema Njongmeta pract. squad add.
Dallas: CB Joey Porter Jr. traded.
Houston: RB Noah Whittington pract. squad del.
LA Rams: S Tanner Ingle pract. squad add.
Minnesota: CB Natrone Brooks pract. squad add.
New England: T Matt Pryor active/prac. squad.
New Orleans: RB Travis Etienne Jr. on IR. RB Ulysses Bentley IV, LB David Ojabo pract. squad add. WR Kevin Austin Jr. active/prac. squad.
NY Giants: LB Jihad Ward active/prac. squad.
NY Jets: CB Jordan Clark, K Blake Grupe pract. squad add. S John Saunders Jr. pract. squad del. T Kohl Levao active/prac. squad.
Philadelphia: LB Anfernee Orji pract. squad add. LB Chance Campbell pract. squad del.
Pittsburgh: CB Doneiko Slaughter, RB Lew Nichols active/prac. squad.
San Francisco: WR KhaDarel Hodge cut. WR Malik Turner pract. squad add. WR Brandin Cooks active/prac. squad.
NHL
Anaheim: D Tristan Luneau re-signed.
Buffalo: D Louis Crevier signed. D Dennis Gilbert called up from minors.
Columbus:
Dallas: RW Colin Blackwell, C Arttu Hyry called up from minors.
Edmonton: C Josh Samanski called up from minors.
NY Rangers: G Dylan Garand called up from minors.
Pittsburgh: RW Rutger McGroarty sent to minors.

WNBA playoffs

FIRST ROUND
MINNESOTA vs. NEW YORK
Liberty win series, 2-0
Sunday, Sept. 27
New York 91...at Minnesota 75
Tuesday, Sept. 29
At New York 87...Minnesota 71
LAS VEGAS vs. INDIANA
Aces win series, 2-1
Sunday, Sept. 27
At Las Vegas 102...Indiana 85
Tuesday, Sept. 29
At Indiana 99...Las Vegas 89
Thursday, Oct. 1
At Las Vegas 94...Indiana 83
ATLANTA vs. WASHINGTON
Dream win series, 2-0
Sunday, Sept. 27
At Atlanta 92...Washington 77
Wednesday, Sept. 30
Atlanta 93...at Washington 75
GOLDEN STATE vs. DALLAS
Series tied at 1
Sunday, Sept. 27
At Golden State 104...Dallas 80
Wednesday, Sept. 30
At Dallas 108...Golden State 100 (OT)
Schedule
Friday at Golden State...9

Aces, 94-83

At Las Vegas

INDIANA (1-2) — Hull 0-0 0-0 0, Timpson 1-2 2-4 4, Boston 8-16 1-2 19, Clark 6-18 3-4 18, Mitchell 7-23 6-8 23, Billings 0-1 0-0 0, R.Johnson 1-5 0-0 2, Cunningham 2-4 0-0 5, Hines-Allen 5-9 2-2 12. Totals 30-78 14-20 83.

LAS VEGAS (2-1) — J.Young 5-13 6-6 18, Wilson 11-18 12-15 36, Turner 0-0 0-0 0, Loyd 3-10 2-4 11, Gray 8-15 6-6 23, Yamamoto 0-2 0-0 0, Parker-Tyus 2-6 2-4 6. Totals 29-64 28-35 94.

Halftime: Las Vegas, 54-48. 3-pt. goals: IND 9-32 (Boston 2-4, Clark 3-12, Mitchell 3-11, R.Johnson 0-2, Cunningham 1-1, Hines-Allen 0-2), LVA 8-20 (J.Young 2-5, Wilson 2-3, Loyd 3-6, Gray 1-3, Yamamoto 0-2, Parker-Tyus 0-1). Rebounds: IND 38 (Hines-Allen 12), LVA 34 (Wilson 10). Assists: IND 16 (Clark 4), LVA 15 (J.Young 7). Fouls: IND 27, LVA 19. A: 10,388.

Wings, 108-100

Wednesday night game
At Arlington, Texas

GOLDEN STATE (1-1) — Zandalasini 2-3 0-0 5, Thornton 4-8 2-2 13, Stokes 0-1 0-0 0, Burton 3-8 3-4 11, Williams 12-23 7-7 36, Chen 2-6 0-0 4, Hayes 1-3 4-4 6, Salaun 5-14 1-2 11, Charles 5-7 3-4 14. Totals 34-73 20-23 100.

DALLAS (1-1) — Siegrist 1-2 0-0 2, Shepard 2-5 0-0 4, Kuier 3-6 1-1 8, Bueckers 3-13 3-4 10, Ogunbowale 12-23 16-18 45, Sims 1-3 3-4 5, James 4-5 3-4 13, Clark 6-7 6-6 21. Totals 32-64 32-37 108.

Halftime: Dallas, 50-45. 3-pt. goals: GSV 12-27 (Zandalasini 1-2, Thornton 3-4, Burton 2-4, Williams 5-12, Salaun 0-3, Charles 1-2), DAL 12-23 (Siegrist 0-1, Kuier 1-2, Bueckers 1-4, Ogunbowale 5-8, Sims 0-1, James 2-3, Clark 3-4). Rebounds: GSV 29 (Thornton, Williams 6), DAL 29 (Shepard 8). Assists: GSV 21 (Williams 7), DAL 20 (Shepard 6). Fouls: GSV 28, DAL 22. A: 6,251.

FINAL LEADERS

SCORING

	FG	FT	Pts.	PPG
Wilson, LVA	378	279	1073	26.2
Mitchell, IND	381	189	1086	24.7
Clark, IND	282	213	891	22.3
Copper, PHO	289	213	859	21.5
Bueckers, DAL	335	128	878	20.9
Mabrey, TOR	218	126	667	20.8
Stewart, NYL	300	244	875	20.8
Miles, MIN	279	168	790	19.8
Gray, ATL	280	196	837	19.0
Young, LVA	293	128	814	18.9

FIELD GOAL PERCENTAGE

	FG	Att.	Pct.
Smith, LVA	183	287	.638
Mack, PHO	135	224	.603
Howard, MIN	266	445	.598
Nelson-Ododa, CON	125	217	.576

Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

BRAINTREE
FALLON, John W. Jr.
CANTON
CARTER, Daniel E.
DEDHAM
CATAPANO, Maureen P. (O'Sullivan)
SCHMIDT, Janna (Fossel)
FRAMINGHAM
CATAPANO, Maureen P. (O'Sullivan)
GRAFTON
FALLON, John W. Jr.
HOPEDALE
McHUGH, Anna Marie
HUDSON
McHUGH, Anna Marie
JAMAICA PLAIN
METCALF, Sheila M. (Connolly)
MARSHFIELD
METCALF, Sheila M. (Connolly)
MASHPEE
FALLON, John W. Jr.
MILFORD
McHUGH, Anna Marie
NEWTON
SCHMIDT, Janna (Fossel)
PEABODY
CATAPANO, Maureen P. (O'Sullivan)
PLYMOUTH
FALLON, John W. Jr.
REVERE
McHUGH, Anna Marie
ROCKPORT
WACHMAN, Amnon MD
ROSLINDALE
METCALF, Sheila M. (Connolly)
SOUTH BOSTON
DWYER, Lawrence A. Jr.
WEST ROXBURY
CATAPANO, Maureen P. (O'Sullivan)
METCALF, Sheila M. (Connolly)
WHITMAN
CATAPANO, Maureen P. (O'Sullivan)

OUT OF STATE

OUT OF COUNTRY

IRELAND
METCALF, Sheila M. (Connolly)

CARTER, Daniel E.

Of Canton, September 27. Beloved husband of 60 years of Ellen (Cohen) Carter of Canton; father of Gene Carter and his wife, Jennifer of Stoughton and Richard Carter and his wife, Jill of Canton. Grandfather of Lauren Carter of South Carolina, Allison Carter of Norton and Harrison and Thomas Carter of Canton. Cousin of Gregory Mazmanian and his wife, Irene of Falmouth and Christine Corff and her husband, George of Sterling; his in-laws, Ann and Bob Adams of Norwood, Kathryn and Jon Springer of Florida, Bob and Michelle Cohen of Canton and Jan and the late William Cohen of Canton. Dan was the proud uncle to many nieces and nephews. Relatives and friends are invited to attend Visiting Hours at the Dockray & Thomas Funeral Home, on Friday, October 2, from 4-7 p.m. A Funeral Service will be held at the funeral home on Saturday, October 3, at 10:30 a.m. Burial at Canton Corner Cemetery. For complete obituary, see www.dockrayandthomasfuneralhome.com

CATAPANO, Maureen P. (O'Sullivan)

Of Dedham, formerly of West Roxbury, passed away on September 29, 2026. Beloved wife of the late Michael Catapano. Devoted mother of John F. Anderson, II and his wife, Margaret. Loving grandmother of Molly Harris. Dear sister of Rosemarie O'Sullivan Stassa and her husband, Peter of Framingham and Eileen Zoldak and her husband, David of Peabody. Cherished aunt of Caitlin Stassa and Christina Zoldak. She is survived by her longtime friend, Evelyn Wigmore; as well as many cousins and friends.

Visiting Hours will be held at the P.E. Murray - F.J. Higgins, George F. Doherty & Sons Funeral Home, 2000 Centre St., WEST ROXBURY, on Sunday, October 4, from 12-3pm. Funeral from the funeral home on Monday, October 5, at 10:30am, followed by a Funeral Mass at St. Theresa of Avila Church, West Roxbury, at 11:30am. Burial in St. Joseph Cemetery. For full obituary and online guestbook, pemurrayfuneral.com

P.E. Murray - F.J. Higgins
George F. Doherty & Sons
West Roxbury 617 325 2000

DWYER, Lawrence A. Jr. "Larry"

Of South Boston, passed away peacefully, surrounded by his family, on September 28, 2026. Beloved husband and best friend of the late Ann Theresa Dwyer. Adored father of Kaitlyn Weafer and her husband, Jason of South Boston. Loving Papa Larry to Emma and Grace Elizabeth. Devoted son of the late Lawrence and Eileen Dwyer. Treasured brother of Mary Ellen Sinkiewicz and her husband, Kenneth, Gerard Dwyer and his wife, Cynthia Strout, Kathleen Dwyer, Daniel Dwyer and his wife, Anne, Suzanne Dwyer and her fiancé, Eric Carlyle and Brian Dwyer and his wife, Janis. Predeceased by his brother, Kevin Dwyer; mother-in-law, Anna Viani; sister-in-law, Donna McIntosh; brother-in-law, Jack McDonough; and niece, Catherine McDonough. Dear uncle of John and Ellen McDonough, Colin, Kelsey, Joseph, Francis, Matthew, Michael, Timothy, Declan and John Dwyer. Also survived by his brother-in-law, Robert McIntosh. Larry started his career as a youth worker at the D Street Multi Service Center. Former Boston Parks Commissioner and Commissioner of Health and Hospitals in the Flynn Administration. A career public servant, he loved to regale his family and friends with his many exploits at the city and in Washington, D.C. Family was at the center of his life, which began with the deep and abiding love that his parents showed him and his siblings on East Eighth St. He and Ann Theresa shared a marriage of uncommon love, devotion, and friendship, and nothing brought them greater joy than their daughter. His favorite job was that of big brother. Coach of the St. Brigid CYO Girls' Softball Team. Drummer and founding member of the legendary South Boston band, Good Friends. He loved to spend time in Bretton Woods, NH. He was happiest on the golf course or in the garden. The Dubliner in Washington, D.C. was his longtime local. A born animal whisperer, he had many faithful companions throughout his life, including Bilbo, Sandy and Ava. Billy Stoddard and Marcus DeFlorimonte were among his steadfast friends. Visitation in the O'Brien Funeral Home,146 Dorchester St., SOUTH BOSTON, on Monday, October 5, from 4-8pm. Funeral Mass in Gate of Heaven Church, 615 East Fourth Street, South Boston, on Tuesday, October 6, at 12pm. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in memory of Larry to his favorite charity, St. Jude Children's Research Hospital, 501 St. Jude Place, Memphis, TN 38105. For directions and guestbook, please visit www.obrienfunerals.com

O'Brien Funeral Home
617-269-1600

Lend support
View The Boston Globe's complete list of death notices and sign the guestbook at boston.com/obituaries.

FALLON, John "Jack" W. Jr.

Age 77, of Mashpee, MA, formerly of Braintree, MA, passed away, surrounded by his loving family, on September 28, 2026.

John is survived by his loving wife of 52 years, Cheryl (Hallam) Fallon; his daughter, Tara Fallon of Mashpee, MA; his son, John Fallon, III of Grafton, MA; and his daughter, Lauren Pineo and son-in-law, Brian Pineo of Plymouth, MA. Loving brother of the late Laurence "Larry" Fallon and wife, Susan Fallon, Mary Fallon and Patricia Fallon, all of Braintree, MA. He adored his four grandchildren, who affectionately knew him as "Papa," Brooks Pineo, Miller Pineo, Jack Fallon and Sailor Pineo. He is also survived by his goddaughter, Maguire Fanuele and her husband, Jason Fanuele. Loving brother-in-law to Pamela DeFederico and Lorna Murray and her late husband, Robert Murray; as well as many nephews and grandnieces and grandnephews.

Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to greet the family during the Visiting Hours on Friday, October 2, 2026, from 4-8 PM, in the McDonald Keohane Funeral Home, NORTH WEYMOUTH, at 40 Sea Street (off Route 3A - Bicknell Square). A Celebration of Life Service will be held in the funeral home at 9 AM, on Saturday, October 3, 2026, prior to the Funeral Mass in St. Mary's Church, Quincy, at 10 AM. Burial in St. Joseph's Cemetery, 990 LaGrange St., West Roxbury. In lieu of flowers, donations in memory of Jack may be made to Cape Cod Commercial Fisherman's Alliance.

Visit www.Keohane.com for complete obituary and online condolences.

Keohane

McHUGH, Anna Marie

Age 82, of Hudson, MA, formerly of Hopedale and Revere, passed away Wednesday, September 30, 2026, at the University of Massachusetts Medical Center in Worcester. Born in 1943, in Boston, Massachusetts, she was the wife of the late, Joseph F. McHugh, Jr.; and the daughter of the late John and Florence (Wall) Doorly. Anna grew up in Revere and was a Revere High School graduate and worked as a Bookkeeper in the Milford area. Anna was a member of the St. Gabriel's and Sacred Heart Women's Group. She enjoyed traveling, going to casinos, watching all Boston sports teams and was an avid reader. She leaves her children, Mary McHugh of Hudson, MA, Michael McHugh of Boston, MA, Larry McHugh of Framingham, MA; and his children, Joseph and John; his girlfriend, Suzan Kelley; and her children, Alexandra and Ryan; and his ex-wife, Maria McHugh. Anna also leaves her brother, John Doorly; her nieces and nephews, Adam and Alexandra Doorly, Debbie and Scott Richards, Kerri and Keith Frost; and her sisters-in-law, Judy McHugh LaRosa and MaryJane Doorly. She was predeceased by her sister, Virginia Doorly; her nephew, Brian LaRosa; and her brother-in-law and sister-in-law, Arthur and Virginia Richards. She also had many cousins and friends whom she loved dearly. Calling Hours will be held, Saturday, October 3, 2026, from 10-11:30 am, at the Buma-Sargeant Funeral Home, 42 Congress Street, MILFORD, MA, to be followed by a Mass of Christian Burial at 12:00 pm, at Sacred Heart Church, 187 Hopedale Street, Hopedale. Burial will follow at Hopedale Village Cemetery, Fitzgerald Avenue, Hopedale, with a luncheon at Willowbrook in Mendon.

Visiting Hours: 10:00 am 11:30 am

METCALF, Sheila M. (Connolly)

Of the Springhouse, and longtime resident of Roslindale, formerly of Marshfield, Norwell, and San Jose, CA, passed away on September 28, 2026. Beloved wife of the late Kenneth M. Metcalf. Devoted mother of Donna Twohig of West Roxbury, Kenneth Metcalf, Jr. and his wife, Laurie of NJ, Katherine Hansen and her husband, Scot of AZ, Margaret Metcalf of CA and John Metcalf of Roslindale. Loving grandmother of Aislinn Galofaro, Meaghan Twohig, William Metcalf, Kenneth Metcalf, III., Kelly Hansen, John J. Metcalf, and Brieanna Metcalf. Great-grandmother of Jhohana Metcalf, Kenneth Metcalf, IV, and Julia Galofaro. Also survived by her cousins, Kathleen Mark and Kathleen Murphy; as well as many nieces and nephews.

Visiting Hours will be held at the P.E. Murray - F.J. Higgins, George F. Doherty & Sons Funeral Home, 2000 Centre St., WEST ROXBURY, on Sunday, October 4, from 5-7pm. Funeral from the funeral home on Monday, October 5, at 9am, followed by a Funeral Mass at Sacred Heart Church, Roslindale, at 10am. Relatives and friends kindly invited. Interment in Knollwood Memorial Park, Canton. Expressions of sympathy may be made in Sheila's memory to the Alzheimer's Association, 309 Waverley Oaks Road, Waltham, MA 02452. For online guestbook and full obituary, pemurrayfuneral.com

P.E. Murray - F.J. Higgins
George F. Doherty & Sons
West Roxbury 617 325 2000

SCHMIDT, Janna (Fossel)

Age 81, of Dedham, formerly of Newton, died September 3, 2026. Born August 8, 1945, to Jane and Mart Fossel, she was raised in Morristown, New Jersey. Trained as a CNA, she worked closely with her patients and their families in their homes. She found her spiritual home at Myrtle Baptist Church and spent her final years at NewBridge on the Charles, nurturing the residents around her. Her greatest joy was her family. A Memorial Service will be held Saturday, October 3, 3:00 PM, in the Conservatory at NewBridge on the Charles, 7000 Great Meadow Road, Dedham. The full obituary she wrote for herself is at https://www.davisofboston.com/obituaries/janna-schmidt

WACHMAN, Amnon MD

Amnon Wachman, MD, died peacefully in his sleep on September 30 at age 91. He is survived by his wife Ann of 58 years, as well as his four children, Shayna Schulz (née Wachman), Rachel Wachman, Liza Percer (née Wachman) and Gabriel Wachman. He is also survived by his 8 grandchildren, Lior Hirschfeld, Aidan Percer, Ela Schulz, Arielle Percer, Benjamin Schulz, Liam Percer, Charlotte Wachman and Zev Wachman as well as his sister Dahlia and many loving nieces and nephews. Amnon had an enormous impact over the course of his life, both with his patients and with his family. He will be deeply missed.

Visiting Hours: A Graveside Funeral Service for Amnon will be held on Friday, October 2, 2026 at 10:00 AM at Mt. Jacob Cemetery, 96 Ferland Street, Gloucester, MA 01930. For more information or to register in the online guestbook, please visit www.stanetskyhymansonsalem.com

STANETSKY HYMANSON MEMORIAL CHAPEL

Stanetsky-Hymanson
Memorial Chapel
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583 Mt. Auburn Street, Cambridge
MON-FRI 9-9; SAT 9-5, SUNDAY 12-5

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Ask your funeral director for details.
The Boston Globe

Reflect on a life well lived

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Obituaries

Biljana Plavsic, 96; ex-Bosnian Serb leader

ASSOCIATED PRESS

BELGRADE — Former Bosnian Serb leader Biljana Plavsic, who pleaded guilty at a United Nations tribunal to persecution as a crime against humanity for her role in atrocities during the 1992-95 Bosnian war, has died in Serbia's capital Belgrade, according to Bosnian Serb public media. She was 96.

Ms. Plavsic was one of the key Bosnian Serb high officials who implemented a peace agreement signed in Dayton, Ohio, while she was serving as a president of the Bosnian Serb political entity, Republika Srpska, just after the war ended.

During the war she served on the Bosnian Serb leadership council. Considered by Western officials as much more liberal than other Bosnian Serb leaders, she became a vocal opponent of wartime Bosnian Serb President Radovan Karadzic.

Nonetheless, she was indicted in 2000 by The Hague-based UN tribunal for the former Yugoslavia on charges of genocide, war crimes, and crimes against humanity for her alleged role in the wartime campaign to carve out a separate Serb entity in Bosnia.

She voluntarily surrendered to face justice in 2001, and later pleaded guilty to the crime against humanity of persecution during the war. Other charges were withdrawn.

"Mrs. Plavsic disregarded reports of widespread ethnic cleansing and publicly rationalized and justified it," the UN court said after she was sentenced. "She was aware that the key leaders of the Serbian Republic of Bosnia and Herzegovina ignored these crimes despite the power to prevent and punish them."

She was sentenced to 11 years imprisonment and was released in 2009 after serving two-thirds of her sentence.

The UN court said that Ms. Plavsic's guilty plea and her acknowledgement of responsibility

ASSOCIATED PRESS/POOL/FILE

Ms. Plavsic was considered more liberal than other Bosnian Serb leaders.

"should promote reconciliation in Bosnia and Herzegovina and the region as a whole."

Former US secretary of state Madeleine Albright told a sentencing hearing that Ms. Plavsic actively supported the Dayton peace agreement. She "stood up for that at times when it was very difficult, when there were those who wanted to destroy the Dayton Accords," Albright said, according to a court statement.

Republika Srpska's public broadcaster RTRS reported on Thursday that the Bosnian Serb leader Milorad Dodik had expressed his condolences at the news of Ms. Plavsic's death, saying that she was his close associate and deserved full state honors.

"Unfortunately, she was unjustly held accountable before the Hague tribunal," said Dodik, whom a Bosnian court barred from public office last year for his efforts to separate Republika Srpska from Bosnia. "But that was part of a trend in which anyone who held a position in Republika Srpska was held accountable, even if they had personally committed no crime."

Ms. Plavsic's death comes just weeks after former Bosnian Serb military chief Ratko Mladic died in detention after being convicted of genocide and other crimes during the Bosnian war.

Before entering politics as the former Yugoslavia crumbled, Ms. Plavsic was a professor of natural sciences and faculty dean at the University of Sarajevo.

Since her release from prison, Ms. Plavsic had withdrawn from public life and lived in Belgrade.

Bill Draper, tech investor before Silicon Valley, at 98

By Alex Williams
NEW YORK TIMES

Bill Draper, who started his pioneering career as a Silicon Valley investor by steering a rented Pontiac through the orchard-dotted Santa Clara Valley of Northern California in the early 1960s, drumming up business in an era when few entrepreneurs had even heard the term "venture capital," died Sept. 8 at his home in Atherton, Calif. He was 98.

His death was confirmed by his daughter Polly Draper.

The "man who saw Silicon Valley before it existed," as the magazine BW Businessworld recently called him, Mr. Draper began his career more than a decade before Silicon Valley acquired its name in the early 1970s, at a time when computer coding was still done using punched paper cards.

As a founder or managing director of a string of trailblazing venture capital companies, including Sutter Hill Ventures and Draper Richards, he helped start an industry worth hundreds of billions of dollars, alongside titans such as Arthur Rock, Eugene Kleiner, Thomas J. Perkins, and Don Valentine.

Known for his glass-half-full mentality, he was called Dr. Yes by his colleagues at Draper Richards because "he loved to say, 'We're in!' to a deal at an initial meeting before we could do the due diligence," Robin Richards Donohoe, the company's cofounder, said in an interview.

His long list of wins over the decades included placing early bets on video game maker Activision, as well as Skype, OpenTable, printer company Qume, and Corbin-Farnsworth, a pioneering maker of defibrillators, pacemakers, and heart monitors.

Armed with a Harvard University MBA, Mr. Draper arrived in California in 1959 to join Draper, Gaither, and Anderson, which was cofounded by his father, William H. Draper Jr., a prominent New York investment banker, and was considered the first venture capital firm west of the Mississippi River.

"It was the only game in town," the younger Bill Draper recalled in a 2011 oral history with the Computer History Museum in Mountain View, Calif.

The tech industry was still in its infancy, and so was its business infrastructure. In those days, the investment community "didn't know a semiconductor from a piece of Swiss cheese," said Jay Last, a celebrated founder of Fairchild Semiconductor who helped develop the chips that propelled the computer revolution.

In 1962, Mr. Draper partnered with his friend Franklin Pitcher Johnson Jr., known as Pitch, to start their own firm, Draper & Johnson Investment Co. At the time, the sun-dappled Santa Clara Valley, south of San Francisco, was one of the largest fruit-growing regions in the world, nicknamed the Valley of Heart's Delight.

"It was a lot of fruit orchards in Sunnyvale, in Santa Clara and so on, and we'd go look for doors to knock on that looked like they had to do with some kind of technology or electronics," Mr. Draper recalled in the oral history.

"We'd ask for the president," he said, "and he'd come out, typically about our age, and he'd ask, 'Well, what do you guys do?' And we'd say, 'Venture capital.' And he'd say, 'What?' And then we'd explain what it was. And then he'd say, 'Well, come on in and hear about my company.'"

Mr. Draper continued: "We became the go-to guys in the Valley. We were the kind of people that friends of friends of friends would call to ask about these various deals."

Around 1965, he and Johnson went their separate ways. Mr. Draper joined Sutter Hill, a real estate company that, under his direction and that of Paul Wythes, another industry trailblazer, branched off into venture capital.

William Henry Draper III was born Jan. 1, 1928, in White Plains, N.Y., the youngest of three children of Katherine (Baum) Draper and William Draper, an executive at Dillon, Read & Co., a premier New York investment banking house. After World War II, his father served as undersecretary of the Army and helped coordinate the Marshall Plan.

Mr. Draper enrolled at Yale University. "I thought Harvard was a little too intellectual for me, and Princeton was a little too social," he said. "Yale sounded right in the middle."

He became a member of the elite Skull and Bones society and studied economics, history, and political science, earning his bachelor's degree in 1950. During the Korean War, he served on the front lines as a second lieutenant.

He went on to attend Harvard Business School, where he studied under influential professor Georges Doriot, who advised him — as Mr. Draper recalled in a 2010 Harvard oral history — to "get out of Boston" after graduating and "get into something that's got some muscle."

Mr. Draper heeded the advice and took a management training position at Chicago-based Inland Steel Co., where he met Johnson, who grew up in Palo Alto and eventually persuaded him to move to California.

During the 1980s, Mr. Draper realized that his "learning curve was flattened out" in venture capital and detoured into public service, serving as president and chair of the Export-Import Bank of the United States, where he oversaw efforts to stoke exports, in part by providing financing and loans to foreign buyers of American goods.

Five years later, he took over the United Nations Development Program, overseeing about 8,000 aid workers around the world, fighting poverty, funding environmental and health programs, and promoting democracy.

During his seven years there, the agency's programs grew in value to $1.5 billion, from $890 million. By the end, he said, "I'd been to 101 developing countries and raised money from the rich countries to give to poor countries.

"I felt like Robin Hood," he continued.

His experience abroad inspired him to return to venture capital, but with an international focus. In the mid-1990s, he joined Richards Donohoe in founding Draper International, one of the first American venture capital funds to focus on companies in India.

A related domestic fund, Draper Richards, has invested in companies such as Skype, OpenTable, Selectica, and Athenahealth.

Mr. Draper later decided to apply his business experience to the nonprofit world — "venture philanthropy," as he called it — and helped establish what became the Draper Richards Kaplan Foundation, which has funded more than 280 nonprofit and for-profit social enterprises serving some 700 million people around the world.

Over the decades, the industry that he helped create evolved almost beyond recognition as it lurched toward the era of trillion-dollar initial public offerings.

At Sutter Hill, "we had a lot of doubles and triples, and not many strikeouts," Mr. Draper said in the Harvard interview. "That has changed because the size of the typical venture firm is so great now that they want to move the needle" — which changed the risk-reward ratio.

His wife of more than 60 years, Phyllis (Culbertson) Draper, died in 2018. In addition to their daughter Polly, he leaves another daughter, Rebecca Draper; a son, Timothy; eight grandchildren; and 13 great-grandchildren.

Venture capitalists are basically fishermen, Mr. Draper said, dropping in countless lines and never knowing when they might reel in a whopper.

For him, there was one very big fish that got away. At Sutter Hill in the 1970s, he sent a younger colleague to check out yet another tech startup.

Upon his return, the colleague told him, "Well, you know, they kept me waiting for a half an hour, and the people were pretty arrogant, and after all it's an $18 million valuation."

Mr. Draper recalled his reply: "'OK,' I said, 'If you don't like it, let's turn it down.'"

"That company," he added, "was Apple Computer."

Morris Ballen, businessman who helped spread indie artists' music, at 88

By Clay Risen
NEW YORK TIMES

Morris Ballen, whose company, Disc Makers, manufactured small runs of high-quality vinyl records, cassettes, and CDs, offering a critical service to countless punk rockers, rappers, church choirs, and garage bands who made music without the backing of a major label, died Sept. 21 at his home in Philadelphia. He was 88.

His daughter Anne Ballen Ladenson confirmed the death.

Especially in the days before digital music, independent artists faced a challenge: They needed to get physical copies of their music into the hands of their fans, but they couldn't afford — and didn't need — the massive production runs offered by major manufacturers.

Enter Mr. Ballen and Disc Makers. His one-stop shop, in a factory outside Philadelphia, provided everything a musician required, including mastering, graphic design and vinyl (and later cassette and CD) pressing, sometimes just a few hundred units at a time.

He also offered free bar codes, so artists could sell their music in record stores, as well as marketing assistance like posters and flyers.

"Disc Makers gave musicians agency to create something on their own, independently," said Mick Chorba, singer-songwriter for New Jersey-based indie rock band Successful Failures, who has been using Disc Makers for decades.

The company and its predecessor, Ballen Record Co., has been around since the 1940s. But it came into its own in the 1980s, as the declining cost of production equipment and the DIY aesthetic of underground music made Disc Makers a favorite for punk and hip-hop artists.

Henry Rollins, who fronted the punk band Black Flag, was a devoted customer; so were DJ Jazzy Jeff and the Fresh Prince (aka Will Smith), who were, famously, "in West Philadelphia born and raised."

Eminem even name checked the company in his 2002 song "Nail in the Coffin."

But Mr. Ballen, who ran the company with his brother, Larry, worked with anyone and everyone.

"There is no such thing as a typical customer," he told The Los Angeles Times in 1996. "You have demos for new bands. You have churches. You have marching bands."

Mr. Ballen liked to hire musicians; at times, they comprised more than three-quarters of the employee rolls.

"I think he thought their brains were wired differently because they could learn music, they could communicate with people, they could work in teams," said Jim Foley, whose band Canadian Invasion was a client and who later worked there himself, "and they generally were hustlers." Foley is now president of BookBaby, a division of Disc Makers' parent company, DIY Media Group, focused on independent publishing. There were so many musicians working at the company, in fact, that for more than 20 years Disc Makers hosted DM Palooza, a charity music festival featuring their bands.

Over more than 30 years, Mr. Ballen and his brother took the company from under $5 million in revenue to more than $40 million, all while navigating the rapid shifts from vinyl to cassette to CD.

With the rise of digital formats, Disc Makers had to pivot again, adding a distribution arm to get clients' music onto online platforms. It also added an e-book division.

Today, though, vinyl and CDs are making a comeback, especially among younger musicians just starting out — the sort of customers who have always formed Disc Makers' client base.

"Our vinyl revenues at Disc Makers are up 400 percent over the last three years," Tony van Veen, the chief executive, said in an interview. "This business is growing again."

ANNE LADENSON VIA NEW YORK TIMES

Mr. Ballen, above at his CD-making facility in 1998, navigated rapid shifts in music format.

Morris Louis Ballen was born on Aug. 10, 1938, in Philadelphia. His father, Ivin, was founder and owner of the Ballen Record Co. It was very much a family business: His mother, Rose (Ostroff) Ballen, worked in the office, and he and his brother worked there in high school.

By the time he graduated from the Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania in 1960, with a degree in economics and accounting, he knew he wanted to work for his father.

The Ballen Record Co. began as a label, with its own vinyl press. Especially after it bought Gotham Records, a New York label, from Sam Goody, the music retailer, it was known for its stable of blues, gospel, and R&B acts.

The label business was unpredictable in the rapidly changing music landscape of the 1950s, so Ivin Ballen shifted to manufacturing for other labels — first 78s, then 45 rpm singles, and later to LPs and eight-track cassettes. He changed the company's name to Disc Makers in 1959.

Even that side of the industry could be tough: Among its clients was Cameo-Parkway, which hit it big with Chubby Checker's "The Twist," in 1960.

It was "probably the biggest single record we ever manufactured," Morris Ballen told The Jewish Exponent in 1995. "But when that label collapsed, we collapsed for a while."

After another downturn in 1980 that briefly pushed the company into Chapter 11 bankruptcy, Mr. Ballen shifted to focus on independent artists. By the end of the 1980s, almost the entirety of Disc Makers' business was directly with musicians.

Mr. Ballen's first marriage ended in divorce. Along with his daughter Anne, he leaves his wife, Lynn; another daughter, Carolyn Ballen Stanish; a stepdaughter, Tracy Steele; and six grandchildren.

It might seem like focusing on a niche market not known for its wealth would be a tough business model, but Mr. Ballen insisted that by keeping his prices low and his quality high, his market extended to anybody with a song in their head and a few dollars in their pocket.

"The whole world's out there, and they all come in," he told The Los Angeles Times. "It's big. Big. Bigger than you can imagine."

Esther Rantzen, U.K. media figure

By Pan Pylas
ASSOCIATED PRESS

LONDON — Esther Rantzen, a British broadcaster who became a prominent voice in the recent attempt to get assisted dying legalized in the United Kingdom, has died. She was 86.

In a statement, her three children said their "adored mother" died on Wednesday. "We will always remember her endless capacity for joy, her ability to comfort every heartache, her beautiful way with words and her expert guidance in all things," her children Miriam, Rebecca, and Joshua Wilcox said.

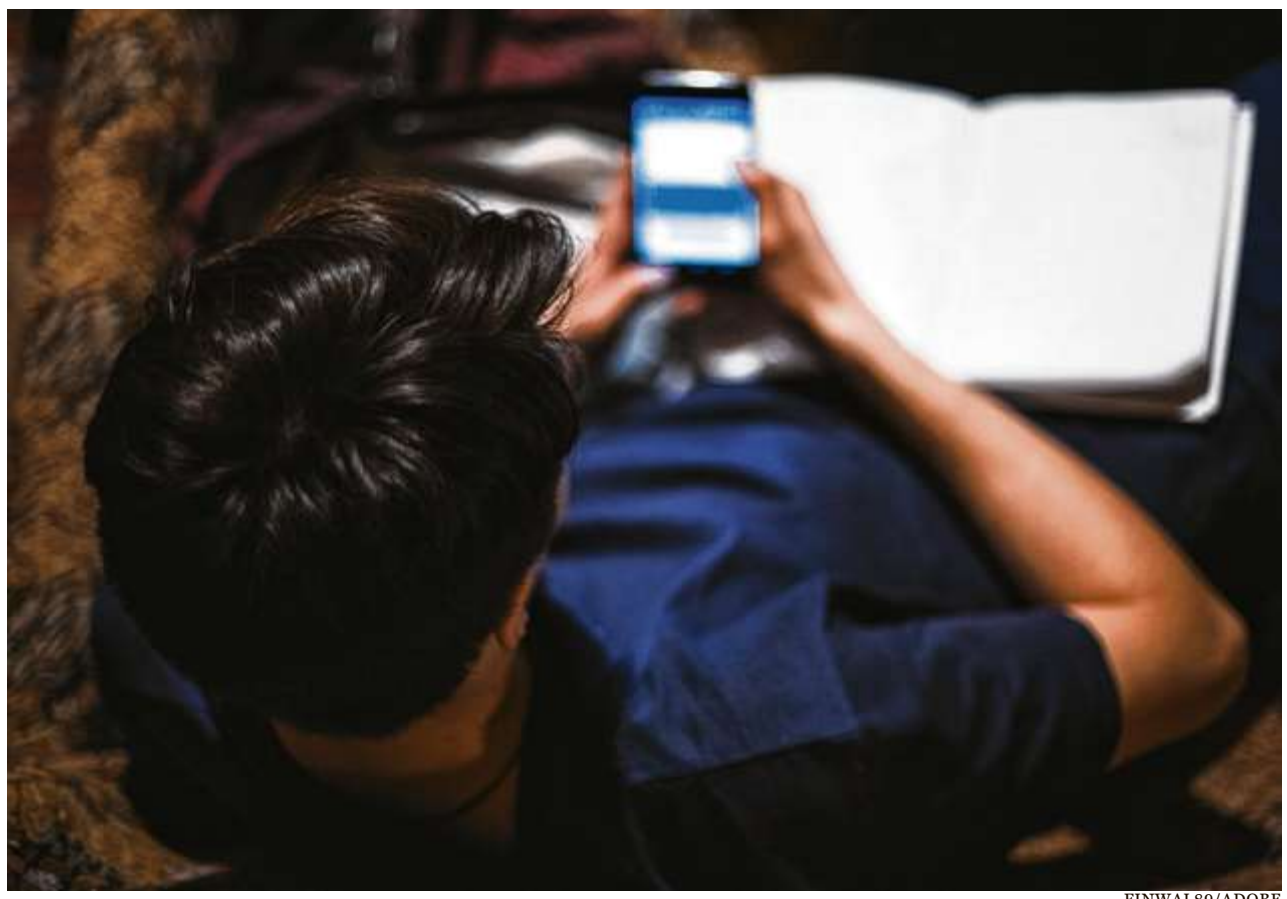
Over the decades, Ms. Rantzen became one of the most respected figures within British media.

She was perhaps most famous for fronting the BBC consumer affairs program "That's Life!" for 21 years from 1973 to 1994. Over the years, the show branched out beyond consumer affairs to investigate life-and-death issues, including an investigation into how a boarding school employed pedophiles and a critique of the UK's lack of organ donors. It could also be light-hearted, blending satire and farce with the more hard-hitting segments.

The program led her to set up Childline in 1986, a helpline for children in distress that was open 24/7 throughout the year. She later launched The Silver Line in 2012, which aimed to tackle loneliness in older people.

In later life, Ms. Rantzen became a strong proponent for assisted dying, after she was diagnosed with stage four lung cancer in 2023. She openly discussed her own plan to "buzz off to Zurich" because assisted dying is legal in Switzerland, and she criticized the "messy and cruel" law in England and Wales that would criminalize loved ones who tried to help in any endeavor to do so.

LivingArts



FINWAL89/ADOBE

SAT prep is great. But teach boys moral courage instead.

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Every woman remembers the smell: sweat commingling with warm rum. And the sticky floors. The thump-thump-thump of music. Those chunky Steve Madden platform shoes. The sense of possibility tempered with caution until one more beer, maybe, and caution slips away. Just another Saturday night.

I was in college in the late 1990s. I went to Mount Holyoke, an all-women's school where we usually took a shuttle, the PVTA, to neighboring campuses for co-ed parties. One such party was TAP at Amherst College. We'd tumble off the bus, file into Seelye Hall, and drink cheap beer from red plastic cups until the last bus to South Hadley pulled out of Boltwood Avenue. Some of us didn't go home until the next day.

There was a degrading pageantry aspect to the enterprise. But any degradation was overridden by the promise of — what exactly? Maybe fun.

I never left Amherst with anything worse than a hangover, but the following year, I met my boyfriend at UMass. I was alone in his darkened dorm room while he talked to someone down the hall. I began to drift to sleep when a bunch of men staggered in. I recognized the voices of his roommate's friends. They seemed drunk and angry. Their night hadn't gone as planned. I lay there, hoping they wouldn't notice me. They all sat down on their secondhand couch and cracked open beers.

"Dude," one said. "What if we just take turns on this girl?"

"I don't know," another one said. "That's Brian's girlfriend..."

How often do women long to make themselves invisible? I folded myself against the cinderblock wall as they debated whether or not to assault me. As if it were their choice. Their right. As if my very presence were an offering. There were no cellphones. No one to text. So I made a choice.

I am perhaps the most uncoordinated person on the planet, but I leapt off that bunk bed in a single bound, landed on my feet, burst out the door, and charged down the hallway until I located my boyfriend. I was furious. Disgusted. And shaken — so shaken.

Brian moved out of this room and filed for a dorm change the very next day. He is now my husband.

My experience was minor compared with what the victim at Cornell University endured in 2024 at the hands of seven men who allegedly gang raped her at a Chi Phi frat house, along with more on a group chat who apparently just scrolled on past when they knew what was happening.

It's been decades since I've gone to a frat party in Steve Madden platform shoes, and I have never, thank God, been raped. Now, though, I'm raising two sons — and the Cornell story brought me right back to those parties, worried about my two sons who were born sweet, cuddly, and innocent but could grow into predatory louts who assume women are theirs for the taking.

I wondered if the accused rapists were born sweet, too, and how they turned cold. Did they hug their mothers after a long day at nursery school? Did they grin toothlessly for their first grade picture? When did they turn bad? Were they, at one time, good?

When I talked to my teenager about Cornell, he bristled.

"Mom, you know I'm a good person!" he insisted, as though the talk were perfunctory. He's a good person: check!

And I do know he's a good person. I think most parents want to believe that their children are good: Who sets out to raise an asshole? But good is just the baseline. The conversation does not, cannot, end there.

What I really wanted to know was: Would you speak up in a text thread? Would you be the one to tell your friends to knock it off? Would you have the courage to dial 911?

"Being a man isn't just about being good," I told him. "It's about being courageous."

And I thought about that word: courage. It should not take courage to do the right thing in this world. But yet, it does. I see his text messages. I know how kids talk. There's nothing nefarious there, not really. But if every other kid is talking smack, it's pretty hard to be the lone friend to say, "Hey guys! I think this is inappropriate." When you're 16 and just want to fit in, self-preservation overrides moral certainty real fast.

But morality should not be a solo enterprise. The larger problem is that courage is not mainstream. It isn't valued or prized. Our priorities are out of whack. I mean "our" in the larger cultural sense, with the messages that are fed to us about what's important, especially when we think about elite colleges.

Eighty-nine percent of victims of reported rape are girls and women. 1 in 3 undergrad women experience rape or sexual assault during four-plus years in college, according to the Rape, Abuse & Incest National Network (RAINN).

Right now, there are interior decorators who style college dorm rooms. Rush consultants who specialize in matching kids with Greek organizations. There are Instagram slideshows of kids getting recruited for competitive sports snapped by professional photographers; get-ready-with-me TikToks showing girls how to prepare for the next party; heated debates in my town and elsewhere over how to bypass preliminary math so that kids can take calculus a year early for an extra edge.

Every week, I field glossy brochures from SAT prep courses, promising my child an advantage. There are consultants who help high school students curate their personal brands, service hours, and digital footprints before they've even applied to college.

This misses the point. As parents of teenagers, the only personal brand we should be interested in is integrity. What would it look like if society actually rewarded and rehearsed decency the way it rewards achievement? But, sadly, decency is not an industry.

We need tutorials for boys about how to stand up for women and how to speak up. We don't need one more SAT prep course or branding session. We need to place that kind of emphasis, that kind of social capital, on teaching boys how to be good men.

Crafting a perfect story to land at an elite college means absolutely nothing if you're morally bankrupt at worst or complicit at best once you arrive. It means absolutely nothing for the girl who goes back to her perfectly decorated dorm room having been assaulted.

We're focusing on the wrong things.

Where are the high school classes that teach not only health ed and consent, but also humanity? When scrolling electives for my sophomore, I saw plenty of fantastic courses in art and team sports. I'd love to see a mandatory seminar about masculinity and bystander intervention training, with real scenarios: group chats, leaked photos, hazing.

I wish coaches were required to teach leadership skills that punctured toxic groupthink. I wish there were awards for kids who intervened, challenged cruelty, or reported a dangerous situation, celebrated with the same enthusiasm as National Merit Scholars or a championship game. I wish there were more role models for boys and men; ones who could make courage aspirational instead of a fluke.

Most of all, I wish we could broaden what boys and men receive status and accolades for: restraint, empathy, outspokenness, the willingness to risk social capital by doing the right thing. I mean, my husband got a wife out of it. (Sometimes he might wonder if this was a reward. I would like to think so.)

But the culture around success right now — around manhood, and womanhood too — often capitalizes on selling achievement, presentation, and crafting a brand to get into college. Moral courage isn't easily monetized. It isn't particularly glamorous. It doesn't exist in the marquee moments or easy arcs: the big win, the state title, the huge scholarship. It's the ordinary, day-in-and-day-out pattern of living a decent life.

Kids are sold ways to get ahead. We also need to teach them how to stand up, not because there are rewards or accolades, but because it's part of the human contract. That's something you cannot find in a prep course or a TikTok tutorial. The real measure of a good kid isn't GPA or community service hours. It's what they're willing to lose to do the right thing.

But until courage carries the same social currency as achievement, I worry that silence will remain the easier choice.

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Godzilla invades this year's New York Film Festival

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

Festival season continues with the New York Film Festival, which offers 18 days of cinema selections for the press and public alike. This year's lineup repeats some films from other fests, like Toronto and Cannes, while offering some anticipated world premieres and revivals. The famous fountain in the middle of Lincoln Center will bear witness to the annual crowd of movie lovers heading toward the venues showing works by Tom McCarthy, Ava DuVernay, and James Gray.

And for the first time, a certain giant of Japanese cinema emerged at Alice Tully Hall, disproving the notion that the NYFF shows nothing but movies for indie snobs. I've attended this festival since 1991, and would never have imagined it would show a Godzilla movie.

Let's start my first of two dispatches with that big ol' kaiju. While that nor'easter from last week drenched the I-95 corridor, attendees at Alice Tully Hall braved the elements to witness the world premiere of "Godzilla Minus Zero," the sequel to the Oscar-winning 2024 film "Godzilla Minus One." Writer-director Takashi Yamazaki, and his stars Minami Hamabe and Ryûnosuke Kamiki, return with a new chapter of the Shikishima family's life in post-World War II Japan. The film is set primarily in 1949.

I was at a screening with my fellow critics, but from what I heard, the public screening brought the house down the way Godzilla smashes a building. A lot of houses come down in this sequel, most of them courtesy of an event I'm not allowed to mention. The score by Naoki Satô is ominous and foreboding. Godzilla's immortal theme gets a beefy makeover that sounds like every trombone and viola in Japan was used to record it.

As with most sequels, this one's bigger, louder, darker, and longer; the spectacle is worth it, however, and Yamazaki may earn his second best visual effects Oscar after his win for "Godzilla Minus One."

The NYFF screened "Godzilla Minus Zero" for the press the morning before its world premiere. Watching a kaiju movie on a rainy Saturday morning in the New York City area took me back to my childhood. Except now I was sitting in the Walter Reade Theater instead of in front of a television — and I was watching an R-rated movie. For the first time in 37 films, Godzilla is in a movie kids can't see without an adult.

You'll have to wait until November to experience an adventure that's equally terrifying and heartbreaking, not to mention a lot of fun. Yamazaki lingers on the carnage long enough to make the MPA skittish, but I'm not sure if this deserved an R (its predecessor was PG-13). The MCU movies are just as violent, but they skirt the R by being relatively bloodless. People bleed in "Godzilla Minus Zero."

Another hot ticket at this year's NYFF was the restoration of Ken Russell's 1971 horror movie, "The Devils." This film was so controversial in its imagery that its distributor, Warner Bros, demanded cuts to a movie that had already been rated X by the ratings board. At the time, it was believed that the excised footage had been destroyed.

For decades, this censored material was as big a white whale to cineastes as the missing footage from Orson Welles's "The Magnificent Ambersons." Unlike Welles's film, "The Devils" has finally been restored to the vision its director intended, and is being released by Clockwork, the new revival arm of Warners. Also unlike "The Magnificent Ambersons," "The Devils" isn't a good movie. It's an over-the-top bore based on a possession that occurred in Loudon, France in 1634. I bet it happened just like this movie depicts it, with camera zooms and nuns executing stripper maneuvers while under the spell of Old Scratch.

This was my third time seeing the film (and my first time in its completed version). I didn't like it the first two times, and I knew that a few minutes of supposedly scandalous debauchery involving nuns wasn't going to suddenly make me give this movie four stars. However, the new footage is admittedly the Ken Russell-est of all Ken Russell scenes, which means all shock value is negated by its unintentional hilarity. Ken Russell's gonna Ken Russell, and you can't help but applaud him for that.

I know I'm supposed to rant and rave about this new version, rending my garments with exaltation the way Vanessa Redgrave's sex-mad nun does after licking the blood off Oliver Reed's interpretation of Jesus. That's not going to happen. I'm happy the movie can finally be seen the way the director intended — censorship should never be tolerated. But that doesn't mean I have to like "The Devils." Decide for yourself when it gets a one-week release on Oct. 16.

TOHO

An scene from "Godzilla Minus Zero."

When I discovered that James Gray's "Paper Tiger" was originally intended as a sequel to his dreadful 2022 film "Armageddon Time," I wanted no part of it. However, I'm duty-bound to cover the opening night film of the New York Film Festival. To my surprise, this Adam Driver-led vehicle had nothing to do with the prior film. Instead, Gray returns to the neo-noirish gangster trappings that propelled earlier works like "We Own the Night" and "Little Odessa."

Set in 1980s New York City, "Paper Tiger" follows the Pearl family, led by nebbish patriarch Irwin (Miles Teller) and his wife, Linda (Scarlett Johannson). Their lives are upended by the return of former cop and black sheep of the family, Irwin's older brother, Gary (Driver). After leaving the precinct, Gary became financially successful and estranged from Irwin. His return proves you should never trust anyone who comes to your house with gifts of Peter Luger steaks (and Peter Luger employees to serve them).

Gary wants scientist Irwin to go in on a project to advise a Russian company about cleaning up the Gowanus Canal. A seemingly innocent job turns dangerous when Irwin sees something he should not have seen, putting his family and his own life in jeopardy. Meanwhile, Linda is facing her own crisis at home, and I don't mean ScarJo's overbaked Noo Yawk City accent.

Gray ratchets up the tension in every scene, delivering an effective, if flawed, thriller with enough New York-based Easter eggs to satisfy its residents. Johannson is good, and Driver is a riveting study in contrasts. But it's Teller who's the biggest surprise. An actor whose work I have never been a fan of, Teller delivers the best performance in "Paper Tiger."

Odie Henderson is the Boston Globe's film critic.

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MOVIES

A big, bold 'La Bola Negra'

CARLA OSET/NETFLIX

Guitarricadelafuente and Miguel Bernardeau star in Javier Calvo and Javier Ambrossi's "La Bola Negra." Below: Calvo (left) and Ambrossi at a film festival in San Sebastian.

Netflix's war drama shines a light on gay love and talent

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

Exploring the beauty of love amid the horrors of war, "La Bola Negra" has captivated audiences from Cannes to Toronto ahead of the Spanish-language drama's Boston debut.

Netflix's generations-spanning epic from directors Javier Calvo and Javier Ambrossi (known together as Los Javis) is the closing night movie for this year's CineFest Latino Boston, screening Sunday at the Coolidge (the film returns to the Brookline theater beginning Oct. 30 and expands to additional Boston-area theaters Nov. 6). Set across 1932, 1937, and 2017, "La Bola Negra" tells an intricately woven story about three gay men navigating the challenges of their times, connected by a history of love, loss, and family secrets.

ANDER GILLENEA/GETTY IMAGES

As the bulk of the film takes place just prior to and during the Spanish Civil War, Ambrossi admitted he was "very surprised" to see a story so heavily steeped in Spanish history resonate with viewers around the world. "La Bola Negra," which serves as Spain's best international feature selection for the upcoming Oscars, won the People's Choice Award at the Toronto International Film Festival last month, with Los Javis also winning the best director prize at this year's Cannes Film Festival.

"We just wanted to write and direct and produce a movie about Spanish culture and Spanish history," Ambrossi told the Globe. "But people [are] connecting a lot with the universal love of the movie and the universal message that we have to live."

"This is a very tragic story, but at the

"LA BOLA NEGRA", Page G5

Put down the phone, pick up a date?

A new dating trend is emerging in the city, and it's offline

By Sterling Davies and Celine Hijazi
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

At Cisco Brewers Seaport, a meeting spot for post-work drinks and mingling, a recent Thursday night started like a middle school formal, with young men clustered in groups on one side and young women on the other. Finally, as drinks started flowing, the ice melted, and they began to mix.

If this seems a bit staged, it was. Two Boston dating platforms, Stoop Dating and STAG Boston, had teamed up, booked space at the venue, and invited singles to take part in what was essentially a mass blind date. Stoop Dating and STAG have staged similar events across the city, betting that Gen Z singles are fed up with dating apps and hungry to meet potential mates face to face.

It appears they are right. Across the

DATING, Page G4

KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Jacob Mulherin and Courtney Wilson got acquainted during a singles mixer at Cisco Brewers Seaport in August.

TELEVISION

Alan Cumming excels in 'Tip Toe,' a drama about a new age of homophobia

By Chris Vognar
GLOBE STAFF

"Tip Toe," the lively but deeply sad new British series making its US premiere this Friday on Starz, would be getting a huge amount of buzz were it set in the States. It's a resonant cry of rage against increasingly vitriolic attacks on gay and trans people, particularly as amplified by the internet hate machine. But it's also a finely acted, carefully layered human drama about how we fear what we don't understand, and why we so often blame others for the graves we dig ourselves. The fact that it presages its final, shocking act of violence at the very beginning of the series points to a haunting fatalism that echoes long after the final credits have rolled.

BEN BLACKALL

Alan Cumming (left) and David Morrissey in "Tip Toe."

So how can it also be so fun to watch? Reason No. 1 is Alan Cumming. Best known these days as the man behind the hit reality competition series "The Traitors," the longtime stage and screen star does everything with a mischievous twinkle in his eye; one character in "Tip Toe" describes Cumming's Leo Struthers as "a daft little Scottish lad with eyes like a fox." Leo owns a Manchester gay bar, the Spit & Polish, where drag queens and trans people are warmly welcomed as servers and customers. Pushing 60, he's lived through plenty in the LGBTQ+ movement, and what he sees now

"TIP TOE", Page G4

Inside

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The Ticket

UPCOMING EVENTS, CHOSEN BY GLOBE CRITICS AND WRITERS

Sign up for The Big To-Do newsletter, your guide to staying entertained, from live shows and outdoor fun to the latest events around Boston.

MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF, JEN ROSENSTEIN, PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF, ADOBE

LAST CHANCE

THROUGH OCT. 4

CINEFEST LATINO BOSTON

Featuring screenings across the Hub, CineFest Latino Boston continues through Sunday. The closing night film at the Coolidge is Netflix's "La bola negra" (above), which recently won the People's Choice Award and will serve as Spain's entry for best international feature film for the upcoming Academy Awards. *Tickets start at $15. cinefestlatino.com — DL*

Welcome to The Ticket, our guide highlighting the top things to do in and around Boston each weekend, as curated by Globe critics, editors, and writers.

On tap this weekend: the Smashing Pumpkins are in town, plus the Topsfield Fair is back.

— Matt Juul

1 SMASHING PUMPKINS The Grammy-winning alt rock legends are back in Boston as a part of "The Rats in a Cage Tour," which headlines TD Garden this Friday. Frontman Billy Corgan revealed in the tour announcement that the first set of this weekend's show will be dedicated to album "Melon Collie and the Infinite Sadness," which just celebrated its 30th anniversary, before diving into the rest of the band's multi-decade catalog. *Oct. 2, 8 p.m. Tickets start at $119. 100 Legends Way. tdgarden.com/events/detail/the-smashing-pumpkins — Daisy Levine*

2 HARPOON OCTOBERFEST Harpoon Brewery, which celebrates its 40th anniversary this year, has two days of Octoberfest festivities planned for this weekend. Friday features glow-in-the-dark fun with live music, beer and cocktails, plus a selection of food from Roxy's Grilled Cheese, the Harpoon kitchen, and more. Visitors can also partake in activities like glow-in-the-dark stein hoisting, coozie decorating, and cornhole. Saturday's event will include more traditional, Munich-inspired activities. *Oct. 2-3, 6-11 p.m. on Friday, noon-7 p.m. on Saturday. Tickets start at $15. Harpoon Brewery and Beer Hall, 306 Northern Ave. harpoonbrewery.com/event/harpoon-octoberfest-2026 — Janira Skrbkova*

3 TOPSFIELD FAIR The annual county fair returns this fall for 11 days of family-friendly entertainment. Presented by the Essex Agricultural Society, the weekend festivities include a giant pumpkin weigh-off, a sheep obstacle course, a hot dog-eating contest, a canine aquatics show, plus a fireworks display on Saturday. Visitors can also enjoy live music and concessions. *Oct. 2-12. Tickets are $20 at the gate or $23 online. 207 Boston St., Topsfield. topsfieldfair.org — JS*

4 BOSTON FESTIVAL OF INDIE GAMES BostonFIG is back — a day of family-friendly entertainment from some of the gaming world's rising stars. Play a variety of unique games, partake in discussions, see the awards and showcase, and introduce yourself to the indie gaming community. *Oct. 3, 10-5 p.m. $35. Kids under 12 are free. The Cyclorama at Boston Center for the Arts, 539 Tremont St. bostonfig.com — DL*

5 SPICETOBER FEST Boston's hottest fall celebration will celebrate bold local flavors and talent this weekend. Visitors can test their limits at a hot sauce tasting challenge, enjoy spice-forward concessions, watch stage demonstrations from Boston chefs, enjoy live music, and more. *Oct. 3, 11 a.m. to 6 p.m. Free. Boston City Hall Plaza, Northern Terrace, 1 City Hall Square. spicetoberfest.com — JS*

6 AMMA MARFO 'FIDGET. SPINSTER.' TAPING A rising voice in the Boston comedy scene and self-described "anxious Black nerd," Marfo has been workshopping this one-woman multimedia show about dating and commitment for nearly a year and a half, and she is ready to commit it to video at Porter Square Books Boston location. *Oct. 3, 7 p.m. $27.38. Porter Square Books: Boston Edition, 50 Liberty Drive. simpletix.com/e/new-normal-comedy-presents-amma-marfo-s-fi-tickets-290142 — Nick A. Zaino III*

7 KATHY GRIFFIN: NEW FACE, NEW TOUR Even though she is now friends with people like Paris Hilton and the Kardashians, whom she lampooned on her "My Life On the D-List," Griffin has not relented in taking on pop culture and politics onstage, targeting everyone from Trump to Taylor Swift, and most of all, herself ("New Face, New Tour" is a reference to her latest cosmetic surgery). *Oct. 3, 7 p.m. $70-$94. The Wilbur, 246 Tremont St. thewilbur.com — NZ*

8 LAURA SEVERSE A Boston native now living in Los Angeles, Severse remembers a painful moment around the family dinner table when her two kids thought their parents were getting a divorce and immediately said they were going with their dad. "That hurt a little bit," she says, "because the audacity of these kids to [expletive] ever think that I would file for custody?" *Oct. 3, 9 p.m. $39.90. Laugh Boston, 425 Summer St. 617-725-2844, laughboston.com — NZ*

9 FIESTA EN LA PLAZA Back for its fourth year, Fiesta En La Plaza returns with a special presentation of "One Night in Alosha," an afternoon-long celebration of the Afro-Latin diaspora right in City Hall Plaza. This free, all-ages event features contemporary performance from Latin America and the Caribbean, including music, dance, and a live podcast taping. *Oct. 4, 1:30 p.m. City Hall Plaza, 1 City Hall Square. pietix.com/fiesta-en-la-plaza-alosha — DL*

CRITICS' PICKS

DON AUCOIN'S PICKS

COVENANT

In this gripping production of York Walker's eerie Southern gothic drama, one of the questions implicitly asked and chillingly answered is: How far would you go to get what — or whom — you want? Directed by Dawn M. Simmons with a sure grasp of atmosphere and pace, "Covenant" tells the story of a bluesman (Anthony T. Goss) who prompts rumors he sold his soul to the devil when he returns to his Georgia hometown in the mid-1930s, possessing musical gifts he didn't have before and intent on marrying the young woman (Deannah DRIPP Blemur) he's been smitten with for more than a decade. *Through Oct. 17. SpeakEasy Stage Company. At Roberts Studio Theatre, Calderwood Pavilion, Boston Center for the Arts, 527 Tremont St. 617-933-8600, speakeasystage.com*

BENJAMIN ROSE

"Covenant" is at Roberts Studio Theatre through Oct. 17.

ALL MY SONS

A powder keg of a production whose fuse is lit early on and slowly burns while we watch and wait. In Arthur Miller's 1947 drama, the Keller family faces a harsh reckoning several years after the factory run by father Joe (a superb Bill Mootos) shipped defective airplane parts that resulted in the deaths of 21 pilots during World War II. Directed by Scott Edmiston, "All My Sons" serves as a reminder that Miller had created a work of profoundly enduring resonance even before writing "Death of a Salesman." *Extended through Oct. 25. Lyric Stage Boston, 140 Clarendon St. 617-585-5678, lyricstage.com*

BOUNCERS

John Godber's raucous comedy is about a single night in a Yorkshire disco, as seen through the eyes of a quartet of bouncers — played by Joe Siriani, Liam McCarron, Michael Ferrari, and Bradley Belanger — as they try to cope with the club's rowdy, drunken clientele. Directed by Bill Doncaster. *Through Oct. 24. Production by Visual City LLC and the Modern Theatre at Suffolk University. At Modern Theatre at Suffolk University, 525 Washington St. ci.ovationtix.com/34432/production/1280397*

PARADE

Ken Crossman plays Leo Frank, a Jewish factory manager wrongly convicted of the murder of 13-year-old Mary Phagan and lynched by a Georgia mob in 1915, in the Tony-winning musical by Jason Robert Brown (music and lyrics) and Alfred Uhry (book). Eliza Barmakian plays Lucille Frank, Leo's wife. The cast also includes Thain Bertin, Darren Paul, Barbara Pierre, Amanda Sargent, Tim Lawton, Matthew Zahnzinger, James Allen, Nick Corsi, Abby Jarcho, and Ellie Lauter. Directed by Brit Garner, with music direction by Alex Taylor. *Through Oct. 10. Newton Theatre Company, Newton. eventbrite.com*

A.Z. MADONNA'S PICKS

HANDEL AND HAYDN SOCIETY

H+H steps into fall with Handel's Milton-inspired oratorio "L'Allegro, il penseroso ed il moderato," a meditation on the human spirit featuring artistic director Jonathan Cohen, vocal soloists Joélle Harvey, Paul Appleby, and Michael Sumuel, and Massachusetts poet laureate Regie Gibson alongside the H+H Orchestra and Chorus. A reception welcoming new president Lecolion Washington Jr. will follow both concerts. *Oct. 2, 7:30 p.m., Oct. 4, 3 p.m. Symphony Hall, 301 Massachusetts Ave. 617-262-1815, handelandhaydn.org*

BOSTON SYMPHONY ORCHESTRA

At this weekend's all-Rachmaninoff program, pianist and BSO frequent flyer Seong-Jin Cho joins the orchestra and music director Andris Nelsons for "Rhapsody on a Theme of Paganini" before the orchestra closes things out with the Symphony No. 2. Next week, Nelsons leads the United States premiere of Francisco Coll's new piano concerto featuring pianist Kirill Gerstein; Beethoven's "Coriolan" Overture and Symphony No. 7 round out that program. *Oct. 8-10. Symphony Hall, 301 Massachusetts Ave. 617-266-1200, bso.org*

MURRAY WHYTE'S PICKS

HOCKNEY REPRODUCTION(S)

The British painter David Hockney, who died earlier this year at 88, was a titan of painting's resurgence in the 1960s and '70s after years of bone-dry conceptualism. But was Hockney, a devoutly exuberant colorist, a closet conceptualist himself? This little show, organized by the artist's Gloucester-based friend Bing McGilvray, explores the artist's keen interest in serial production of his work by various means — including, in one case, a fax machine. Hockney's canonical painting oeuvre ran parallel to a tireless drive to break new ground wherever the game experimentalist could find it, as this show explores. *Through Oct. 18. Open Fridays, Saturdays, and Sundays, 1-5 p.m. Registration required. Manship Artists Residency, 1069 Washington St., Gloucester. manshipartists.org*

COUNTER HISTORY: CONTEMPORARY ART FROM THE COLLECTION

"How do we remember the past, and how does it inform the present?" is the central query posed by this exhibition of several dozen works acquired by the MFA in recent years, and it's hard to imagine a more fraught or timely frame for the current moment. In a regressive time in American culture, the show feels like a flashing beacon in the gathering dark, with artists including Andy Warhol, Mark Bradford, Jeffrey Gibson, Dana Chandler Jr., and Steve Locke here to "stand against official narratives" to "set the record straight." Hold that thought tight. We're going to need it.*Ongoing. Museum of Fine Arts Boston, 465 Huntington Ave. 617-267-9300, mfa.org*

WHY LOOK AT HORSES?

An exhibition with disturbingly on-point accidental timing — wild horses in the west have been recently victimized by a rapacious federal government determined to make meat of them — this exhibition asks an essential question about mankind's most noble animal symbol of progress: "What happens when an animal that once shaped the course of human history becomes experienced primarily as an image?" A wild guess, if you'll pardon the pun: We become disconnected from its physicality, its animal-ness, and distracted by its symbolic might. Recent events should be enough to shake off the distraction, but we'll see. *Through March 14. Colby College Museum of Art, 5600 Mayflower Hill Drive, Waterville, Maine. 207-859-5600, museum.colby.edu*

Did you miss Olivia Rodrigo's all-women music fest? Head to this Martha's Vineyard event instead.

By Victoria Wasylak
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

SOUND CHECK

Kelly Feirtag doesn't remember many details about the first she show she ever attended, but she remembers how it made her feel.

"My best friend's mom bought us tickets and brought us, and I had no idea what it was, and I don't think my friend did, either," Feirtag says on a recent phone call. "I just remember being like, 'Oh my God, there's so many women'. . . . I was so young, but it felt like such a safe place."

The event was Lilith Fair, **Sarah McLachlan**'s traveling music festival that exclusively featured women performers and women-led acts. Over the course of Lilith Fair's existence — three editions in the 1990s, and another in 2010 — the festival raised millions of dollars for charity with stacked lineups that included artists like **Missy Elliot**, **Erykah Badu**, **Indigo Girls**, **Bonnie Raitt**, **Queen Latifah**, **the Pretenders**, and **Fiona Apple**.

It's no wonder that 20 years later Feirtag would become one of the co-founders of **Ladyfest Martha's Vineyard**, an annual all-ages festival in Oak Bluffs that fosters a similar environment. Launched in 2017, the one-day event takes place every fall to raise money for CONNECT to End Violence, an island-based domestic violence program and rape crisis center that offers free short-term counseling, court advocacy, and other services. This year's festival, which takes place Saturday, marks Ladyfest's ninth year on Martha's Vineyard and second year at Waban Park.

Ladyfest isn't limited to women artists, but the lineups typically skew in that direction. (The name "Ladyfest" comes from a 2000 event launched in Washington state, which has inspired spinoffs across the globe, including in Madrid, Budapest, and Shanghai.) Two Los Angeles acts are making the trek for Saturday's event — **Wolftrap** and **Sunny War** — but the majority of the performers are New Englanders. Hartford, Conn., artist **GABI** sings bossa-nova-inspired pop; **Ali McGuirk**, who was raised outside of Boston, remains a staple of New England's blues scene in her new home of Montpelier, Vt.; and **Kate Taylor**, sister of James and Livingston, needs little introduction.

JOSHUA ROBINSON WHITE

esperanza spalding at last year's Ladyfest Martha's Vineyard.

MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

The Linda Lindas perform at Paradise Rock Club Tuesday.

RICHARD HAWKE

Boston ska-punk band Pink Slip have released their debut LP, "Bathtub Madonna."

JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Phoebe Bridgers heads to TD Garden for two shows.

Delanie Pickering, an internationally-traveling blues artist, calls Martha's Vineyard home, as do **the Alpha Gals**, **Elda Berlin**, **DJ Dolce Vita**, and dance group **Island Hip-Hop**.

Events in the vein of Lilith Fair and Ladyfest are common, but not easy to sustain. Similar Boston-area shows from the recent past include Reimagining Lilith Fair, held at Club Passim, and the free, outdoors We Make Noise Fest, neither of which have returned this year. Even McLachlan's Lilith Fair only lasted for four years, including its 2010 revival. But the Martha's Vineyard edition of Ladyfest has been growing steadily since its first edition at the Ritz Cafe, the Oak Bluffs bar and venue that Feirtag managed at the time. When attendees started spilling out of the 99-person dive, Feirtag shifted the festivities to Circuit Avenue, one of the main streets in Oak Bluffs.

Last year, the event made the leap to Waban Park — "the perfect location for something like this," Feirtag says — and featured headliner **esperanza spalding**, the nationally renowned Berklee alumna and jazz bass wiz.

"I think [the longevity] has a lot to do with personal relationships," says Feirtag, "and the people that are on Martha's Vineyard want to be a part of this."

In August, 23-year-old pop star **Olivia Rodrigo** reignited conversations about Lilith Fair-style events when she launched her own women-led music festival, Daisy Chain Fields. The Irvine, Calif. event sold out in 30 minutes, drew 45,000 attendees, and raised over $20 million for nonprofits that support women and girls. (Not to mention that the bill was stellar, with **Bikini Kill**, **Doechii**, **Chappell Roan**, McLachlan, and Rodrigo among the performers.)

Speaking as someone whose introduction to live music was Lilith Fair, Feirtag says that Rodrigo's effort "gives me a lot of hope in the world, and for the next generation."

GIG GUIDE

After weathering two storms — "Macklegate" and last weekend's nor'easter — Gillette Stadium closes its concert season with a twofer from country singer **Zach Bryan**, who promotes his January album, "With Heaven On Top," Friday and Saturday.

Just in time for pumpkin spice fever, fans of **the Smashing Pumpkins** will get a double shot of the alt-rock band Friday at TD Garden, as they perform "distinct," back-to-back sets honoring the belated 30th anniversary of their LP "Mellon Collie and the Infinite Sadness." Pop artist **beabadoobee**, who just released the gritty LP "Pylon," makes her headlining debut at the arena Saturday, followed by Tuesday and Wednesday appearances from indie rock darling **Phoebe Bridgers**, who this fall juggles the release of her third studio album, "Lost Weekend," and her acting debut in the new Robert Pattinson-led thriller, "Primetime."

MGM Music Hall at Fenway breaks into new territory with a "toddler techno" show Sunday, courtesy of family-friendly DJ **Lenny Pearce**. Otherwise it's business as usual at the venue, as **Foster the People** share danceable yet vulnerable indie-pop Tuesday, Christian rock group **Skillet** toast the 20th anniversary of their album "Comatose" Wednesday, and South Korean pop group **Monsta X** perform their first-ever headlining show in Massachusetts Thursday.

Across the street, the House of Blues welcomes a joint tour from Brazilian stars **Eduardo Costa** and **Pablo** Friday and the twisting rhythms of Cape Verdean artist **Djodje** Saturday. The Agganis Arena's schedule this weekend is just as diverse, with Pakistani singer **Rahat Fateh Ali Khan** visiting Friday and Greek performer **Konstantinos Argiros** stopping by Saturday.

John Lydon wasn't at Royale with the Sex Pistols earlier this week; instead he's at Big Night Live Saturday with the other band he co-founded, **Public Image Ltd.** If you want to double down on post-punk, **Interpol** head to Roadrunner Sunday. (Also at Roadrunner this week: indie-pop dreamers **MUNA** on Friday, folk group **Buffalo Traffic Jam** on Monday, and eccentric alt-rock vets **Modest Mouse** on Wednesday.)

The Linda Lindas are all grown up at the Paradise Rock Club Tuesday; the all-women rock band went viral as kids in 2021, and have since released three albums, including August's "GOTTA GET OUT."

NOW SPINNING

Pink Slip, "Bathtub Madonna." Would you rather have fun, or rage against the gradual decline of, well, everything? With "Bathtub Madonna," Boston's Pink Slip boldly ask — why should you have to choose? The seven-piece ska-punk band jump, jive, and bounce through life's frustrations on their debut album, nine songs' worth of proof that everything is less infuriating if you add the right amount of horns. Pink Slip celebrate the new LP with a Friday show at Faces in Malden.

BONUS TRACK

Saturday at Club Passim, **Kim Moberg** hosts an early celebration of Indigenous People Day with a performance of her project "The Seven Fires Prophecy Suite for Humanity." Moberg, a Cape Cod-based artist of Tlingit descent, will be joined by Americana opener **Thea Hopkins**, a member of the Aquinnah Wampanoag tribe of Martha's Vineyard.

Victoria Wasylak can be reached at victoria.wasylak@globe.com.

How beabadoobee went from playing bedroom-pop to headlining arenas

ERIKA KAMANO

beabadoobee performs at TD Garden Oct. 3.

By Maura Johnston
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

BEABADOOBEE
With Wisp. At TD Garden, 100 Legends Way, Saturday, Oct. 3, 8 p.m. Tickets: $54 and up. tdgarden.com

"I want moshing!"

That's the vision Beatrice Laus, the Filipino-English singer-songwriter known as beabadoobee, has for her current tour, which stops at TD Garden Saturday. With her fourth album "Pylon," which came out in September, beabadoobee has laid the groundwork for such crowd antics: It's an elliptical full-length with gnarled guitars that recall Boston-area indie legends of the '90s, like Blake Babies and Helium, with beabadoobee's candy-coated voice twisting around them.

beabadoobee — the name comes from an old friends-only Instagram account — began as a bedroom-pop artist, with her debut single, the sparse singalong "Coffee," possessing the immediate feel of a 4-track demo.

"I always write music like a journal or my diary, very personal and honest," Laus wrote via email.

Her later singles expanded her sonic palette and revealed her interest in droll, feedback-drenched indie rock; "She Plays Bass" is an ode to her bass player and pal Eliana Sewell that crashes and shimmers, while "I Wish I Was Stephen Malkmus" name-checks the lead singer of slacker-rock kings Pavement and throws glitter on that band's laconic vibes.

A few years after its original release, the producer-songwriter Powfu sampled "Coffee" on his track "death bed (coffee for your head)," warping beabadoobee's original song just enough to make her voice heighten the song's regretful tone. The track became a hit almost immediately after its release, serving as the soundtrack to a massive number of lockdown-era clips on TikTok, and getting airplay on almost every non-country radio format.

beabadoobee's profile rose in the wake of that left-field smash, but she remained true to her vision, releasing albums that dug in further to her love of swirling dream-pop and smartly angled riffs. Last month she released "Pylon," which digs into those inspirations further alongside a slew of A-list alt-rock guests like Brendan Yates (of the Baltimore warehouse-scene heroes Turnstile) and sharp-tongued singer-songwriter Hayley Williams.

The 26-year-old worked out the new songs in hotel rooms, which brought her back to the early days of making music in her bedroom.

"A lot of this album was written while on the road and in between being on tour," she explained. "So [I was in] a lot of hotel rooms while coming to the understanding and acceptance that this is my life. It really struck me while being on the road in the middle of nowhere — sometimes, places [where] I don't even know where I am — but still finding the things that reminded me of home."

Those moments in "the middle of nowhere" and a growing obsession with pylons — the hulking structures that dot highways around the world—inspired the album's title.

"Often, I'd be on buses looking out the window, seeing pylons and realizing that they are always there — such strong and blunt structures spread out all over, city to city, and the thing that keeps us all connected," she wrote. "Something about that made me feel comforted and assured. I'd take that feeling and write in my hotel rooms.

"Pylons are pretty badass," she added.

Musically, "Pylon" has a lot of similar qualities to its namesakes. beabadoobee hardened her sound just enough to make songs like the speedy, sneering "Sun Has Set" and the chiming "It's Alright" land like world-beaters, while the feedback-drenched "Switchblade" is one of the album's many highlights, its churning verses exploding into a shout-along chorus.

"I also had some sessions with Shane [Moran, from the post-hardcore titans Title Fight] and others in studios where we were starting in a place that felt like we wanted things to be loud and very live."

That intensity even translates to the album's quieter moments, like the icy "Spark" and the spaced-out "Despite That," which have an urgency about them that should turn into live catharsis.

beabadoobee's current tour is her first stint headlining arenas, and she's made sure that her staging will be as structure-filling as her music.

"I'm so excited to play these shows, because I'm bringing in the biggest stage design I've had to date, and it's going to be super fun," she wrote. "Me and my team had the stage design in mind and would talk about it way before the album was even recorded, so it's going to be fun to show the fans the album, performing with all the visuals."

Ticket To The Arts

THEATER

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MUSIC

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OPERA

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ARTS IN BRIEF

The big picture, very big, at the Coolidge

In "Digger," Tom Cruise plays a larger-than-life energy mogul. To film the movie, director Alejandro González Iñárritu chose a format worthy of its subject, VistaVision. It's similar to CinemaScope, the best-known large-screen format. Developed in the '50s, VistaVision is famed for the quality of the images it produces. It was the format Paul Thomas Anderson used for "One Battle After Another." The Coolidge Corner Theatre, which showed "Battle" in VistaVision, will be one of only six venues in the world to show "Digger" in the format. "We're honored to be entrusted yet again with showing one of the season's highest-profile releases in this rare and technically-challenging format," Coolidge artistic director Mark Anastasio said in a statement. — *Mark Feeney*

MFA names new chair for Art of the Americas

The Museum of Fine Arts has named Layla Bermeo as its next John Moors Cabot Chair for the Art of the Americas.

Bermeo, currently a curator of paintings in the Art of the Americas department, takes over from Ethan Lasser, now the MFA's chief of curatorial affairs and conservation. She begins her new role on Nov. 2.

"Layla's vision, scholarship, and dedication to community-centered storytelling make her the perfect leader for our Art of the Americas department," MFA director Pierre Terjanian said in a statement.

Bermeo, who arrived at the MFA as an assistant curator in 2016, organized the museum's first Frida Kahlo exhibition and has been a driving force behind some important recent acquisitions, including a painting by surrealist Remedios Varo.

As head of the Art of the Americas department, she will oversee a collection of enormous cultural sweep — more than 16,000 objects ranging from Mayan ceramics and pre-Columbian jewelry to paintings by John Singer Sargent and the silverwork of Paul Revere.

"The Art of the Americas department has always been my greatest inspiration for connecting people with art," Bermeo said in a statement. "I am deeply honored to now be in a position to uplift the curatorial team that has long championed underrepresented artists, experimented with displays and storytelling, and strived to serve audiences from all backgrounds."

— *Malcolm Gay*

The art of play on display in Ryerson exhibit

Playgrounds don't just happen; someone has to design them. For several playgrounds in Cambridge, as well as Boston and Watertown, that someone has been artist Mitch Ryerson. "Joyful Anarchy: Mitch Ryerson — Playgrounds", which celebrates his work, runs at Cambridge Arts' Gallery 344 through Dec. 31. The exhibition includes models, sketches, and full-size playground pieces, at least one of which visitors are encouraged to play on. A reception will be held at the gallery on Monday, from 5 p.m.-7 p.m. Gallery 344, City Hall Annex, 344 Broadway, Cambridge, www.cambridgema.gov/arts/publicart/gallery344

— *Mark Feeney*

A Gottlieb donation for Cape Ann Museum

The Cape Ann Museum's "Avery, Gottlieb & Rothko: By the Sea" has been one of the most popular shows in the museum's history. It closed Sunday. In August, Mark Rothko's son, Christopher, announced the donation to CAM of a watercolor by his father. Last week, the Adolph & Esther Gottlieb Foundation announced the gift of a 1936 oil painting to the museum. "It is fitting that this painting will belong to the community where it was conceived," said Sanford Hirsch, the foundation's executive director. Later this month, the exhibition opens at the Phillips Collection, in Washington, D.C.

— *Mark Feeney*

BSO's free chamber concerts begin this month

The Boston Symphony Orchestra will be presenting 11 free hourlong community chamber concerts at different venues around the Boston metropolitan area this year, continuing its neighborhood series that was established in 1998.

The first concert of the autumn will be on Oct. 25 at La CASA, the new Latino arts and culture center in the South End developed by Inquilinos Boricuas in Acción. Violinists Elita Kang and Lucia Lin, violists Rebecca Gitter and Danny Kim, and cellists Jonah Ellsworth and Owen Young will play music by Dvorak, Brahms, and Libby Larsen.

Across the season, the series will feature 23 BSO players and guests, in venues including churches, schools, public libraries, and cultural centers.

Admission is free, but tickets must be reserved in advance. Seats for all concerts will be available at www.bso.org.

— *A.Z. Madonna*

At the Griffin, offering tender loving photographic care

By Mark Feeney
GLOBE STAFF

WINCHESTER — Four of the five shows currently up at the Griffin Museum of Photography appear under the rubric of "TLC" — meaning tender loving care. The idea is that the photographers display a special degree of concern for or connection to the individuals being photographed.

As organizing principles go that's more than a little porous. Star Montana photographs her family, so TLC certainly applies. It's more tenuous with Harlan Bozeman's photographs of the segregated rural town of Elaine, Ark., Charles H. Lee's of Black cowboys, and Alanna Airitam's of members of a Black motorcycle club. The sympathy they share with their subjects is evident. Also, Airitam's and Lee's nicely complement each other. They're both photographing riders, after all. But what good photographer, unless taking mug shots or covering trials at the Hague, doesn't show at least some sympathy for who she or he is photographing?

"TLC" runs through Oct. 25, as does Lua Kobayashi's installation "The Persistence of Memories."

Montana's "By the rivers, I stood and stared into the sun" includes both family snapshots and her own photographs of her relations. In all of them, there's a consistent sense of warmth and connectedness. That's true even of a photograph of Montana's grandmother's desk and of the two landscapes in the show.

Montana lives in Los Angeles. Bozeman does not live in Elaine (most recent population estimate 419). Instead, he visited there for four years. So he brings an outsider's eye but an insider's sympathy. That's evident in all 16 of the black-and-white photographs in "Out The E." That's true whether they show kids in a playground or a bridge crossing the Mississippi. The images are 20 inches by 25 inches. But none are framed or matted, which helps keep them from seeming imposing.

ALANNA AIRITAM

CHARLES H. LEE

Above: Alanna Airitam, "Boss Mike, Chosen Few Nomad President," 2023.

Left: Charles H. Lee, "So you wanna be a bull rider?," 2025.

The two dozen photographs from Lee's series "Sweat + Dirt" are also unframed and unmatted, adding to the matter-of-fact quality they convey. In one sense, there's nothing new or unusual about Black cowboys. They date back to the Wild West. Which makes Lee's casualness of approach just right. But within each image, there's clearly something special going on: the relationship between human and horse, the commitment of each person to a task as hard and demanding as caring for those creatures. A whole lot more is going on here than just saddles and Stetsons and rodeos.

There's nothing casual about the eight large-scale color photographs from Airitam's "Black Diamonds" project. She poses members of the Chosen Few motorcycle club against a painted landscape backdrop. The backdrop evokes the open road; and the Chosen Few members command the setting as assuredly, if not as loudly, as their bikes hold the road. "Boss Mike," which shows the club's president, is so dominating an image — it's 40 inches by 60 inches, and size may be the least of it — it's a wonder he isn't emperor.

Lua Kobayashi's "The Persistence of Memories" is a video installation, projected on three walls, lasting eight minutes. It was inspired by interviews Kobayashi conducted last year with Boston-area residents of Japanese descent. She asked them about family histories and their thoughts on being Japanese American today.

The video shows items of personal significance that came up in the interviews: a pearl necklace, cutlery, statuary, vegetation. The one that stands out is of a guard tower, recalling the moral disgrace of Japanese internment during World War II. (Making it all the more disgraceful was that it wasn't "criminal," the Supreme Court managing to rule it legal.) The effect of the installation is of a dreamscape, assuming a dreamscape can also be an indictment.

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PHOTOGRAPHY REVIEW

TLC
Star Montana: By the rivers, I stood and stared into the sun
Harlan Bozeman: Out The E
Charles H. Lee: Sweat + Dirt
Alanna Airitam: Black Diamonds
LUA KOBAYASHI: The Persistence of Memories
At Griffin Museum of Photography. 67 Shore Road, Winchester, through Oct. 25. 781-729-1158, griffinmuseum.org

'Tip Toe' examines a new age of homophobia

▶"TIP TOE"
Continued from Page G1

frightens him: internet trolls and right wing culture warriors conflating homosexuality and pedophilia, and men and women — including his best friend, Stephanie (Elizabeth Berrington) — dismissing trans rights.

But Leo's primary antagonist lives right next door to him, their townhouses separated by just a few feet. Clive Goss (David Morrissey, every bit Cumming's equal here) is a bundle of blue-collar resentment, a morose, underemployed electrician with two sons: George (Jackson Connor), a closeted 16-year-old, and Saul (Joseph Evans), a 25-year-old hetero beefcake who bares all on OnlyFans. A random mishap brings Leo and Clive together, and even as Leo hires his neighbor to do electrical work at the bar, we know things are going to end very, very badly. To Clive, gay and trans people are part of the vast conspiracy keeping people like him down. Once Leo tries to befriend George — he remembers what it was like to be a closeted teen — Clive grows increasingly unstable.

"Tip Toe," which premiered in the UK earlier this year, occasionally lapses into speechifying; it's a show with something to say, and it makes sure you get the point. But both of the main characters are carefully written and acted with fierce intelligence. Leo is a little full of himself, and he seems to know it; Clive never feels like a straw man villain, largely because Morrissey won't let that happen. Rigid and weary, he needs something, somebody, to be a scapegoat, and as he tells Leo, "You lot" must be responsible for everything bad. Morrissey brings to mind Chris Cooper, an actor who excels at bringing repressed and angry figures to life.

But Leo is angry too — angry at the homophobia he's been fighting his whole life, angry at the abuse his employees and patrons take, and angry at this neighbor who thinks he knows all about him. At times "Tip Toe" plays like a British version of "Beef," a high-stakes power struggle, except the deck is stacked high against Leo and his "lot." Even when we have some idea of how it will all end, the climax is shocking, escalating from razzing to accusation to primal mob violence. The series has been building toward this denouement, and as it unfolds, several previous conversations and confrontations come into sharp relief.

Starz has never really developed a firm identity in this streaming-dominated age, but this is its second high-quality British import of the year, following the premiere of "The Listeners" in June. Like that series, "Tip Toe" unfolds over a brisk five episodes, showing once again that British TV creators, in this case Russell T. Davies, know how to make the most of the less-is-more model of TV storytelling. (See also Apple TV's "Slow Horses," which runs through tightly-told six-episode seasons with no letup in quality.) "Tip Toe" comes to us from the UK, but you'd have to bury your head in the sand to miss its relevance on these shores. Kudos to Starz for bringing it to the US, where it deserves to find a robust audience.

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TELEVISION REVIEW

TIP TOE
Starring Alan Cumming, David Morrissey, Stephanie Berrington, Iz Hesketh, Jackson Connor, Paul Rhys, Pooky Quesnel, Joseph Evans, Luyanda Unati Lewis-Nyawo, and Gabriel Clark. First episode premieres Oct. 2 on Starz; subsequent episodes premiere Fridays through Oct. 30.

An offline dating trend is emerging in the city

▶DATING
Continued from Page G1

country, similar events and services have suddenly taken off. And the owners of Stoop Dating and STAG say their recent events have attracted up to 800 people looking for an in-person connection.

But they need some encouragement.

Stoop Dating and STAG Boston are introducing this new form of blind dating to Boston, creating what they say are easy and open environments for people to meet potential love interests without the stress.

Stoop Dating, created by Julz Radley, and STAG Boston, created by Krissy Bets, are different entities, but they come together to plan these dating events.

Stoop Dating, a social media page started by Radley, works as a pseudo-dating site. Participants sign up for a date, then Radley pairs them up and joins them on a first date to help break the ice. And yes, that date takes place on a stoop — an idea that came to Radley after she moved to South Boston and saw that one way people naturally met was while sitting on a front stoop.

STAG Boston, run by Bets, puts on social events around the city exclusively for singles. Bets started STAG after documenting her own dating experiences in Boston on social media.

After she started to host dating events, Bets saw how much people enjoyed mingling without the added stress of approaching someone at a bar or going on a first date from a dating app.

Now, the two are joining forces and planning the dating events together.

"People are over the dating apps," Bets said. "On top of that, it's really hard to approach people at a bar in person and meet people in person because you don't know if they're single. You don't know if they're interested."

Unlike a regular date, you can expect yard games, conversation starters, and other activities at a STAG event to keep the energy casual and low-stress.

After the night ends, attendees can fill out a questionnaire indicating who they are interested in getting to know better, so they don't have to deal with the usual logistics of swiping left or right or getting ghosted on Hinge — or risk rejection.

At these events, Bets said, "You know everybody's single, and then it takes away the pressure of having to be like, 'Hey, are you interested? Can I give you my number?'"

It's no secret that the younger generation is frustrated with the dating scene, but some say dating in Boston is especially difficult.

Fair warning, however: The events are fairly exclusive. Radley and Bets sift through hundreds of applicants; after some are selected, they purchase a ticket, and the hunt for love begins. (Tickets for the STAG Cisco event were $40.)

KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

From left: Julz Radley, creator of Stoop Dating, and Krissy Bets, creator of STAG Boston, spoke to singles gathered at an event in August.

But that's not the only way Radley and Bets support their initiatives. As TikTok dating aficionados, they also make their money through brand deals and sponsorships.

"It's awful," Emma DeJesus of Somerville said. "I feel like nobody is ready to commit. That's what I hear the most, 'You're great, but I'm not looking for anything serious.'"

"It's brutal out there," added Emma Rose, 27, who attended the STAG event at Cisco. "It's very superficial. You can just swipe and swipe and swipe and swipe, and these are real people, and you're just swiping away. ... People don't approach anyone anymore."

Many of the attendees came alone, looking for a nice drink and good conversation. While many singles moved around, talking to different potential matches, some hit it off from the start.

Jacob Mulherin, 27, of Marlborough, said he met Courtney Wilson, 32, of Melrose, and immediately hit it off. They stayed attached at the hip the rest of the night.

"I feel like I have a great conversation going right now. That's a success, right?," Mulherin said.

The night also included live stoop dates, minus the stoop. After a date, moderated by Ridley, Theo Cooper, 26, of Natick, and Courtney Chapman, 35, of Somerville, stood with their arms around each other.

"I saw her having a quiet moment, and I thought I should share some positive energy," Cooper said.

"He's a total babe," Chapman said about Cooper after the date.

By the end of the night, the bar looked completely different from how it did when the event began. Everyone seemed to be coupled up, flirting and exchanging information.

‘Digger’ is Tom Cruise’s worst movie

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

Here there be spoilers!

It was rather odd that the first trailer released for “Digger” spent most of its runtime as a sizzle reel for Tom Cruise’s career. As clips of the actor’s biggest hits filled a montage, I questioned why we needed this refresher course in the films of one of the most bankable stars of the last four decades. And then it hit me: it was a pure ego trip. After all, this is a man whose Ethan Hunt, in the recent “Mission: Impossible” movies, had other characters offering speeches about his greatness.

My weary cynicism blinded me to the parallel the “Digger” trailer had to Robin Williams’s 1992 disaster, “Toys.” That Barry Levinson film may have the funniest teaser trailer ever cut — and you don’t see a single frame from the movie. It was just Williams riffing. If you’ve seen “Toys,” you know why Fox didn’t want to show you any clips from the movie, opting instead to sucker you in with Williams’s penchant for hilarious improvisation.

When Warner Bros. offered up a second trailer for “Digger,” it was full of clips. Trailers are marketing devices, which is why I dislike them. So it’s only natural that the studio would want to entice you with a funny joke, a salacious bit of innuendo, or the dangled carrot of “what happens next?” The “Digger” trailer made me ask, “Is this the best two-and-a-half minutes they could carve out of this movie?”

The answer is yes, because there aren’t two-and-a-half minutes of a good movie in this turgid, unfunny, and borderline unwatchable 128-minute mess. The mess isn’t even hot here; it’s as ice cold as the filmmakers think their satire is, and as devastatingly bad as the cataclysmic climate control crisis at the center of its plot.

In fact, this movie is confused about what satire actually is. It can’t tell the difference between the stage play, “Noises Off,” which is a farce, and “Dr. Strangelove: Or How I Learned To Stop Worrying and Love the Bomb,” which is the hilarious and timely satire “Digger” so desperately wants to be.

If you doubt me, know that late in the film, Tom Cruise’s character (who shall remain nameless at this point in my review) actually says, “This isn’t satire, it’s farce!” He then asks, “Why is this funny?,” which led me to write “OK, I’m being trolled” in my notebook. You can find traces of Cruise’s self-deprecating humor if you go back 30 years to “Jerry Maguire” or more recently, to 2008’s “Tropic Thunder,” where Cruise played a character like the one he plays here. But it’s been in short supply since, and it’s clear that director and co-writer Alejandro G. Iñárritu thinks he’s bringing it back.

The script feels as if there was no communication between Iñárritu and the four other credited writers. Even worse, their central conceit is stolen from Preston Sturges’s wonderful 1941 satire, “Sullivan’s Travels.” The big difference is that the great Mr. Sturges had a sense of humor, while Iñárritu has always had absolutely none. His idea of big laughs is having John Goodman’s president of the United States repeatedly scream out “I’ve got cancer in my a—hole!” or reveling in the visual brutality of a raggedy, fake looking cat who is clearly in pain from old age and numerous illnesses, including cancer. Those cancer jokes must have slayed in the writers’ room, folks.

Of course, the poor cat dies. It was the only character worth a damn in this godawful misfire.

I’ve given you enough time to exit this review. As critics, we’re not supposed to reveal spoilery plot points. Mind you, the “twist” in this movie occurs 20 minutes in and changes the entire structure of what happens over the next 108 minutes. Unlike my review for “The Drama,” I refuse to work around the twist here. You were warned.

Turns out “Digger” is the story of the onstage and backstage dramas of a play, one that depicts a real climate-based disaster caused by the world’s most powerful man, Digger Rockwell. An actor in heavy makeup named Curtis (Cruise) plays Digger. I’ve no idea how they expected this concept to work, as this play does not look as if it could possibly be presented on a stage.

What is the point of presenting the movie this way? The backstage shenanigans have no dramatic heft, nor do they contribute anything of worth. A category 6 hurricane, a missing plane, and a lead actor battling the director (Sophie Wilde) are the major elements of the backstage drama, none of which are fleshed out enough for us to care.

However, we do get scenes where people tell Curtis he’s a great actor! The play concept also gives Iñárritu a chance to shoot scenes of audience members giving spirited standing ovations to *his own movie’s plot*.

The story you were sold in ads is a red herring to get you into the theater to hear endless commentary on climate change and how fossil fuel is ruining Earth and will kill us all if we don’t act. Cruise delivered this important message far more effectively when he voiced Captain Planet on that animated series from the 1980s.

I assumed that the play within “Digger,” called “Fossil Fools,” was meant to be dreadful, but we’re told it’s run for 25 years and has been a huge hit. Meanwhile, on “stage,” everyone from Goodman to Riz Ahmed (as an actor playing an abused Indian scientist) screams incessantly and makes endless speeches. As the actor playing Digger’s onstage sister, Sandra Hüller is shockingly bad. Cruise gets to grandstand and overact in downright embarrassing ways, chewing the scenery with impunity. And there’s a lot of scenery for him to chew: This film was shot in VistaVision.

In addition to pointing out in dialogue every possible criticism one could have with the movie, “Digger” distrusts its audience so much that it literally stops for its actors to explain the movie’s themes to you. One of these themes is that people suffering through a global crisis need something to take their minds off their troubles. That something, as Joel McCrea’s character learned in “Sullivan’s Travels,” is a comedy. I bet Iñárritu and Cruise thought they were offering the same option with “Digger.” By comparison, doomscrolling about the world going to hell is a better use of your time than paying to see this movie. You’ll laugh more, for starters.

Editor’s note: Odie has written only nine zero-star reviews in his 20 years as a critic. At the Globe, this marks his fourth.

Odie Henderson is the Boston Globe's film critic.

WARNER BROS. PICTURES

Tom Cruise in “Digger.”

MOVIE REVIEW

ZERO stars
DIGGER
Directed by Alejandro G. Iñárritu. Written by Iñárritu, Sabina Berman, Jez Butterworth, Alexander Dinelaris, Nicolás Giacobone. Starring Tom Cruise, John Goodman, Riz Ahmed, Sandra Hüller, Sophie Wilde. At Coolidge Corner, AMC Boston Common, Landmark Kendall Square, Alamo Drafthouse Seaport, AMC Causeway, suburbs. 129 minutes. R (the characters swear as much as I did watching them)

A war drama that boldy shines a light on gay love and talent

▶"LA BOLA NEGRA"
Continued from Page G1

same time is very uplifting in a weird way, so I’m very excited to see the different reactions, how people really connect with the queer vibe, with the Spanish vibe,” he added.

“La Bola Negra” features three intersecting storylines, with the 1932 portion of the film centering on a young man named Carlos (Milo Quifes) who tries to join a prestigious social club, but faces opposition thanks to town gossip about his rumored homosexuality. The second storyline set during the Spanish Civil War in 1937 follows Sebastián — played by Álvaro Lafuente Calvo, a.k.a. Spanish music superstar Guitarricadelafuente, in his acting debut — another young man struggling with his identity while forced to face the terrors of the battlefield as a reluctant soldier for the fascist side. Amid the barrage of warfare, Sebastián forms an intimate bond with captured prisoner Rafael (Miguel Bernardeau), which sets the course for the rest of their lives.

“It kind of represents the impossibility of those times and the frustration, but also the hope, in a way,” Guitarricadelafuente said of how Sebastián and Rafael form a deep connection during “a time where you cannot show vulnerability, and you cannot show any sign of weakness.”

“They let themselves recognize themselves while the rest of the world is burning down,” he added.

In addition to telling heartbreaking tales about queer love, the film is at times a bloody and violent war story, filled with planes bombing villagers and soldiers fighting on the battlefield. For the filmmakers, it was important that “La Bola Negra” felt epic in scale, something not often seen in LGBTQ+ stories on screen, according to Ambrossi.

“The purpose of this movie is to be big, bold, and go all the way with a big epic war movie, because we don’t have that,” Ambrossi said. “Some people put us in a corner, like, ‘Oh no, LGBTQ+ stories are only for LGBTQ+ people, they are niche,’ and we want to create a big, bold, epic drama for everyone, but with queer characters and with gay love.”

“Gay love is also universal love, and I think that trying to pretend that our stories are niche is saying, in a way, that we are not the same, and we are the same,” he added.

“La Bola Negra” is partly based on the unfinished work of the same name by Federico García Lorca, the famed Spanish poet and playwright, as well as the play “La piedra oscura” by Alberto Conejero, who co-wrote the film with Los Javis. Conejero’s play brought Calvo to tears while reading it during a flight, and mainly informs the Sebastián and Rafael relationship (it also mentions Lorca’s unfinished work, which is what inspired them to explore the writings).

“I started to read it on a plane, and I started to cry suddenly; I didn’t know why, but it touched a wound I didn’t know I had,” Calvo explained. “The civil war was 90 years ago, and we’re talking about the story of our grandparents. So I felt like we had to do something with that.”

“I showed the play to Javi — we saw the play many years ago, and he said, ‘I think you’re right, but maybe we have to make it more complex,’” he added. “In the play they mentioned ‘La Bola Negra,’ the unfinished play of Federico. We started to investigate how the play was gonna be, and we realized it was gonna be his first play about a gay man. So it was like, wow, what a loss, right?”

Lorca’s unfinished play has surprising ties to the film’s 2017 scenes as well, which follows Alberto (Carlos González), a playwright turned historian juggling his research and a strained relationship with his irritable mom (Lola Dueñas). Alberto eventually stumbles upon a surprising secret from his family’s past (González gets to share scenes with New England native Glenn Close, who plays a scholar named Isabelle).

Ambrossi felt that Alberto’s timeline is “the most important part” of the story, as it’s meant to speak to today’s audiences.

“It was very important to make as a question, as creators of the movie, and the question is: Do we pay tribute to the LGBTQ+ people that were killed or that were silenced?” Ambrossi said. “Do we pay tribute for those who fought for our rights? And the answer to me is no.”

“It was very important to intertwine the three stories in order to have a present where the character is free, but he doesn’t know what to do with his freedom,” he added. “We have to honor the past in order to be in a good place with our freedom.”

“This movie also talks about all of these open wounds that this war left for us and that have touched everybody in Spain,” said Guitarricadelafuente, the musician turned first-time actor, who also performs the original song “La nieve” featured in the film.

The cinema newcomer said he met Los Javis in Barcelona one night to discuss the Sebastián role. The filmmakers wanted Guitarricadelafuente for the part as he had “the most beautiful eyes ever” and the musical sensibilities required, as the character plays the trumpet in several scenes, according to Calvo. It was also important for Los Javis to hire a gay performer like Guitarricadelafuente for the role. The directors made a point to use a diverse team both in front of and behind the camera, with Calvo noting the many women and LGBTQ+ people who worked on the film.

“We wanted a gay performer [for Sebastián] because we’re tired of seeing this production that when they get big, they don’t hire queer actors and they hire straight stars,” Calvo said. “I’m not against that. I just think the decision, when you think the movie is big, you can’t have a gay actor, I think it’s because you don’t think gay actors can reach a big audience.”

“It’s a homophobic decision sometimes,” he added, explaining that when he was “a teenage gay actor,” he felt rejection over not landing auditions after he played a gay character on TV. “So I know what I’m talking about. So we needed a gay performer.”

Guitarricadelafuente said he “felt this big responsibility” taking on the role and “was very frightened” since it was his first acting gig, but was put at ease thanks to the confidence Los Javis had in him. He praised costar Penélope Cruz, who plays a performer for the troops named Nené, for her help during their scenes together, calling the experience “a dream come true.”

“She has this super caring personality and this empathetic personality that she helped me so much,” Guitarricadelafuente said. “For Sebastián, she’s like the mother that shows the gateway to the future, and it was something similar with myself.”

Overall, Los Javis hopes the movie can help LGBTQ+ audience members feel seen, as well as break barriers and inspire non-LGBTQ+ viewers to better understand the community.

“Maybe, too, the non-LGBTQ+ people could defend us because they understand us more,” Ambrossi said. “We need allies, and hopefully the movie can reach a lot of people.”

“Godard used to say that the movies of the future will resemble the people who make them,” added Calvo. “I don’t know if this movie looks like us, but it certainly has something from us… from the team and the actors. We really put our souls and our hearts in this.”

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‘Verity’ thrives on its soapy severity

By Odie Henderson
GLOBE STAFF

MOVIE REVIEW

★★½
VERITY
Directed by Michael Showalter. Written by Nick Antosca. Starring Anne Hathaway, Dakota Johnson, Josh Hartnett, Brady Wagner. At AMC Boston Common, Landmark Kendall Square, Alamo Drafthouse Seaport, AMC Causeway, suburbs. 114 minutes. R (sex, bloody violence, Grand Canyon-size plot holes)

Based solely on the movie adaptations I’ve seen, I’ve concluded two things about Colleen Hoover’s novels. One, her soapy plots are so extreme that even I, a lifelong “All My Children” fan and Mary Higgins Clark addict, find them preposterous. And two, the author has a bigger jones for car accidents than the fetishist characters in David Cronenberg’s 1996 movie, “Crash.” The plot of the last movie based on one of her books, March’s “Reminders of Him,” hinges on a fatal car accident. And 2025’s Hoover adaptation, “Regretting You,” also has a car accident woven into its plot.

Not to be outdone, “Verity” has *two* car accidents, one of which involves Verity Crawford (Anne Hathaway, in her fifth movie released this year). Crawford is a best-selling author who writes sicko crime novels from the bad guy’s point of view. This Patricia Highsmith wannabe is first seen in a TV interview with Gayle King, who calls Verity’s career “a miracle built on villains.”

Cut to a nearly empty book event hosted by our narrator, Lowen Ashleigh (Dakota Johnson). She’s a Verity Crawford wannabe whose latest book has so little buzz that an attendee interrupts Lowen’s reading to take a phone call. After the disastrous event, Lowen’s agent calls her with some good news: She’s been asked to meet with the same editor who handles Verity’s books. All she has to do is get to Hachette Publishing’s Manhattan office by 3 p.m.

Lowen’s walking commute is interrupted by, you guessed it, a car accident. In a jump scare so ineptly staged that it should have been reshot, a bike messenger is brutally killed by a vehicle. The man’s blood splatters all over Lowen, and director Michael Showalter’s camera circles her in a dramatic 360-degree spin that clarifies that there’s no way in hell this accident could have happened the way it did. No car goes from 0 to 100 on a New York City street.

Even less believable is Lowen’s reaction. She’s less in shock and more concerned that she can’t attend her important business meeting looking like Carrie White after the prom. To her rescue comes Jeremy (Josh Hartnett), a hunky stranger who takes her to a nearby men’s room so she can clean up and change into his dress shirt. This constitutes their Meet Cute because, as we learn a few minutes later when Lowen arrives at her meeting, Jeremy’s last name is Crawford. He’s Mister Verity, and he has a job for her.

You see, Verity is now comatose and can no longer complete her novels. She can neither move nor speak, and she’s being cared for in her vast mansion located in Middle of Nowhere, Vermont. The publisher wants Lowen to finish the latest book in Verity’s massively successful series of gruesome novels, then write the next two. The public has no idea of Verity’s condition, though they are aware that she was in a boating accident that killed one of her twin children. Verity’s condition may be psychological.

Even though Lowen is skeptical, I can buy that she’d be asked to continue a series under its creator’s name. V.C. Andrews and Robert Ludlum cranked out books long after they were dead. What I don’t completely buy is that city dweller Lowen agrees to live at this shady estate with a strange man she just met, even if she’s getting half a million dollars. Girl, he might kill you!

If you’ve seen any of the thrillers from the 1980s and 1990s like “The Hand that Rocks the Cradle” or “Pacific Heights,” you have an idea what happens next. Verity may or may not be as incapacitated as she appears, and Lowen may or may not be tacky enough to jump Jeremy’s bones and play stepmom to his surviving son, Crew (Brady Wagner).

Additionally, Verity left a memoir manuscript on a thumb drive that Lowen starts reading. The sinister story gives the film’s biggest star something to do besides lay in a bed — after all, they’re paying her the big bucks, so she better appear in some sexy and violent flashbacks. Hathaway is far more adept at manipulative femme fatale activity than Johnson, so Verity’s scenes pull you into the preposterous plot more than Lowen’s present-day actions. Hartnett is just there for the ride, playing the himbo role to the delight of my audience’s female attendees. They reacted the way you hope an audience would at a thriller like this.

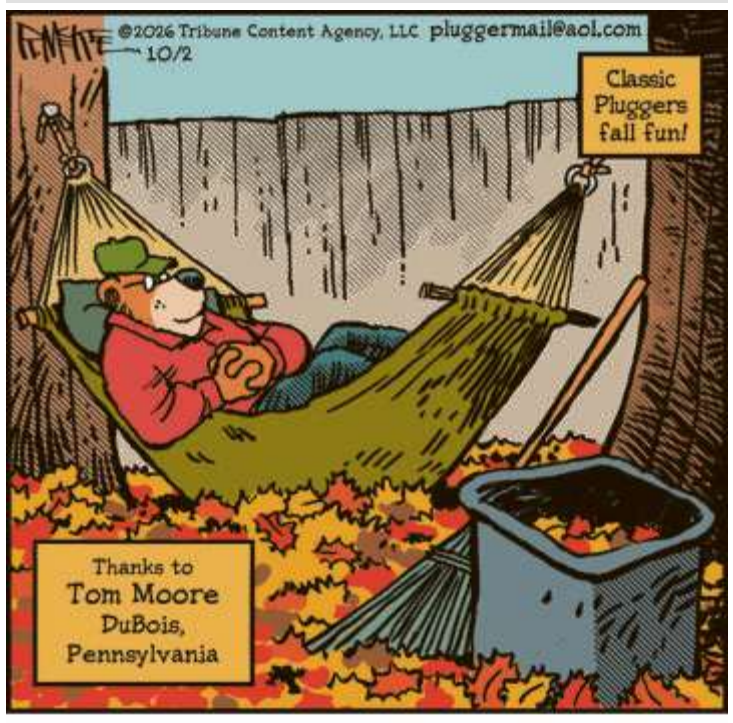
In my one-star review of “Reminders of Him,” I wrote that if “the movie gods are remotely merciful, this horrible adaptation of a 2022 Colleen Hoover novel will top my 10 worst list of 2026.” The gods have no mercy, but they did bless me with an infinitely better Hoover adaptation. In fact, “Verity” would be a total trashy hoot if it weren’t so damn slow-moving. Shave 20 minutes off its nearly two-hour runtime and you’d have a tight and nasty time waster.

No matter. The 2018 novel this is based on was a huge success and, according to the fans I know, it’s the most popular of her books. This one’s for them.

CRABGRASS by Tauhid Bondia

ZITS by Jerry Scott & Jim Borgman

PLUGGERS by Rick McKee

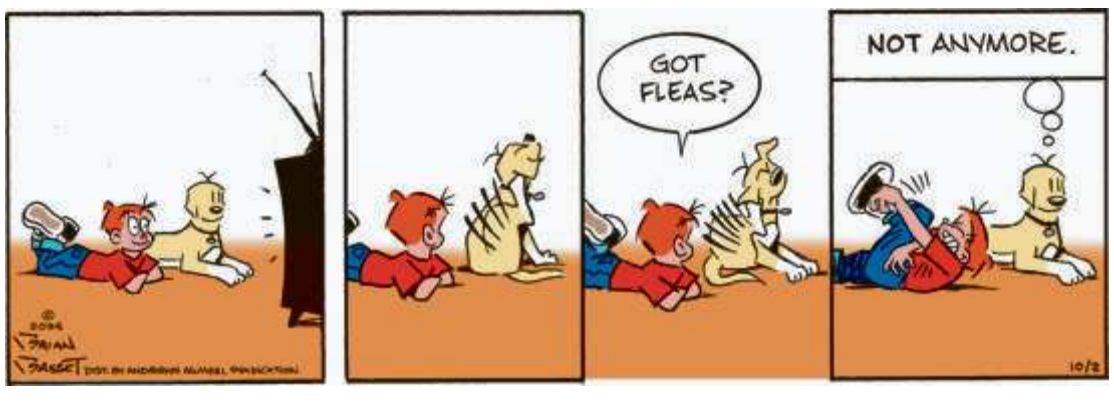


Whenever a plugger feels like raking the leaves, he usually just lies down until the feeling goes away.

DOONESBURY by Garry Trudeau

DUSTIN by Steve Kelley & Jeff Parker

RED & ROVER by Brian Basset



ARCTIC CIRCLE by Alex Hallatt

FOR BETTER OR FOR WORSE by Lynn Johnston

CURTIS by Ray Billingsley

RHYMES WITH ORANGE by Hilary Price

ARLO & JANIS by Jimmy Johnson

UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

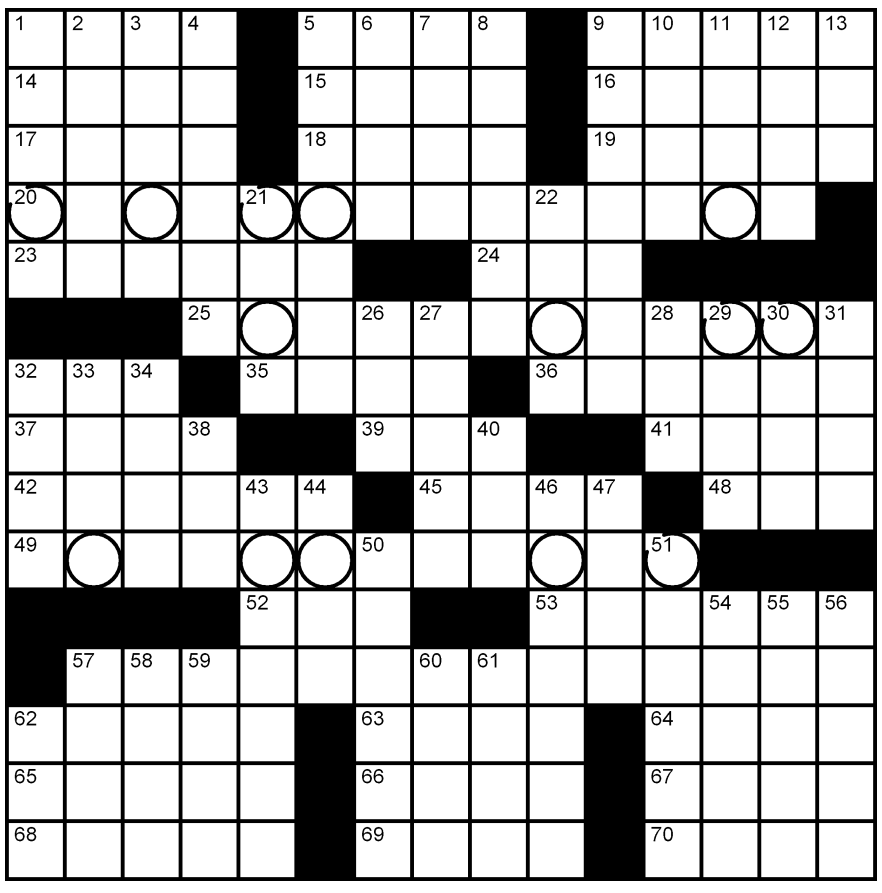
PLAYING TOGETHER BY BETSY OCHESTER AND ANDREW GUTELLE | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

ACROSS

1 A-lister
5 Squandered, as a big lead
9 Beach house elevator?
14 ___ Alto
15 RGB's iconic collar material
16 Ciphers
17 Yard sale disclaimer
18 Name that's one letter short of a zodiac sign
19 Concert venue
20 Movies about rallying together in Louisiana (1989) and Alabama (2014) (In this answer, see letters 1, 3, 5, 6 and 13)
23 Oprah Winfrey, to Maya Angelou
24 34th POTUS
25 Movies about hardships in the Salinas Valley (1992) and at the High School of Performing Arts (1980) (Letters 2, 7, 10 and 11)
32 The "punch" in planter's punch
35 STEM part, for short
36 How birthdays are celebrated
37 Lots and lots
39 Someone the tooth fairy visits
41 1,760 yards
42 Elsa's was made of ice
45 Lark's lair
48 ACT alternative
49 Movies about extended stays at Barton Academy (2023) and Camp Green Lake (2003) (Letters 2, 5, 6, 10 and 12)
52 ___ of the land
53 Bean
57 Events offering two movies for one ... and a theme hint
62 Heart throb?
63 Stand up at the altar
64 "Cool!"
65 Fury
66 Thereabouts
67 Nirvana drummer Grohl
68 Slightest
69 Suds
70 Hook's sidekick

DOWN

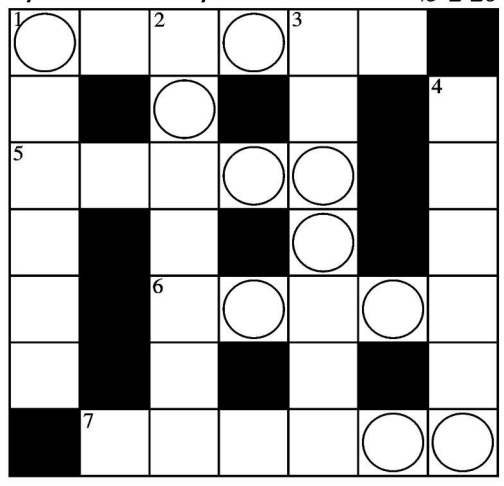
1 Twitch
2 What you do with your buds?
3 ET
4 ___ the occasion (came through)
5 "It's my fault!"
6 Croft of video game fame
7 Vape pen, for short
8 Frankfurter
9 Type of triangle
10 Singer Amos
11 Notion
12 Fish-eye ___
13 SEA scanning group
21 Not right?
22 "Works for me!"
26 ___ factor (gross quality)
27 Khaki cousin
28 Beaver's barrier
29 Alternatives to CT scans
30 "First Lady of Song" Fitzgerald
31 Kremlin refusal
32 Engrossed
33 The Beehive State
34 Burrowing mammal
38 "No thanks"
40 Actor Patel
43 Letterman successor
44 Airline with a Hebrew name
46 One of 100 in Washington
47 Hot to ___
50 Way to handle gray areas?
51 Squeak and squawk
54 Nightmare, for one
55 Depart
56 Cosmetician Lauder
57 ___ buggy
58 Literature Nobelist Tokarczuk
59 Takes advantage of
60 Awesome, to Gen Z
61 Otherwise
62 Friend



JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt®

10-2-26



ACROSS

CLUE	ANSWER
1. Outcome	LRUSTE
5. ____ act	MGAIC
6. ____ Banks	NIERE
7. Jet ____	SRMAET

DOWN

CLUE	ANSWER
1. ____ control	ERTMEO
2. Part	STGMNEE
3. Driver's ____	NEEICLS
4. Art ____	USMUME

CLUE: This person won the 1903 Nobel Prize in Physics and the 1911 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.

BONUS

How to play: Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

ANSWERS: 1A-Result 5A-Magic 6A-Ernie 7A-Stream 1D-Remote 2D-Segment 3D-License 4D-Museum 5D-Marie Curie

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Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

Boston's forecast

AccuWeather. Proven Superior Accuracy™ Get the AccuWeather app

TODAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **80-85** LOW **56-61** Brief showers late this afternoon. Winds WSW 10-20 mph. Brief showers early this evening. Winds NW 8-16 mph.

SATURDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **67-72** LOW **49-54** Mostly sunny, cooler and less humid; a beautiful start to the weekend. Winds NE 7-14 mph. Clear at night. Winds ENE 6-12 mph.

SUNDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **60-65** LOW **53-58** Clouds and sunshine. Winds E 8-16 mph. Mostly cloudy at night. Winds N 6-12 mph.

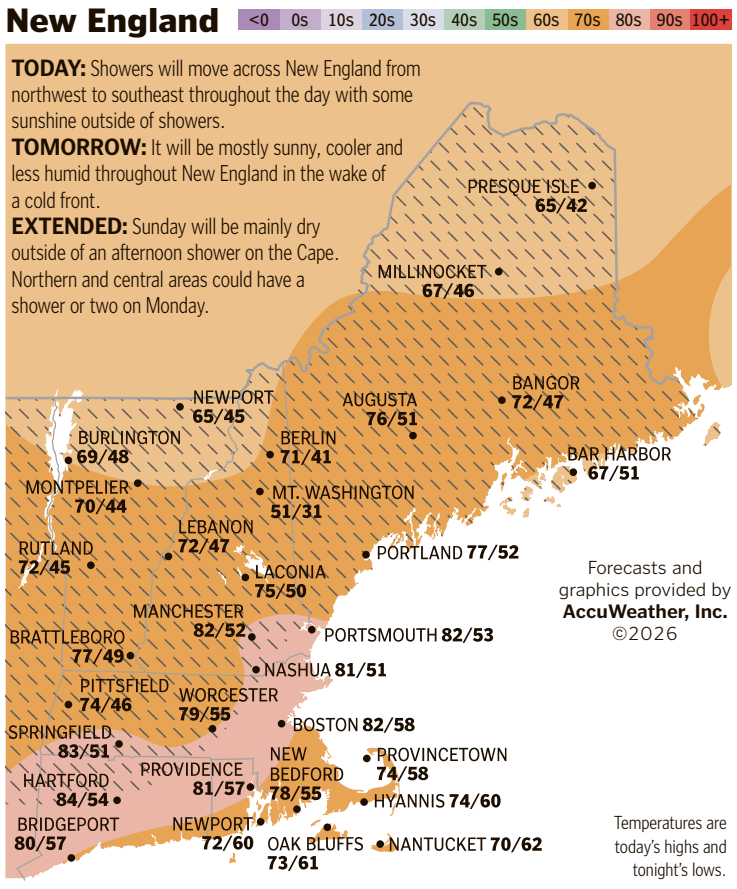
MONDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **67-72** LOW **44-49** Times of clouds and sun. Winds WNW 8-16 mph. Mainly clear at night. Winds WNW 8-16 mph.

TUESDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **57-62** LOW **43-48** Cooler with plenty of sunshine. Winds WNW 10-20 mph. Clear at night. Winds WNW 6-12 mph.

New England

<0 0s 10s 20s 30s 40s 50s 60s 70s 80s 90s 100+

TODAY: Showers will move across New England from northwest to southeast throughout the day with some sunshine outside of showers.
TOMORROW: It will be mostly sunny, cooler and less humid throughout New England in the wake of a cold front.
EXTENDED: Sunday will be mainly dry outside of an afternoon shower on the Cape. Northern and central areas could have a shower or two on Monday.



Forecasts and graphics provided by **AccuWeather, Inc.** ©2026

Temperatures are today's highs and tonight's lows.

Almanac

Yesterday's high/low	79°/59°
Sunrise today	6:42 a.m.
Sunset today	6:24 p.m.
Moonrise today	10:20 p.m.

Mount Washington (5 p.m. yesterday)

Weather	Dense fog
Visibility	1/16 of a mile
Wind	west at 38 m.p.h.
High/low temperature	51/43
Snow depth at 5 p.m.	0.0"

Allergies Source: Asthma & Allergy Affiliates, Inc.

Trees	Weeds	Grass	Mold
Absent	Absent	Absent	N.A.

Yesterday's mold and spore rating.

Eastern Massachusetts air quality
GOOD MOD. UNHEALTHY VERY UNHEALTHY
45 — 50 100 150 200 300

For more information on today's conditions, call the state hotline at (800) 882-1497 or Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection web site www.state.ma.us/DEP

24 Hr. Precipitation (valid at 5 p.m. yesterday)

Yesterday	0.00"	Month to date	0.00"	Year to date	22.94"
Precip days in October	0	Norm. month to date	0.13"	Norm. year to date	31.73"

Climate data are compiled from National Weather Service records and are subject to change or correction.

Tides

	A.M.	P.M.
Boston high	3:50	4:04
Height	9.3	10.6
Boston low	9:52	10:38
Height	0.9	0.1
High tides		
Old Orchard ME	3:37	3:50
Hampton Beach NH	3:51	4:04
Plum Island	4:09	4:27
Ipswich	3:43	3:54

High tides	A.M.	P.M.
Gloucester	3:49	4:05
Marblehead	3:50	4:04
Lynn	3:53	4:05
Scituate	3:53	4:10
Plymouth	4:02	4:21
Cape Cod Canal East	3:43	4:00
Cape Cod Canal West	2:42	
Falmouth	3:34	3:48

High tides	A.M.	P.M.
Hyannis Port	5:07	5:11
Chatham	4:45	4:55
Wellfleet	4:04	4:18
Provincetown	4:00	4:15
Nantucket Harbor	5:09	5:18
Oak Bluffs	4:24	4:51
New Bedford	12:41	1:06
Newport RI	12:25	12:52

New England marine forecast
● Small craft advisory ● Gale warning ● Storm warning

	Wind	Seas	Temp
Boston Harbor	SW 8-16 kts.	1-3 ft.	83/56
● East Cape Cod Canal	SW 10-20 kts.	4-8 ft.	76/59
● Buzzards Bay	SW 8-16 kts.	3-5 ft.	75/59
● Martha's Vineyard	SW 10-20 kts.	2-4 ft.	73/58
Nantucket	SW 12-25 kts.	3-5 ft.	70/59
● Provincetown	S 10-20 kts.	2-4 ft.	73/58

For current Charles River Basin water quality, call (781) 788-0007 or go to http://www.charlesriver.org.

Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions

● Travel delays possible, **C** Clouds, **F** Fog, **H** Haze, **I** Ice, **Pc** Partly Cloudy, **R** Rain, **Sh** Showers, **S** Sun, **Sn** Snow, **Fl** Flurries, **T** Thunderstorms, **W** Windy

	Today		Tomorrow	
● Atlanta	87/70	T	83/71	T
Atlantic City	85/61	Pc	67/57	Pc
Charlotte	89/70	Pc	83/64	T
Chicago	64/51	Pc	68/51	S
● Dallas	79/68	Sh	74/69	Sh
Denver	80/52	S	83/48	S
Detroit	66/47	R	65/47	S
● Fort Myers	89/77	T	89/75	T
● Los Angeles	99/75	S	104/77	S
● Miami	89/80	T	89/79	T
● New Orleans	88/77	T	83/75	T
● New York City	84/60	Pc	70/57	Pc
● Philadelphia	87/61	Sh	72/59	Pc
Phoenix	96/76	S	98/78	S
Salt Lake City	84/61	S	82/59	Pc
San Francisco	77/57	Pc	84/61	Pc
Seattle	70/54	Pc	68/53	S
Washington	88/62	Pc	66/59	Pc
Beijing	75/48	S	73/54	Pc
● Cancun	86/78	R	88/78	T
● Mexico City	75/58	R	75/57	R
Montreal	66/46	Sh	63/44	Pc
Toronto	68/47	R	63/49	S
Vancouver	62/52	Pc	64/51	S
Jerusalem	77/61	Pc	78/59	S
London	71/54	Pc	70/52	Pc
Moscow	55/43	C	52/37	C
Paris	72/52	Pc	72/56	C
Rome	80/60	S	81/59	S
● San Juan	90/79	T	90/79	T
Stockholm	63/49	Pc	61/49	C
● Tokyo	71/64	R	74/62	Pc

SUDOKU

	4		8				3	
		3					7	
		2			1			8
2	3	7		6		9		
		8		9		7	2	3
9			4			8		
	2					6		
	5				6		1	

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART

East dealer — Both sides vulnerable

North
♠ Q 10 9 5
♡ 9 6 3
♢ A Q 10 8
♣ A 6

West
♠ 8 4
♡ J 8 2
♢ 7 5 4 2
♣ J 9 3 2

East
♠ 7 3
♡ A K 10 7 4
♢ K J 3
♣ K 10 4

South
♠ A K J 6 2
♡ Q 5
♢ 9 6
♣ Q 8 7 5

East	South	West	North
1 ♡	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♡
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

Opening lead — ♡ 2

This week's deals (and last week's) have focused on the defenders' play. By counting, thinking logically and applying some principles, anyone can defend well.

Cover the West and South cards; defend as East. Against four spades, your partner leads the deuce of hearts. You take the K-A, but declarer ruffs the third heart. He cashes the A-K of trumps — West follows — and next lets the nine of diamonds ride to your jack.

What do you return?

You seem to be stuck between Scylla and Charybdis: Leading a club from your king is risky, and leading a diamond from your king into dummy's A-Q looks suicidal. (Another heart lead may concede a fatal ruff-sluff.)

Count declarer's tricks. He has five spades and one club, so even if he wins three diamond tricks, he will be a trick short. Lead a diamond. South can take three diamond tricks in dummy, pitching two clubs, but you still get your king of clubs.

This was a tough defensive problem. Did you get it right?

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ Q 10 9 5 ♡ 9 6 3 ♢ A Q 10 8 ♣ A 6. Your partner opens one spade, you respond 2NT as a conventional forcing raise, and he bids three hearts. What do you say?

ANSWER: As part of the structure after your 2NT, partner's bid of a new suit shows a singleton there. You can judge whether you have useful or "wasted' honors opposite his singleton. Since you have no waste in hearts, slam is possible. Cue-bid four clubs.

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Friday, Oct. 2, 2026: You're gregarious, intelligent, and pleasure-loving. You like to inform and guide others. This is a year of building and construction. The structures you build might be internal or external. Simplicity is key. Take charge of your health. Physical exercise will play an important role. Stay grounded and levelheaded.

ARIES *(March 21-April 19)*
This is a creative day for you. Because you're the artisan of the zodiac, tap into your talents and make some art or explore one of your many hobbies. However, avoid intense discussions with partners, spouses, and friends. Keep things light. Tonight: Relax at home.

TAURUS *(April 20-May 20)*
In your heart, you want to be helpful to a family situation or whatever is going on at home because you feel sympathetic. However, conversations with others might be too loaded with emotions, too powerful. Skate through this day by avoiding crazy moments. Tonight: Discussions.

GEMINI *(May 21-June 20)*
Power struggles with romantic partners or your kids are par for the course today. Be patient and cut everyone some slack. You don't have to be right. Things don't have to go your way. Lighten up and be gentle. Tonight: Check your money.

CANCER *(June 21-July 22)*
You're a good saver and generally careful with your money. However, today confusion about your money, your earnings, or even something you own might be at play, which in turn triggers family arguments about shared property and shared costs. Run for cover. Tonight: You win!

LEO *(July 23-Aug. 22)*
Today you're in touch with your muse, which means your imagination is heightened and you might spend time daydreaming. However, you can also do some wonderful artistic work or explore new ideas. Meanwhile, you might have sympathy for someone and do what you can to help them. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

VIRGO *(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)*
Among many things, you are the sign of service, which is why you're willing to help those in need. This quality might arise today if you discover someone who needs your help, perhaps someone behind the scenes. Unfortunately, disputes about money and possessions might also arise. Tricky. Tonight: Be friendly.

LIBRA *(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)*
Avoid power struggles with others, especially romantic partners, your kids, or anyone in the hospitality industry or the entertainment world. You don't like to rock the boat. You like to keep the peace and keep everyone happy. Protect your own peace of mind today. Tonight: You're admired.

SCORPIO *(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)*
Your desire to help a co-worker or pet, or to explore self-help care for yourself might be at odds with someone else's ideas, especially someone at home or within the family. Learn as much as you can so you can arm yourself with information to support your ideas. Tonight: Explore and learn.

SAGITTARIUS *(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)*
This is a romantic and affectionate day for many of you. You also might feel very caring toward children. Even the arts will flourish today. However, an intense encounter with a friend or a member of a group might be a bit overwhelming. Tonight: Check banking and finances.

CAPRICORN *(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)*
You might convince a third party to help you or your family today because you feel concerned. Nevertheless, a conversation with a parent, boss, or someone in authority might be demanding. They might want you to account for yourself. (Yikes.) Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

AQUARIUS *(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)*
Steer clear of controversial topics today. These could quickly become power struggles instead of rational discussions. In either case, you might still pursue your desire to help someone in need because your idealism is aroused. (You always want to save the world before bedtime.) Tonight: Get better organized.

PISCES *(Feb. 19-March 20)*
Even though disputes about shared property or how to share expenses might arise today, you will do your best to be supportive to co-workers and people who want to help you. Explore romance and playful opportunities today. Live it up! Tonight: socialize!

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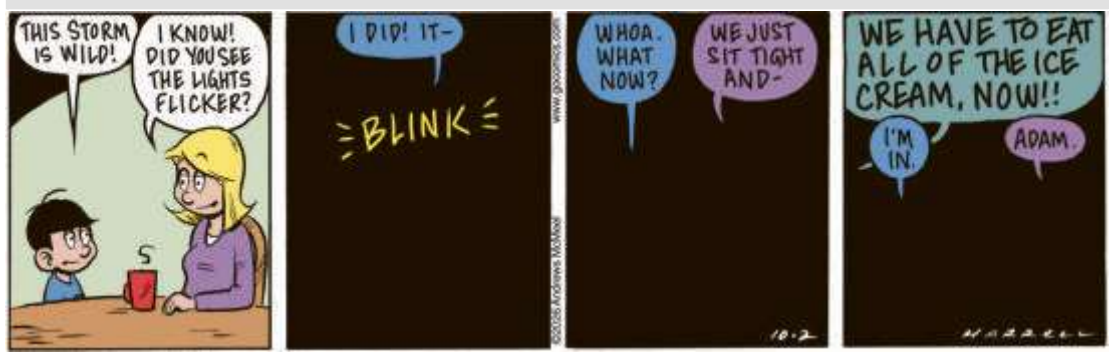
ZIPPY "Comics Noir 1." by Bill Griffith

ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell

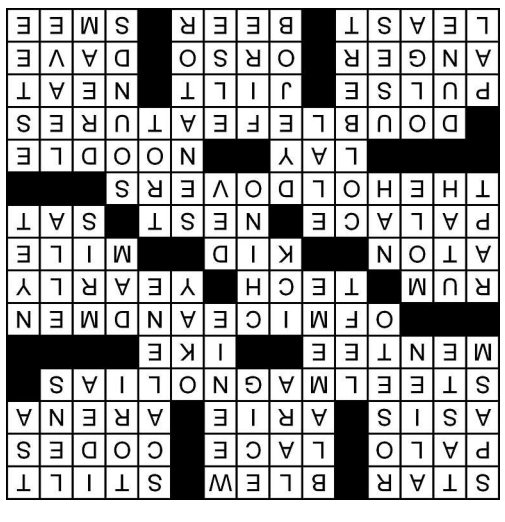


BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro

ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer

MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters

Today's Crossword Solution



Today's Sudoku Solution

6	4	5	8	7	2	1	3	9
1	8	3	6	4	9	2	7	5
7	9	2	3	5	1	4	6	8
2	3	7	5	6	8	9	4	1
4	1	9	2	3	7	5	8	6
5	6	8	1	9	4	7	2	3
9	7	6	4	1	3	8	5	2
3	2	1	7	8	5	6	9	4
8	5	4	9	2	6	3	1	7

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY MATT JUUL

SERGEI BACHLAKOV/DISNEY

Zach Braff and Donald Faison in the revival of "Scrubs." Season 2 is available on Hulu.

'Camp Miasma,' 'Scrubs,' plus more to stream

Spooky season is in full swing, with plenty of horror fare and other new titles now streaming as we kick off the first weekend of October. From Jane Schoenbrun's latest to an animated series with ties to Anthony Bourdain, here's what to watch.

New movies to stream

'Evil Dead Burn' Looking for a good scare this weekend? The "Evil Dead" franchise continues with its latest installment, "Burn," streaming on HBO Max beginning Friday. Directed by Sébastien Vanicek, the Deadites are back to plague new unsuspecting victims, with the flick centering around a woman named Alice (Souheila Yacoub), who looks to her in-laws for comfort after the death of her husband, only to see them transform into chaos-causing demons. *Available on HBO Max*

'The Last First: Winter K2' The dangerous world of mountain climbing takes center stage in the new documentary "The Last First: Winter K2," streaming on Apple TV beginning on Friday. The film follows a treacherous climb of K2 in 2021 by Icelandic mountaineer John Snorri Sigurjónsson alongside Ali and Sajid Sadpara, a Pakistani father-son team. *Available on Apple TV*

New TV to stream

'Get Jiro!' For folks in need of more Bourdain after seeing the "Tony" biopic, the new animated series "Get Jiro!" may help scratch that itch. Premiering on Adult Swim at midnight on Saturday (streaming the next day on HBO Max), the show adapts the acclaimed graphic novel of the same name by Bourdain and Joel Rose. "Get Jiro!" is set in an apocalyptic future where chefs hold all the power, with the titular sushi chef character (voiced by Brian Tee) embarking on a mission of vengeance. *Available on HBO Max beginning Sunday*

Binge-worthy TV pick

'Scrubs' It's rare for shows these days to shoot and release new seasons in a timely manner (we're looking at you, "Wednesday"). Thankfully for "Scrubs" fans, the revival of the hit hospital sitcom is already back with a new season, which debuted this week on ABC and streams on Hulu, coming just months after the season 1 finale in April. Kick back with Zach Braff's J.D., Donald Faison's Turk, and the rest of the Sacred Heart gang with a binge-watch of the revival and the original series, which is streaming on Hulu, too. *Available on Hulu*

Movie night pick

'Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma' Following the success of their 2024 horror hit "I Saw the TV Glow," Schoenbrun returned to the big screen this year with "Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma," streaming on Mubi beginning on Friday. "Hacks" star Hannah Einbinder plays Kris, a filmmaker tasked with rebooting the fictional "Camp Miasma" slasher franchise, who becomes obsessed with getting the actress (Gillian Anderson) who played the original film's final girl to star in her project. "The relationship between Einbinder and Anderson remains believable even as the film flies off the rails in its final act," Globe film critic Odie Henderson wrote in his three-star review. *Available on Mubi*

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

LOVE LETTERS

BY MEREDITH GOLDSTEIN

I don't want to be coupled if I have to give up peace and quiet

Q. My question is about how I start dating after a very long hiatus during which I learned that I love being alone. I live alone. It's just me and my cat up in an apartment in Vermont. I'm in an area where it's not only difficult to date within my demographic of other young queer women, but I also love my alone time.

That may also be the problem. I love sitting at home reading. I don't really go out that much. A lot of my friends don't live near me or in my state. I spend a lot of time talking to them digitally, but I spend the majority of my time by myself. While I'd love to find a partner and spend time with people in a romantic sense, I am worried that it will infringe on my quiet time, which I really appreciate. How do I get myself back out there in a way that preserves my independence, but also doesn't feel like isolation?

Thank you, Meredith.

QUIET

A. 1. Dating platforms are all about digital communication, so getting back out there via app might feel natural to you. What might frustrate others about the experience — the occasional *long* lead-up to in-person quality time — might not bother you at all.

2. You live in the middle of nowhere, right? That builds in some space. Set your geographical boundaries for 60 or 70 miles from home. If your place is in Waitsfield (for anonymity 's sake, I hope I'm not guessing right) and you date someone in Burlington, you *will* get your alone time.

3. Years ago, a friend told me that one of the pleasures of being with her husband was that she could feel alone, even if he was right next to her. She could also feel partnered and entertained, but if she *wanted* to be by herself and read a book, his presence allowed for that. That's one of the reasons she knew he was good for her; she could be introverted in a corner and not have to feel like she was disappointing anyone. He understood her desire for quiet. He liked it, too. They could entertain themselves and then be social when they were ready. You could find someone like that.

By the way, I asked this woman about her marriage because I was worried about my *own* ability to trade love for quiet time. I do believe what she said — and it makes sense. A great partner for you, specifically, will make room for solitude.

I'll add that as much as a wonderful partner might accept quiet, they might also know you well enough to pull you out of your comfort zone on occasion to say, "It's been a lot of 'shhhh' for you. Let's go out together and make some noise."

Noise can be very good, too.

MEREDITH

Meredith is seeking questions about everything from dating and marriage to life after divorce. Scan the QR code to make your anonymous submission.

READERS RESPOND:

You mention "love" regarding being alone four times, and zero times regarding finding a partner. For some reason you are searching for a partner but you aren't being honest (with us and yourself) about *why* you want a partner. Come back when you can give an honest answer. BIGSIGH

Your entire letter emphasizes how great being alone is; the "I want to date" is a mere afterthought buried amongst the pleasures of solitude. Being in a relationship requires the willingness to adapt to someone and incorporate them into your life. I'm not so sure you'd be happy doing that. It sounds more like you'd want to just conjure up a person in the rare instance when you're lonely, then order them to leave when you're through with them. That's not how relationships work. LUPELOVE

Burlington, Vt. seems like it would have some options for you, and it's probably not an insurmountable distance. There is a difference between being alone and being lonely. If you really want to be alone, then go for it, you don't need permission. But if you want a partner you'll need to leave your cocoon at least temporarily.

ASH12345

Send your own relationship and dating questions to loveletters@globe.com. Catch new episodes of Meredith Goldstein's "Love Letters" podcast wherever you listen to podcasts. Column and comments are edited and reprinted from boston.com/loveletters.

Friday October 2, 2026

Movies | Sports

		7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News The	R. Steves	Stories-Stage	My Music With	Hispanic Heritage (N)		VOCES: ASCO -- Without Permission (N)			Aman-pour (N)
4	WBZ CBS	Patriots All Access		Sheriff Country "Mexico"		Fire Country "Try Not to Drown"		Boston Blue "Patrol"		News (N)	(:35) Comics
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	Wheel Gillian Jacobs (N) (SP)		20/20 (N)				NewsCe-nter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live		SNL Kevin Hart; Sia	
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)		7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Wheel (N) (SP)		20/20 (N)				News (N)	J.Kimmel
10	NBC Boston	NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)		Line of Fire "A Bigger Picture"		Dateline NBC (N)				Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon
10	WJAR NBC	News (N) (Live)	Extra (N)	Line of Fire "A Bigger Picture"		Dateline NBC (N)				News (N) (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	R. Steves	Week (N)	Hoover (N)	Hispanic Heritage (N)		VOCES: ASCO -- Without Permission (N)			Aman-pour (N)
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Sheriff Country "Mexico"		Fire Country "Try Not to Drown"		Boston Blue "Patrol"		12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	College Football Penn State at Northwestern New Ryan Field (N) (Live)							News (N) (Live)
27	WUNI	Rosa "Un hermoso lugar para vivir"		Sabor a ti "En busca del secreto" (N)		Tierra de amor y "Favor especial" (N)		Corazón de oro (N)		Noticias Univisión	(:35) Noticiero
36	WSBE PBS	Lively with	Ian Donnis	Treas-ures Insid	Treas-ures Insid	The Forsytes on Masterpiece		Downton Abbey on Masterpiece			
38	WSBK	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	WBZ News 8p (N)		Patriots	Jeopardy!	Perfect (N)	Perfect (N)	Flip Side (N)	Flip Side (N)
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	GBH Rooted	Week (N)	Hoover (N)	Frontline "Scammed" (N)			POV Shorts	PBS News Hour (N)	
50	WWJE	Murder USA		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		The FBI Files	
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Freddie Mercury: The Final Act				7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)		Modern Family	Modern Family
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	College Football Penn State at Northwestern New Ryan Field (N) (Live)							12 News (N)
68	WBPX ION	S.W.A.T. "Vagabundo"		S.W.A.T. "Madrugada"		S.W.A.T. "27 David"		S.W.A.T. "Sentinel"		S.W.A.T. "West Coast Offense"	
	PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax		(6:00) ★★★ Hidden Figures ('16)		(:10) ★★★ Room ('15) Jacob Tremblay, Joan Allen, Brie Larson.				(:05) ★★ Tomb Raider ('18) Dominic West, Walton Goggins, Alicia Vikander.			
Flix		(6:00) ★★ You've Got Mail ('98)		★★★★ When Harry Met Sally... ('89) Billy Crystal.			(:40) ★★★ Basic Instinct ('92) Sharon Stone, George Dzundza, Michael Douglas.				(:50) The Crow
HBO		(6:05) The Royal Tenenbaums (P)		Jaÿ-Z in 8 (N)	(:45) Jaÿ-Z in 8 (N)		(:40) It'	Real Time With Bill Maher (N)		Jaÿ-Z in 8	(:40) Jaÿ-Z in 8
HBO 2		(6:25) ★★ Cocktail ('88) (P)		(:05) Lanterns		War		(:55) Siren: The Voices of Shelley Beattie			(:40) ★★ The Craft
Paramount-Sho		★★★ Troy ('04) Eric Bana, Orlando Bloom, Brad Pitt. (P)					(:45) ★★★ Magic Mike ('12) Alex Pettyfer, Channing Tatum.				(:40) Magic M...
Showtime 2		(6:05) ★★★ Gone Baby Gone ('07)		★★★ Argo ('12) Bryan Cranston, Alan Arkin, Ben Affleck.				★★★ V for Vendetta ('06) Hugo Weaving, Stephen Rea, Natalie Portman. (P)			
Starz!		(:05) Outlander "The Veil of Time"		(:05) Outlander (N)		(:05) Tip Toe "Episode 1" (N) (P)		S.W.A.T. Exiles	(:50) Outlander: Blood of my Blood		(:45) Tip Toe
TMC		(5:45) Terms of Endearment		Daniela Forever ('24) Beatrice Grannò, Aura Garrido, Henry Golding.				★★★ Blue Valentine ('10) Michelle Williams, Faith Wladyka, Ryan Gosling.			
	SPORTS										
CBSSN		College Football Liberty at Delaware From Delaware Stadium in Newark, Del. (N) (Live)							Football (N)	Football (N)	Inside-Football
ESPN		College Football Pittsburgh at Virginia Tech From Lane Stadium in Blacksburg, Va. (N) (Live)						Scoreb-oard (N)	College Football Montana State at Idaho (N) (Live)		
ESPN2		Hoop (N)	Count-down	WNBA Basketball Playoffs: Teams TBA (N) (Live)				NFL Live Marcus Spears		E60 28 Outs: An Imperfect Story	
Fox Sports 1		(6:30) NHRA Drag Racing		UEFA Nations League Soccer France vs. Italy League A, Group 1.				UEFA Nations Bosnia and Herzegovina vs. Sweden League B, Group 4.			
Golf		(5:00) PGA Tour Golf		LPGA Tour Golf Lotte Championship, Second Round (N) (Live)						Central (N) (Live)	
NBA		Boys High School Basketball			WNBA	The Association (N) (Live)				Top 100 Dunks	
NBC Sports		(6:30) Early (N)	Early Edition		Pats Podcast	Quick Slants	Pats Podcast	BST Fridays (N) (Live)		BST Fridays	
NESN		Breakaw..	Bruins	NHL Hockey Boston Bruins at Winnipeg Jets (N)					Bruins	Bruins	Chat (N)
	FAMILY										
Cartoon		Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty	President
Disney		★★ Hocus Pocus ('93) Sarah Jessica Parker, Bette Midler.			(:45) Place	(:15) Ladybug	(:45) Ladybug	(:15) Zombies	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
Encore Family		(6:50) Lena & Snow...		(:20) ★★ I Can Only Imagine 2 ('26)				(:10) ★★★ Bandslam ('09) Aly Michalka.			
Nickelodeon		★★ Hotel Transylvania 2 ('15)				Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.		PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Rubble	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig

News | Specials

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	The First 48 "A Troubled Mind"		The First 48 "Blood Brothers"		The First 48 "Death at the Door"		The First 48 "Chat Trap"		(:05) The First 48 "Sudden Impact"	
AMC	(5:30) Conjuring		★★★ Insidious ('10) Rose Byrne, Patrick Wilson.					★★ Insidious: Chapter 2 ('13)		
Animal Planet	Treehouse Masters		Treehouse Masters "Santa's Workshop"		Treehouse "Wild Butterfly Escape"		Treehouse "Mile-High Mancave"		Treehouse Masters "African Safari Hut"	
BBC America	Law "Vengeance"		Law & Order		Law & Order		Law & Order		Law "Intolerance"	
BET	(6:30) ★★ Fist Fight ('17) Ice Cube, Tracy Morgan, Charlie Day.				★ Blue Streak ('99) Luke Wilson, Peter Greene, Martin Lawrence.					(:35) Martin
Bravo	Below Deck "Man Down!"		Below Deck "The Proposal"		Below Deck		Below Deck		Below Deck "Magic Ashton"	
CMT	(5:00) A League of T...		★★★ A League of Their Own ('92) Geena Davis, Tom Hanks.						Cheers	Cheers
CNN	OutFront (N) (Live)		Cooper 360 (N)		The Source With (N)		CNN NewsNight (N)		Laura (N) (Live)	
Comedy Central	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	South Park	South Park
CSPAN	Ceasefire		C-SPAN Primetime				Ceasefire		C-SPAN Primetime	
CSPAN2	(6:30) Public Affairs		(:20) Public Affairs Events				(:10) Public Affairs Events			
Dest. America	BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters		BBQ Pitmasters	
Discovery	(6:00) Gold Rush (N)		Gold Rush "The Most Gold Wins" (N) (SP)				Gold Rush: "Double Trouble"			
Discovery Life	(6:00) 600-Lb. Life		600-Lb. Life "Lacey and Mercedes"				600-Lb. Life "John and Lonnie"			
E!	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	How I Met	How I Met
Encore	(6:05) Longest Yard		★★ Invincible ('06)			(:45) ★★ Any Given Sunday ('99) Al Pacino. (P)				
Food	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive (N)	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive	Diners, Drive
Fox News	Ingraham (N) (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (N) (Live)		Gutfeld! (N)		Fox News (N) (Live)	
Freeform	Tim Burton's Nightmare Before Christmas				(:55) ★★★ Beetlejuice ('88)				The 700 Club	
FUSE	Jim Morrison's F		Fatal Addiction: Michael Jackson			Stevie Nicks: Wild at Heart			The Love Doctor	
FX	Movie	★★★ The Avengers ('12) Chris Evans, Robert Downey Jr..						★★ Ghostbusters ('16)		
FXM	(:20) ★ Lucy in the Sky ('19) Jon Hamm, Natalie Portman.						★★ Freud's Last Session ('23)			
Hallmark	(6:00) Holiday Touc...		Holiday Touchdown: A Bills Love Story				Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Garage Sale		Emma Fielding Mysteries "Past Malice"				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote	
HGTV	Dream Home	Dream Home	Scariest House in America		Scariest House in America (N)		Roast My "Suites or Sheds!?" (N) (SF)		House Hunters	House Hunters
History	UnBelievbl "Bizarre Innovations"		The UnBelievable With Dan Aykroyd		UnBelievable "Epic Fails" (N) (SP)		(:05) Mysteries (N) (SP)		(:05) UnBelievable "Outlandish Ideas"	
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN	DG2 Fash (N) (Live)		DG2 Fash (N) (Live)		Debbie & Adam's		Debbie (N) (Live)		MarlaWynne (N)	
ID	See No Evil "It Looks Like You"		See No Evil "Remember Me?"		Murder "Murder in Disguise"		Detective "Wolf in the Shadows"		Killer Confessions "True Crime Lies"	
IFC	(6:00) Leprechaun 3		★ Leprechaun 2 ('94) Warwick Davis.				★★ Leprechaun ('93) Warwick Davis.			
Lifetime	NCIS		NCIS "The Curse"		NCIS "High Seas"		(:05) NCIS		(:05) NCIS	
LMN	(6:00) Stepdaughter 2		For Better or Worse ('21) (P)				The Wrong Stepfather ('20) Vivica A. Fox.			
MAGN	Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine	
MSNBC	The Weeknight (N)		All in (N) (Live)		Briefing (N) (Live)		Last Word (N) (Live)		The 11th (N) (Live)	
MTV	★★★ Pitch Perfect ('12) Anna Kendrick.					★★★ Mean Girls ('04) Lindsay Lohan.				
National Geographic	(:05) Lion "Chapter Four: To Be King"		Africa Earth's Wild Home (N) (P)		(:55) Africa Earth's Wild "Jungle" (N)		Africa Earth's Wild Home "Islands" (N)		Africa Earth's Wild Home "Desert" (N)	
NatGeoWild	The Incredible		Africa Ear (N)		(:55) Africa Ear (N)		Africa Ear (N)		Africa Ear (N)	
NECN	Your News (N)		Your News (N)		The Big	YourNews	Your News (N)		Your News (N)	
NewsNation	Vargas Report (N)		Cuomo (N)		On Balance (N)		Katie Pavlich (N)		Jesse Web (N)	
Ovation	Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise		Death in Paradise	
OWN	Put a Ring		Ready (N) (SP)		Iyanla: Inside (N)		Ready to Love		Ready to Love	
Oxygen	Snapped		Prosecuting Evil		Prosecuting Evil		Killer Couples		Killer Couples	
Paramount	(6:00) ★★ Jack Reacher ('12) Tom Cruise.				(:15) ★★ Jack Reacher: Never Go Back ('16) Tom Cruise. (P)					
QVC	JAI (N) (Live)		Minkoff (N) (Live)		Jewelry (N) (Live)		David Markstein Italian Jewelry (N) (Live)			
Science	What on Earth?		What on Earth?		What on Earth?		What on Earth?		What on Earth?	
Sundance	(5:00) Amityvill...		★★ The Haunting in Connecticut ('09) Kyle Gallner, Virginia Madsen.			(:45) ★★ Carrie ('13) Julianne Moore, Judy Greer, Chloë Grace Moretz.				
SyFy	(6:30) ★★ Lisa Frankenstein ('24) (P)				★★★ Don't Breathe ('16) Jane Levy.				The Ark	
TBS	Big Bang	Big Bang	★★ Coming 2 America ('21) (P)				(:20) ★ Blended ('14) Adam Sandler.			
TCM	(6:15) Connection		Lon Chaney: A Thousand Faces			★★★ Man of a Thousand Faces ('57)				Movie
TLC	90 Day Fiancé		90 Day "More to Love: Tell All Part 3" (N)				90 Day	Last Resort		90 Day
TNT	(6:30) NHL Hockey				NHL Hockey St. Louis Blues at Dallas Stars (N) (Live)					
Travel	The Dead Files		The Dead Files		The Dead Files		The Dead Files		The Dead Files	
TruTV	(6:30) NHL Hockey				NHL Hockey St. Louis Blues at Dallas Stars (N) (Live)					
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	CosbySh..
USA	Anna Pigeon "The Death Grin"		WWE Friday Night SmackDown (N) (Live)				Pigeon "Nature vs Nurture" (N)		(:05) The Rainmaker "Episode 7"	
VH-1	Chris	Chris	★ Mr. Deeds ('02) Adam Sandler.				★★ Little Nicky Adam Sandler.			
WE	(6:45) ★★★ 13 Going on 30 ('04)				Relation (N) (P)		Relationship Rehab		Two Weeks Notice	

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; **TV-Y7** For children age 7 and older; **TV-G** General audience; **TV-PG** Parental guidance suggested; **TV-14** May be unsuitable for children under 14; **TV-MA** Mature audience only **Additional symbols: D** Suggestive dialogue; **FV** Fantasy violence; **L** Strong language; **S** Sexual activity; **V** Violence; **HD** High-Definition; **(CC)** Close-Captioned